

Humanities (History & Geography)

Year 8

Cambridge Lower Secondary

Student Manual





Humanities

Year 8

Cambridge Lower Secondary

Student Book · Prime Books

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Civilisations, empires and the medieval world. Twenty-seven chapters in seven parts run from map skills and landforms through Greece, Alexander, Rome and medieval Europe to Renaissance and Atlantic expansion, then return to human geography. Portugal appears inside the global story, never as a chapter of its own. About 238 pages.

Prime Books is the student book series of Prime School.

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Written in British English. Distances are metric, money is in euros and times are given on the 24 hour clock.

This book was written for the pupils of Prime School by the Prime School Humanities Department. Every fact, date and figure in it was checked against a named source before it was printed, and those sources are listed at the back of this book, where you can check them too.

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We extend our sincere appreciation to the Pedagogical Department and the Content Creation Team of Prime School for their invaluable contributions, dedication, and collaborative efforts in making this publication possible.

◆ HOW TO CHECK THIS BOOK

Everything in these pages can be checked, and the book is arranged so that you can.

✓ Every **figure, map, graph and table** carries a number, a title and a caption

saying what to look for. A figure numbered 7.2 is the second figure of unit 7.

✓ Every **date, figure and statistic** was verified against a source before it

was printed, and every source is named in the Sources section at the back.

✓ Every **square code** leads to a checked English-language resource from a

museum, archive, survey or public body. **No code appears twice**, and no institution is used twice. The full web address is printed beside each one, so the page still works without a device. An adult holds the device.

✓ Every **closed question** has an answer at the back. Open questions have

acceptance criteria instead: what a good answer must contain, rather than the words it must use.

If you find something in this book that is wrong, tell your teacher. That is how the next edition gets better, and it is also the habit this subject is trying to teach you.

Introduction

Year 7 asked how human societies became complex civilisations. Year 8 asks a sharper question: **how do states, empires and networks develop?**

You will watch communities become city-states, kingdoms, republics, empires and trading systems. You will keep geography in the same sentence as power: where something happened, why there, and how mountains, rivers and seas priced every choice.

The year runs in seven parts.

Part one builds the tools: maps, landforms, population and trade, with the Mediterranean as a key stage.

Parts two to four run classical history from the Greek world through Alexander to Rome, faith and the transformation of imperial power.

Part five enters the medieval world: Byzantium and Islam, feudal society, towns, crusades, plague and stronger monarchies.

Part six turns to Renaissance learning and Atlantic exploration.

Part seven returns to human geography so you can name borders, economic sectors, cities, development and globalisation with history already in your hands.

Portugal in the global story appears at the end of major history chapters. It is never a separate national history book inside this book. Each panel asks what was happening on the western Atlantic edge, names a key person or place, links geography and global connection, and ends with a key question.

The progression to keep is:

city-state → kingdom → empire → trade network → medieval kingdom → town → stronger monarchy → Renaissance → maritime expansion

That prepares Year 9, where industrialisation, ideologies and world wars build on the same idea: **history happens somewhere**.

What Year 8 asks of you

A good Year 8 answer does more than name facts. It:

- ✓ uses a map skill or place name to support a historical claim
- ✓ ranks causes instead of listing them
- ✓ notices when periods overlap rather than replacing each other overnight
- ✓ treats sources as evidence with origin, purpose, value and limitation

Three habits will carry you through the year:

- ✓ Define the term before you argue with it.
- ✓ Give the evidence, then say what it shows.
- ✓ Put the strongest objection to your own answer, then deal with it.



Figure 0.1 · Maps on the desk, ready for Year 8.

Every claim in this book sits somewhere. Notice how tools, not only stories, open the year: measure place before you argue about power.

How to read a Year 8 page

Start with the enquiry at the top of the chapter. Write a short first answer before you read the account, even if you are unsure. Then read the account properly, not as a hunt for one keyword. When you meet a figure, read the caption first: it tells you what to look for. Only then answer **Your turn**.

A strong notebook habit is three columns:

COLUMN	WHAT YOU WRITE
Term	The definition in your own words
Place	A map link or location that makes the term real
Power	Who gains, who pays, or what choice becomes expensive

Table 0.1

If you can fill those three columns for a topic, you are ready for the enquiry project at the end of the unit. Test yourself: cover the Place column and still explain the term. If you cannot name a place, the idea is still floating. History and geography meet when the word and the map sit in the same sentence.



Figure 0.2 • River valley and higher ground.
Settlement, roads and power often follow water and avoid the steepest slopes. Notice how landscape is already an argument about where people live and fight.

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How to use this book

Every numbered topic follows the same rhythm, so you learn the furniture once.

BEFORE YOU READ	Your first answer to the enquiry, written before teaching changes it.
THE ACCOUNT	The teaching in continuous prose. Read it properly before the tasks.

FIGURES

Clear diagrams and timelines. The caption says what to look for.

QR CODE

One unique extension per chapter. Adult holds the device. URL printed in full. No code and no host is repeated in this book.

YOUR TURN

Practice after the account, not instead of it.

CAREFUL

The common mistake, named in advance.

PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY

What was happening; key person or place; geography; global link; key question.

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

Self-check at the end of the unit.

THE ENQUIRY

The unit project that pulls the chapter together.



Figure 0.3 · A market still busy after empire.

Exchange, towns and routes keep running when rulers change. Notice people and goods meeting: that is the same habit you need when you read a figure, check a source, or test an answer against evidence.

How to use the answers honestly

Closed answers and open acceptance criteria sit at the back. They are useful only after you have tried. Reading them first costs you the only thing they are for: finding the gap while you still remember your thinking.

A practical routine:

- 1 Close the answers section before you start the task.
- 2 Write your best answer in full sentences.
- 3 Only then open the back of the book and mark what you missed.
- 4 Rewrite one improved sentence, not the whole page.

That is how answers become a mirror, not a short cut.



Figure 0.4 • A caravel-type hull for long horizons.

Part six turns to Renaissance learning and maritime expansion. Notice the ship as technology and as a new map of the world, not only as decoration on the page.

Year at a glance

PART	CHAPTERS	FOCUS
1	1-4	Maps, landforms, people, trade
2	5-7	Ancient Greece
3	8	Alexander and the Hellenistic world
4	9-13	Rome from rise to transformation
5	14-20	Medieval Europe and connections
6	21-22	Renaissance and maritime expansion
7	23-27	Human geography and synthesis

Table 0.2 · The seven parts of Year 8.
Use this as a map of the year, not as a substitute for the full contents.

Keep one thread through every part: **place prices power**. Mountains, rivers, seas and routes do not decide history alone, but they change what every ruler, trader and migrant must pay in time, risk and food.



Figure 0.5 · Harbour, ships and market colour.
Trade and towns keep connecting people even when empires change name. Notice goods and water together: that link returns from the Mediterranean to the Atlantic chapters.

When you finish a chapter, return to this table and tick the part you have just studied. Ask: which place-name did I learn, which route mattered, and who held power there? That habit joins the seven parts into one year story instead of twenty-seven separate folders. Roads, harbours and valleys in the figures above are not decoration: they are the same kinds of place you will measure in every later unit.

PART ONE

Geographical thinking

Before the story of states and empires, you need the tools and the ground. These four chapters teach maps, landforms, people and trade so that every later place-name can be found, measured and questioned.

Start here when a later chapter names a coast, a pass or a harbour. Part one is not a warm-up you can skip: it is the skill set that turns place-names into evidence about power.

Units 1 to 4 run map skills, physical landforms, population and trade routes. Keep the thread: geography prices choices; people still choose.

Geographical thinking

Four chapters, and the question each one answers. Use this page as a map of the part: read the enquiry for the unit you are about to start, then turn the page into the opener.

Unit 1

Maps and geographical skills

How do different maps and skills help us ask better questions about the past?

Unit 2

Landforms and human settlement

How do landforms shape where people settle and how power works?

Unit 3

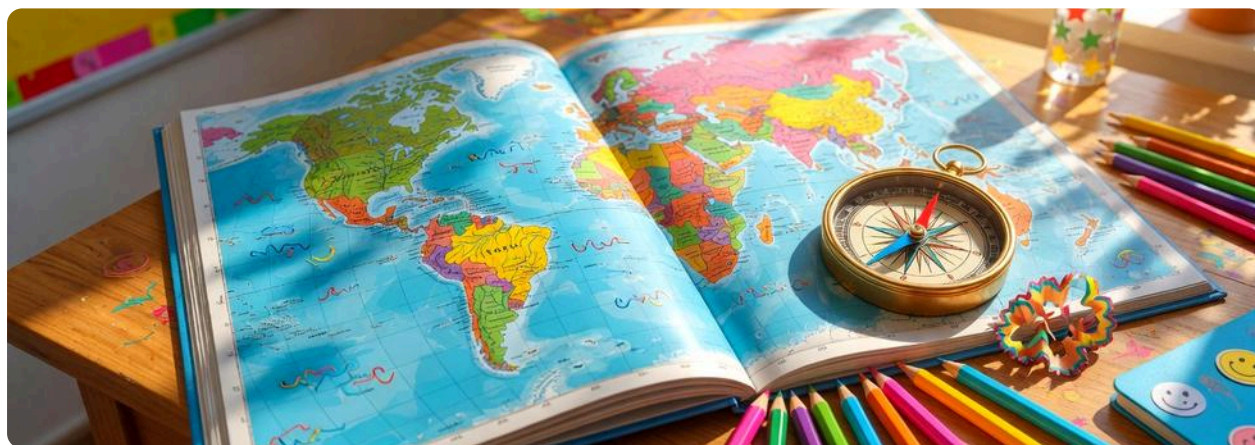
Population, migration and settlement

Why do people live where they live, and why do they move?

Unit 4

Trade, transport and connection

Why do societies trade, and which routes shape power?



Geographical thinking. Look for place and movement in the image, then name which unit enquiry it helps you answer first.

Revision tip: cover the enquiry column and say each unit title in order. Then uncover and check you still know the question each chapter is for.

PART ONE • UNIT 1

1

Maps and geographical skills

How do different maps and skills help us ask better questions about the past?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Distinguish physical, political, topographic, thematic and historical maps.
- ✓ Use compass directions and scale with confidence.
- ✓ Locate key places with latitude and longitude.
- ✓ Read simple contours and explain what GIS layers can show.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How do different maps and skills help us ask better questions about the past?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 1.1

Types of maps

The account

A **map** is a drawn or printed picture of a place that shows selected features, not a perfect photograph of the whole world. Map-makers decide what to show and what to leave out. That is why the same coastline can look different on two maps: one might colour the mountains, another might draw borders and capital cities. Your first skill is to notice that choice and match it to your question.



Figure 1.1 · Maps on a learning desk.

Colourful map sheets and tools spread on a desk. Notice how different sheets show landforms, borders or routes; each answers a different question about the past.

Define five common types, then use them. A **physical map** shows landforms and water: hills, rivers, seas and deserts. A **political map** shows borders, countries and capital cities. A **topographic map** adds **elevation** (how high the land is above sea level) so you can see steep slopes and valleys. A **thematic map** highlights one theme, such as trade routes, population density or battle sites. A **historical map** shows how control of land changed over time, for example who ruled the Mediterranean in different centuries.

Step by step: (1) write your historical question in one sentence; (2) name the feature you need (height, border, route, density, past control); (3) open the map type that shows that feature; (4) read the key before you argue. Skipping the key is like reading a story with the names blacked out.

Everyday example: you plan a walk from your home to school. A map of bus routes helps if you take the bus; a map of hills helps if you cycle; a street map helps if you walk. History works the same way. If you ask how steep a castle site is, a political map will disappoint you. If you ask who ruled a coast in 1200, a physical map will not answer.

Year 8 examples: for Athens and the Aegean islands, a physical map shows why sea links mattered more than land roads. For Rome's empire, a historical map of provinces shows change over centuries that a modern political map cannot. For Lisbon on the Tagus, a thematic map of harbours and trade routes explains why a river mouth city punched above its size.

Worked example: your question is "Why did so many Mediterranean cities grow near water?" Open a physical map of the Mediterranean. Mark Athens, Rome, Carthage and Alexandria. Notice coasts and harbours. A political map of today's countries would hide the shared basin. Conclusion: the right map type turns place-names into evidence.

	What the map shows	Best question for it
Physical	Landforms, rivers, coasts.	What is the landscape like?
Political	Countries and borders.	Who claims this land?
Topographic	Elevation and slopes.	How steep is the ground?
Thematic	One theme, e.g. trade.	Where is this pattern strongest?
Historical	Past territories.	How did control change?

Figure 1.2 · Five map types matched to questions.

Compare each row: the left column names what the map shows; the right column names the best historical question for that map. Use it before you open any atlas page.

Why it matters: every empire claim and every battle story sits on a landscape. The right map type turns place-names into evidence instead of decoration. A weak historian waves at a wall map and hopes. A careful historian says, "This question needs elevation," or "This question needs borders in the year 1000."

Link to the next idea: once you know *what kind* of map you need, you still have to describe *where* things lie. That is why the next topic teaches compass directions so your sentences point clearly on the page.

**LOOK FURTHER**

Ordnance Survey Mapzone. Practise map types, symbols and scale with school-level tools.

www.ordnancesurvey.co.uk/mapzone

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define physical map and political map in your own words, then give one historical question each type answers well.
- 2 You are studying why ships used Lisbon's river mouth. Which map type would you open first, and why?
- 3 A friend says a map is "just a photo of the world." Explain why that claim is wrong, using one example from this topic.

◆ CAREFUL

A map is an argument about what matters, not a neutral photo. Always match map type to question before you claim evidence.

TOPIC 1.2

Compass directions

The account

North, south, east and west are the four main **cardinal directions**: the principal points on a compass used to describe where things lie. Between them sit four **intermediate directions**: north-east, south-east, south-west and north-west. Together they let you describe movement without waving your hands or saying "over there". A **compass rose** is the star-shaped diagram on a map that shows these directions so everyone reads the sheet the same way.

Define the skill in one line: direction is a shared language for location and movement. How it works: (1) find the compass rose or north arrow on your map; (2) face the same way the map assumes north; (3) name the direction of a place relative to another place; (4) if the path is not straight north or east, use an intermediate direction. Most school maps put north at the top, but check every time. A rotated image without a rose can trick you.

Everyday example: "The sports hall is north of the canteen" is clearer than "the sports hall is that way." History needs the same precision. Armies expand **northward**; fleets sail **south-east** toward islands; migrants move **west** along a coast looking for farmland. If you only say "the Romans went out", the story stays vague. If you say "Rome pushed west across the Italian peninsula and later south into North Africa", a listener can follow the path on a map.

Year 8 places to practise: from Lisbon, the Atlantic opens west and south-west; Madrid lies roughly east; the Mediterranean coast of Spain lies south-east. From Athens, Egypt lies roughly south-east across the sea; the Black Sea lies north-east for many grain routes. From Rome, the Alps lie roughly north; Sicily lies south. Precision is not pedantry: it is the difference between a claim you can test and a claim you can only wave at.

	Cardinal	Intermediate
Main four	N, S, E, W	NE, NW, SE, SW
Use	Armies, coasts, maps	Routes that are not straight
Example	North of the Alps	South-east toward Asia Minor

Figure 1.3 · Cardinal and intermediate directions.
Use the left column for the main four points and the right for the in-between points. Practise naming a route from Athens toward Egypt before you write your next history sentence.

Worked example: "Greek colonists settled in southern Italy and Sicily." Rewrite with directions: "From the Aegean, many Greek settlers sailed **west** and **south-west** to southern Italy and Sicily." Now open a physical map and check: the sea is the highway; the direction names match the coast they reached. That sentence is now evidence-ready.

Why it matters: states and empires expand in directions, not in vague "outward" clouds. Clear direction language lets you track power across the Mediterranean and later across the Atlantic from Iberian ports.

Bridge: direction tells you *which way*; scale tells you *how far*. The next topic turns centimetres on paper into kilometres on the ground.



Figure 1.4 • Coastline where direction matters.

Sea routes need clear language for heading and return. Notice how a coast and open water force you to name directions if you want a ship (or an army) to meet a place, not a guess.

Think like a geographer. Pick two Year 8 places (for example Athens and Egypt, or Lisbon and Rome). Write one sentence that uses a cardinal or intermediate direction correctly. Then swap with a partner and check each sentence against a map.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List the four cardinal directions and the four intermediate directions.
- 2 Describe the journey from Athens toward Egypt using two precise directions (for example south-east), and say what map type would support your sentence.
- 3 Why is "they went that way" weaker evidence than "they marched north-east through a mountain pass"?

◆ CAREFUL

Always check the compass rose: north is not "up the page" until the map says so. Wrong orientation makes every direction sentence false.

TOPIC 1.3

Scale

The account

Scale is the relationship between distance on the map and distance on the ground. Without scale, a centimetre on paper could mean a street, a valley or half a continent. That is why empires can look "small" on a classroom wall map even when walking across them took months. Scale restores honesty: it tells you what the paper is claiming about the real world.

Two common tools help. A **linear scale bar** is a drawn line labelled with real distances (for example 0, 10, 20 km). A **ratio scale** such as 1:50 000 means one unit on the map equals 50 000 of the same units on the ground. Both stop you treating a centimetre as a kilometre by accident. A **large-scale map** shows a small area in more detail (useful for a city). A **small-scale map** shows a large area with less detail (useful for a whole empire). The words feel backwards at first: "large scale" means large detail, not large region.

How a calculation works, step by step: (1) measure the straight-line distance on the map in centimetres with a ruler; (2) read what one centimetre stands for on the scale; (3) multiply map centimetres by the ground value per centimetre; (4) ask whether the answer makes sense for walking, sailing or marching. If 1 cm represents 10 km, then 3.5 cm represents 35 km. If 1 cm represents 20 km, then 2.5 cm represents 50 km.

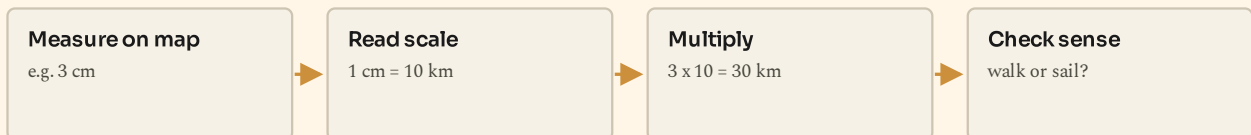


Figure 1.5 • Scale calculation steps.

Follow the four boxes in order: measure, read the scale, multiply, then check whether the distance is walkable or only sailable. Use this whenever a wall map makes places look "close".

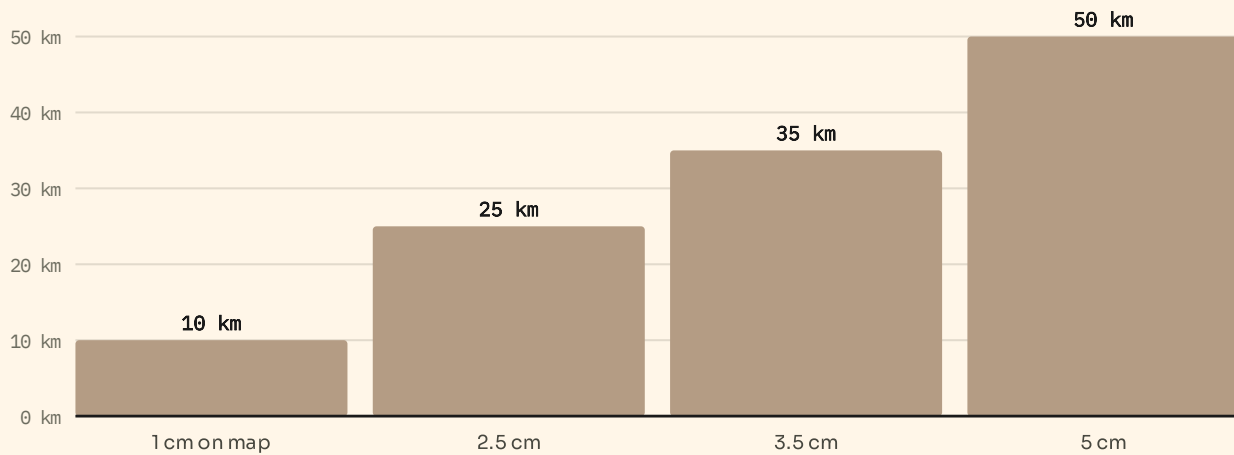


Figure 1.6 · Example distances when 1 cm = 10 km.

Read the bars as worked teaching numbers: 1 cm is 10 km on the ground; 2.5 cm is 25 km; 3.5 cm is 35 km; 5 cm is 50 km. Copy the method, not the exact trip.

Everyday example: a phone map zoomed into your street shows every shop (large scale). Zoomed out to Europe, cities shrink to dots (small scale). Neither is "wrong"; each answers a different need.

History examples: on a small-scale wall map, Athens and Sparta look almost next door. On the ground, the journey crossed rough land and took days. Rome's empire looked tidy on one sheet of paper, yet a messenger from the capital to a distant frontier could travel for weeks. Lisbon and the eastern Mediterranean can sit on one atlas page while still being months of ancient sailing apart.

Worked example: scale bar says 1 cm = 20 km. You measure 4 cm between two coastal towns. Ground distance = $4 \times 20 = 80$ km. At a steady march of about 20 km a day in good conditions (a rough teaching estimate, not a promise), that is about four days, not an afternoon. Now you understand why bulk goods preferred ships when possible.

Why it matters: power networks cost time and food. Scale stops you treating paper nearness as cheap contact. Empires look compact on walls; they felt enormous on foot.

Bridge: scale measures distance; latitude and longitude fix position. Next you learn the global grid that pins places such as Athens, Rome and Lisbon.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define scale, then explain the difference between a linear scale bar and a ratio scale.
- 2 If 1 cm on a map represents 20 km, how far is 2.5 cm on the ground? Show your working.
- 3 Why might two cities look "close" on a wall map yet be expensive to link by land in the ancient world?

◆ CAREFUL

Large-scale means large detail of a small area; small-scale means a large region with less detail. Swap those terms and every homework answer goes wrong.

TOPIC 1.4

Latitude and longitude

The account

Latitude is the measurement of how far north or south a place is from the **Equator**, the imaginary line around the middle of the Earth at 0 degrees. **Longitude** is the measurement of how far east or west a place is from the **Prime Meridian**, the agreed zero line of longitude that runs through Greenwich in London. Together, latitude and longitude fix a point the way a street name and a house number fix a home.

Lines of latitude run east-west and are also called **parallels** because they never meet. Lines of longitude run north-south and meet at the poles; they are also called **meridians**. A place is not "somewhere in Europe" once you can give both numbers. **Hemispheres** (northern, southern, eastern, western) are large regions defined by those lines, not vague cultural labels. Saying "northern hemisphere" is a geographic claim about position relative to the Equator.

How to use the grid, step by step: (1) find the Equator and the Prime Meridian on a globe or atlas; (2) read latitude as degrees north (N) or south (S); (3) read longitude as degrees east (E) or west (W); (4) combine both for a full fix. You do not need full decimal precision in Year 8, but you do need the idea of a unique pair.

	Latitude	Longitude
Runs	East-west, parallel to Equator.	North-south, meet at poles.
Measures	North or south of Equator.	East or west of Prime Meridian.
Key line	Equator = 0 degrees.	Prime Meridian = 0 degrees.
Helps locate	Climate bands and hemispheres.	Time zones and east-west place.

Figure 1.7 · Latitude and longitude compared.

Use the left column for north-south position and the right for east-west position. Notice the zero lines: Equator for latitude, Prime Meridian for longitude.

	Latitude (N-S)	Longitude (E-W)
Zero line	Equator	Prime Meridian (Greenwich)
Tells you	How far from Equator	How far east or west
History link	Climate bands	Time and sea charts
Locate	Athens ~38 N	Lisbon ~9 W

Figure 1.8 · Using the grid with Year 8 places.

Rough teaching positions: Athens is about 38 degrees N; Lisbon is about 9 degrees W. Practise saying whether a place feels more Atlantic or more eastern Mediterranean from its longitude.

Everyday example: a sports stadium address needs street and number. "Near the river" is not enough if three stadiums sit near rivers. Latitude and longitude are the Earth's street-and-number system.

Year 8 places: Athens sits further east beside the Aegean Sea. Rome sits on the Italian peninsula, roughly mid-Mediterranean for classical stories. Lisbon sits on Europe's western edge beside the Atlantic, far west in longitude compared with Athens. Constantinople (today Istanbul) sits where Europe and Asia meet, guarding a strait. Jerusalem sits further south and east relative to Greece. Practise saying each place as "north of the Equator" and roughly "east or west of Greenwich".

Worked example: a pupil writes "Lisbon and Athens are both in Europe so they are in the same place." Challenge that claim. Both are in the northern hemisphere, yes. Longitude differs a lot: Lisbon is Atlantic-west; Athens is eastern Mediterranean. That difference shapes climate feel, trade doors (ocean versus Aegean) and later empire routes. Same continent label, different grid position, different historical opportunities.

Why it matters: states, fleets and merchants need fixable places. Without a shared grid, every journey is guesswork. With it, you can compare Athens, Rome and Lisbon on one system and ask how networks linked them.

Bridge: coordinates pin a point; topography describes the land under your feet at that point. Contours are next.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define latitude and longitude in your own words, and name the zero line for each.
- 2 Name three Year 8 places and say roughly whether each is more Atlantic or more eastern Mediterranean in feel, using longitude as your reason.
- 3 Why are hemispheres geographical regions, not cultural nicknames?

◆ CAREFUL

Latitude is north-south of the Equator; longitude is east-west of the Prime Meridian. Swap them and every coordinate you write is meaningless.

TOPIC 1.5

Topographic maps

The account

A **topographic map** shows the shape of the land, not only its borders. The main tool is the **contour line**: a line that joins points of equal height above sea level. When contour lines sit close together, the slope is **steep**. When they sit far apart, the slope is **gentle**. A closed loop of contours often marks a hill; a V-shape pointing uphill often marks a valley with a stream. Learning to read those patterns is like learning to read a new alphabet for the ground.

How to read contours, step by step: (1) find the contour interval (the height jump between lines, for example 10 m); (2) spot where lines bunch (steep) or spread (gentle); (3) look for closed loops (hilltops or hollows, check the heights); (4) follow V-shapes to guess valleys and possible routes. Always read the key: colours and spot heights support the lines.

	What you see on the map	What it means on the ground
Lines close	Steep slope; hard climb.	Forts often sit above this.
Lines wide	Gentle slope; easier road.	Farms and carts prefer this.
Closed loops	Hill or mountain top.	Watch posts and castles.
V pointing uphill	Valley; often a stream.	Routes and settlement.

Figure 1.9 · Reading contour patterns.

Match what you see on the map (left) with what it means on the ground (right). Close lines mean hard climbs; wide lines mean easier roads; closed loops often mark high ground used for forts.



Figure 1.10 • A green river valley.

Flat land beside water and higher ground beyond. Imagine contour lines tight on the hillsides and wider on the valley floor: that pattern explains why farms and roads follow valleys.

Why does this matter for history? Castles, forts and watch posts often sit on high ground because attackers must climb while defenders look down. Mountain **passes** (natural gaps through ranges) become roads for trade and invasion. Low river valleys attract farms and roads. If you only see a political border drawn as a smooth line, you miss the hills that made the border hard to cross. Topography prices every choice: climb, go around, or stay put.

Everyday example: walking up a steep street in Lisbon after rain, then walking along a flat riverside path. Same city, different effort. Armies, carts and messengers felt those differences every day.

Year 8 examples: Greek mountain ranges cut valleys into separate communities; that steepness helped many poleis stay independent. Thermopylae later shows a narrow coastal pass where contour and coast together make a bottleneck. Roman roads preferred gentler ground where possible because carts and soldiers both pay the climb tax. Iberian ranges and Atlantic coasts later shape how easy inland travel is from ports such as Lisbon.

Worked example: a map shows tight contours around a hill and wide contours along a river. Question: where would a market town grow? Reason: the river flats give water, soil and easier roads; the hill might host a fort above. Conclusion: topography does not force one answer, but it prices the options rulers and settlers face.

Why it matters: power sits on slopes as well as on paper borders. Strategic high ground, passes and valleys return in every unit about war, settlement and empire.

Bridge: paper contours and photos from space both show the ground. GIS layers stack many kinds of information at once. That is the last skill of this unit.



Figure 1.11 • A mountain pass under open sky.

Traders and armies often have only a few corridors through high ground. Notice how the road is forced into a narrow line: that is strategic geography you can read from contours before you open a political map.

Think like a historian. A chronicle says "the pass was held for three days." Using contours, explain why holding a pass can matter more than holding a wide plain of the same size.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What do close contour lines mean, and what do wide ones mean? Define contour line in your answer.
- 2 Give one reason a commander might choose a hilltop site for a fort, using the idea of steep slopes.
- 3 How could a mountain pass help both traders and invaders in the same century?

◆ CAREFUL

Close contours mean steep ground, not "important" ground. Always read height and pattern together before you claim a fort or farm "must" sit somewhere.

TOPIC 1.6

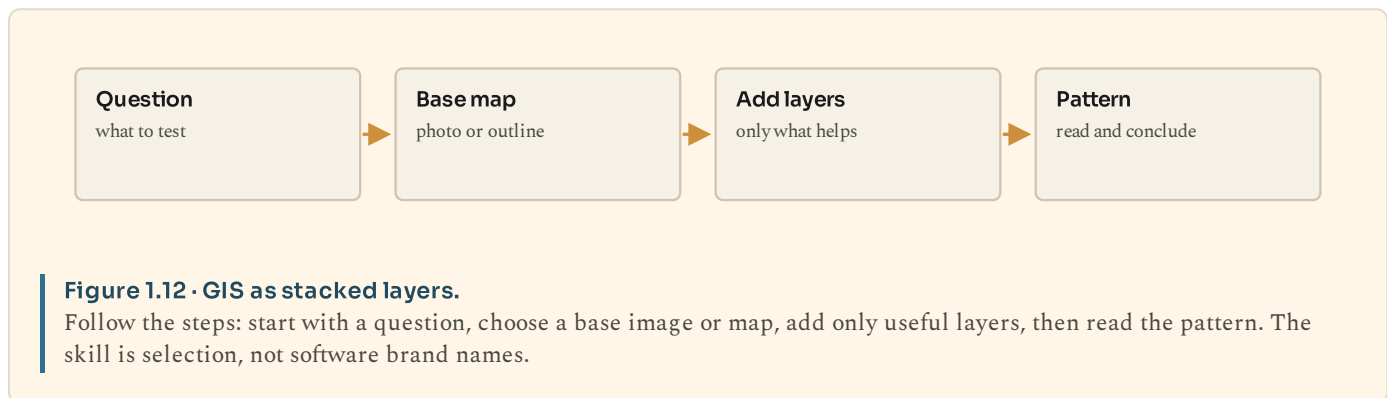
Satellite images and GIS

The account

A **satellite image** is a photograph of the Earth's surface taken from space. It can show rivers, cities, fields and coasts as they look today. **GIS** means **Geographic Information Systems**: computer tools that stack different kinds of information as **layers** on one base map. Roads, rivers, population, elevation, borders and land use can be switched on or off so you can test what matters for a question.

The point is not the brand of software. The point is selection. Just as a paper map chooses what to draw, a GIS user chooses which layers to show. A satellite photo of the Mediterranean coast is powerful, but without labels you may not know which bay was a Roman harbour. Add a layer of ancient ports and another of modern roads, and patterns appear: many old harbours still sit near water, even if the city has grown. Technology multiplies choices; it does not replace thinking.

How a GIS enquiry works, step by step: (1) write a clear question (for example "Do old ports still sit near water?"); (2) choose a base map or satellite image; (3) add only the layers you need (coastline, ancient ports, modern roads); (4) compare patterns; (5) write a conclusion and name what you left out. Leaving layers off is as important as turning layers on. Too many colours create noise, not knowledge.



Everyday example: your school on a digital map. One layer might show buildings, another bus stops, another flood risk. Different layers answer different questions: "Where do I walk?" is not the same as "Where floods?"

History examples: stack Greek poleis on a physical map of mountains and seas, and the separation-and-connection pattern becomes visible. Stack Roman roads on rivers and plains, and you see why some routes worked. Stack medieval trade towns on Mediterranean coasts, and harbours light up. For Lisbon, satellite views of the Tagus estuary still show why a harbour city grew where river meets ocean, even though modern buildings cover ancient quays.

Worked example: question: "Why did Athens become a sea power?" Layers: elevation of Attica, coastline and harbours (including Piraeus), known silver mining area of Laurion, and later alliance lists if available. Pattern: limited inland grain land, good sea access, resources for ships. Conclusion: GIS does not invent the answer, but it organises evidence so the geography of power is hard to ignore.

Why it matters: states, empires and networks leave traces in space. Satellite images and GIS help you test claims about routes, density and coasts with the same discipline as paper maps, only with more switchable layers.

Bridge: you now have map types, direction, scale, coordinates, contours and layers. Unit 2 applies those tools to landforms: mountains, rivers, plains, islands and peninsulas that priced settlement and power.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What does GIS stand for, and what is a map "layer"? Define both clearly.
- 2 Give one advantage of a satellite image and one reason it is not enough on its own for ancient history.
- 3 How is choosing GIS layers similar to choosing a map type? Use one shared example (for example trade or elevation).

◆ CAREFUL

A satellite image shows today's surface; ancient harbours may be buried, silted or rebuilt. Always add historical layers or sources before you claim "what it looked like then".

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

physical map, political map, scale, latitude, longitude, GIS

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How do different maps and skills help us ask better questions about the past?

Make a five-box key that matches each map type to one historical question from this year.

UNIT 1 AT A GLANCE

Maps and geographical skills

Enquiry. How do different maps and skills help us ask better questions about the past?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 1.1 Types of maps
- 1.2 Compass directions
- 1.3 Scale
- 1.4 Latitude and longitude
- 1.5 Topographic maps
- 1.6 Satellite images and GIS

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** priced a choice for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

- physical map
- political map
- scale
- latitude
- longitude
- GIS

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 6 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.

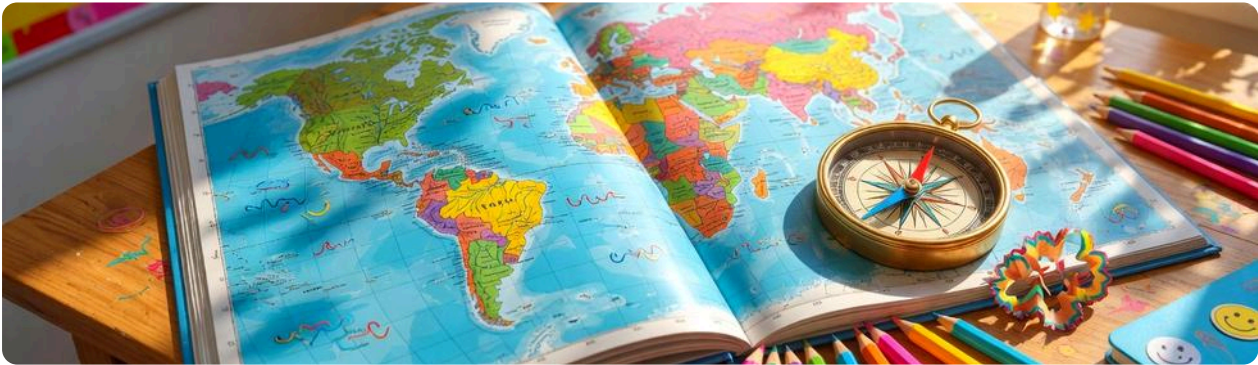


Figure · Unit 1 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?

PART ONE · UNIT 2

2

Landforms and human settlement

How do landforms shape where people settle and how power works?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain advantages and difficulties of mountains, rivers, plains, islands and peninsulas.
- ✓ Define strategic location with historical examples.
- ✓ Link Greek and later Mediterranean history to physical geography.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How do landforms shape where people settle and how power works?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 2.1

Mountains

The account

Mountains are high land that rises steeply above the surrounding country. They can protect, mark borders, store water in snow and ice, and hide minerals such as metals. They can also slow armies, block carts and leave little flat soil for grain. Geography does not "decide" history alone, but mountains change the **price** of every choice: climb, go around, or stay put. That price idea is the key to this whole unit.

How mountains shape settlement, step by step: (1) steep slopes limit large grain fields, so communities often cluster in valleys; (2) height gives watch posts and defensive walls of rock; (3) **passes** (natural gaps through ranges) become the few routes traders and armies must use; (4) winter snow and rockfalls can close those routes, isolating valleys; (5) minerals and summer pasture pull some people uphill for work even when farming is hard.



Figure 2.1 · A green river valley.

Look at the flat land beside the water and the higher ground beyond. Notice why farms and roads often follow valleys while hills slow travel.



Figure 2.2 · A mountain pass under open sky.

A road threads between peaks where armies and traders had little choice of path. Notice how high ground forces movement into a narrow corridor that can be taxed, blocked or defended.

Everyday example: think of a steep hill on the walk to school. On a dry day it is tiring. On a wet day with a heavy bag it is worse. Now imagine moving food, weapons or stone over mountain tracks for days. Rulers who wanted to tax or conquer mountain peoples paid that cost.

Year 8 examples: in Greece, mountain ranges cut communities into valleys. People who lived in one valley often organised their own laws, markets and defence. That pattern helped many **poleis** (city-states: political communities joining a town and its land) stay independent instead of melting into one huge kingdom. Alpine passes later mattered for any power crossing into Italy. Iberian ranges shaped how coastal ports linked (or failed to link) to inland plains. Balkan heights slowed easy unification the same way Greek ridges did.

	Advantage for settlement	Difficulty
Mountains	Defence, borders, minerals, water.	Travel, farming, communication.
Rivers	Water, soil, food, transport.	Flood risk.
Plains	Farming, roads, large armies.	Fewer natural defences.
Islands	Sea trade, fishing, navy.	Isolation if fleets fail.
Peninsulas	Sea on many sides.	Can be cut off by land wars.

Figure 2.3 · Landforms and settlement: advantages and difficulties.
Read each row as a trade-off. For mountains first, name one advantage and one difficulty, then ask how that trade-off might shape a small state's independence.

Worked example: question: "Why did many Greek communities stay separate?" Evidence: ridges divide valleys; passes are few; travel is slow. Reasoning: a king who wants one tax system must police every pass and winter road. Cost is high. Local leaders can defend a valley more cheaply than a distant ruler can control it. Conclusion: mountains do not ban kingdoms forever (Macedon and Rome later prove that), but they raise the price of unity and lower the price of local independence.

Why it matters: mountain patterns explain why some regions stayed split into small states while others could be marched across more easily. Political maps that draw smooth borders through peaks hide the climbs that made those borders hard to police.

Bridge: mountains divide and defend; rivers collect people and goods. The next topic shows how flowing water lowers the cost of farming and bulk transport.



LOOK FURTHER

USGS geology explorer. Clear diagrams of landforms that shape settlement.

www.usgs.gov/science/science-explorer/geology

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

- YOUR TURN**
- 1 Define mountains, then give two advantages and two difficulties of living among them.
 - 2 How did Greek mountains help many poleis stay independent? Use the idea of valleys and passes.
 - 3 Why can the same mountain both protect a community and cut it off from trade?

CAREFUL

Mountains raise the cost of travel and unity; they do not freeze history. People still choose: mine, herd, fortify, or pay the climb tax to trade.

TOPIC 2.2

Rivers

The account

A **river** is fresh water flowing toward a sea, lake or another river. Rivers offer drinking water, fertile silt for farms, fish, transport and trade lines. Before modern roads and railways, moving heavy goods by water was usually cheaper and smoother than hauling them over land by cart or pack animal. That cost difference shaped where cities grew.

How rivers work for settlement, step by step: (1) water supports people and animals daily; (2) floods (when managed or lucky) can leave **silt** that enriches fields; (3) boats move bulk cargo more cheaply than carts on muddy tracks; (4) a **ford** is a shallow place where people can wade or drive animals across; (5) a bridge, ferry or harbour at the right spot can turn a village into a market; (6) a river mouth meeting the sea can become a gateway for ocean and inland trade at once.

Everyday example: imagine bringing sacks of grain from a farm to a market. On a muddy track the cart sticks. On a barge the same load rides more easily if the river allows it. That is why river towns outgrew many dry hill villages.

Year 8 examples: the **Tiber** for Rome is a classic case: a river that linked inland Italy toward the Mediterranean world. **Lisbon** on the **Tagus** grew where a great river meets the Atlantic, useful for inland and ocean links. Egyptian civilisation on the Nile (met later as a comparison) shows how flood plains can feed dense populations. Greek communities with short seasonal streams still used harbours and coastal shipping because inland rivers were not always reliable highways.



Figure 2.4 • Busy market beside exchange routes.

Markets thrived where goods could arrive by water or road. Notice how people cluster where transport lowers cost.

Worked example: a ruler controls a bridge across a navigable river. Merchants must use that bridge or risk a long detour. The ruler taxes cargo. Wealth flows without the ruler growing the grain. Question: is the bridge "just stone"? Answer: no. It is a choke point on a cheaper transport line, so it is political power as well as engineering.

Why it matters: states and empires feed on rivers. Capitals, tax posts and ports sit where water lowers cost. When you meet Rome, Constantinople or Lisbon later, ask first: what water did they use?

Bridge: rivers collect people along lines; plains spread people across wide open land. Next: what flat ground gives, and what it takes away.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List four benefits a river can give a settlement, and define ford in your answer.
- 2 Why was moving bulk goods by water often cheaper than by land in the past?
- 3 Why might a ruler care about controlling a bridge or river mouth more than a distant empty hill?

◆ CAREFUL

Rivers feed and connect, but they also flood and freeze. A gift in summer can be a disaster in a wet year; always weigh risk with advantage.

TOPIC 2.3

Plains

The account

A **plain** is a large area of relatively flat land. Plains favour agriculture because ploughs and irrigation work more easily on gentle ground. Roads can run straighter. Large armies can march and fight with fewer mountain bottlenecks. Those strengths come with a cost: plains leave fewer natural walls. Open land can feed a state and invite invasion in the same century.

How plains shape power, step by step: (1) flat soil supports grain surplus more easily than steep terraces; (2) surplus feeds towns and armies; (3) straight roads and open views speed messengers and cavalry; (4) the same openness removes cliff defences; (5) rulers then invest in forts, ditches, walls, disciplined troops and diplomacy instead of relying on mountains.

Everyday example: compare a flat riverside park with a steep hillside neighbourhood. On the flat ground you can run; on the hill you climb. In history, that difference scales up to harvest wagons and invading horsemen.

Year 8 examples: wide Mediterranean and European plains later supported Roman roads and marching columns. Steppe horsemen (riders from vast grasslands) used open ground for speed in other regions of Eurasian history. Greek communities often lacked huge endless plains of the steppe type; their small valley plains still mattered as precious grain pockets. Iberia's inland plateaus and river plains later fed kingdoms that also needed coastal outlets.

Worked example: year one: rich harvest on a plain strengthens a kingdom's taxes and army. Year two: a neighbour's cavalry uses the same open ground to advance quickly. Question: did the plain "help" or "hurt"? Answer: both. It priced farming and invasion differently from a mountain fortress zone. Defence skills matter more when cliffs are missing.

Why it matters: empires that grow on grain plains look powerful, yet they must spend on human defences. Geography does not remove human skill; it changes which skills matter most.

Bridge: plains open land routes; islands push people toward the sea. Next: water all around, opportunity and trap together.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define plain, then explain why plains are good for farming and for moving large armies.
- 2 How can the same open land both strengthen and endanger a state in the same century?
- 3 Give one everyday comparison that shows why flat ground changes speed of travel.

◆ CAREFUL

Open plains feed surplus and invite attack. Do not call a plain "safe farmland" without asking who else can march across it.

TOPIC 2.4

Islands

The account

An **island** is land completely surrounded by water. Islands push people toward the sea for fishing, harbours, navies and exchange. If the surrounding water is a highway, island communities can become expert sailors and traders. If someone else controls that water, the same island can feel trapped. Water is opportunity and risk at once.

How island life works, step by step: (1) limited farmland and fresh water force careful storage and often food imports; (2) harbours in sheltered bays become the main doors in and out; (3) ships bring fish, trade goods, news and sometimes invaders; (4) storms, pirates and enemy fleets raise risk; (5) a strong navy or friendly sea power can turn isolation into safety; a hostile fleet can turn isolation into a prison.

Everyday example: think of a school trip by ferry to an island. Once the boat leaves, you depend on the schedule and the weather. Ancient islanders lived that dependence every day. They built harbours in sheltered bays, watched the winds and stored food carefully. A bad season at sea could mean hunger even if the island itself was peaceful.

Year 8 examples: **Crete** under the **Minoans** is a classic case of a maritime society: wealth and influence linked to ships and Mediterranean contacts rather than to a huge inland empire. Smaller Aegean islands specialised in harbours, naval bases or stopover points for longer voyages. Sicily and other large Mediterranean islands later became prizes for Greek colonists, Carthaginians and Romans because whoever held them could tax or block sea lanes. Britain as an island (later in European history) shows the same double face: sea defence and sea dependence.



Figure 2.5 • Greek coast and sea.

Rocky shores meet bright water. Island and coastal communities lived by this edge: hard land behind, highway ahead if ships were ready.

Worked example: an island city has excellent sailors but little grain. It trades pottery and oil for Black Sea or Egyptian grain. Question: is the island "rich"? Answer: it can be, while ships and friends work. If war closes the sea, wealth collapses fast. Island power is networked power, not self-sufficient fortress power alone.

Why it matters: island geography trains you to see navies, harbours and grain imports as political tools. States that control seas can chain islands into networks; states that lose the sea lose the chain.

Bridge: islands are fully surrounded; peninsulas are almost surrounded but still joined to a mainland. That land neck changes the game.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define island, then explain how being surrounded by water pushes people toward maritime skills.
- 2 Why can an island be both well connected and easily trapped?
- 3 Give one reason Crete's island geography mattered for Minoan society.

◆ CAREFUL

An island is not automatically safe. Water protects only if friendly ships control it; hostile fleets turn the same water into a wall against you.

TOPIC 2.5

Peninsulas

The account

A **peninsula** is land almost surrounded by water but still joined to a larger landmass by a neck of territory. The Greek, Italian and **Iberian** (Spain and Portugal) peninsulas all wrap large areas of land in sea. That shape encourages coastal trade and naval habits, while mountain spines often run inland. Peninsula states often face two fronts at once: a land frontier where armies can invade, and a sea frontier full of opportunities and threats.

How peninsulas shape strategy, step by step: (1) long coastlines multiply harbours and fishing grounds; (2) sea routes link communities that mountains divide inland; (3) a land neck or mountain spine can still let armies invade from the continental side; (4) rulers must fund both fleets and land forces, or risk losing one frontier; (5) river mouths on peninsulas (Tagus, Tiber) combine inland and ocean doors.

Everyday example: imagine living near Lisbon on the western edge of Iberia. The river and ocean invite ships; the interior hills and plains link you to inland routes. That double face is typical of peninsulas. Power depends on balancing both. A state that only thinks about the sea may lose the land frontier; a state that only thinks about the land may miss the wealth of harbours.

Year 8 examples: Greece's jagged peninsula and islands multiplied harbours and separate poleis. Italy's long boot sits between seas that Romans later treated as their own highway after defeating rivals. Iberia's Atlantic and Mediterranean edges later pulled traders west and south as well as east into the Mediterranean world. Southern Italy and Sicily became Greek colonial zones partly because peninsula-and-island geography offered coastal footholds.

Worked example: compare a pure island kingdom with a peninsula kingdom. The island fears fleets only (plus starvation). The peninsula fears fleets *and* a land army marching down the neck. Question: which is "easier" to defend? Answer: neither always; the tests differ. Peninsula rulers must watch two maps at once.

Why it matters: Year 8's big stories (Greece, Rome, Iberia and Atlantic expansion) sit on peninsulas. Learning the landform once explains repeated patterns of ports, land wars and sea wealth.

Bridge: every landform can hide a special place that matters more than its size: a pass, a strait, a river mouth. That is strategic geography.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define peninsula in one clear sentence, including the idea of a land connection.
- 2 Name three Mediterranean peninsulas and one shared advantage they offer.
- 3 Why might a peninsula state need both an army and a navy?

◆ CAREFUL

Peninsulas offer sea wealth and land danger together. Never describe only the coast or only the land neck; power lives on both.

TOPIC 2.6

Strategic geography

The account

A **strategic location** is a place whose control changes power out of proportion to its size. It might be a port, a river crossing, a mountain pass, an island fortress or a narrow waterway. Holding it can tax trade, block an army or shelter a fleet. Losing it can open a whole region. Not every hill is strategic. The key is the relationship between the place and the routes people must use.

How to test if a place is strategic, step by step: (1) name the route (road, pass, river, strait, sea lane); (2) ask whether travellers *must* use it or can cheaply avoid it; (3) ask what tax, delay or defence the controller gains; (4) ask what happens if the place falls to an enemy; (5) only then call it strategic. A pretty viewpoint fails the test if nobody needs to pass it.

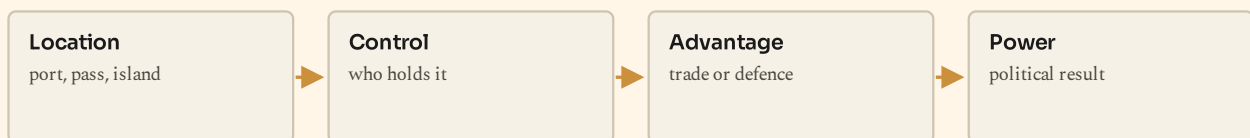


Figure 2.6 · From location to power.

Follow the flow: a special place, who controls it, the advantage gained, then the political result. Use this chain for any pass, port or strait in later units.

Everyday example: think of a single narrow door into a crowded hall. The person who controls the door controls the flow. Strategic geography is that idea written on landscapes.

Year 8 examples: **Thermopylae** in Greece was a narrow coastal pass where a smaller force could delay a larger army. The **Bosphorus** links the Black Sea to the Mediterranean world; whoever watches that strait watches a vital sea gate (later Constantinople). **Gibraltar** guards the entrance between the Atlantic and the Mediterranean. Lisbon's river mouth, where the Tagus meets the Atlantic, later helped a harbour city punch above its weight in trade and navigation. Piraeus mattered to Athens as the harbour door of a naval polis. Different centuries, same idea: choke points and gateways matter.

Worked example: two hills. Hill A sits above the only pass into a valley. Hill B sits in empty high pasture. Both are high. Only Hill A is strategic, because armies and traders must use the pass. A fort on Hill A taxes or blocks traffic. A fort on Hill B watches sheep. Height alone is not strategy; route control is.

Why it matters: empires and city-states compete for choke points as fiercely as for farmland. When you later meet wars, capitals and trade empires, ask which small places made large systems work.

Bridge: landforms and strategic sites explain *where* power can sit. Unit 3 asks *who* lives where, and why people move: population, density, rural and urban life, migration and urbanisation.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define strategic location and give two examples from this topic.
- 2 Why can a small place matter more than a large empty plain for power?
- 3 How does Lisbon's river mouth illustrate strategic geography?

◆ CAREFUL

Strategic means "control changes the wider game", not "looks important on a poster". Always link the place to a route people cannot easily avoid.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

strategic location, polis, peninsula, harbour, pass

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How do landforms shape where people settle and how power works?
Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

PART ONE · UNIT 3

3

Population, migration and settlement

Why do people live where they live, and why do they move?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain density and the factors that shape it.
- ✓ Describe rural and urban settlement types.
- ✓ Use push and pull factors and the village-town-city idea.

BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why do people live where they live, and why do they move?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 3.1

Population distribution

The account

Population distribution means how people are spread across a place. **Density** measures how crowded that spread is: how many people live in a unit of area, for example per square kilometre. **High density** means many people per unit area. **Low density** means few. A map of density is not a moral ranking of regions. It is an argument about opportunity and risk, not about who is "better".

How distribution patterns form, step by step: (1) people need water, food and safety; (2) fertile land, mild climate, jobs and transport pull settlement into some places; (3) deserts, high mountain interiors, marshes and war zones often leave places thin; (4) at a local scale, more people live near a market street than on a steep empty hillside; (5) denser areas can raise larger armies and richer taxes, yet face disease, fire and food stress if harvests fail.



Figure 3.1 · A busy market town.

Crowds, stalls and colour show people clustering where goods change hands. Notice how markets pull settlement into denser places.

	Sparse settlement	Dense settlement
People	Few per square kilometre.	Many per square kilometre.
Land	Mountains, dry steppe, marsh.	River plains, coasts, capitals.
History example	High Alps herding villages.	Rome or Lisbon city cores.
Question	Why so few here?	What made density possible?

Figure 3.2 · Sparse and dense settlement.

Read each row as a contrast: few people versus many, harsh land versus river plains and capitals. Always ask *why* density is high or low, not which place is "better".

Everyday example: a busy metro station at 08:00 compared with a quiet country lane. Both are "places to be", but they support different numbers of people for different reasons.

Year 8 examples: river valleys and Mediterranean coasts often show higher density because farms and harbours support more people. Athens, Rome, Constantinople and Lisbon became dense cores because harbour, river, farmland, walls and trade stacked advantages. High mountain interiors of Greece stayed thinner; that thinness and valley separation link back to Unit 2. A capital on a thin population base must import food and people; a dense river valley can feed power more easily.

Worked example: two regions of equal size. Region A has a navigable river, fertile plains and a port. Region B is high dry plateau with few wells. Question: which can support higher density? Reason: A offers water, food surplus and trade jobs. Conclusion: distribution follows opportunity and risk. If war hits Region A, density can fall fast: high density is strength and strain together.

Why it matters: states, empires and networks grow from where people cluster. Before you argue about who ruled a city, ask what made density possible there.

Bridge: density maps show *where* people are. Most of them, for most of history, lived in the countryside. Rural settlements come next.



LOOK FURTHER

United Nations, **population**. How population is discussed at world scale.

www.un.org/en/global-issues/population

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define high density and low density in your own words, and say what population distribution means.
- 2 Name three factors that can pull people into a place, and one factor that can leave a place thin.
- 3 Why is a density map not a moral ranking of regions?

◆ CAREFUL

High density is not a prize and low density is not a failure. Crowding can mean wealth *or* stress; thin land can mean hardship *or* specialist herding. Always ask why.

TOPIC 3.2

Rural settlements

The account

A **rural settlement** is a countryside community, often a village or a scatter of farms. For most of pre-modern history, most people lived rural lives. They grew grain, kept animals, cut wood and paid rents or taxes to lords, temples or states. Rural does not mean unimportant. Food **surplus** (more food than the farmers need themselves) is what lets towns exist at all. Without surplus, every person must farm, and cities cannot specialise.

How rural patterns work, step by step: (1) families farm land around the settlement; (2) surplus grain, oil, wine or animals move to markets or tax collectors; (3) villages might sit beside a stream, on a hill for defence, or along a road to market; (4) some villages are **nucleated** (houses clustered together); others are **dispersed** (farms spread out); (5) the pattern depends on water, soil, safety and custom; (6) when harvests fail, towns feel hunger too, because urban food comes from rural work.

Everyday example: the difference between buying bread at a bakery and growing the wheat yourself. Rural work is the hidden engine behind every city meal. A king who ignores peasants ignores his own food supply.

Year 8 examples: Greek poleis depended on surrounding farmland as well as harbours; limited valley soil made surplus precious. Roman Italy's countryside fed urban Rome through rents, markets and later grain fleets from overseas when local supply was not enough. Medieval villages across Europe (met later in the book) still produced most food while towns specialised. A village near Lisbon's hinterland that sent produce to the city was linked to urban life even if its streets were muddy and quiet.

Worked example: a polis has fine temples but a failed harvest. Question: can culture feed the city? Answer: no. Without rural surplus or imported grain, workshops empty and armies shrink. Urban fame sits on rural work or on trade that replaces it. Rural and urban are partners, not opposites on a moral scale.

Why it matters: empires tax rural surplus. Population history is not only about cities; it is about the fields that make cities possible.

Bridge: when surplus, safety and specialisation stack, towns and cities grow. Urban settlements concentrate people and skills.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a rural settlement, and why did most people live rurally in the past?
- 2 Explain why food surplus matters for towns. Define surplus in your answer.
- 3 Give one reason a village might sit beside a stream or on a hill.

◆ CAREFUL

Rural is not "backward" and urban is not "advanced" by default. Towns die without food; countryside can be highly skilled. Judge function, not snobbery.

TOPIC 3.3

Urban settlements

The account

An **urban settlement** is a town or city: a place where many people live close together and work is more specialised. Towns and cities concentrate markets, crafts, temples or churches, courts, harbours and later universities. Not everyone farms. Some people bake, weave, metalwork, trade, keep records or serve rulers. Specialisation is the urban difference: more jobs that are not growing food.

How cities work, step by step: (1) people gather where defence, trade or power makes closeness useful; (2) markets regularise exchange; (3) specialists appear because not everyone must farm every day; (4) walls, harbours and roads manage risk and connection; (5) a **capital** is a political choice as well as a geographic one: rulers may pick a site for defence, river access, tradition or to control a frontier.

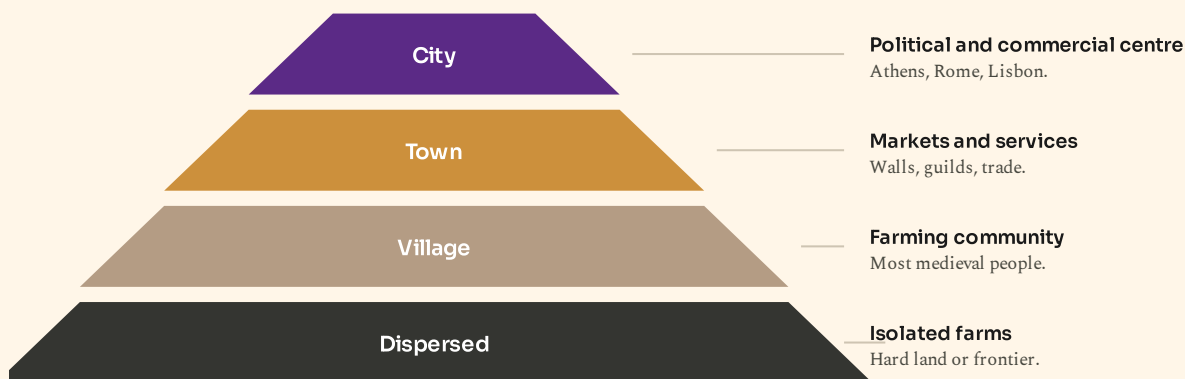


Figure 3.3 · Settlement ladder from dispersed farms to city.

Read from bottom to top: function grows as well as size. A place is more urban when markets, walls, officials and crafts multiply, not only when headcounts rise.

Everyday example: walking through a busy market square feels different from walking through quiet fields. Noise, smell, chance meetings and strangers all increase. That energy is useful for trade and ideas, and risky for disease and riot.

Year 8 examples: **Athens** mixed rocky heights with nearby harbours and sea power. **Rome** sat on hills by the Tiber. **Constantinople** guarded a strategic strait between seas. **Lisbon** grew where a great river meets the Atlantic, useful for inland and ocean links. Location is never only scenery; it is a toolkit for power. Greek poleis, Roman colonies and later medieval towns are all urban experiments with different rules.

Worked example: compare Athens and a small Attic village. Same region, different functions. The village grows olives and grain. Athens hosts assembly debates, workshops, fleets and foreign traders. Question: what makes Athens urban? Answer: concentration of specialised work and political institutions on a small patch of ground, fed by rural surplus and sea trade. Urban power is not only walls; it is people and skills stacked tightly.

Why it matters: states and empires need urban nodes to tax, judge, worship and command. Networks of cities become the skeleton of wider power.

Bridge: people do not only stay put. They move when pressure and opportunity combine. Migration is next.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List four activities you are more likely to find in a city than on a farm.
- 2 Why is a capital both a political choice and a geographic one?
- 3 Compare two of these cities by location: Athens, Rome, Constantinople, Lisbon.

◆ CAREFUL

A capital is chosen as well as found. Geography offers options; rulers still pick (and sometimes move) the seat of power for political reasons.

TOPIC 3.4

Migration

The account

Migration means moving to live in a new place for a time or for good. People rarely move for no reason. **Push factors** are pressures that drive people out: conflict, famine, heavy taxes, fear, lack of land. **Pull factors** are attractions that draw them in: work, better land, trade chances, safety, family already settled there. Always look for both sides of the move.

How to analyse a move, step by step: (1) name who moved (family, warriors, traders, whole community); (2) list pushes from the old place; (3) list pulls of the new place; (4) note the route and risks; (5) check how sources label the movers (hostile words such as "invasion" or softer words such as "settlement" can describe related events from different voices).

	Push factors	Pull factors
Safety	Conflict, persecution.	Peace and security.
Work	No jobs or land.	Employment and markets.
Food	Famine, poor soil.	Fertile land, trade food.
Power	Harsh rulers.	Rights or opportunity.

Figure 3.4 • Push and pull factors of migration.
For each theme (safety, work, food, power), read the push on the left and the pull on the right. Then invent one historical or modern example that pairs a push with a pull.

Everyday example: changing schools or moving house. Something pushes (work ends in one town) and something pulls (new work, a better flat). Historical migration scales that up, sometimes with whole communities on the road.

Year 8 examples: after the western Roman Empire changed, movements of peoples across Europe were not random wandering. Groups responded to pressure behind them and opportunity ahead: safer ground, weaker borders, or alliance with a powerful neighbour. Quieter moves matter too: a farmer's child walking to a town for craft work; a trader's family shifting to a better harbour; Greek colonists sailing to southern Italy or the Black Sea when land and grain were short at home. Colonisation, conquest and refugee movements later in the book all still answer to push and pull.

Worked example: "They just wandered after Rome." Challenge that sentence. Push: conflict, collapsing pay for soldiers, pressure from other groups, poor harvests. Pull: open land, weaker frontiers, chance to serve a new lord, richer soils. Conclusion: direction without push and pull is only half the story. Maps of migration should show both the route and the reasons.

Why it matters: push and pull factors stop you treating population movements as mysterious tides instead of human decisions under pressure. States grow, strain and change when people move.

Bridge: over time, more people and more functions can concentrate in towns. Urbanisation names that process of climbing from village toward city roles.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define push factor and pull factor with one example of each.
- 2 Why is "they just wandered" a weak explanation for migration after Rome?
- 3 Give a modern school or family example that shows push and pull together.

◆ CAREFUL

Labels in sources can be hostile or proud. "Barbarian invasion" and "seeking land" may describe related events from different voices: always check push, pull and who is writing.

TOPIC 3.5

Urbanisation

The account

Urbanisation is the process by which a larger share of people live in towns and cities, and by which settlements gain more urban functions. The path from village to town to city is a change in **function** as much as size. A place becomes more urban when markets regularise, walls rise, officials settle, specialised crafts multiply or a port expands. Counting heads is not enough if the settlement still does only farm work.

How urbanisation climbs, step by step: (1) a crossroads or harbour attracts regular exchange; (2) a weekly market becomes permanent shops; (3) defence works or a court draw more residents; (4) crafts and services multiply; (5) more of the region's people live in or depend on the town; (6) the town's functions (trade, tax, worship, law) mark it as urban even before modern skyscrapers exist.



Figure 3.5 · Location to growth.

Follow the chain: a useful site, a clear function, people attracted by jobs, then city expansion. Use it for Athens, Rome or Lisbon as well as for a modern town.

Everyday example: a quiet village that gains a weekly market, then a bridge, then a fort, then permanent shops. Each step changes daily life: more strangers, more rules, more chances to buy and sell.

Year 8 examples: Greek poleis urbanised as political and religious centres with markets and harbours. Roman colonies planted urban patterns across conquered lands. Medieval towns (later units) grew around castles, bridges and trade fairs. Lisbon's long climb from river settlement to major Atlantic harbour is urbanisation written on an estuary. Urbanisation in this book is a historical process across centuries, not only a modern graph of skyscrapers.

Worked example: Settlement X has 2 000 people who all farm. Settlement Y has 1 200 people including merchants, metalworkers, a court and a harbour office. Question: which is more urban? Answer: Y, by function, even if X has more heads. Size helps, but specialisation and institutions define the urban step.

Why it matters: empires need urban nodes; urbanisation changes who has power, how taxes work and how ideas spread. Networks of towns become the wiring of states.

Bridge: people cluster and move; goods move too. Unit 4 asks why societies trade, which routes they use, and how Mediterranean and Silk Road networks shaped power.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is urbanisation, beyond "more people in cities"? Include the idea of function.
- 2 Name three drivers that can turn a village toward town functions.
- 3 Why is function as important as size when judging whether a place is urban?

◆ CAREFUL

Urbanisation is not only headcount. A large farming camp is not a city; a smaller port with markets, law and specialised crafts can be more urban by function.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

density, push factor, pull factor, urbanisation

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why do people live where they live, and why do they move?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

UNIT 3 AT A GLANCE

Population, migration and settlement

Enquiry. Why do people live where they live, and why do they move?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

3.1 Population distribution

3.2 Rural settlements

3.3 Urban settlements

3.4 Migration

3.5 Urbanisation

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** priced a choice for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

density

push factor

pull factor

urbanisation

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 5 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 3 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?

PART ONE · UNIT 4

4

Trade, transport and connection

Why do societies trade, and which routes shape power?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain resources to production to exchange to trade.
- ✓ Describe Mediterranean and Silk Road networks.
- ✓ Compare ancient and later transport systems.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why do societies trade, and which routes shape power?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 4.1

Why do societies trade?

The account

Places differ in resources, skills and products. One valley grows good olives; another has metal ore; a coastal town builds ships. That difference creates **surplus** (extra goods beyond local need) in some items and **shortage** in others. **Trade** is regular exchange that moves goods between people and places to fill those gaps. Societies trade because no place has everything it needs or wants.

A simple chain helps: **resources** → **production** → **exchange** → **trade**. **Resources** are what the land or sea provides (timber, grain, salt, silver). **Production** turns them into useful goods (flour, cloth, tools). **Exchange** is giving one thing for another, even in a village market. Trade is exchange that regularly crosses longer distances and often involves merchants, ports and taxes. Learn the chain in order so you do not jump straight to "gold and spices" and forget grain.



Figure 4.1 • A sailing ship on open sea.

Trade and power needed vessels that could carry bulk goods far from home. Notice how the sea becomes a highway when ships are reliable.



Figure 4.2 · From resources to trade.

Follow the four steps left to right. Stop at each box and invent one Greek or Iberian example (for example olives, silver, pottery, grain).

How the chain works in practice: (1) a place has timber and little metal; (2) carpenters produce ships and barrels; (3) villagers exchange timber goods for tools in a market; (4) merchants carry surplus oil or pottery to another port and bring back grain. Each step adds organisation: storage, trust, roads or ships, and often a tax collector.

Everyday example: a school lunch box. If everyone brought only apples, you would still want bread or cheese. Swap with a friend and both gain. Societies scale that idea across seas and deserts.

Year 8 examples: Greek communities exported oil, wine and pottery and imported grain when valley soils ran short. Athens used silver from Laurion to fund fleets and public projects. Rome later moved bulk grain by sea to feed a huge capital. Iberian metals drew Mediterranean traders long before Portugal was a country. Ordinary goods built states: armies march on food; temples need stone and skilled workers.

Worked example: a coastal polis has fish and ships but poor soil. An inland valley has grain but no harbour. Question: who should trade? Answer: both. The coastal polis offers fish, transport and maybe oil; the valley offers grain. Power grows for whoever taxes the exchange at the port or pass. Luxury spices can appear later; grain and metal come first in serious history.

Why it matters: trade is not decoration around "real" politics. It is how states feed, arm and enrich themselves. Networks of exchange become networks of power.

Bridge: once people trade regularly, paths form. Trade routes are the next topic: lines that lower cost and attract control.



LOOK FURTHER

National Geographic Education, trade. Why places exchange goods and ideas.

education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/trade/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the four-step chain from resources to trade and explain each step in a few words.
- 2 Why is it a mistake to think ancient trade was only about luxury goods?
- 3 Give one local example of surplus and shortage (for example fish by the sea, grain inland).

◆ CAREFUL

Trade starts from surplus and shortage, not from treasure maps. Grain, salt, metal and cloth built power

as surely as silk or gold.

TOPIC 4.2

Trade routes

The account

A **trade route** is a repeated path along which goods and people move. Routes follow roads, rivers, coasts and open seas because those lines lower cost and risk compared with random wandering. Towns grow at **junctions** where cargo changes hands: a river meets a road, a mountain pass opens onto a plain, or ships unload at a harbour. Junctions are where geography and human choice meet.

How routes form and matter, step by step: (1) merchants choose the path with lower cost and danger; (2) valleys, coasts and known wells become habit; (3) seasonal winds shape sailing calendars; (4) junctions attract inns, warehouses and markets; (5) rulers place forts and customs posts on the same lines; (6) when politics change, routes can shift: a safe port becomes unsafe, a new road opens, a canal is dug. Routes are living systems, not frozen lines on one map.



Figure 4.3 · How goods create wealth.

Surplus meets need, follows a route, reaches a market, then feeds tax and power. Use this flow whenever you study a port or pass.

Everyday example: carrying shopping bags along the easiest pavement rather than climbing fences. Merchants did the same with valleys and coastlines. They preferred known wells, friendly markets and seasonal winds.

Year 8 examples: Aegean coastal hops linked Greek poleis and islands. Italian roads and seas later carried Roman goods and armies. Mediterranean sea lanes joined Athens, Carthage, Rome and Alexandria. Overland caravan paths (next topics) linked Asia and the Mediterranean edges. Lisbon's later Atlantic role sat on the idea that a river-mouth junction can redirect whole networks. A thin mountain pass may matter more than a wide empty field if everyone must use the pass.

Worked example: control of a pass on the only good road between two rich plains. Merchants pay a toll. The fort commander grows rich without farming. Question: is this "trade" or "power"? Answer: both. Strategic locations (Unit 2) and trade routes belong together. Power sits on the path as well as on the farm.

Why it matters: empires tax routes as well as fields. Whoever holds the path can shape prices, alliances and war without producing the goods themselves.

Bridge: the greatest near-enclosed sea highway of this book is the Mediterranean. Next: one sea, many roles.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a trade route, and why do routes follow rivers and coasts so often?
- 2 How can controlling a route create wealth without producing goods?
- 3 Name one kind of junction where a town is likely to grow, and explain why.

◆ CAREFUL

A route on a map is only half real. Winds, war, pirates and politics can close it overnight. Always ask who makes the path safe.

TOPIC 4.3

The Mediterranean Sea

The account

The **Mediterranean Sea** is the key stage of Year 8. It is a nearly enclosed sea between southern Europe, North Africa and western Asia, linked to the Atlantic at Gibraltar. For ancient and medieval societies it was a trade route, cultural bridge, military space, food source and migration path. One sea, many roles: that is why it appears in almost every later unit.

How the sea works as a system, step by step: (1) coasts provide harbours and food; (2) ships move bulk goods faster than many land journeys of equal distance; (3) cities grow on bays and river mouths; (4) fleets fight for control of lanes and straits; (5) ideas, styles and people travel with cargo; (6) storms and pirates keep risk high even when the highway is open.

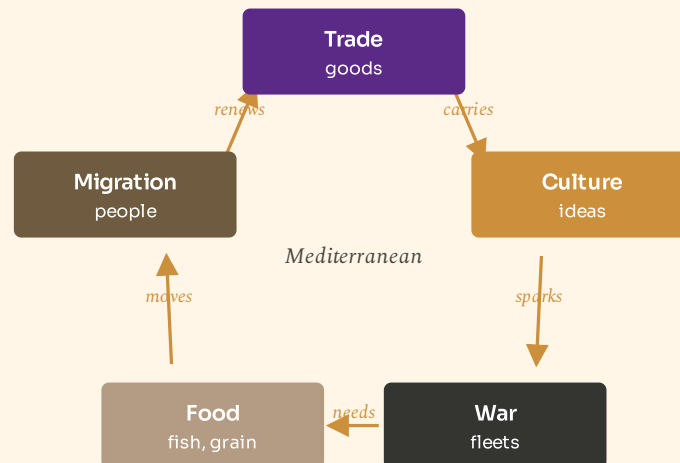


Figure 4.4 • Five roles of the Mediterranean.

Read the cycle around the centre: trade, culture, war, food and migration feed one another. Pick any node and name one historical example that fits it.

	Mediterranean	Silk Road network
Links	Europe, N. Africa, W. Asia.	China to Europe via Asia.
Moves	Grain, oil, pottery, people.	Silk, spices, ideas, disease.
Space	One sea, many coasts.	Many routes, not one road.
Power	Who holds ports wins.	Who holds oases and cities wins.

Figure 4.5 - Mediterranean and Silk Road compared.

Use the left column for the shared sea basin and the right for the land-and-oasis network. Notice different goods and different choke points, but the same lesson: who holds the path holds power.

Everyday example: a busy shared corridor at school. News, rumours, arguments and friendships all travel along it. The Mediterranean was that corridor for whole civilisations.

Year 8 examples: Greeks founded colonies around its shores. Romans treated the sea as their own highway after defeating rival powers. Later, Byzantines and Islamic caliphates also fought and traded across the same waters. Famous cities sat on or near it: Athens, Carthage, Rome, Alexandria, Constantinople, and later busy Iberian ports facing both Mediterranean and Atlantic worlds. If you live near Lisbon, you sit closer to the Atlantic door of this system than to the Aegean, yet goods and techniques still moved along coasts and through the strait.

Worked example: question: "Why did so many major cities grow on this sea?" Evidence: harbours, fishing, cheaper bulk transport, contact with many coasts. Reasoning: a city on a dead-end inland plateau must haul everything by land; a harbour city plugs into many partners. Conclusion: place first, then politics. The Mediterranean is not "someone else's sea"; it is the shared basin that links the stories in this book.

Why it matters: treating the Mediterranean as a highway explains how cultures met, fought and borrowed without needing modern borders. Distance from Athens does not mean isolation from Mediterranean networks.

Bridge: long-distance land and oasis routes also linked Asia and Europe. The Silk Road network is the land partner to Mediterranean sea systems.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List five roles the Mediterranean played for ancient societies.
- 2 Why did so many major cities grow on or near this sea?
- 3 How does the Mediterranean link southern Europe, North Africa and western Asia?

◆ CAREFUL

The Mediterranean was a highway *and* a war zone. Never describe only peaceful trade: fleets, pirates and rival empires used the same water.

TOPIC 4.4

The Silk Road

The account

The **Silk Road** was a **network**, not one single road: a web of caravan paths, oasis towns and sea links that moved goods between China, Central Asia, the Middle East and Europe over many centuries. Silk gave the network its popular name, but traders also carried spices, glass, metals, horses, paper ideas and religious teachings. If you draw only one line, you miss the system.

How the network worked, step by step: (1) goods leave a production region (for example silk from China); (2) caravans move stage by stage between oases and cities; (3) middlemen trade locally and pass cargo on; (4) taxes and protection costs rise at each fort or desert gate; (5) some goods reach Mediterranean ports and join sea trade; (6) ideas, faiths and diseases can travel with the same caravans. Few individuals walked the whole distance; the system was a relay.

Everyday example: a relay race. The baton changes hands many times. Each runner knows only their leg. Silk Road goods changed hands the same way. Middlemen are not "noise"; they are how the network works.

Year 8 examples: Mediterranean cities could receive Asian luxuries without any single merchant knowing every desert well. Oasis towns grew rich by taxing traffic and offering water, food and safety. When war closed a pass, prices jumped and routes shifted. Beliefs spread along with goods: soft power and hard cargo often shared the same track. Connection creates wealth and vulnerability in the same caravan: a city on the network can prosper, then suffer when disease or armies follow trade.

Worked example: a pupil draws one red line labelled "Silk Road" from China to Rome. Improve it: many branching lines, sea alternatives, oasis dots, and arrows both ways. Question: who "owns" the Silk Road? Answer: no single empire owned the whole web for long. Power sat in segments: who held which oasis, mountain pass or port.

Why it matters: empires and city networks gain from long-distance exchange, but they also import risks. Global connection is not only a modern story; it has deep roots in land and sea webs.

Bridge: routes need vehicles and surfaces. Transport networks (roads, ships, later rails) change how tightly a state can hold together.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why is it better to call the Silk Road a network than a single road?
- 2 Name three things besides silk that could travel along it.
- 3 How can the same trade link make a city both richer and more vulnerable?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not draw one motorway and call it the Silk Road. It was many routes, many hands and many centuries: a network, not a single street.

TOPIC 4.5

Transport networks

The account

A **transport network** is the set of paths and vehicles a society uses to move people and goods. Compare footpaths and pack animals, Roman paved roads, medieval tracks, river barges, sailing ships and, much later, rails and highways. Speed and capacity change what a state can hold together. A message that arrives in days rather than weeks lets a ruler react. An army that reaches a frontier faster can defend or conquer more ground.

How transport shapes power, step by step: (1) choose mode (foot, animal, cart, barge, ship); (2) match mode to cargo weight and urgency; (3) build or maintain paths (roads, harbours, canals); (4) protect travellers enough that merchants risk the journey; (5) tax and command along the same lines; (6) when routes break, regions slip out of control. Technology and politics meet on the road.



Figure 4.6 · A Roman road surface.

Stone routes were engineering and politics together: soldiers, messengers and traders moved with more predictability. Notice how a firm path lowers the cost of distance.

Everyday example: your journey to school by walk, bus, car or bike. Each mode changes time, cost and how much you can carry. Empires faced the same maths with grain fleets and mountain tracks.

Year 8 examples: Rome's roads are famous: stone surfaces, milestones and bridges helped soldiers, messengers and traders. Water transport still often beat roads for bulk cargo, which is why rivers and seas never stopped mattering. Greek shipping linked poleis more tightly than many inland tracks. Later medieval pack routes and fairs (later units) rebuilt exchange after imperial systems changed. Atlantic sailing from Iberian ports eventually opened ocean-scale networks that rebalanced the old Mediterranean centre.

Worked example: a capital needs grain. Option A: carts over muddy hills for three weeks. Option B: ships along a coast in days if winds allow. Question: which supports a larger city? Answer: usually B for bulk food. That is why harbour capitals and grain fleets appear again and again. Roads and ships are partners, not rivals, in most empires: fleets feed cities; roads move troops and tax collectors.

Why it matters: states, empires and networks are only as strong as their ability to move people, goods and orders. Improve transport and markets widen; break routes and power fragments.

Bridge: Part one gave you tools, landforms, people and trade. Part two enters the Greek world: mountains, islands and seas that shaped city-states rather than one easy kingdom.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How do better roads change what a ruler can control? Define transport network in your answer.
- 2 Why did water transport often beat land transport for heavy goods?
- 3 Give one way Roman roads were political as well as technical.

◆ CAREFUL

Faster roads do not automatically create justice or peace. They help whoever already holds power to tax, march and command more quickly.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Silk Road, Mediterranean, surplus, network

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why do societies trade, and which routes shape power?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

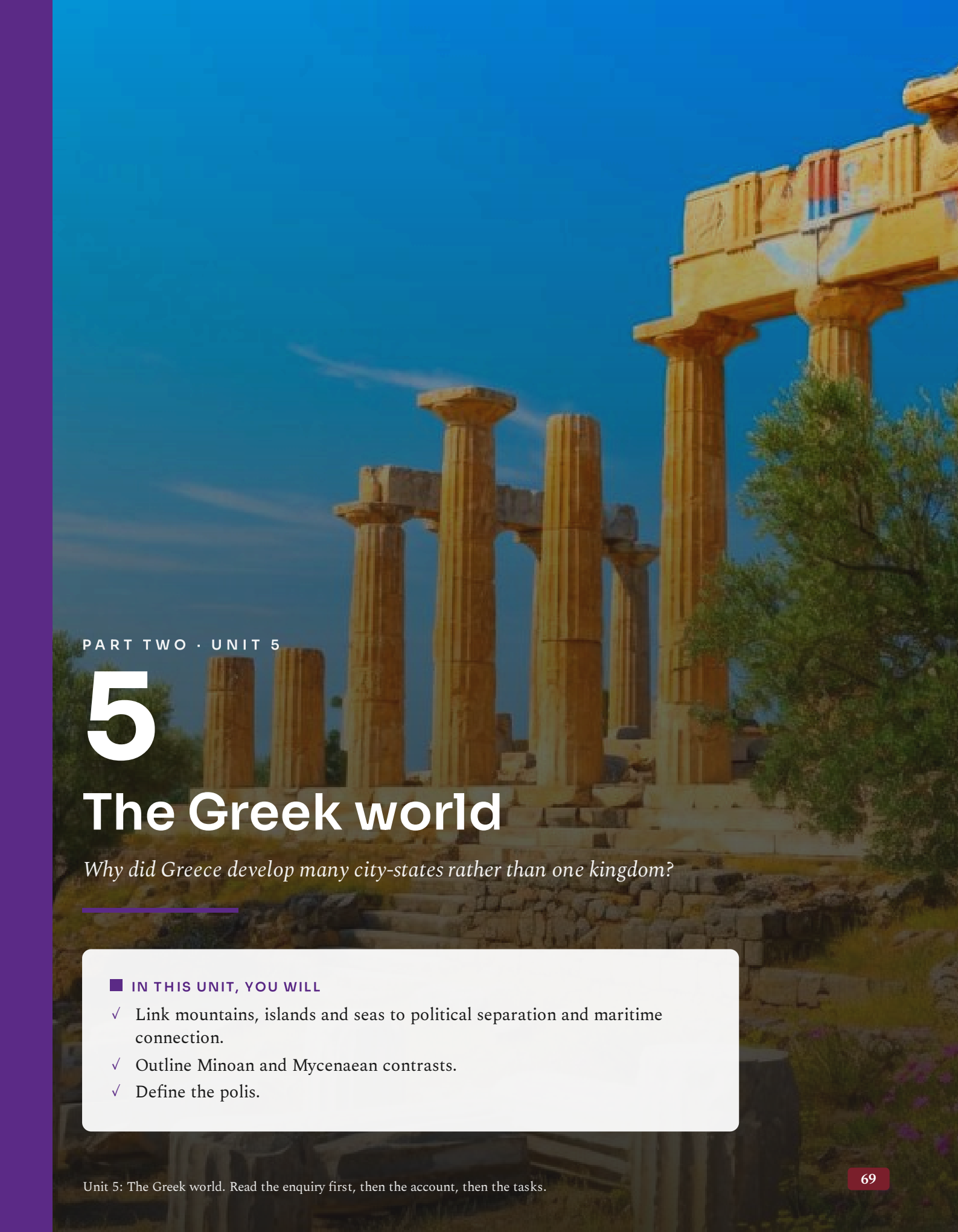
PART TWO

Ancient Greece

Mountains, islands and seas shaped a world of city-states. From geography to Athens and Sparta, then culture and war, this part asks how political separation and maritime connection worked together.

Watch how the same sea that splits valleys also links harbours. Greek history is not only speeches and statues: it is ridge lines, olive terraces and fleets.

Units 5 to 7 move from the land and early centres to democracy debates, rivalry, culture and conflict.



PART TWO · UNIT 5

5

The Greek world

Why did Greece develop many city-states rather than one kingdom?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Link mountains, islands and seas to political separation and maritime connection.
- ✓ Outline Minoan and Mycenaean contrasts.
- ✓ Define the polis.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why did Greece develop many city-states rather than one kingdom?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 5.1

Geography of ancient Greece

The account

Start with the place, not the famous names. Ancient Greece sat on a mountainous mainland, a scatter of islands, and seas that linked them: especially the **Aegean Sea** between Greece and Asia Minor, and the wider **Mediterranean**. Natural harbours and narrow valleys created a repeated pattern you can learn as a formula.



Figure 5.1 • Greek coast and sea.

Rocky shores meet bright water. Notice how mountains push communities apart on land while harbours invite connection by ship.



Figure 5.2 • Temple columns above the Aegean.

Stone architecture on high ground claims public religion and city pride. Notice the open sky and sea highway beyond: Greek life sat between hills, harbour and gods.

Mountains cut communities apart. Island chains and peninsulas multiplied separate shores. Seas, however, offered highways for ships. The result can be written as: **mountains + islands + seas → political separation + maritime connection**. People who lived two valleys apart might rarely meet by land, yet sailors from both could meet in the same harbour. Separation and connection are not opposites here; they are partners.

How the landscape priced politics, step by step: (1) ridges divide valleys into small farming packets; (2) each packet can support a local centre more easily than a distant capital; (3) harbours open sea routes for trade, news and colonies; (4) good farmland is limited, so grain and sea skills both matter; (5) unity is possible (later Macedon and Rome prove that) but expensive to hold from the centre for long. Separation was the easier default; connection came by ship.

	Mountains divide	Seas connect
Politics	Many independent poleis.	Leagues and colonies.
Farming	Small valleys, limited grain.	Oil, wine, sea trade.
War	Hard to unite for long.	Navies decide power.
Culture	Local identity strong.	Shared language and gods.

Figure 5.3 - Mountains divide, seas connect.

Read each row as a pair: politics, farming, war and culture all show the same double pattern. Use this table when you answer the unit enquiry.

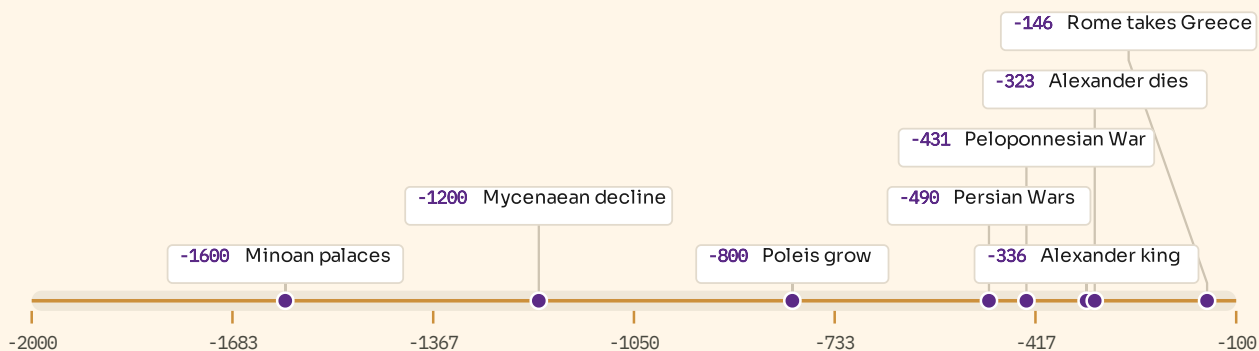


Figure 5.4 - Greek world timeline from palaces to Rome.

Read left to right from Minoan palaces through Mycenaean decline, the growth of poleis, the Persian and Peloponnesian wars, Alexander, and Roman control. Place this unit's topics on the early and middle parts of the line.

Everyday example: if you picture walking over steep hills with a heavy load, then stepping onto a boat in a sheltered bay, you feel the Greek geography problem: hard land, inviting water.

Year 8 examples: Attica's rocky land pushed Athens toward harbours such as Piraeus. Sparta's valley setting in Laconia suited land power more than open sea empire. Islands such as those in the Aegean chain lived by ships. Colonies in southern Italy and Sicily show how sea connection could spread Greek culture far from the mainland valleys.

Worked example: enquiry question: "Why many city-states, not one kingdom?" Evidence: mountains, limited plains, many harbours. Reasoning: local defence and local identity cost less than permanent central control; sea trade links culture without forcing one government. Conclusion: lead with landscape before you name Athens or Sparta. Geography did not forbid unity forever, but it priced unity highly.

Why it matters: Greek geography is the stage on which city-states, navies and colonies make sense. Without the stage, the play looks random.

Bridge: climate and crops explain *what* the land could grow, and why grain worries pushed people outward.

**LOOK FURTHER**

British Museum, Greece. Objects from the Greek world with find contexts.

www.britishmuseum.org/collection/galleries/greece

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the formula linking mountains, islands and seas to separation and connection.
- 2 Why was good farmland limited, and how did that push people toward the sea?
- 3 Why might one central kingdom be harder to maintain in this landscape than in a wide plain?

◆ CAREFUL

Geography prices choices; it does not write the script alone. Greeks still chose laws, wars and colonies. Never say "the mountains made democracy".

TOPIC 5.2

Climate and agriculture

The account

Ancient Greece had a **Mediterranean climate**: hot, dry summers and milder, wetter winters. Rain often falls when farmers need it for sowing, while summer heat dries the ground. That pattern suited certain crops better than others. Climate is not background weather chat; it is the timetable of food.

How farming fitted the climate, step by step: (1) winter rains support sowing and early growth; (2) summer drought stresses shallow-rooted plants; (3) **olives** and **grapes** thrive on hillsides where deep plough soil is scarce; (4) cereals (grain crops) grow in pockets of better soil in valleys and plains; (5) those pockets are not endless, so grain shortages are a real risk; (6) olive oil and wine become valuable for use and trade; (7) communities look outward for food and land through trade and colonisation when population presses on soil.

Everyday example: a garden that gets winter wet and summer bake. Deep-rooted shrubs survive; thirsty lettuce may need extra care. Greek farmers worked with that rhythm, not against a northern European rain pattern.

Year 8 examples: Attica's limited grain land made sea imports and alliances important for Athens. Black Sea and Egyptian grain later mattered in wider Mediterranean trade. Colonies in more fertile overseas shores (southern Italy, Sicily, Black Sea coasts) answered scarcity as well as ambition. A good harvest year felt different from a dry one in every polis: festivals, taxes and army size all felt the weather.

Worked example: a growing polis has more citizens than its valley can feed in a dry year. Options: reduce population pressure by sending settlers overseas; buy grain through merchant networks; fight neighbours for land. Question: did climate "cause" colonisation? Answer: not alone. Climate raised the value of ships and overseas friends. Ambition without hunger still existed; hunger without ships was more dangerous.

Why it matters: food systems sit under politics. Navies, colonies and markets make more sense when you know why grain worried Greek communities.

Bridge: before classical poleis, earlier civilisations rose on Crete and the mainland. The Minoans come first on the island stage.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Describe the Mediterranean climate in one or two sentences.
- 2 Which crops suited Greek hillsides well, and why was grain still a worry?
- 3 How can scarcity help explain colonisation without ignoring ambition?

◆ CAREFUL

Olives and wine did not make grain unimportant. A polis rich in oil could still starve without cereal imports or good valley harvests.

TOPIC 5.3

The Minoans

The account

Long before classical Athens, a civilisation flourished on the island of **Crete**. Historians call its people **Minoans** (after the legendary king Minos). Their palace centres, such as **Knossos**, show storage rooms, elaborate art, religious spaces and links across the Mediterranean. This is early Greek-world history, not a side note.

How Minoan power worked, step by step: (1) Crete sits south of the Aegean mainland routes, well placed for ships; (2) palace centres organise storage and administration; (3) sea links move goods and styles across eastern Mediterranean shores; (4) art and remains suggest wealth from trade and organisation, not only from farming one valley; (5) island geography encourages sea skill and also exposes the society to sea risk and natural disaster.

Everyday example: a school that stores sports kits centrally and shares them across teams. Palaces were not only royal houses; they were organisation hubs for goods and ceremonies.

Year 8 examples: frescoes of sea life and palace complexes point to a society comfortable with maritime connection. Crete was a stepping stone in space and in time: an island power with Mediterranean reach before the classical poleis of the mainland. Later Greek myths about labyrinths and monsters are not modern site reports. Archaeologists read walls, pottery and writing fragments; those sources have gaps. Myths can hint at memory; they cannot replace excavation notes.

	Minoans (Crete)	Mycenaeans (mainland)
Setting	Island, sea routes.	Fortified hill towns.
Focus	Palaces, trade, art.	Warriors, walls, power.
Risk	Sea and earthquake.	War and invasion.

Figure 5.5 • Minoans and Mycenaeans compared.
Use the left column for island Crete and the right for mainland fortress centres. Hold the contrast: sea palaces versus fortified hill towns, without turning either into a cartoon.

Worked example: a pupil says "Minoans are just the Minotaur myth." Improve it: start with Crete, Knossos, storage and sea trade; then add that later myths are a different kind of evidence. Question: why does Year 8 study Minoans? Answer: they show early maritime power in the Greek world and set up the later mainland story.

Why it matters: island geography and palace organisation offer a first model of Mediterranean connection before Athens and Sparta exist as classical powers.

Bridge: on the mainland, different centres rose with thicker walls and warrior elites. The Mycenaeans are next.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Where did Minoan civilisation centre, and name one palace site.
- 2 How did Crete's island position encourage maritime links?
- 3 Why should we treat myths and archaeology as different kinds of evidence?

◆ CAREFUL

Myths are windows into later memory and values, not site reports. Always separate story from archaeology when you write about Knossos or Crete.

TOPIC 5.4

The Mycenaeans

The account

On the Greek mainland, **Mycenaean** centres rose in the later Bronze Age. Sites such as **Mycenae** show massive walls, hilltop positions and evidence of warrior elites. Compared with Minoan Crete, the mainland centres often look more like fortresses than open palace complexes. The contrast is about emphasis, not a cartoon of "traders versus fighters only".

How Mycenaean society appears in the evidence, step by step: (1) hilltop sites and thick walls suggest defence and display of power; (2) warrior elites compete and store wealth; (3) Linear B writing records palace goods and officials; (4) trade and sailing still happen, so "warrior" does not mean "cut off from the sea"; (5) when centres decline, a poorer, less centrally recorded period follows before classical poleis rise. Decline is not "end of Greece"; it is a change of organisation.

Everyday example: two neighbouring schools. One invests in open halls and festivals; the other invests in strong fences and competitive teams. Both educate; the emphasis differs. Minoan and Mycenaean centres show different emphases in the same wider world.

Year 8 examples: Mycenae's walls became a byword for massive stonework. Mainland kingdoms watched each other, prepared for conflict and still traded. Later Greek myths of heroes and sieges may dimly echo this world, but myths are not photographs. What matters for Year 8 is the comparison: geography and society interacted differently on island Crete and on the mountainous mainland.

Worked example: essay line: "Mycenaeans were only warriors." Challenge it with Linear B records of goods, evidence of trade, and the need for food storage. Fort walls suit raid and defence; harbours suit bulk trade. Both patterns can exist. Conclusion: hold a balanced comparison, not a team cheer for "peaceful islanders" versus "violent mainlanders".

Why it matters: early mainland power, fortification and later collapse set the stage for a new political form: the classical polis.

Bridge: after Bronze Age centres change, Greek communities organise as city-states. Defining the polis unlocks the rest of Part two.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did Mycenaean centres often differ in appearance from Minoan palaces?
- 2 Why is it unfair to say Mycenaeans were only warriors with no trade?
- 3 What comparison should you hold between Crete and the mainland?

◆ CAREFUL

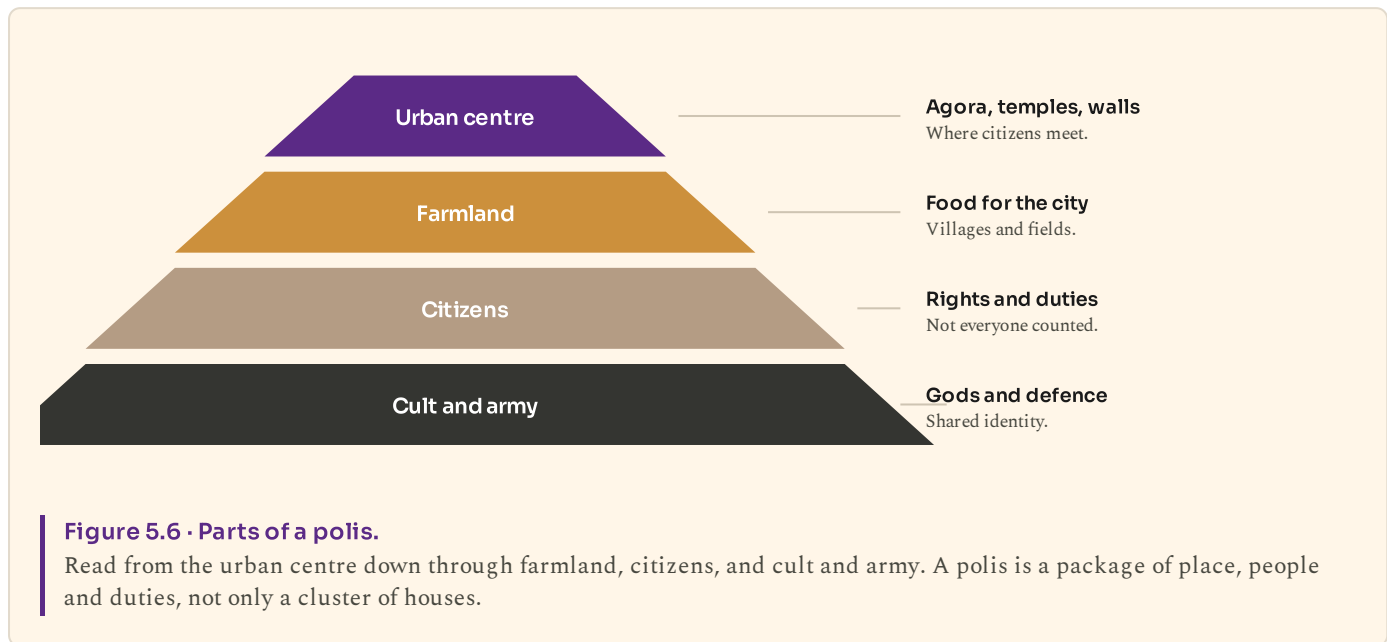
"Warrior culture" is not the whole story. Walls and weapons matter, but records and trade show organisation beyond fighting alone.

TOPIC 5.5

The polis

The account

A polis (plural poleis) was more than a town. It joined an urban centre, surrounding farmland, shared institutions, military duty and religious identity. Citizens (usually free adult men in the classical period) belonged to a political community that made laws, fought wars and honoured the same gods at local festivals. Learn the parts before you debate democracy or dual kings.



How a polis works, step by step: (1) an urban centre holds agora (meeting and market space), temples and often walls; (2) surrounding farmland feeds the community; (3) citizens share rights and duties, including military service; (4) local cults and festivals bind identity; (5) hundreds of poleis share language, gods and cultural habits yet guard independence; (6) they can cooperate in leagues or against a common enemy, then fight each other the next decade. Shared culture is not the same as shared government.

Everyday example: neighbouring schools that share a language and sports rules but compete fiercely and run their own classrooms. A polis felt its own honour. Exile from your polis was a heavy punishment because identity sat in the community, not only in a private house. Belonging was political and sacred at once.

Year 8 examples: Athens and Sparta were both poleis with very different internal rules. Smaller poleis filled the map of mainland and islands. Mountains and coasts helped this patchwork survive; pride and institutions kept it alive. Understanding the polis unlocks democracy, oligarchy, dual kingship, the Persian Wars and the Peloponnesian War.

Worked example: define "city" as "lots of buildings". Improve it for Greece: list urban centre, land, citizens, army duty and cult. Question: why does definition matter? Answer: if you only say "city", you miss why losing citizenship or farmland could destroy a person's political world. Democracy and Spartan discipline are different answers to how a polis should run.

Why it matters: the polis is the political atom of classical Greece. States and later empires interact with this form: sometimes allying with it, sometimes crushing it, sometimes copying pieces of it.

Bridge: Unit 6 compares two famous answers inside the polis form: Athens and Sparta, democracy's tools and limits, and land power built on unfree labour.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define polis using at least three of its parts (for example land, city, army, religion).
- 2 How could poleis share culture yet stay politically separate?
- 3 Why does understanding the polis come before judging Athens or Sparta?

◆ CAREFUL

A polis is not "just a city". Leave out farmland, citizen duties or cult and your definition is too thin for classical Greece.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

polis, Aegean, Minoan, Mycenaean

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why did Greece develop many city-states rather than one kingdom?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

UNIT 5 AT A GLANCE

The Greek world

Enquiry. Why did Greece develop many city-states rather than one kingdom?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 5.1 Geography of ancient Greece
- 5.2 Climate and agriculture
- 5.3 The Minoans
- 5.4 The Mycenaeans
- 5.5 The polis

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** **priced a choice** for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

- polis
- Aegean
- Minoan
- Mycenaean

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 5 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 5 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART TWO · UNIT 6

6

Athens and Sparta

Was Athens really a democracy for everyone, and how did Sparta differ?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Describe Athenian democracy and its exclusions.
- ✓ Explain Spartan military society.
- ✓ Compare government, economy, gender and culture.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Was Athens really a democracy for everyone, and how did Sparta differ?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 6.1

Athens

The account

Athens became one of the most famous poleis in the Greek world: a commercial, naval, cultural and political centre in **Attica**, in south-eastern Greece. Its power rested on place as well as people. The city had access to the sea through harbours such as **Piraeus**, so merchants and warships could move goods and force across the Aegean. Sea access is the first fact to lock in.



Figure 6.1 · Temple ruins in sunlight.

Stone columns stand for public religion and civic pride. Notice how temples sit in the open, part of city life not a private corner.

How Athenian strength stacked, step by step: (1) harbours link the polis to the Aegean; (2) limited grain land in Attica makes sea trade and alliances essential; (3) silver from the mines at **Laurion** helps fund fleets and public projects; (4) pottery, olive products and crafts support exchange; (5) daily life mixes free citizens, women with limited public rights, foreign residents and enslaved people; (6) fame for drama, building and speech grows in the classical period, especially in the fifth century BCE, but that fame sits on labour and silver as much as on genius.

Everyday example: a busy coastal school with a ferry link to other towns feels more open to news and visitors than a quiet inland school with one road. Athens felt open to strangers and news. That openness fed both democracy debates and imperial ambition.

Year 8 examples: Piraeus was the naval and commercial door. Laurion silver helped pay for ships that later mattered against Persia and in empire-building among Greek allies. Compared with Sparta's landlocked valley emphasis, Athens leaned on the sea. Glory and exclusion can share one city: temples and plays for citizens, hard labour for many who never voted.

Worked example: a pupil writes "Athens was rich because of genius." Improve it: add harbours, silver, trade, enslaved labour and limited grain land. Question: why does the stage matter before the word "democracy"? Answer: sea power and wealth explain how one polis could lead alliances and fund culture without owning a huge inland empire. Do not skip the stage and jump only to politics.

Why it matters: Athenian sea power and wealth set up both cultural fame and later conflict with land-based rivals. Geography and economy sit under the speeches.

Bridge: the next topic asks who was allowed to speak on that stage. Democracy's tools and its limits belong together.



LOOK FURTHER

Ashmolean Museum, ancient Greece. A museum reading on the Greek world after you compare the two cities.

www.ashmolean.org/article/ancient-greece

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name two geographical or resource advantages that helped Athens.
- 2 Why did sea access matter for a polis with limited grain land?
- 3 Who lived in Athens besides free adult male citizens?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not describe Athens only as marble and genius. Silver, harbours, trade and enslaved labour funded the stage on which famous speeches happened.

TOPIC 6.2

Athenian democracy

The account

Democracy means rule by the people. In classical Athens, that idea took a specific form. Male **citizens** could speak and vote in the **Assembly** on laws, war and policy. Many offices were filled by **lot** (random selection) so ordinary citizens, not only rich speakers, held posts for a time. Juries were large. Public debate was a civic skill taught by practice as well as by teachers. These are the tools that made Athens famous.

Yet "the people" was a narrow club. Three large groups were left out of full political rights: **women** were excluded from the Assembly; **enslaved people** had no political voice; and foreign residents (**metics**) paid taxes and worked in the city but did not share full citizenship. Even among free men, wealth and education still shaped who spoke with confidence. So was Athens really a democracy for everyone? The honest answer is no, and that does not make the experiment unimportant.

	Who could take part	Who was left out
Athenian ideal	Adult male citizens	Women, children
Voice	Assembly debate	Enslaved people
Law	Citizen courts	Foreign residents (metics)
Lesson	New idea of rule	Not democracy for all

Figure 6.2 · Who could take part, and who was left out.
Read each row of the ideal and the exclusion. The lesson of the bottom row matters: a new idea of rule can still leave many people outside.

How to judge Athens fairly, step by step: (1) list the tools (Assembly, lot, juries, public speech); (2) list who used them (adult male citizens); (3) list who was excluded (women, enslaved people, metics, and often the quiet poor among freemen); (4) hold both lists in one paragraph; (5) never stop at "yes, democracy" or "no, slavery" alone.

Everyday example: a class vote where only some pupils are allowed to raise a hand. The procedure can still teach argument and majority decisions, while remaining unfair by modern standards. Athenians were proud of citizen equality among those inside the circle. Critics then and now point to the people left outside.

Year 8 examples: Assembly decisions about war and empire affected thousands who could not vote. Lot reduced the chance that only a few rich families held every office, yet rhetorical skill still mattered in open debate. Later political history often argues with Athens: copying its words, criticising its limits, or both.

Worked example: enquiry line: "Was Athens a democracy for everyone?" Weak answer: "Yes, they invented democracy." Stronger answer: "Athens created bold tools of citizen participation, including Assembly votes and offices by lot, but women, enslaved people and metics were excluded, so it was not democracy for everyone even though the idea of citizen rule was powerful."

Why it matters: judging Athens fairly trains you to separate political ideas from the full list of who was allowed to use them. That skill travels to every later "rule of the people" claim.

Bridge: Sparta answers the problem of power differently, with land force, dual kings and unfree labour on farms.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What could male citizens do in the Athenian Assembly, and what does lot mean for offices?
- 2 Name three groups excluded from full political rights in Athens.
- 3 Answer the enquiry line: was Athens a democracy for everyone? Give one reason for your answer.

◆ CAREFUL

Praise the tools without erasing the exclusions, and name the exclusions without pretending the tools never mattered. Hold both truths in the same paragraph.

TOPIC 6.3

Sparta

The account

Sparta lay in the **Peloponnese**, in a landlocked valley region of **Laconia**, with access to the sea but a culture built around land warfare. Spartan society organised for discipline and control. Boys entered harsh training systems aimed at producing tough soldiers. Adult male full citizens, the **Spartiates**, focused on military readiness. Training stories are famous; the economic base is more important for serious history.

How Spartan power worked, step by step: (1) full citizens train for war as a central life path; (2) conquered peoples known as **helots** farm much of the land; (3) helot labour and produce support the Spartiate class; (4) helot status is unfree and tightly watched; fear of revolt shapes policy; (5) government mixes two kings with powerful elders and other bodies; (6) power is shared among elite institutions rather than an open assembly like Athens. Dual kingship and elder power are not "the same as democracy with different clothes".

Everyday example: a sports team that trains every day looks tough in match photos. The hidden story is who cooks, who pays for kit, and who is not allowed to play. Spartan discipline stories become cartoons if we forget helot labour under the system.

Year 8 examples: Spartiates could focus on military readiness because someone else farmed. Helot oppression and citizen pride belonged to one structure. Spartan women of the citizen class had more public physical training and property influence than many Greek women, yet the system still rested on hierarchy and exclusion. Relative freedom for some citizen women does not cancel helot oppression. Compared with Athens' naval and commercial face, Sparta presented austere land power.

Worked example: headline: "Sparta equals only tough training." Rewrite: training + dual kings and elders + helot agriculture + fear of revolt. Question: what made the training possible? Answer: unfree labour freed citizens for war. Without that base, the famous discipline cannot feed itself.

Why it matters: Sparta shows another polis answer: control, land infantry excellence and a narrow citizen elite. Rivalry with Athens later shakes the whole Greek world.

Bridge: fair comparison needs categories, not team cheers. The next topic lines Athens and Sparta side by side.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Who were the helots, and why did they matter to Spartan citizens?
- 2 How was Spartan government different from a wide citizen assembly?
- 3 Why is "Sparta equals only tough training" an incomplete explanation?

◆ CAREFUL

Never reduce Sparta to training montages. Ask who farmed, who ruled, and who feared revolt. Discipline was policy built on an economic base.

TOPIC 6.4

Athens and Sparta compared

The account

A fair comparison uses categories, not team cheers. Compare **government**: Athenian citizen assembly and lot versus Spartan dual kingship and elder power. Compare **education**: speech, arts and varied training in Athens versus collective military upbringing in Sparta. Compare **military form**: Athenian naval empire and citizen rowers versus Spartan land infantry excellence. Compare **economy**: trade, silver and crafts versus land and helot labour. Compare **women's public roles, citizenship rules and culture** (drama and philosophy versus austere public image). Categories keep you honest.

	Athens	Sparta
Power	Navy and trade.	Land army and discipline.
Government	Citizen assembly.	Kings, elders, training.
Who votes	Adult male citizens only.	Spartiate males; women more public space.
Ideal	Speech, law, culture.	Endurance and collective force.

Figure 6.3 · Athens and Sparta side by side.
Read each row as a paired contrast: power base, government, who counts politically, and public ideals. Pick three rows for any comparison paragraph.

How to write a comparison, step by step: (1) pick two or three categories; (2) give one concrete fact for Athens and one for Sparta in each; (3) state what test you are using (navy or army, speech or silence, empire or endurance); (4) avoid the word "better" unless you name the test; (5) remember both cities excluded large groups from power and could be cruel to enemies and subordinates.

Everyday example: comparing two sports teams only by "who is better" fails if one plays football and the other swims. Name the sport. In history, name the test: sea war, land campaign, cultural production, social control.

Year 8 examples: in a sea war, Athens had tools Sparta lacked. In a grinding land campaign, Spartan strengths showed. In cultural production, Athens left a louder written and artistic record. In endurance and social control, Sparta impressed and frightened neighbours. Both shaped Greek history by rivalry as much as by example. The Persian Wars forced temporary cooperation; the Peloponnesian War later ground the systems against each other.

Worked example: weak sentence: "Athens was better than Sparta." Strong paragraph: "In naval power and public cultural production, Athens had clear advantages through harbours, silver and an open citizen culture of speech and drama. In land infantry discipline and social control of a helot underclass, Sparta excelled. Neither was better in every way, and both excluded most residents from full political rights."

Why it matters: comparison is a core historical skill. States and empires later pick pieces of both models, or warn against both. Rivalry between systems can reshape a whole network of poleis.

Bridge: Unit 7 steps beyond two cities to shared Greek culture, big wars and ideas that outlived armies: religion, Olympics, Persian and Peloponnesian conflicts, philosophy, theatre, architecture and a Portugal panel on western Iberia.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose three comparison categories and give one fact for Athens and one for Sparta in each.
- 2 In what kind of conflict might Athens have an advantage over Sparta?
- 3 Why is calling one city simply "better" a weak historical judgement?

◆ CAREFUL

"Better" only works if you name the test. A navy advantage is not a moral gold medal, and austere discipline is not proof of overall superiority.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

democracy, helot, Assembly, Spartiate

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Was Athens really a democracy for everyone, and how did Sparta differ?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART TWO · UNIT 7

7

Greek culture, ideas and conflict

What did the Greeks create that outlived their armies?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Outline religion, Olympics, Persian and Peloponnesian wars.
- ✓ Introduce philosophy, theatre, science, medicine and architecture.
- ✓ State a balanced legacy and Iberia's Mediterranean links.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **What did the Greeks create that outlived their armies?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 7.1

Greek religion and mythology

The account

Greek religion was woven into city life, not locked in a private corner. Gods such as **Zeus** (sky and kingship), **Athena** (wisdom and the city of Athens), **Poseidon** (sea), **Apollo** (among other roles, music and prophecy) and **Artemis** (hunt and wild places) appeared in temples, festivals, oaths and family stories. Each polis had favourite cults and local heroes. Belief was public and political as well as personal.



Figure 7.1 · Sacred stone in the Greek landscape.

A temple on a hill shows how belief, place and politics mixed. Notice the open approach: festivals and processions used the whole site.

Myths are traditional stories about gods, heroes and origins. They carry values and explanations: why a festival exists, why a landscape is sacred, how pride is punished. They are evidence of belief and identity, not modern science reports. A myth about a sea god does not replace a chart of winds, but it shows what sailors feared and honoured. Use myths as windows into values, not as weather reports.

How religion worked in a polis, step by step: (1) temples house cult statues and mark civic pride; (2) festivals mix sport, sacrifice, processions and competition; (3) leaders claim divine favour for policy; (4) temples can store wealth; (5) shared gods help Greeks recognise one another even when poleis fight; (6) local heroes and cults keep identity distinct. Sacred calendars organised public time.

Everyday example: a school day that includes assembly, match and celebration: different activities, one community calendar. Greek cities ran on sacred calendars like that.

Year 8 examples: Athena mattered specially in Athens; sea gods mattered more where fleets were life. Oaths before gods bound treaties and court speech. When you read a myth in this course, ask what it reveals about gender, power, hospitality or the sea, rather than only whether the plot is "true". Belief shaped choices about war, colonisation and law.

Worked example: a pupil says "Myths are fake so they are useless." Improve it: myths are not lab reports, but they show values and identity. Question: what does a story punishing arrogant heroes suggest about Greek worries? Answer: pride and the limits of human power were public themes, not only private bedtime tales.

Why it matters: religion linked politics, place and belonging. Armies fade; stories, cult sites and shared gods helped Greek identity travel and later be reused by others.

Bridge: one famous shared festival mixed sport and sacred honour for Zeus: the Olympic Games.



LOOK FURTHER

Metropolitan Museum, Greek legacy in art. Art and ideas that travelled beyond Greece.

www.metmuseum.org/toah/hd/grlg/hd_grlg.htm

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name three Greek gods and one role or link for each.
- 2 Why are myths useful evidence even when they are not scientific reports?
- 3 How could shared gods help different poleis feel connected?

◆ CAREFUL

Myths are not weather reports or lab notes. Treat them as evidence of values and identity, not as literal timelines of events.

TOPIC 7.2

Olympic Games

The account

The ancient **Olympic Games** were held at **Olympia** in the western Peloponnese as a religious festival for Zeus as well as a set of athletic contests. Athletes from many poleis competed in running, combat sports and other events. During the festival, a sacred truce tradition aimed to protect travellers, though politics never fully disappeared from Greek life. Sacred and political always mixed.

How the Games worked as culture, step by step: (1) athletes and spectators journey to a sanctuary site, not a random field; (2) contests express excellence (**arete**: excellence or virtue in achievement); (3) a winner brings honour to his polis; (4) shared rules create a temporary stage where rivals meet; (5) the festival honours Zeus as well as human skill; (6) modern Olympics borrow the name and some symbols, but continuity of name is not sameness of purpose.

Everyday example: schools that compete in a regional tournament: separate teams, shared sport, temporary focus. The tournament does not erase school rivalry; it channels it.

Year 8 examples: Olympia's geography still counts: people travelled to a sanctuary. Victory lists and fame linked sport to civic pride. The Games were not a modern international sports brand with medals tables and television. When comparing ancient and modern Games, notice both continuity and change. Continuity: athletic contest linked to Greek memory. Change: religion, who could compete, and the scale of the modern event differ.

Worked example: "The Olympics prove Greeks were peaceful." Challenge it: the truce aimed to protect festival travel; it did not end Greek wars for good. Question: what did the Games actually do? Answer: they offered shared rules, sacred honour and civic glory across separate poleis without creating one permanent government.

Why it matters: shared festivals were one of the few regular stages where rivals met under common rules. Culture can connect what politics divides.

Bridge: temporary cooperation also appears under military threat. The Persian Wars forced rivals to face a huge empire together.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Where were the ancient Olympics held, and which god was honoured?
- 2 How did victory bring honour beyond the individual athlete?
- 3 Give one similarity and one difference between ancient and modern Games.

◆ CAREFUL

A sacred truce is not permanent peace. Do not turn the Olympics into proof that Greek poleis stopped competing for power.

TOPIC 7.3

Persian Wars

The account

In the early fifth century BCE, Greek poleis faced the huge **Persian Empire**. The **Persian Wars** include famous clashes such as **Marathon** (land battle near Athens, 490 BCE), **Thermopylae** (a narrow pass where a small Greek force delayed Persians, 480 BCE), **Salamis** (a sea battle in a narrow strait, 480 BCE) and later land victory at **Plataea** (479 BCE). Temporary cooperation among rivals, especially between Athens and Sparta at key moments, helped Greek forces survive.

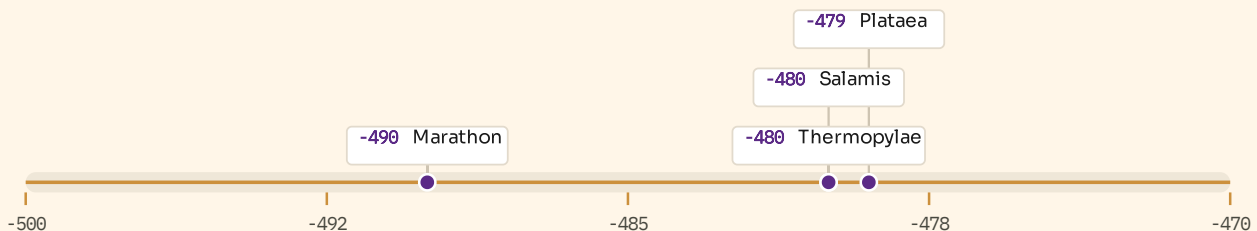


Figure 7.2 · Persian Wars timeline (about 490–479 BCE).

Read the sequence: Marathon, then Thermopylae and Salamis, then Plataea. For each event, decide whether land or sea geography mattered most and why numbers alone do not decide a bottleneck fight.

How geography and politics mixed, step by step: (1) a larger empire projects force into Greece; (2) Greek poleis form temporary alliances under threat; (3) narrow places (pass, strait) limit how many enemy troops or ships can attack at once; (4) local knowledge of coasts and harbours helps, especially the Athenian navy; (5) after danger lessens, old competitions return; (6) Athens uses naval leadership to build influence that other Greeks later resent. Victory against Persia is not the same as permanent Greek unity.

Everyday example: two rival teams joining for one match against a much larger club, then arguing again the next week. Cooperation under threat does not erase rivalry.

Year 8 examples: Thermopylae returns Unit 2's strategic location idea as a real battlefield. Salamis shows sea power deciding a campaign. Marathon becomes proud Athenian memory. The political map remains a patchwork of poleis, not one permanent nation-state. If you only remember hero stories, add the map: where was the pass, where was the strait, why could ships beat a land army in that campaign? Memory without geography becomes legend without mechanism.

Worked example: "Greeks won because they were braver." Improve it: bravery may matter, but bottlenecks, fleets, alliances and local knowledge also priced the fights. Question: what seed of the next war sits in this success? Answer: Athenian naval leadership and influence after the wars feed later resentment and the Peloponnesian conflict.

Why it matters: the Persian Wars show temporary unity under threat and set up Athenian naval power that later fuels conflict with Sparta. Success can plant the seed of the next war.

Bridge: that next great internal struggle is the Peloponnesian War: naval empire against land power.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name three key battles or places from the Persian Wars and say whether each was land or sea.
- 2 How did narrow geography help smaller Greek forces?
- 3 Why did Greek cooperation against Persia not create permanent political unity?

◆ CAREFUL

Hero stories without maps mislead. Always place Marathon, Thermopylae and Salamis on land or sea and ask how the place changed the odds.

TOPIC 7.4

Peloponnesian War

The account

The **Peloponnesian War** (late fifth century BCE, often dated 431-404 BCE) was a long, damaging conflict centred on rivalry between **Athens** and **Sparta** and their allies. In simple terms, a naval empire met a land power. Athens relied on walls, harbours and tribute from allies; Sparta relied on infantry and coalitions on land. Each side tried to force the other to fight on unfavourable ground. Systems that looked strong in Unit 6 now grind against each other.

How the war damaged the Greek world, step by step: (1) Athens uses sea power and long walls linking city to harbour; (2) Sparta pressures land and seeks ways to break Athenian supply and alliances; (3) plague, siege, shifting allies and civil strife inside cities multiply harm; (4) neither side's system looks purely glorious by the end; (5) exhaustion and division later make it easier for **Macedon**, a northern kingdom, to dominate Greek affairs in the next century under Philip II and Alexander. Internal Greek conflict reduced the chance of balanced independence among poleis.

Everyday example: two strong school teams that destroy their own season by endless grudge matches while a third team waits. The war is not only a list of battles; it is a warning about how rivalry can consume the energy a region needs for defence and recovery.

Year 8 examples: the strengths of Athens (navy, walls, tribute) and Sparta (infantry, discipline, land coalitions) become weaknesses when the conflict drags on. Allies suffer. Trust breaks. Glory stories that skip the damage mislead. Macedon's later rise makes more sense after you see how Greek division spent blood and treasure.

Worked example: question: "Who won the Peloponnesian War?" Thin answer: "Sparta." Fuller answer: Sparta forced Athens down by the end of the main war, but the wider Greek world was weakened, and northern Macedon later dominated. Military "victory" and long-term regional strength are different judgements.

Why it matters: states and networks can destroy their own balance through prolonged rivalry. Culture and ideas from this world still travel, but the political independence of many poleis is harder to sustain after exhaustion.

Bridge: while armies clashed, thinkers, playwrights and doctors shaped tools of argument and observation. Ideas are next.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Which strengths did Athens and Sparta each bring to the Peloponnesian War?
- 2 Give two ways the war harmed the wider Greek world.
- 3 How did Greek division later help Macedon?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat the war as a sports final with one clean winner. Ask who was exhausted, which allies suffered, and who later took advantage.

TOPIC 7.5

Philosophy, theatre, science and medicine

The account

Greek thinkers asked public questions about knowledge, justice and nature. **Socrates** became famous for questioning people in Athens until their easy answers broke. His student **Plato** explored knowledge, reality and the ideal city in written dialogues. **Aristotle** organised logic, biology observations and political comparisons with a drive to classify and reason carefully. These three names are a start, not a full list; they stand for a habit of public argument.

Theatre staged tragedy and comedy for citizens at festivals. Plays explored pride, fate, war and family conflict in front of large audiences. Performance was civic culture, not only private entertainment. In science and maths, figures such as **Pythagoras** and **Archimedes** stand for mathematical reasoning and problem-solving. In medicine, the tradition linked to **Hippocrates** sought natural explanations of illness rather than only blaming gods, though ancient medicine was not modern hospitals. Natural explanation is a method, not a modern clinic.

How these achievements fit together, step by step: (1) poleis value public speech and competition; (2) philosophers model questioning and classification; (3) playwrights stage hard moral cases for crowds; (4) mathematicians and inventors push proof and problem-solving; (5) medical writers look for natural causes; (6) all of this grows alongside slavery, war and exclusion. Legacy is not a medal for moral perfection. It is a set of tools: dialogue, proof, drama, observation.

Everyday example: a debate club, a school play and a science fair in one term. Different subjects, shared culture of showing work in public. Greek civic life mixed argument, performance and enquiry in related ways.

Year 8 examples: Athenian festivals gave theatre a mass audience. Socrates' public questioning could annoy powerful people. Aristotle's habit of comparing constitutions links back to studying many poleis. Hippocratic emphasis on natural causes does not mean modern hospitals; it means a method shift toward observation and reasoned care.

Worked example: "Greeks invented everything good." Challenge it: other cultures contributed; Greek tools were selected and changed later; exclusions and wars remain part of the same world. Question: what should Year 8 keep? Answer: habits of dialogue, proof, drama and natural explanation, held with clear eyes about who was left out.

Why it matters: ideas can outlive armies. Later empires and schools reuse Greek tools of thought even when Greek political independence is gone.

Bridge: stone and style also travel. Architecture and the idea of legacy close the cultural arc before the Portugal panel.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Match Socrates, Plato and Aristotle to one focus each (questioning, the city and knowledge, logic and observation).
- 2 Why was Greek theatre a civic event, not only private fun?
- 3 What did the Hippocratic tradition emphasise about illness?

◆ CAREFUL

Legacy is not a moral gold medal. Celebrate tools of thought without erasing slavery, exclusion and war in the same Greek world.

TOPIC 7.6

Architecture and legacy

The account

Greek builders developed architectural **orders** (styles) such as **Doric**, **Ionic** and **Corinthian**, visible in column design and temple proportion. Symmetry and careful ratios shaped famous temples, including the **Parthenon** on Athens' Acropolis. Public buildings announced civic pride and religious devotion in stone. A temple was a house for a god's statue and a statement of the city's wealth and taste. Stone is a message as well as a shelter.

Legacy means what later people inherit, reuse or argue with. Greek influence on politics, thought, science, medicine, theatre, architecture and sport is a legacy of ideas under debate, not a claim that Greece was perfect or that every later achievement "belongs" to Greece alone. Other cultures contributed. Romans adapted Greek models for forums and theatres. Later Europe and the wider world selected pieces for their own purposes, sometimes forgetting the original religious setting.

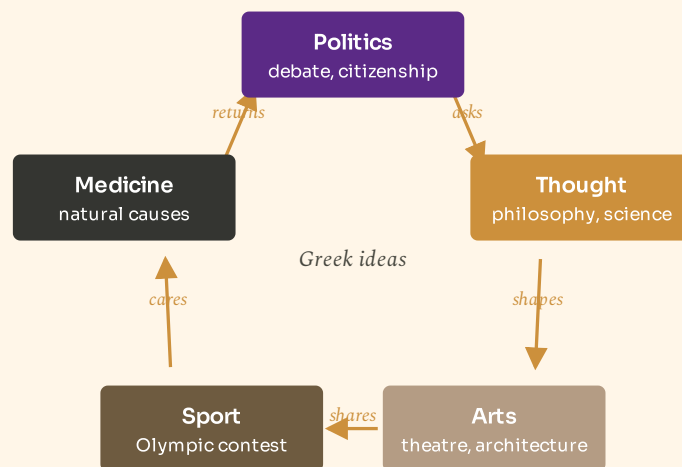


Figure 7.3 · Greek ideas in a cycle.

Politics, thought, arts, sport and medicine feed one another around a centre of Greek ideas. Pick one node and name a concrete example from this unit.

How to handle legacy fairly, step by step: (1) name a concrete achievement (for example column orders, tragedy, democratic vocabulary, natural medicine ideas); (2) say who later reused it; (3) note what changed in the reuse; (4) name a limit or silence (enslaved labour, excluded women, cities destroyed in war); (5) write both achievement and limit in linked sentences.

Everyday example: walk past a modern bank or museum with columns and you may see a faint echo of temple language. Watch a democratic debate and you may hear Athenian words used in new ways. Those echoes are real, and so are the silences.

Year 8 examples: the Parthenon becomes a symbol far beyond its original cult role. Roman builders copy and adapt. Renaissance and later architects (later units) return to classical forms. Sporting festivals borrow Olympic memory. None of that erases helots, enslaved quarry workers, or the wreckage of Greek wars.

Worked example: two sentences required. Achievement: "Greek architectural orders and public theatre gave later societies reusable languages of beauty and civic performance." Limit: "Those achievements grew in poleis that excluded many residents from power and fought devastating wars." Together they answer the unit enquiry without cheerleading or sneering alone.

Why it matters: what outlives armies is often tools of thought, style and story. Empires pick them up; critics argue with them; students must hold both inheritance and cost.

Bridge: while Greek poleis clustered around the Aegean, western Iberia had its own communities and Mediterranean contacts. The Portugal panel keeps that wider map honest.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the three classical column orders and one famous Athenian temple.
- 2 What does legacy mean in this topic?
- 3 Write two sentences: one achievement to keep, one limit to remember.

◆ CAREFUL

Columns on a modern building are an echo, not proof that "we are the Greeks". Legacy is reuse and argument, not ownership of the past.

TOPIC 7.7

Portugal in the global story: western Iberia and the Greek world

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?**** WHILE GREEK POLEIS CLUSTERED AROUND THE AEGEAN, THE WESTERN **IBERIAN PENINSULA** HELD DIVERSE COMMUNITIES WITH THEIR OWN LANGUAGES, CRAFTS AND LOCAL POWERS. PORTUGAL DID NOT YET EXIST AS A COUNTRY. PEOPLE LIVED BY FARMING, HERDING, METALWORKING AND COASTAL EXCHANGE. ATLANTIC SHORES AND RIVER MOUTHS, INCLUDING THE AREA OF LATER LISBON ON THE TAGUS, OFFERED FISHING AND TRADE LONG BEFORE PORTUGUESE KINGS. DAILY LIFE WAS LOCAL AND PRACTICAL, NOT AN EMPTY BLANK WAITING FOR LATER GLORY.

Key person, place or event. Phoenician and other Mediterranean traders contacted Iberian communities, drawn by metals such as silver and tin and by coastal markets. Those contacts linked western shores into wider exchange without turning Iberia into a dense Greek colony zone like parts of southern Italy or Sicily. Traders, not Athenian settlers, were the usual middle step. That difference matters: connection can arrive through many hands.

Geography connection. The Atlantic coastline and metal-rich interiors made western Iberia valuable even when far from Athens. Distance from the Aegean was real, but sea routes along the Mediterranean and through the Gibraltar strait still allowed goods, styles and techniques to move step by step. A river mouth such as the Tagus is a strategic doorway of the kind you met in Unit 2: inland and ocean options on one site.



Figure 7.4 • Lisbon and the Tagus edge.

A harbour city on a great river shows why western Iberia mattered to long-distance trade even when it was not a Greek colony zone. Notice water as the link, not emptiness.

How to place Iberia beside Greece, step by step: (1) start with local Iberian communities, not later national flags; (2) add Mediterranean traders seeking metals and markets; (3) note the lack of dense classical Greek colonisation compared with southern Italy or Sicily; (4) keep the Atlantic and Tagus in view as long-term geographic advantages; (5) refuse the false story that only Aegean places had "real history" in this era.

Everyday example: two streets in the same city. One hosts a famous club; the other hosts workshops and market stalls. Both are full of life. Aegean fame does not empty Iberian time.

Worked example: "Nothing happened in Portugal during the Greek age." Challenge it with farming, herding, metalwork, coastal exchange and Phoenician contacts. Question: why include this panel?

Answer: Year 8's identity is states, empires and networks from Greece to Atlantic expansion. Western Iberia is part of that arc from early, not only from 1415 onward.

Why it matters: networks reach beyond famous centres. Metals, coasts and middlemen link the Atlantic edge to Mediterranean systems long before ocean empires. Power and exchange are multi-centred.

Bridge: Part two continues into Macedon and Alexander, then Rome. Keep map skills, landforms and trade ideas alive as the political scale grows.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the key person, place or event from this panel and say why it matters.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason Portugal's story connects to this wider period (use metals, coast or the Tagus).
- 3 Answer the key question in four to six sentences, using one piece of evidence: how was western Iberia linked to Mediterranean networks without being a dense Greek colony zone?

◆ CAREFUL

Portugal did not yet exist as a country. Write about western Iberian communities and contacts, not modern borders projected backward.

■ WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Parthenon, Thermopylae, philosophy, legacy

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

What did the Greeks create that outlived their armies?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

PART THREE

Alexander and the Hellenistic world

A Macedonian army connected cultures from the Aegean to the edge of India. Conquest is not the whole story: language, cities and exchange outlived the empire that tried to hold them.

Follow the route and the cost. Speed of victory is not the same as a lasting single state. After Alexander, Hellenistic kingdoms and new cities kept Greek language in contact with older cultures.

Unit 8 is the hinge from many Greek poleis toward wider imperial space.

PART THREE AT A GLANCE

Alexander and the Hellenistic world

One chapter, and the question each one answers. Use this page as a map of the part: read the enquiry for the unit you are about to start, then turn the page into the opener.

Unit 8

Alexander the Great

Was Alexander a great leader, a commander, or primarily a conqueror?



Alexander and the Hellenistic world. Look for place and movement in the image, then name which unit enquiry it helps you answer first.

Revision tip: cover the enquiry column and say each unit title in order. Then uncover and check you still know the question each chapter is for.



PART THREE · UNIT 8

8

Alexander the Great

Was Alexander a great leader, a commander, or primarily a conqueror?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Locate Macedon and explain Philip's reforms.
- ✓ Follow conquest to Egypt and the east, and why the army stopped.
- ✓ Define Hellenistic and debate legacy.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Was Alexander a great leader, a commander, or primarily a conqueror?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 8.1

Macedon and Philip II

The account

Macedon was a kingdom north of the famous Greek city-states, on the edge of the Greek-speaking world. Many southern Greeks looked down on Macedonians as rough outsiders, more useful as allies or enemies than as equal partners in culture. That view changed under **Philip II**, who ruled from 359 to 336 BCE. Philip did not invent war, but he rebuilt how Macedon fought and how it paid for fighting. He built a professional army that trained all year, not only when war broke out. He improved the **phalanx**, a deep block of soldiers armed with long spears called **sarissas**. The long spears gave the front ranks reach that shorter weapons struggled to match. Cavalry struck from the sides while the phalanx held the centre. Money from mines and careful alliances helped him buy loyalty and hire specialists. Think of a sports club that suddenly gains full-time coaches, better kit and a clear game plan: the same players can look transformed.



Figure 8.1 · Aegean-style coast under open sky.

Philip and Alexander moved from a northern kingdom into a sea-linked Greek world. Notice how coast and inland both matter for empire.

Philip also used politics. He forced most of Greece into a league under Macedonian leadership after winning at **Chaeronea** in 338 BCE. Athens and Thebes had to accept his power even though they still called themselves free cities. When Philip was murdered in 336 BCE, his son **Alexander** inherited that machine: a drilled army, a plan to invade the Persian Empire, and a famous tutor, **Aristotle**, who had taught him about

plants, politics and Greek culture. Alexander was about twenty when he became king. He was not starting from nothing. His father had already solved the hardest early problem: how to turn a northern kingdom into the strongest force in the Greek world.

Geography shaped the story. Macedon sat north of the main Greek poleis, with access to timber, metals and routes into the Balkans as well as south toward Thessaly. That position let Philip pressure Greece from outside while drawing on resources the rocky south sometimes lacked. Understanding Philip first stops you treating Alexander as a lone genius who invented power overnight. Skill on the battlefield built on reforms made before he was born. A fair enquiry answer names the inheritance as well as the heir. Worked reasoning: if two leaders share one army system, judging only the second leader hides half the causes. Read the short timeline figure: Philip's rise sits before Alexander's famous battles for a reason. That order matters for states and empires because professional armies and forced leagues are tools of power that outlast any single speech. Next you will follow how that same machine moved far beyond Greece.

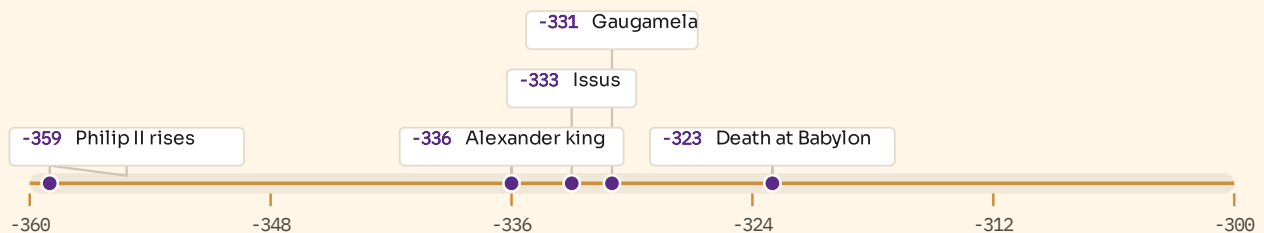


Figure 8.2 · Philip to Alexander: a short timeline.

Read left to right. Notice how little time separates Philip's rise, Alexander's accession, the great battles and his death: the career is brilliant and brief.



LOOK FURTHER

Livius, Alexander the Great. A careful classical site on route, sources and disputed legacy.

www.livius.org/articles/person/alexander-the-great/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Where was Macedon in relation to Athens and Sparta, and why did that northern position matter for Philip's rise?
- 2 Define **phalanx** and **sarissa** in your own words, then explain how cavalry fitted Philip's battle plan.
- 3 Why is it unfair or incomplete to judge Alexander without mentioning Philip? Use one concrete reform as evidence.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat Alexander as a self-made genius. Philip's army reforms, mine wealth and victory at Chaeronea built the platform Alexander inherited.

TOPIC 8.2

Alexander, army and conquest

The account

Alexander led the Macedonian army into **Anatolia** (the large peninsula that is now mostly Turkey) and then deep into the **Persian Empire**. At battles such as the **Granicus**, **Issus** and **Gaugamela**, combined tactics beat larger Persian forces. The phalanx fixed the enemy in place; cavalry, often led by Alexander himself, hit weak points. Persian kings fielded huge armies, but numbers did not always equal coordination. Alexander's force was smaller, better drilled and used to fighting as one machine. Imagine two school teams: one with more players but muddled instructions, one with fewer players who have practised the same moves for years. Skill and unity can beat raw size.

Maps make the story harder, not easier. Each victory pushed the army further from home. **Supply lines** are the routes that carry food, water, spare weapons, pay and replacements to an army. When those routes stretch across mountains, deserts and rivers, every day of marching raises the risk of hunger, delay and mutiny. Local guides, captured stores and new cities along the route mattered as much as glory speeches. Soldiers walked for years. Some married into local families. Others grew tired and angry. Conquest looks smooth on a wall map of coloured arrows; on the ground it was dusty, slow and dangerous.



Figure 8.3 • Alexander's route as a chain of stages.

Follow from Macedon through Anatolia and Egypt into Persia, then to the Indian edge. Notice how each stage lengthens supply and risk, not only glory.

Worked reasoning: suppose an army wins a battle but loses half its pack animals and has to wait weeks for grain. The next map arrow still looks bold, but the real choice is whether the next march is possible. That is why logistics is part of military history, not a boring add-on. Named places help you hold the story: the Granicus opened Asia Minor; Issus broke a Persian army near the Mediterranean coast of modern Syria and Turkey; Gaugamela opened the path into the Persian heartland. Why it matters for states and empires: a state that can only win battles but cannot feed an army cannot hold an empire. Networks of roads, rivers and cities decide whether victory turns into lasting control. Bridge: Egypt and the far east will show both the rewards of good sites and the hard stop when people refuse to march further.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Describe one way the phalanx and cavalry worked together in Alexander's battles, using a named battle if you can.
- 2 Why did each new victory make the next stage of the campaign harder, not easier? Mention distance or supply.
- 3 Define **supply lines** and give one reason they matter more the further an army marches from home.

 CAREFUL

Do not read coloured arrows on a map as easy travel. Every stage east of Greece lengthened supply lines, risk of mutiny and the cost of holding what was already taken.

TOPIC 8.3

Egypt, Asia and the limits of expansion

The account

In Egypt, Persian rule was resented by many locals. Alexander was welcomed in places and founded a new city on the Mediterranean coast: **Alexandria**. The site had a harbour, access to the Nile's trade, and a position that faced both Africa and the wider sea. Alexandria later became one of the greatest hubs of trade and scholarship in the ancient world, with libraries, scientists and mixed populations. Founding cities was a way to plant Greek-speaking settlers and keep control after the army moved on. A new city is both a gift to merchants and a tool of empire: people live there, pay tax there, and spread the ruler's language there. Choose the site carefully and the city can outlive the conqueror.

Further east, the story changed. Through modern Iran and into Central Asia and the **Indus** region, climate, terrain and distance piled up. Mountain passes, monsoons, unknown rivers and hostile tribes slowed the march. Soldiers faced heat, cold, illness and the simple fact that home was years of walking away. In 326 BCE, after years of campaigning, the army refused to push deeper into India. Alexander turned back. **Can geography stop even the most powerful army?** In practice, yes. Exhausted people, broken equipment and endless supply problems set a hard limit that no speech could erase.



Figure 8.4 • Temple stone in a Greek world of belief and display.

Hellenistic rulers later mixed Greek forms with local religions from Egypt to Asia. Notice how sacred buildings signal power as well as faith.

Worked reasoning: compare Alexandria with a dusty camp on a far eastern river. One site offers harbour, grain and long-term tax; the other offers only another march. A rational army may cheer at the first and mutiny at the second. That difference is geography pricing choices, not cowardice as a full explanation. Why it matters for states and empires: capitals and new cities fix power in place; endless expansion without bases

burns men and money. Networks need nodes. Alexandria became a node that lasted centuries after Alexander's death. Bridge: when the conqueror dies without a stable heir, those same cities and mixed cultures become the stage for the Hellenistic world, not one single empire.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why was the site of Alexandria a smart choice for a new city? Use harbour, river and sea in your answer.
- 2 List three non-battle reasons the army could not keep expanding forever (for example climate, supply, morale).
- 3 How does the army's refusal in India change the picture of Alexander as all-powerful? Use evidence, not only opinion.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not confuse founding a city with permanent control of a whole region. Alexandria thrived as a hub; the army still hit a hard limit on the Indian edge in 326 BCE.

TOPIC 8.4

The Hellenistic world and legacy

The account

After 323 BCE, Alexander died at Babylon with no adult heir ready to hold the whole map. His generals fought for pieces of the empire. Political unity broke even while Greek culture kept spreading. Rival kingdoms took shape: the **Ptolemies** in Egypt, the **Seleucids** across much of Asia, and the **Antigonids** in Macedon, among other short-lived claims. Yet Greek language, art styles, coins and city plans spread and mixed with Egyptian, Persian and Asian traditions. Historians call this mixed culture **Hellenistic**, from a Greek word linked to "Greek-like". It was a Greek mix, not pure Athens copied everywhere. Local gods gained Greek names or Greek statues; Greek settlers adopted local dress and partners; Ptolemaic rulers in Egypt acted as both pharaohs and Greek kings.

A useful classroom image is a recipe: Greek ingredients stirred into older local dishes, not a plate of only Greek food. Alexandria in Egypt became a symbol of that mix: scholarship, trade and power under a dynasty that spoke Greek but ruled an Egyptian land. Other cities from the Aegean to Asia carried theatres, gymnasia and markets. Ideas moved with merchants and soldiers. So did conflict. Hellenistic kingdoms warred with each other for generations until Rome swallowed them one by one.

	Achievement	Cost
Military	Huge conquests, fast.	Cities destroyed, lives lost.
Culture	Hellenistic mixing.	Local rule often crushed.
Politics	New cities founded.	Empire split after death.

Figure 8.5 · Judging Alexander: achievement against cost.

Read each row across. A balanced legacy paragraph needs evidence from both columns, not only victory lists.

Worked reasoning: if culture spreads while political unity fails, then "empire" and "influence" are not the same word. Alexander's conquests were brief as a single state; Hellenistic exchange lasted much longer. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: networks of language, coin and city design can outlive the army that first carried them. That is a key Year 8 idea. Bridge: while the eastern Mediterranean reshaped under Greek-speaking dynasties, the western Mediterranean and Iberia followed different powers. The next topic asks where Portugal's future lands sat in that wider map.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What does **Hellenistic** mean, and why is "Greek mix" a better phrase than "purely Greek"?
- 2 Give one positive and one critical piece of evidence for judging Alexander's legacy (use the achievement/cost idea).
- 3 Why did the empire split after 323 BCE even though Greek culture kept spreading? Name at least one successor kingdom.

 CAREFUL

Do not treat "Hellenistic" as "Athens everywhere". It means Greek forms mixed with local Egyptian, Persian and Asian traditions under rival kingdoms after 323 BCE.

TOPIC 8.5

Portugal in the global story: Iberia and Mediterranean trade

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?****ALEXANDER'S ARMIES NEVER REACHED THE **IBERIAN PENINSULA**.** WHILE MACEDONIAN POWER RESHAPED THE EASTERN MEDITERRANEAN, WESTERN IBERIA (THE LANDS THAT WOULD MUCH LATER BECOME PORTUGAL AND SPAIN) STAYED OUTSIDE HIS POLITICAL MAP. THAT DOES NOT MEAN THE REGION WAS CUT OFF FROM THE WORLD. COMMUNITIES ALONG THE ATLANTIC COAST AND INLAND METAL-RICH ZONES ALREADY FARMED, HERDED AND TRADED WITH MEDITERRANEAN PARTNERS. GOODS, IDEAS AND TECHNIQUES COULD TRAVEL WITHOUT A MACEDONIAN GOVERNOR. THINK OF A SCHOOL NETWORK WHERE NEWS REACHES A DISTANT CLASSROOM THROUGH FRIENDS OF FRIENDS: CONNECTION WITHOUT FORMAL MEMBERSHIP.

Key person, place or event. Carthage, a powerful North African city founded by Phoenician settlers, built commercial and political influence in parts of Iberia during the centuries around Alexander's lifetime and after. Carthaginian traders and, later, armies linked the peninsula to wider western Mediterranean rivalries, especially with Rome. Iberian metals, including silver from mining districts and coastal markets, mattered to powers that never flew Alexander's banner. Places such as Gadir (later Cadiz) show long Phoenician and then Carthaginian interest on Iberia's southern edge. **Geography connection.** Western Mediterranean sea routes ran from North Africa and Italy toward Iberia's coasts. Rivers and mining districts inland made the peninsula valuable for metals and farm produce. The Atlantic edge was not empty: it was a resource zone tied by sea to Carthage's network long before Rome's full conquest.

Worked reasoning: if two regions share a sea but not a conqueror, trade can still link them. Empire is one form of connection; commercial networks are another. Why it matters: Portugal's later story sits on Iberian land that entered Mediterranean power politics through Carthage and then Rome, not through Alexander. Bridge: Unit 9 turns to Italy and the city that would eventually dominate both the eastern Hellenistic kingdoms and western Iberia: Rome.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the key person, place or event from this panel (Carthage or a linked site) and say why it matters for western Iberia.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason the future territory of Portugal connected to Mediterranean trade even though Alexander never marched there.
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in four to six sentences: was Alexander mainly a leader, a commander, or a conqueror? Use at least one piece of evidence from this unit.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not assume "outside Alexander's map" means "isolated". Iberia linked to Mediterranean trade through Carthage and coastal routes long before Macedonian armies arrived in the east.

WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Hellenistic, phalanx, Alexandria, Macedon

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THE ENQUIRY

Was Alexander a great leader, a commander, or primarily a conqueror?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

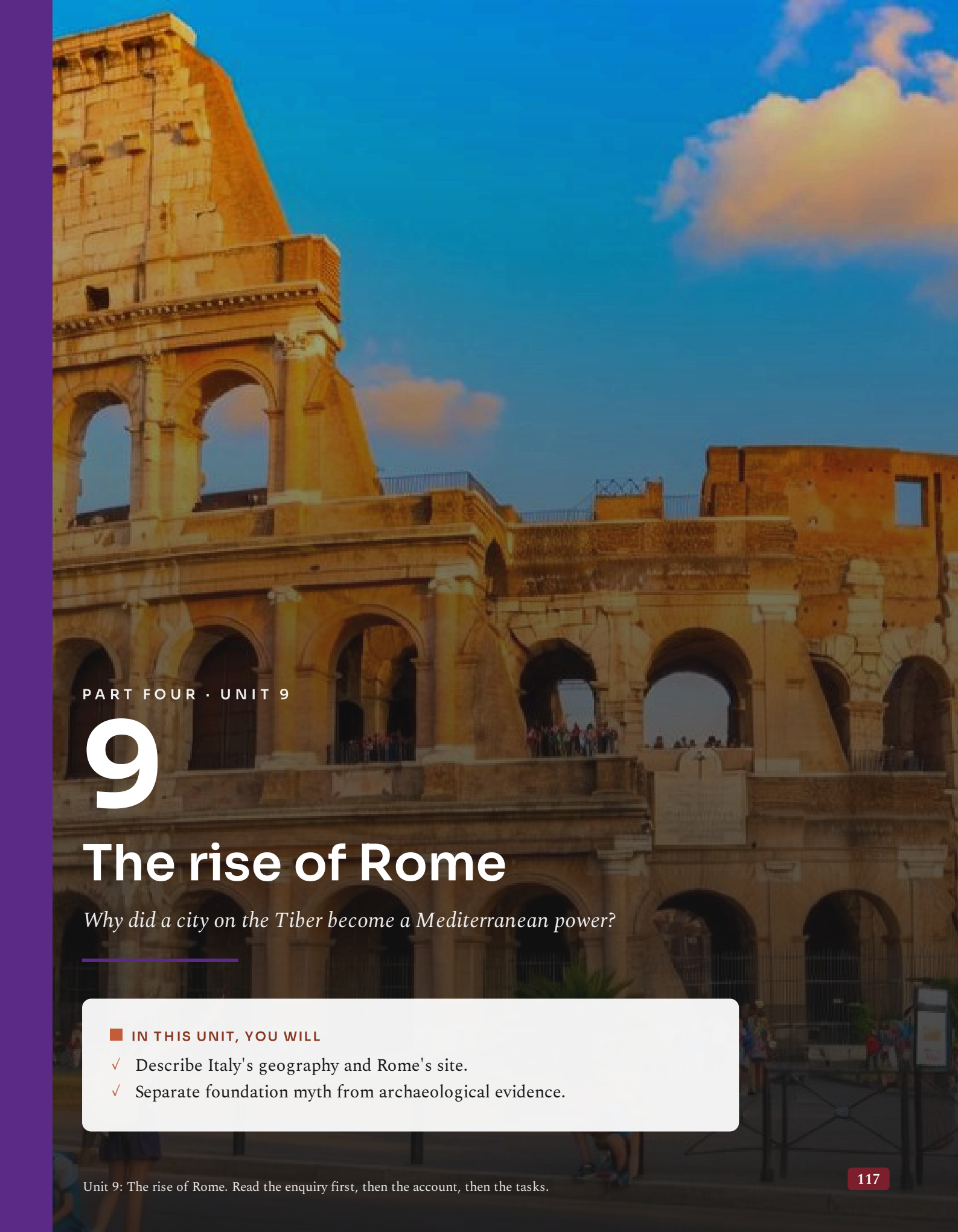
PART FOUR

Ancient Rome

A city on the Tiber became a Mediterranean empire of roads, law and armies. Follow republic into empire, then faith, capitals and the transformation of the West.

Ask at every stage who held the army, who paid the tax and which routes moved grain and orders. Rome is a story of institutions under the pressure of distance.

Units 9 to 13 run from geography and republic through empire, Christianity and the fall of the West.



PART FOUR · UNIT 9

9

The rise of Rome

Why did a city on the Tiber become a Mediterranean power?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Describe Italy's geography and Rome's site.
- ✓ Separate foundation myth from archaeological evidence.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why did a city on the Tiber become a Mediterranean power?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 9.1

Geography of Italy

The account

The **Italian Peninsula** juts into the central Mediterranean like a long boot. That position mattered. From Italy, ships and armies could reach North Africa, Greece, Spain and the eastern seas without crossing a whole continent first. The **Apennine Mountains** run down the spine of the peninsula. They break the land into valleys and coastal strips, but they do not cut Italy off from the sea the way higher, colder ranges might. Fertile plains, especially in the **Po Valley** in the north and along parts of the west coast, could grow grain and support growing populations. Think of a long pier sticking into a busy harbour: whoever organises the pier can step onto many boats.



Figure 9.1 • The Colosseum in Rome.

A vast public building from the city that grew on the Tiber. Notice scale and stone craft; Rome later projected this urban power across the Mediterranean.

Long coastlines offered harbours and fishing, but they also exposed communities to raiders and rival fleets. Italy is not an island, so overland links to the rest of Europe always existed through the north. For a city that later wanted empire, the peninsula was a launch pad in several directions at once: west toward Iberia, south toward Africa, east toward Greece and Asia. Central position lowered travel time compared with a capital stuck at the far edge of the sea. Summer sailing seasons and winter storms still priced every naval plan, but the map offered options.

Geography did not make empire automatic. Many peoples lived in Italy before Rome dominated them: **Etruscans** in the north and centre, **Latins** around Rome, **Samnites** in the southern mountains, Greek colonists in the south (often called **Magna Graecia**), and others. Mountains and distances slowed unification. Yet once one power organised the peninsula, the same geography that had kept communities apart helped that power project force outward. A united Italy is a platform; a divided Italy is a patchwork of local wars. Rome's later success rests partly on winning that Italian puzzle first.

	Italian advantages	Why they matter
Peninsula	Sea on three sides.	Trade and navy options.
Centre of Med	Short hops to coasts.	Expansion in many directions.
Plains + hills	Farm and defend.	Rome's seven hills + Tiber.

Figure 9.2 · Italian geography as advantages and reasons.

Read each row: peninsula, central sea position, plains and hills. Link each physical fact to a political or military consequence.

Worked reasoning: a grain ship leaving a west-coast port can reach North Africa faster than an army marches over the Alps. Sea shortcuts matter. Why it matters for states and empires: location prices options; it does not choose winners. Bridge: the next topic zooms from the peninsula scale to the exact hills and river bend where Rome grew.



LOOK FURTHER

Museum of London, Roman collections. Roman material culture at the edge of empire.

www.museumoflondon.org.uk/collections/about-our-collections/what-we-collect/roman

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

- YOUR TURN**

 - Why does Italy's central position in the Mediterranean help explain later Roman expansion? Name two directions power could project.
 - How might the Apennines both help and hinder a power trying to unite Italy?
 - Name two peoples who lived in Italy before Rome dominated them, and say why that matters for the enquiry.

CAREFUL

Do not treat Italy's boot shape as destiny. Many peoples shared the peninsula; Rome still had to win wars, alliances and organisation before geography became a launch pad.

TOPIC 9.2

Seven hills and the Tiber

The account

Rome grew beside the **Tiber River**, inland from the coast but close enough to reach the sea by water. The famous **seven hills** gave height for defence, lookout and settlement above flood-prone ground. Crossing points on the Tiber made the spot useful for trade between coastal and inland communities. Early huts and villages on the hills slowly knitted into one city. Water, transport and a defensible site are not exciting on a poster, but they are the practical reasons a place thrives. Imagine several neighbouring hamlets on slight rises beside a bridge: over time they share markets, walls and a name.

Geographers separate **site** from **situation**. **Site** means the exact local features: hills, river bend, soil. **Situation** means how that place relates to a wider region: distance to the sea, position in Italy, links to other towns. Rome's site was the hills and the Tiber. Rome's situation was central western Italy, with access both inland and toward the Mediterranean. A strong site with a weak situation stays local. A strong situation with a poor site struggles to survive attack. Rome combined both over time. Train yourself to use both words in one sentence about any capital you study.



Figure 9.3 • River valley landscape.

Water routes, flood plains and higher ground shaped early settlement choices. Notice how a river is both resource and risk.

The Tiber also linked Rome to the coast near **Ostia**, which later grew as a port serving the capital. Salt, grain and other goods moved by water more cheaply than by rough track. Floods remained a danger; low ground near the river was useful for markets but risky for permanent housing, which is one reason hilltops mattered. Worked reasoning: if you only praise the hills, you miss the river trade; if you only praise the river, you miss defence. Site is a package. Why it matters for states and empires: capitals need defensible cores and links outward. Bridge: Romans later told dramatic stories about how the city began. Those myths are evidence of identity, not the same as archaeology.

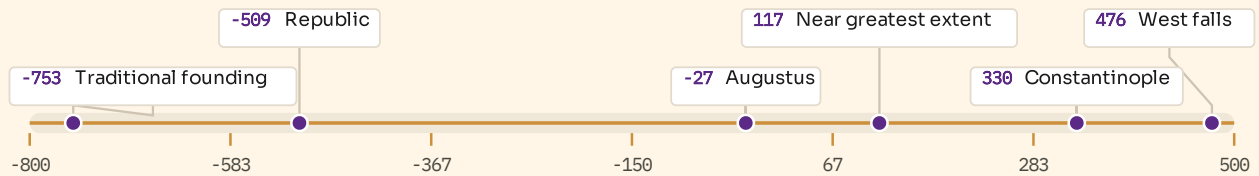


Figure 9.4 • Rome on a long timeline of conventional markers.

Use the line to place founding tradition, republic, empire and the fall of the west before you argue about causes. This unit sits at the left-hand end of that story.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Explain the difference between **site** and **situation** using Rome as your example in one clear sentence for each word.
- 2 Give two advantages the Tiber gave early Rome, and one risk river living still carried.
- 3 Why were the hills useful even though they are not very high mountains? Link your answer to flood, defence or lookout.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not mix up **site** and **situation**. Site is the local hills and Tiber bend; situation is how Rome sits in Italy and the wider Mediterranean.

TOPIC 9.3

Foundation myth and the kingdom

The account

Romans told a famous **foundation myth** about twin brothers, **Romulus and Remus**, raised by a she-wolf and linked to the fall of Troy through the hero **Aeneas**. In the story, Romulus founds the city and kills Remus after a quarrel about walls and power. A **foundation myth** is a traditional story about how a community began. Myths like this are evidence of what Romans wanted to believe about courage, destiny and divine favour. They are not the same as modern historical proof. Treat them as stories that shaped identity. A school origin story that claims the founders were "the bravest class ever" tells you about pride, not about a laboratory measurement.

Archaeology looks at layers of soil, pottery, walls and graves. It shows early settlements on the hills and gradual growth, not a single magic day when a wolf created a capital. Finds of huts, graves and later stone structures help historians sketch a slow rise from villages to a denser town. A period of **kings** is said to have ruled before the Republic. Later Roman writers listed kings and dramatic tales, but details are patchy and contested. Some kings may reflect real leaders; some stories may be later inventions to explain customs or justify power. The traditional date **753 BCE** for the founding is a conventional marker, useful for timelines, not a stopwatch reading from the day itself.

Worked reasoning: if a source is written centuries after the events and tells a perfect hero story, ask what purpose the story serves. Identity and politics often need origin tales. Archaeology answers different questions: what people ate, how they buried the dead, when walls appear. Why it matters for states and empires: shared myths can glue a people together as strongly as shared laws, but historians must separate story from proof. Bridge: Unit 10 leaves the kingdom tradition and enters the **Republic**, the system Romans claimed after they rejected kings.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a **foundation myth**, and what can the Romulus and Remus story tell us even if it is not proven fact?
- 2 How does archaeology give a different kind of evidence from legends written centuries later? Give one concrete type of find.
- 3 Why should we treat lists of early Roman kings and the date 753 BCE with care?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not use the she-wolf story as if it were a dated news report. Foundation myths show identity and values; archaeology and careful source criticism show what we can support about early Rome.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Tiber, foundation myth, peninsula, site, situation

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why did a city on the Tiber become a Mediterranean power?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

UNIT 9 AT A GLANCE

The rise of Rome

Enquiry. Why did a city on the Tiber become a Mediterranean power?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 9.1 Geography of Italy
- 9.2 Seven hills and the Tiber
- 9.3 Foundation myth and the kingdom

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** **priced a choice** for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

Tiber

foundation myth

peninsula

site

situation

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 3 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 9 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART FOUR · UNIT 10

10

The Roman Republic

How did republican institutions and the army expand Roman power?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define republic, Senate and social orders.
- ✓ Explain army and expansion including Carthage.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did republican institutions and the army expand Roman power?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 10.1

What is a republic?

The account

A **republic**, in the Roman sense, meant government without a hereditary king. Power was shared among offices and assemblies that claimed to serve the public thing, the **res publica** (literally "the public thing" or public affairs). Two **consuls** usually led for a year. Other magistrates handled courts, finances and public order. Written and customary laws limited what one man could do, at least in theory. Romans were proud of having thrown out kings and of checking ambition with shared rule and fixed terms. Think of a school council with two co-chairs who swap roles yearly: no permanent head pupil wearing a crown.



Figure 10.1 · A Roman road still running true.

Straight paved surfaces moved armies, messages and goods. Notice how engineering turns geography into control.

Ideal and practice did not always match. Rich families dominated high office. Emergency powers could concentrate authority in a crisis. Groups left out of full political rights included **enslaved people**, **women** and many **free non-citizens** (people living under Rome without the vote). Noticing who was left out matters because a system can look fair on paper while most people still cannot choose laws. Still, the republican idea mattered. It shaped how Romans explained their success and how later thinkers borrowed Roman language for their own governments.

A system can be exclusive and still be different from monarchy: the rules of competition among elites are not the same as rule by one hereditary king. When you define republic, always add *who could take part*. Compared with a monarchy, a republic spreads decision-making and makes succession less automatic. Compared with pure democracy (rule by the whole citizen body in person), Rome mixed popular assemblies with elite guidance. The balance shifted under stress, which is why later units watch the system crack. Geography of a growing Italian state already tested short-term offices designed for a smaller city. Worked reasoning: if power rotates yearly among elites but only elites can win, you have competition without full equality. Why it matters for states and empires: institutions shape how conquest is decided and who benefits. Bridge: the Senate and citizen conflict show how that system actually ran day to day.



LOOK FURTHER

Perseus Digital Library, Greco-Roman texts. Primary texts for careful, adult-supervised reading.

www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/collection?collection=Perseus:collection:Greco-Roman

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 In your own words, what made Roman government a **republic** rather than a monarchy? Mention offices or terms of power.
- 2 Name two limits on power that the republican system tried to use (for example two consuls, fixed terms).
- 3 Why is it important to notice who was left out of political rights when you define the Republic?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not define "republic" as "everyone was free and equal". Rome rejected kings, but enslaved people, women and many non-citizens still lacked full political rights.

TOPIC 10.2

Senate, citizens and conflict

The account

The **Senate** was a council of experienced, usually wealthy men who advised magistrates and guided foreign policy and finance. It did not always pass laws the way a modern parliament does, but its prestige made its opinions hard to ignore. **Magistrates** held power for limited terms and were expected to respect custom. Ordinary male **citizens** could vote in assemblies on laws and elections, though organisation of voting often favoured the rich. Picture a powerful staff room that never formally "rules" the school yet shapes almost every serious decision: influence without a single crown.

Roman society was divided. **Patricians** were the old aristocratic clans; **plebeians** were the broader citizen body, including rich and poor. For generations they struggled over debt, land and access to office. Over time plebeians gained **tribunes** (officials who could protect plebeians and block some measures) and more legal equality, but wealth still bought influence. **Citizenship** expanded as Rome defeated and absorbed Italian communities. Offering partial or full rights was a tool of incorporation: join us and gain legal status, or resist and face harsher terms. Law became a weapon of empire as well as a protection for Romans. Conflict inside the city never fully stopped.

Named examples help. The **Conflict of the Orders** is the long struggle between patricians and plebeians that produced reforms such as written law and tribunes. Later, arguments over land and debt returned when conquest poured wealth into few hands. Worked reasoning: if defeated Italians can become allies or citizens, Rome multiplies soldiers without inventing a new ethnicity. That is statecraft, not only battlefield luck. Why it matters for states and empires: incorporating outsiders through law is a network-building tool. Bridge: the army and the wars with Carthage show how those institutions met their greatest overseas test.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What role did the **Senate** play, and why did senators matter even without being kings?
- 2 Explain one difference between patricians and plebeians and one way plebeians improved their position (for example tribunes).
- 3 How could expanding **citizenship** help Rome control Italy? Use the idea of allies or legal status.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat the Senate as a modern elected parliament. It was a prestigious elite council whose advice steered policy; voting power and wealth still skewed who was heard.

TOPIC 10.3

Army, expansion and Carthage

The account

Roman expansion rested on a tough, organised army and a web of alliances in Italy. Early **legions** were formations of citizen soldiers who fought in flexible units rather than one rigid block. Discipline, roads, camps and the promise of land or loot kept armies effective. Defeated Italian peoples were often made allies who had to supply troops. That system multiplied Roman strength without turning every neighbour into a permanent enemy overnight. Think of a sports league where the winner forces other teams to play for it next season: the core club grows without fielding every player itself.

Across the sea stood **Carthage**, a rich North African power with a strong navy and interests in **Sicily**, Sardinia and Spain. The **Punic Wars** (from the Latin name for Carthaginians) dragged Rome into long, brutal conflict across three major wars (264-146 BCE in outline). In the Second Punic War, the Carthaginian general **Hannibal** marched from Spain over the Alps into Italy with war elephants and won terrifying victories, including at **Cannae**. Rome refused to surrender. It raised new armies, attacked Carthage's allies, and eventually invaded Africa. The Roman general **Scipio** defeated Hannibal at **Zama** near Carthage. Victory forced Rome to become a naval and overseas power, not only an Italian land force. Later, Rome destroyed Carthage in the Third Punic War and took direct control of more overseas territory.

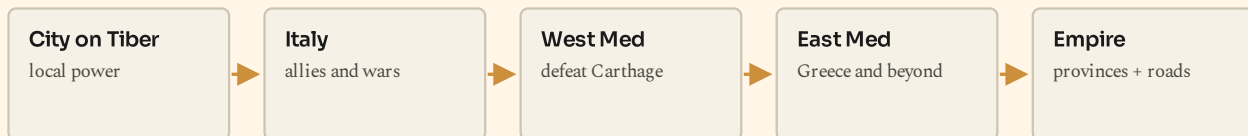


Figure 10.2 · Expansion as a staged flow.

Follow the boxes from city on the Tiber to empire. Each stage is a wider geography of control, not only a longer list of battles.

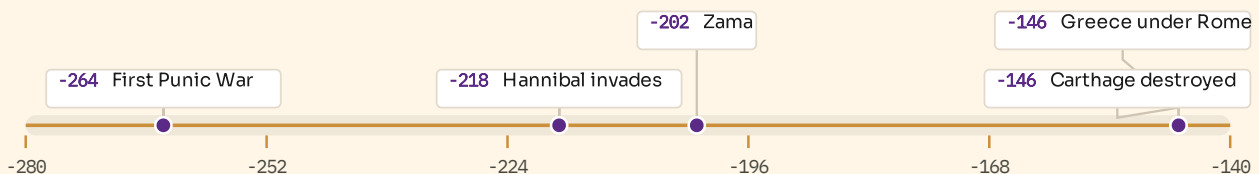


Figure 10.3 · Punic War milestones.

Read the timeline left to right. Notice how rivalry with Carthage spans decades and how 146 BCE marks both Carthage destroyed and Greece under Rome. Use dates as anchors, not as the whole explanation.

Worked reasoning: if Hannibal wins battles in Italy but cannot take Rome's alliances apart completely, Rome can still outlast him by raising new legions and striking elsewhere. Strategy is more than one battlefield. Why it matters for states and empires: defeating a rival sea power opens western Mediterranean routes and

locks Rome into governing provinces far from the Tiber. Bridge: Iberia, including the lands of the Lusitanians, entered that same story of conquest and resistance.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did alliances in Italy help Roman armies grow stronger than Rome alone?
- 2 Why was Hannibal's invasion of Italy such a shock, and how did Rome respond without collapsing? Mention at least one place or action.
- 3 In what way did the wars with Carthage change the kind of power Rome had become (land power only, or more)?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not reduce the Punic Wars to "Hannibal and elephants" alone. The long struggle forced Rome into naval and overseas empire, alliances, and the costly conquest of Iberia.

TOPIC 10.4

Portugal in the global story: Lusitania and Viriathus

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** AS ROME FOUGHT CARTHAGE AND THEN PUSHED DEEPER INTO THE IBERIAN PENINSULA, THE LANDS OF THE FAR WEST ENTERED THE SAME IMPERIAL STORY AS SICILY AND GREECE. THE PEOPLE ROMANS CALLED **LUSITANIANS** LIVED IN PARTS OF WHAT IS NOW PORTUGAL AND WESTERN SPAIN. THEY WERE NOT A SINGLE MODERN NATION, BUT THEIR RESISTANCE BECAME FAMOUS. ROMAN ADVANCE WAS SLOW, VIOLENT AND INCOMPLETE FOR DECADES. BURNING VILLAGES, TAKING HOSTAGES AND FOUNDING FORTS DID NOT INSTANTLY CREATE PEACEFUL PROVINCES. FOR PEOPLE LIVING ON THE ATLANTIC EDGE OF THE PENINSULA, "ROMAN VICTORY" WAS A LONG STORM, NOT A SINGLE AFTERNOON.

Key person, place or event. Viriathus, a Lusitanian leader in the second century BCE, organised guerrilla-style war against Roman forces. Roman writers, even when hostile, admitted his skill. He used mobility, local knowledge and surprise rather than matching Rome in open set-piece battles every time. His career shows that "Roman victory in Iberia" was a long, costly process, not a weekend parade. Resistance leaders matter because they reveal the price of empire for both sides. After his death (treachery and assassination feature in the sources), Rome still needed years to tighten control.

Geography connection. Western Iberia's mountains, river valleys (such as the Tagus basin) and Atlantic edge favoured mobile defence and made supply hard for invading armies. Distance from Italy meant messages and reinforcements took time. Mining wealth and coastal access made the region worth conquering anyway, which is why Rome kept pressing west after Carthage fell.

Worked reasoning: if an empire wins at Zama but still faces years of mountain war in Lusitania, overseas victory is staged, not automatic. Why it matters: Portugal's later identity sits on land that entered Mediterranean empire through resistance as well as roads and towns. Bridge: Unit 11 shows how success abroad cracked politics at home in Rome itself.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the key person from this panel (Viriathus) and say why his resistance matters for understanding Roman expansion.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason western Iberia was hard to conquer quickly (mountains, rivers, distance, or supply).
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in four to six sentences: how did republican institutions and the army expand Roman power? Use one Italian and one overseas example.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not write "Rome conquered Iberia overnight after Carthage". Lusitanian resistance under leaders such as Viriathus shows decades of costly war on difficult ground.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Senate, legion, Carthage, Lusitania**■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO**

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How did republican institutions and the army expand Roman power?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FOUR · UNIT 11

11

Julius Caesar and the end of the Republic

Did Julius Caesar destroy the Republic?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain republican crisis, Caesar's career and Augustus's settlement.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Did Julius Caesar destroy the Republic?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 11.1

Problems of the Republic

The account

By the late Republic, Rome ruled vast lands, but its old habits of short-term magistrates and elite competition cracked under the weight of empire. Conquest poured in wealth, slaves and grain. Some senators and traders grew enormously rich. Many small farmers, who had once been the backbone of citizen armies, lost land after long wars or debt. Crowds of poor citizens in the city became a political force that ambitious men could feed, flatter or frighten. Think of a club that wins every match abroad while its own changing room fills with jealousy, debt and unpaid bills: victory outside does not guarantee health inside.



Figure 11.1 • Monumental Rome after civil war.

Public stone shows the capital that generals fought to dominate. Notice how city display and political crisis shared one stage.

Rival **generals** became more dangerous than foreign kings. Soldiers who served for years far from home often felt more loyalty to the commander who paid them and promised farms than to the abstract Senate. When politicians such as **Marius** and **Sulla** used armies in civil conflict, a terrible lesson spread: force inside Italy could decide politics. Street gangs, bribery and assassinations made peaceful competition harder. Laws still existed, but **norms** (the unwritten rules of fair play) wore thin. A written rulebook means little if people stop respecting the spirit of the game. Reformers who tried to solve land and debt problems, including the **Gracchi** brothers in earlier decades, often met violence, which taught ambitious men that waiting for calm debate was risky.

None of this was caused by one man alone. Geography of empire mattered: provinces stretched from Spain to Asia, so governors commanded real armies at a distance from Rome. Communication was slow. A successful proconsul could return as a hero with veterans at his back. The Republic's institutions had been designed for a city-state managing Italy, not for a Mediterranean superpower. Long frontiers and rich provinces priced a new kind of political risk. Worked reasoning: if soldiers depend on a general for pay and land, then elections in Rome become less decisive than camps outside the walls. Why it matters for states and empires: expansion can break the institutions that first made expansion possible. Bridge: Julius Caesar steps into this cracked system, he does not invent every crack.

	Republic	Empire (principate)
Top power	Magistrates and Senate.	Emperor with army loyalty.
Risk	Rival generals.	Bad succession crises.
Strength	Shared offices.	Faster command over distance.

Figure 11.2 · Republic compared with empire (principate).

Read each row across. Notice which risks and strengths swap when top power moves from shared offices to an emperor with army loyalty.



LOOK FURTHER

BBC History, Julius Caesar. A short biography after you have ranked causes yourself.

www.bbc.co.uk/history/historic_figures/caesar_julius.shtml

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Give two ways wealth from conquest made republican politics more unstable (think land, slaves, inequality or urban crowds).
- 2 Why might a soldier feel more loyal to his general than to the Senate? Use pay, land or distance from Rome.
- 3 How did the size of Rome's empire put pressure on institutions built for a smaller state? Give one geographical or military reason.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not blame the whole late-Republic crisis on Julius Caesar alone. Marius, Sulla, land loss, provincial armies and broken norms already made politics violent before he crossed the Rubicon.

TOPIC 11.2

Caesar, civil war and Augustus

The account

Julius Caesar was a brilliant politician and general. In **Gaul** (roughly modern France and neighbours) he won fame, loot and a fiercely loyal army through years of campaigning. His enemies in the Senate feared he would use that army to dominate Rome. When they tried to strip his command, Caesar led troops across the **Rubicon** river into Italy (49 BCE), a step that meant civil war. Crossing that small boundary without permission was a public choice to use force against the state. He defeated rivals, including **Pompey**, and took the title of **dictator**, at first for limited periods and then in ways that looked permanent. On the **Ides of March** in 44 BCE, conspirators stabbed him to death, claiming they were saving the Republic. A dagger can kill a man; it cannot automatically repair broken institutions.

Assassination did not restore the old order. Another round of civil wars followed. Caesar's heir **Octavian** (later **Augustus**) outmanoeuvred rivals such as **Mark Antony** and **Cleopatra** of Egypt. After victory at **Actium** (31 BCE) and the settlement that followed, Augustus kept many republican *forms*: there were still consuls, a Senate and elections of a sort. In reality he held the key military and financial powers. Historians call this the start of the **Empire** (or **principate**), even though Romans often avoided the word "king". Augustus advertised peace after decades of bloodshed. For many exhausted elites and ordinary people, order mattered more than full republican competition.



Figure 11.3 · Maps and planning tools of power.

Commanders and emperors needed geography as well as armies. Notice how control of distance becomes a political skill.

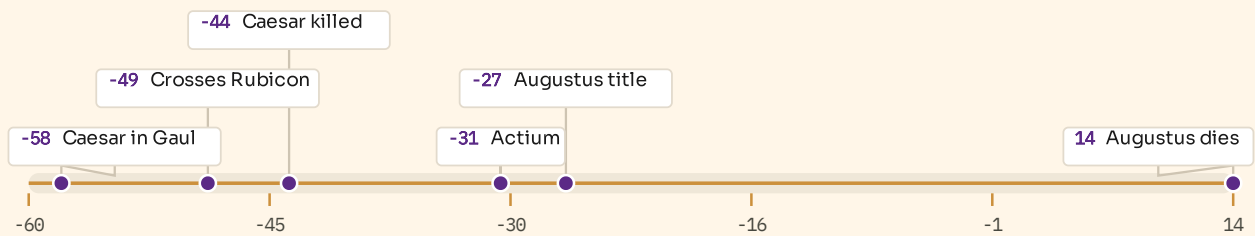


Figure 11.4 · From Gaul to Augustus.

Follow the dates: command in Gaul, Rubicon, assassination, Actium, then the Augustan settlement. Notice that killing Caesar did not restore the old Republic by itself.

Worked reasoning for the enquiry: argument A says Caesar destroyed the Republic by seizing permanent power and fighting civil war. Argument B says the Republic was already broken by generals, wealth gaps and provincial armies, so Caesar accelerated a collapse that was underway. A strong Year 8 answer uses both, then weighs them. Why it matters for states and empires: when army loyalty outruns shared offices, a system can keep old names while changing real power. Bridge: Unit 12 asks how emperors actually controlled a vast Mediterranean empire once one man stood at the top.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why was crossing the **Rubicon** such a serious political act? What did it signal about force and the state?
- 2 How did Augustus keep republican forms while holding real power? Give one form he kept and one real power he held.
- 3 Give one argument that Caesar destroyed the Republic and one argument that it was already broken before him. Which weighs more for you, and why?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not stop the story at Caesar's murder. The Republic did not automatically return in 44 BCE; Augustus later held military and financial power while keeping republican titles.

■ WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

dictator, civil war, Augustus, Rubicon

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ **THE ENQUIRY**

Did Julius Caesar destroy the Republic?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FOUR · UNIT 12

12

The Roman Empire

How did Rome control such a large empire?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain Pax Romana, infrastructure, towns, law and trade.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did Rome control such a large empire?**
You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 12.1

Pax Romana

The account

Under the early emperors, many provinces experienced long stretches of relative internal peace that later writers called the **Pax Romana**, the Roman peace. "Peace" here does not mean kindness for everyone. Frontiers still saw war. Rebellions were crushed. Slavery continued. Yet inside large parts of the empire, roads were safer for merchants, cities grew, and local elites often cooperated with Roman governors because order protected trade and status. Think of a busy corridor where monitors keep fights down so most pupils can walk to class: calm for some is still enforcement, not friendship for all.



Figure 12.1 • Roads that held an empire.

Look along the paved line and imagine legions, tax collectors and traders. Notice why infrastructure is political as well as technical.

Control mixed force with incentives. Legions and forts warned against revolt. Citizenship, legal rights and careers in the army or administration offered paths for some provincials to join the system. Emperors advertised stability after the civil wars. Coins, statues and public buildings carried the message that one centre held the Mediterranean together. The peace was uneven: a farming village far from trouble lived differently from a frontier fort or a recently conquered zone. Geography of the Mediterranean basin helped: sea lanes and road corridors linked provinces, but mountain edges and long river frontiers still needed soldiers. The sea was a highway when weather allowed; deserts and forests still slowed messages and armies.

Compared with the late Republic's chaos, the early empire looked, to many elites, like a working bargain. Compared with modern ideas of freedom, it was still a hierarchy backed by weapons. Both views can be true at once if you specify *for whom* and *where*. Empires often sell "peace" as a brand; historians ask who pays tax and who faces the sword at the edge. A merchant in a quiet port such as **Ostia** and a captive on a frontier raid do not share the same Pax Romana. Worked reasoning: if local elites keep their land and status under Roman law, they may police their own region cheaper than a full legion. Why it matters for states and empires: durable control usually blends coercion and cooperation. Bridge: roads, forts and engineering made that blend possible across distance.

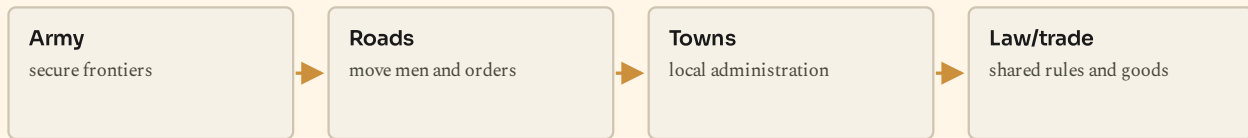


Figure 12.2 · How control worked as a chain.

Follow Army to Roads to Towns to Law and trade. Each step supports the next; remove one link and the others weaken.



LOOK FURTHER

English Heritage, **Romans in England**. Roads, towns and empire at the frontier.

www.english-heritage.org.uk/learn/story-of-england/romans/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What does **Pax Romana** mean, and why is "peace" an incomplete word on its own? Who might not feel peaceful?
- 2 Give one way force and one way incentives helped Rome keep provinces quiet.
- 3 Why might a local elite support Roman rule even if ordinary people paid heavy taxes?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat **Pax Romana** as soft kindness for all. Frontiers still saw war, slavery continued, and peace for merchants often rested on legions and tax.

TOPIC 12.2

Army, roads and engineering

The account



Figure 12.3 · A long stone road toward the hills.

Roman engineering made distance usable for legions, messages and merchants. Notice the straight line and hard surface: design that turns geography into a system of control.

A large empire needs movement. Rome built and maintained **roads** that carried soldiers, messengers and goods in straighter, more reliable lines than muddy tracks. Famous routes such as the **Via Appia** in Italy show the pattern: stone, drainage and milestones turning travel into something countable. Permanent forts and frontier systems, such as walls and river lines in the north (including **Hadrian's Wall** in Britain), marked where dense control met looser zones. The army was not only for conquest; it was a tool of everyday rule, building, policing and displaying power. Imagine a delivery network for messages and soldiers: if the paths are clear, orders arrive; if they wash out, the edge of the map goes quiet.

Engineering turned geography into infrastructure. **Aqueducts** brought fresh water into cities across valleys, so towns could grow beyond what local wells alone could supply. Bridges crossed rivers that once slowed armies. Harbours and warehouses supported grain fleets that fed Rome and other big centres: Egyptian and North African grain, for example, mattered to the capital's crowds. Roads, aqueducts and harbours together moved **soldiers, messengers** and **goods** (including tax grain). None of this was free: taxes, forced labour and military organisation paid for stone and maintenance. When engineering failed or funds ran out, urban life suffered. A city without water and grain is a crowd waiting for crisis. Stone is political because someone must pay for it and someone must guard it.

Worked reasoning: measure distance not only in kilometres but in days of march. A good road can cut those days; a broken bridge can double them. Emperors ruled through time as much as through maps. Why it matters for states and empires: infrastructure is a network that multiplies army power without needing a

soldier on every farm. Bridge: towns, law and trade were the soft layer that sat on top of that hard engineering.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List three things Roman roads helped move, and say why each mattered for control of the empire.
- 2 How did **aqueducts** change life in towns compared with relying only on local wells? Link to growth or health.
- 3 Why could even excellent roads not make the empire feel small to an emperor in Rome? Use distance, frontiers or seasons.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat roads and aqueducts as neutral "progress". They were paid for by taxes and labour, and they served control: soldiers, messages and grain as well as everyday travel.

TOPIC 12.3

Towns, law, religion and trade

The account

Roman **towns** spread a recognisable toolkit: **forums** for business and politics, baths for washing and social life, theatres and amphitheatres for shows (the **Colosseum** in Rome is the most famous example), temples, and grid-like streets in many new foundations. Living in a town meant contact with Latin or Greek, coins, and officials. Rural villas and farms still produced most food, but towns were nodes of administration and culture. Think of a chain of similar school buildings with the same timetable layout: different local accents, same basic design.

Law and shared **coinage** lowered the cost of exchange. Contracts, property rules and courts (however biased toward the rich) made long-distance trade more predictable than pure private revenge. Ships carried olive oil from Spain, wine from Italy and Gaul, grain from Egypt and North Africa, pottery, metals and enslaved people around the Mediterranean. Ports such as **Ostia**, **Alexandria** and coastal hubs in Gaul or Africa linked producers to consumers. Religion was flexible for a long time: local gods mixed with Roman ones, and emperor worship added a political layer. Diversity of belief was common until later centuries when Christianity rose to a privileged place (Unit 13). A merchant who trusts the coin in his hand travels further than one who only trusts neighbours he knows by face. Empire control was cultural as well as military.

Worked reasoning: if two traders from different provinces use the same silver coin and similar contract habits, a deal can close without both sides speaking the same mother tongue. That is network power. Why it matters for states and empires: cultural and legal tools hold space between army visits. Bridge: western Iberia shows the same toolkit at the Atlantic edge of the map.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name three features of a Roman town and explain how one of them supported government or trade.
- 2 How did shared law and coinage make Mediterranean trade easier? Give a concrete goods example if you can.
- 3 Why is it too simple to say everyone in the empire became fully Roman? Mention local gods, language or rural life.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not assume every provincial became "fully Roman". Towns, Latin and coins spread widely, but local customs, rural life and mixed religions continued under the same empire.

TOPIC 12.4

Portugal in the global story: Roman Lusitania

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?**** AFTER LONG WARS OF CONQUEST, MUCH OF WESTERN IBERIA WAS ORGANISED AS THE ROMAN PROVINCE OF **LUSITANIA**. LATIN LANGUAGE, ROMAN LAW, TAXES AND ARMY SERVICE REACHED THE ATLANTIC EDGE OF THE EMPIRE. LOCAL PEOPLES DID NOT VANISH; THEY ADAPTED. FARMERS, ARTISANS AND ELITES MIXED ROMAN HABITS WITH OLDER CUSTOMS. VILLAS PRODUCED OIL, WINE AND GRAIN. ROADS LINKED INLAND SETTLEMENTS TO RIVERS AND COASTS SO THAT GOODS AND ORDERS COULD MOVE. LIFE UNDER EMPIRE MEANT NEW BUILDINGS AND NEW DUTIES AT THE SAME TIME.

Key person, place or event. Towns such as **Conimbriga** (near modern Coimbra) and **Emerita Augusta** (Mérida, capital of Lusitania) show urban life in stone: houses, baths, forums, theatres and later walls. Archaeology at Conimbriga is a classroom for how a western province looked on the ground, far from the Colosseum but inside the same imperial system. Walking a plan of Conimbriga is a way to see Pax Romana tools without travelling to Rome. **Geography connection.** River valleys (including the Tagus) and road corridors stitched Atlantic Iberia into Mediterranean administration. The ocean edge was not a dead end; it was a resource zone connected by land routes to the rest of Hispania and by sea to wider trade. Distance from Italy still mattered: governors and legions could not be everywhere at once, so local elites and towns did much of the day-to-day ruling.

Worked reasoning: if the same forum-baths-road package appears in Lusitania and in Italy, control is partly about copying a toolkit, not only about winning one battle. Why it matters: Portugal's later cities sit on landscapes first reorganised under Roman provincial rule. Bridge: Unit 13 shows how faith and new capitals transformed that imperial system from within.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name a key place from this panel (**Conimbriga** or **Emerita Augusta**) and say why it matters for Roman Lusitania.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason Portugal's story connects to Mediterranean administration (rivers, roads or the Atlantic edge).
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in four to six sentences: how did Rome control such a large empire? Use army/roads and towns/law.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not describe Lusitania as empty land waiting for Rome. Local peoples adapted; towns such as Conimbriga show mixed provincial life, not a copy of Rome in every detail.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Pax Romana, aqueduct, forum, province

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How did Rome control such a large empire?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FOUR · UNIT 13

13

Christianity and the transformation of Rome

How did faith and new capitals change imperial power?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Outline Christian origins, Constantine, Constantinople, division and western fall.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did faith and new capitals change imperial power?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 13.1

Origins and early communities

The account

Christianity began in the eastern provinces of the Roman Empire, in the Jewish world of **Judea** and nearby regions, in the first century CE. Early followers of Jesus formed small communities that met in homes, shared teaching and cared for members. They spread along the same **roads and sea lanes** that carried grain, pottery and soldiers. Greek and Latin helped ideas travel between cities. Merchants, travellers and converts carried the message further than any single preacher could walk. Think of a letter chain that uses the school post system: the content is new, but the paths already exist. Cities such as **Antioch**, **Ephesus**, **Corinth** and later **Rome** itself appear in early Christian history as nodes where communities formed.



Figure 13.1 • Imperial Rome and new faith.

Christianity grew inside an empire of roads, ports and cities like this capital. Notice how public space later hosted churches as well as arenas.

Roman officials sometimes saw the new faith as a threat because Christians refused to join certain public sacrifices linked to the gods and the emperor. **Persecution** (organised punishment for belief or practice) happened in periods and places; it was not constant everywhere for three centuries. Between crises, communities often grew quietly. Bishops and networks of letters held distant groups in contact. Diversity of

practice existed; arguments about teaching were already part of the story. A fair history holds both courage under pressure and ordinary decades of quiet growth. Slogans that say "always" or "everywhere" usually fail this topic.

Geography matters here as much as belief. A faith born in the Levant could not have spread so far so fast without Mediterranean connectivity. Cities were multipliers: one converted household in a port might influence dozens of visitors. Rural areas often changed more slowly than urban centres. The same empire that sometimes punished Christians also built the roads that carried their message. That double role of empire is a key idea for Year 8: power can suppress and transmit at the same time. Worked reasoning: if a missionary uses a Roman road and a grain ship, empire infrastructure is part of religious history. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: belief can travel along the same networks that move tax and troops. Bridge: when emperors later support Christianity, those networks and communities already exist.



Figure 13.2 · How Christianity spread inside empire networks.

Follow from Judea along roads and ports into cities, then to Constantine's public support. Notice empire paths before empire favour.



LOOK FURTHER

Vatican, Bible online (English). A primary religious text tradition; preview with a teacher.

www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0839/_INDEX.HTM

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Where did Christianity begin, and how did Roman roads and sea routes help it spread? Name one early city if you can.
- 2 What is **persecution**, and why is it wrong to say Christians were always persecuted everywhere for three centuries?
- 3 Why might a port city matter more than a remote village for the early growth of the faith?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not write that Christians were "always persecuted everywhere". Persecution came in periods and places; quiet growth and letter networks were also part of the story.

TOPIC 13.2

Constantine and Constantinople

The account

In the early fourth century, the emperor **Constantine** gave open support to Christianity after a long period in which the faith had been unofficial or, at times, attacked. Laws and patronage changed the Church's public place: bishops gained influence, churches rose in stone, and imperial politics intertwined with religious disputes. Constantine did not invent Christian belief, but he transformed its relationship with the state. Being Christian became compatible with high office in a new way. Think of a school club that suddenly gets a hall, a budget and the head teacher's blessing: the ideas may be older, but the power position has changed. Later in the century, other emperors moved further toward making Christianity the favoured imperial faith.

Constantine also founded a new capital in the east on the site of **Byzantium**, renamed **Constantinople** (today Istanbul). The city sat on the **Bosphorus**, the narrow waterway between the Black Sea and the Sea of Marmara, with access toward the Mediterranean. That position controlled a strategic choke point between continents and seas. Trade, customs duties and naval movement all felt the advantage. While Rome remained symbolically important, real power increasingly had eastern centres, armies and tax bases. Moving the centre of gravity is a decision about money, defence and display. A capital on a strait can tax ships and watch two seas; a capital far from the richest provinces struggles to respond quickly.

Worked reasoning: if the wealthiest provinces and hardest eastern frontiers need attention, placing a capital nearer them is a strategic choice, not only a vanity project. Why it matters for states and empires: faith and capital cities both rewire who holds influence. Bridge: even with new faith and new capitals, the western half of the empire still faced division and collapse of imperial rule.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did Constantine change the public position of Christianity without inventing the faith itself?
- 2 Why was the **Bosphorus** such a powerful place for a capital city? Use trade, defence or choke points.
- 3 In what way can a new capital change how an empire is ruled even if old cities such as Rome still exist?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not say Constantine "invented Christianity". He gave open imperial support and founded Constantinople; Christian communities and teachings already existed.

TOPIC 13.3

Division and fall of the West

The account

The empire was often too large for one ruler to manage crises everywhere at once. Administrative **division** between east and west hardened over the fourth and fifth centuries. Separate courts, armies and priorities meant that trouble in Gaul or Britain might not get the same attention as threats near the wealthy eastern cities. External pressures increased: migrating and invading groups, some seeking land or safety, others raiding, pushed on the frontiers. Peoples such as Goths, Vandals and others appear in the story of the western provinces. Internal strains included tax burdens, political murders, weak child emperors and reliance on non-Roman military leaders. Think of a large company split into two offices that stop sharing staff and budgets: a crisis on one side may go unanswered.

In 476 CE, the last widely recognised emperor in the west was deposed. That date is a useful marker for textbooks, but it was not a single explosion that erased Roman life. Many people still spoke Latin, used Roman law habits, lived in towns with Roman pasts, or followed Christian bishops who had taken on civic roles. The **eastern** empire continued, ruling from Constantinople for nearly a thousand years more. Historians often call that continuation **Byzantium**, though its people long called themselves Romans.

	Internal	External
Politics	Civil war, weak succession.	Border peoples press in.
Economy	Tax strain, inflation.	Trade routes disrupted.
Army	Loyalty to generals.	Long frontiers to defend.

Figure 13.3 · Internal and external pressures on the western empire.

Read each row across. A strong paragraph on the fall uses both columns and says how they fed each other, rather than picking a favourite side.

Worked reasoning: if tax income falls while frontier costs rise, and if generals chase personal power, then one "barbarian invasion" explanation is too thin. Multi-causal means several causes working together. Why it matters for states and empires: large systems can fragment unevenly; culture and faith may outlast political unity. Bridge: Iberia felt this transition in local form, which is Portugal's panel next.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why did dividing the empire into east and west make the west more vulnerable in some crises?
- 2 What happened in 476, and why is it misleading to say Roman civilisation ended that year everywhere?
- 3 Give two different types of cause (for example military and economic, or political and frontier) that helped weaken western imperial power.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat 476 CE as the day "everything Roman stopped". It marks the end of western imperial rule; Latin, law habits, towns and the eastern empire continued.

TOPIC 13.4

Portugal in the global story: late Roman Iberia

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** AS WESTERN IMPERIAL STRUCTURES WEAKENED, THE IBERIAN PROVINCES FACED NEW MILITARY GROUPS, SHIFTING TAX AUTHORITY AND UNCERTAIN LOYALTY OF ARMIES. ROMAN TOWNS, VILLAS AND CHRISTIAN COMMUNITIES DID NOT VANISH OVERNIGHT. BISHOPS, LOCAL LANDOWNERS AND REMAINING OFFICIALS NEGOTIATED SURVIVAL IN A WORLD WHERE THE EMPEROR IN ITALY OR GAUL MIGHT BE FAR AWAY OR POWERLESS. LAYERS OF CHANGE OVERLAPPED: LATE ROMAN, THEN KINGDOMS LED BY PEOPLES SUCH AS THE **SUEBI** AND **VISIGOTHS** (EXPLORED MORE IN UNIT 14). FOR PEOPLE ON THE GROUND, "THE FALL OF ROME" OFTEN FELT LIKE SLOWER PAY, MORE LOCAL DEALS AND NEW WAR-BANDS, NOT A SINGLE CALENDAR DATE.

Key person, place or event. The long late Roman and post-Roman transition in Iberia, visible in archaeology and in the survival of towns, roads and Christian organisation even when central imperial pay and protection failed. Continuity of landscape and belief sits beside change of rulers. Bishops in towns that once paid Roman tax sometimes became the strongest local organisers. **Geography connection.** The peninsula sits open to both Mediterranean and Atlantic-facing movements. Mountain ranges and river basins created regions that could hold out or change at different speeds. Distance from Italy meant Iberia often felt crises late or in local form. A valley behind mountains might keep older habits longer than a coastal road open to new armies.

Worked reasoning: if roads and bishops remain while legions leave, "fall" is uneven. Why it matters: Portugal's medieval story grows from this layered transition, not from empty ruins. Bridge: Unit 14 asks whether the early Middle Ages were a "Dark Age" and follows Byzantium, Islam and Iberia's next rulers.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the key idea from this panel (the late Roman / post-Roman transition) and say why it matters for Iberia.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason Portugal's story connects to this wider period (distance from Italy, mountains, or open coasts).
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in four to six sentences: how did faith and new capitals change imperial power? Use Constantine or Constantinople and one western point.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not imagine Iberia emptying in 476. Towns, roads, villas and Christian communities continued while rulers, taxes and armies changed layer by layer.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Constantinople, Bosphorus, persecution, Byzantium

■ **WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO**

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ **THE ENQUIRY**

How did faith and new capitals change imperial power?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

PART FIVE

The medieval world

After Rome, new centres of power rose. Feudal ties, towns, crusades, plague and stronger kings remade Europe, while Iberia lived between Christian and Islamic worlds.

The medieval world is not a dark pause. It is a rewiring of power: local lords, long-distance faith, busy markets and, later, sharper monarchies.

Units 14 to 20 connect Byzantium and Islam, feudal society, trade, crusades, plague and war to the Atlantic edge of Iberia.

PART FIVE AT A GLANCE

The medieval world

Seven chapters, and the question each one answers. Use this page as a map of the part: read the enquiry for the unit you are about to start, then turn the page into the opener.

Unit 14**Europe after Rome**

Were the early Middle Ages really a Dark Age?

Unit 15**Feudalism and medieval society**

Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did?

Unit 16**Life in medieval Europe**

How did village, town, Church and learning organise medieval life?

Unit 17**Medieval trade and connections**

How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe?

Unit 18**The Crusades**

Were the Crusades only about religion?

Unit 19**The Black Death**

How did plague transform medieval society?

Unit 20**War, monarchies and national identity**

How did long war and stronger kings remake Europe?



PART FIVE · UNIT 14

14

Europe after Rome

Were the early Middle Ages really a Dark Age?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Outline early medieval West, Byzantium, Islam and Mediterranean links.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Were the early Middle Ages really a Dark Age?**
You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 14.1

Early Middle Ages

The account

After the western empire's political collapse, new **kingdoms** rose on former Roman provinces: in Gaul (later linked to the **Franks**), in Italy, in Spain and elsewhere. Kings often ruled with warrior elites, while bishops and monasteries kept literacy, charity and local leadership alive. Some cities shrank. Long-distance trade patterns changed. Roads and aqueducts were harder to maintain without imperial taxes and labour. Life could be insecure when armies marched or harvests failed. Think of a large company that closes its head office: branch towns may keep working, but with fewer shared services and more local bosses.



Figure 14.1 • A colourful market after empire.

Exchange and town life continued even when western Roman rule faded. Notice people and goods still meeting, not a world of empty darkness.

The label **Dark Age** is a judgement, not a neutral measurement. It grew from later writers who saw fewer Latin classics copied, less grand building in some regions, or more local violence. But "dark" as total darkness is a slogan to test. Monasteries copied books. Metalwork and law codes show skill. Contact with Byzantium and, soon, the Islamic world kept ideas and goods moving. Different regions had different experiences: Italy was not identical to Britain; Iberia was not identical to the Rhineland. A fair enquiry asks *what* declined, *what* continued and *what* was new. Year 8 answers that use all three questions beat answers that only sigh about darkness.

Political unity under one western emperor faded. Christian organisation often thickened. Rural life remained the norm for most people, as it had under Rome. Calling three centuries "dark" can hide those mixed facts and insult the people who lived them. Geography of former Roman roads, river valleys and coastal pockets still shaped where power and learning clustered even when maps of "empire" looked broken. A monastery on a river may keep a library while a ruined villa a few valleys away loses its roofs. Worked reasoning: if literacy survives in monasteries while some cities shrink, the evidence is mixed, not pure night. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: new political maps can form without erasing every older skill. Bridge: the eastern Roman state, Byzantium, shows a different path of continuity.

	Byzantine East	Western kingdoms
Capital	Constantinople.	Many smaller courts.
Continuity	Roman law and taxes longer.	Local lords rise.
Faith	Orthodox Christianity.	Latin Church networks.

Figure 14.2 · East and west after Rome.
Compare Byzantine continuity with western kingdoms. Use the rows to build a balanced "Dark Age" answer that names both sides of the Mediterranean.



LOOK FURTHER

Dumbarton Oaks online exhibits. Byzantine art and world for school-level browsing.
www.doaks.org/resources/online-exhibits
Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name two changes in western Europe after Rome's political fall and two things that continued (think cities, trade, church, farming).
- 2 Why do historians argue about the phrase **Dark Age**? What does the label judge rather than measure?
- 3 How might a monastery give evidence against the idea of total cultural darkness?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not use "Dark Age" as a full description of three centuries. Ask what declined, what continued and what was new, and remember regions differed.

TOPIC 14.2

Byzantine Empire

The account

While western kingdoms reorganised, the **Byzantine Empire** (the eastern Roman state centred on **Constantinople**) taxed, built, legislated and fought for centuries. Emperors claimed Roman legitimacy. Greek became the main language of government over time, and **Orthodox Christianity** shaped law and identity. The city of Constantinople remained a giant of trade and strategy, protected by massive walls and fed by a wide hinterland and sea links through the Bosphorus. Calling it simply "the leftover east" undersells a living empire with its own long story.

Byzantium faced Persians, then Islamic caliphates, and later other rivals. It lost and regained provinces. At times it was the richest Christian power in the Mediterranean; at times it fought for survival. Under the emperor **Justinian** in the sixth century, famous law codes reorganised Roman legal traditions in ways that later influenced Europe, and ambitious building (including the great church of **Hagia Sophia** in Constantinople) displayed power. Art, dome architecture and diplomacy (including marriage alliances and carefully managed ceremonies) were tools of soft power as well as war. Think of a capital that still runs a full timetable of tax, army and ceremony while neighbouring regions invent new local systems. Survival under pressure is still history worth studying, not a footnote.

For western Europeans, Byzantium could be ally, rival or source of luxury goods and books. Silk, spices and crafted goods moved through its markets. Worked reasoning: if a capital keeps minting coins, enforcing law and holding walls for centuries after 476, then "the Roman world ended in 476" is too western a sentence. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: continuity in one half of the old empire challenges any map that paints the whole Mediterranean as ruined. Bridge: a new faith and new states from Arabia soon rebalanced that map again.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What was the **Byzantine Empire**, and how was it linked to earlier Rome (capital, law or self-name)?
- 2 Why did Constantinople remain important for trade and war? Use walls, strait or hinterland.
- 3 How does Byzantium challenge the idea that the whole Mediterranean world went dark after 476?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not call Byzantium a mere "leftover". It was a living eastern Roman state with taxes, law, armies and a capital at Constantinople for centuries after 476.

TOPIC 14.3

The rise of Islam

The account

In the seventh century CE, **Islam** emerged in Arabia through the teachings of the Prophet **Muhammad**. Within decades, Muslim armies and communities expanded across the Middle East and North Africa, and in 711 they crossed into Iberia. New states called **caliphates** claimed both religious and political leadership of the Muslim community. Capitals such as **Damascus** and later **Baghdad** became centres of power, scholarship and trade. A **caliphate** is a form of rule that links leadership of the faith community with political authority over wide lands.

Expansion used existing roads, cities and discontent with older empires as well as military energy. Many regions kept local languages and customs while adopting new rulers, taxes and, over time, often the new faith. Islamic civilisation was not a single culture frozen in one form: Arabs, Persians, Berbers and many others shaped it. Science, medicine, mathematics, geography and philosophy flourished in major cities, drawing on Greek, Persian and Indian learning as well as original work. Libraries and translation movements in places such as Baghdad show curiosity as well as conquest. Reducing the story to "only armies" erases farms, markets and scholars. A fair paragraph needs at least one non-military fact.

From a Mediterranean point of view, the rise of Islam rebalanced the map. North Africa and much of Iberia entered a new political and religious world. Sea routes still linked coasts, but who taxed ports and who wrote the laws changed. Worked reasoning: if a faith spreads with traders and teachers as well as soldiers, then network history matters as much as battle lists. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: a new imperial-religious system joined Byzantium and western kingdoms as a third major frame around the shared sea. Bridge: that shared sea is the topic of connection next.

	Byzantine East	Islamic caliphates
Capital idea	Constantinople	Changing centres, wide lands
Continuity	Roman law and taxes	New faith and law systems
Sea	Control key straits	North Africa and Iberia routes
Iberia link	Trade contacts	Al-Andalus from 711

Figure 14.3 · Byzantine and Islamic powers around the Mediterranean.

Read each row: capitals, continuity, sea routes and Iberia. Use both columns when you explain the new balance of the early medieval sea.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a **caliphate**, and which regions did early Islamic expansion reach by the eighth century (include Iberia)?
- 2 Why is it inaccurate to treat Islamic civilisation as only armies and conquest? Give one non-military example.
- 3 How did the rise of Islam change the political map of the Mediterranean compared with the old Roman unity?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not reduce early Islamic history to "only conquest". Capitals such as Damascus and Baghdad were also centres of scholarship, trade and administration.

TOPIC 14.4

A connected Mediterranean

The account

Christian and Islamic powers fought, negotiated and traded across the same sea. Ships carried silk, spices, metals, timber, grain and enslaved people. Ideas moved with merchants, pilgrims, prisoners and scholars. Sicily, southern Italy, North Africa and Iberia were contact zones where languages and technologies mixed. Ports needed pilots, interpreters and credit. Isolation happened in some inland pockets, but as a total story of the Mediterranean it is the exception, not the rule. Think of a busy shared corridor between rival school blocks: arguments happen, but so do swaps of notes and kit.

Connection does not mean friendship. Raids, piracy and holy war rhetoric were real. So were treaties, bilingual traders and shared farming tricks. A Venetian merchant and a Tunisian sailor might disagree about faith and still agree on the price of grain. Maps of "Christian Europe" and "Islamic world" as solid colour blocks hide the fuzzy borders and busy ports. Coastal people often knew more about the opposite shore than about a mountain valley a hundred kilometres inland. Colour blocks are teaching shortcuts that can become thinking traps.



Figure 14.4 · Lisbon and Atlantic light on the Tagus.

Later Portuguese power grew from Iberia's long mix of Mediterranean and ocean-facing geography. Notice harbour position for connection, not isolation.

Worked reasoning for the enquiry: if goods and ideas cross the sea while kingdoms fight, then "Dark Age" cannot mean total disconnection. Trade evidence is positive proof of networks. Why it matters for states, empires and networks: rivalry and exchange can exist together; Year 8 must hold both. Bridge: Portugal's lands sat inside that connected, contested Iberian story of Suebi, Visigoths and Al-Andalus.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Give two examples of how Christian and Islamic societies might interact without only fighting (trade, treaties, shared techniques, bilingual ports).
- 2 Why do solid colour blocks on a map mislead us about medieval Mediterranean life?
- 3 How does evidence of trade support a challenge to the "Dark Age" label? Use a concrete good or port type if you can.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not read solid colour blocks of "Christian" and "Islamic" as sealed worlds. Ports, treaties and trade mixed people even when wars and raids were real.

TOPIC 14.5

Portugal in the global story: Suebi, Visigoths and Al-Andalus

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** AFTER ROMAN RULE LOOSENED, **SUEBI** AND **VISIGOTHIC** KINGDOMS CONTROLLED PARTS OF IBERIA. THEY USED ROMAN TOWNS, CHRISTIAN CHURCH STRUCTURES AND NEW ELITE WARRIOR CULTURE IN DIFFERENT MIXTURES. FROM **711**, MUSLIM FORCES ENTERED FROM NORTH AFRICA UNDER LEADERS LINKED TO THE EARLY CONQUEST, INCLUDING FIGURES REMEMBERED IN THE SOURCES SUCH AS **TARIQ IBN ZIYAD** AT THE CROSSING NEAR GIBRALTAR. MUCH OF THE PENINSULA BECAME **AL-ANDALUS**, LANDS UNDER MUSLIM RULE WITH SHIFTING FRONTIERS FOR CENTURIES. CITIES SUCH AS **CÓRDOBA** LATER SHONE AS CENTRES OF LEARNING AND CRAFT. IN THE FAR NORTH AND WEST, CHRISTIAN POLITIES HELD OR RECONQUERED GROUND OVER A LONG, UNEVEN PROCESS. THE FUTURE KINGDOM OF PORTUGAL FORMED ON THAT CONTESTED MAP, NOT IN AN EMPTY WILDERNESS. LAYERS OF RULE STACKED ON THE SAME RIVERS AND ROADS.

Key person, place or event. The beginning of Al-Andalus after 711, together with the earlier Visigothic kingdom, marks Iberia's place between late Roman, Christian and Islamic worlds. That transition is a hinge for the whole Portuguese story that follows in later units. Córdoba's libraries and workshops, when at their height, show why "Dark Age" fails as a full Iberian label. **Geography connection.** The Strait of Gibraltar is a narrow sea gate between Africa and Europe. It made invasion, migration and trade across the narrow water realistic. Mountains and river basins inside the peninsula then shaped which armies could hold which valleys. Atlantic-facing coasts later gave western polities a different outlook from purely Mediterranean powers.

Worked reasoning: if the same Tagus valley sees Roman, Visigothic and Andalusí rule in sequence, history is layered, not reset. **Why it matters:** Portugal's medieval and ocean-age story grows from this hinge. **Bridge:** later units follow feudal Europe, crusades and Portugal's own path to Atlantic expansion.

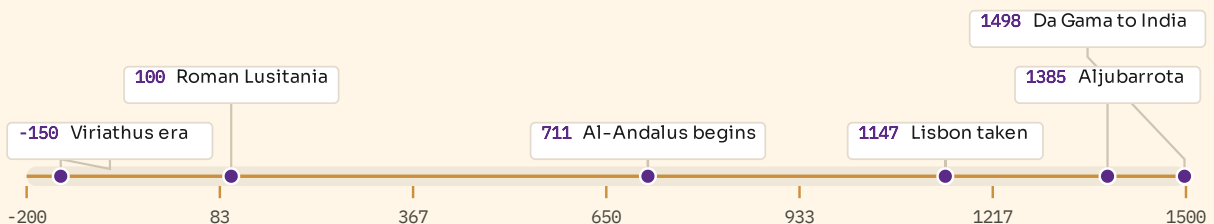


Figure 14.5 · Portugal's long story in markers.

Read left to right from the Viriathus era through Roman Lusitania, Al-Andalus, Lisbon, Aljubarrota and the ocean age. This unit sits in the middle stretch where kingdoms and faiths reorganise Iberia.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the key place or event from this panel (**Al-Andalus** after 711, or the Visigothic kingdom) and say why it matters for Iberia.
- 2 Explain one geographical reason Portugal's story connects to this wider period (Strait of Gibraltar, mountains, or river basins).
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in four to six sentences: were the early Middle Ages really a Dark Age? Use Byzantium or Al-Andalus and one western point.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat post-Roman Iberia as empty land. Suebi, Visigoths and then Al-Andalus layered new rule on Roman towns, roads and Christian or later Islamic institutions.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Byzantine, caliphate, Al-Andalus, Dark Age

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Were the early Middle Ages really a Dark Age?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FIVE · UNIT 15

15

Feudalism and medieval society

Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain feudal relationships, knights, manors and castle geography.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 15.1

Why feudal relationships developed

The account

Imagine a world with no national police force, no fast roads and no king who can protect every village in a week. After the western Roman Empire broke apart, many people lived with that kind of risk. Raiders, rival lords and sudden war made safety a local problem. In that setting, people built **feudal** bonds: personal deals about land and service that held society together when distant governments could not.



Figure 15.1 • Local exchange in a medieval world.

Lords, peasants and towns still needed markets. Notice how everyday trade sits under castle and manor politics.

Feudalism is a modern word. Historians use it as a teaching model for a pattern that appeared in many parts of medieval Europe, not as one single law book that everyone followed the same way. The basic idea is simple. A powerful person (often called a **lord**) granted the use of land to another person (a **vassal**). In return, the vassal promised loyalty, advice and military help. Think of it as a deal: "I give you land to live from; you fight for me when danger comes." The land granted for service was often called a **fief**. The same person could sit in more than one place on the ladder: a knight might be a vassal to a count and a lord to the peasants on his estate.

Why did this pattern grow? Work the problem like a puzzle with three pieces. First, **security**: people needed protection closer than a far capital. Second, **land**: wealth mostly came from farms, woods and mills, so land was the main gift a ruler could offer. Third, **loyalty rituals**: ceremonies of kneeling and oath-taking

made the deal public and hard to deny. Geography made those deals more likely in some places than others. Wide open plains could be hard to defend. River valleys, hill country and forest edges offered natural barriers. When a central government was weak, a hill, a ford or a bridge became more valuable than a distant capital. Local strong men who controlled those points could protect (or tax) the farmers nearby.

Example 1. A valley with one bridge and one ridge: whoever holds the ridge controls the road and can demand service or dues from villages below. **Example 2.** A border zone between rival kingdoms: farmers need a nearby lord's horsemen more than a written law from a king they never see. That is why feudal ties and castles cluster where danger, routes and high ground meet.

This matters because it explains medieval maps of power: not one smooth empire colour, but many nested loyalties. It also bridges to the next topics: once you understand the deal, you can study who lived on the manor, how knights trained, and why stone castles rose on chosen ground.

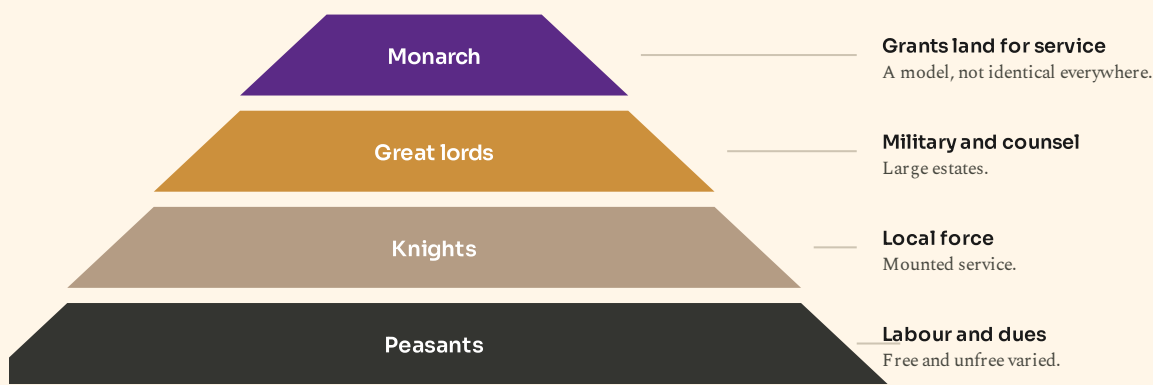


Figure 15.2 · A simplified feudal pyramid.

Read each tier from the top down: land and protection flow one way, service and loyalty the other. Notice the caption "a model, not identical everywhere": treat this as a teaching tool, not a photo of every kingdom.



LOOK FURTHER

The National Archives, education resources. Medieval documents and who produced them.

www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/resources/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 In your own words, what deal did a lord and a vassal make? Use the words land and service once each.
- 2 Why might a hill or a river ford matter more than a far-away capital when the king is weak? Give two geographical reasons.
- 3 Draw a simple chain of three people (for example king, lord, knight). Label what each gives and what each gets. Then add one sentence: why is this only a model?

◆ CAREFUL

Feudalism is a modern teaching model. Real kingdoms mixed written custom, Church power and local habit; not every place matched the neat pyramid.

TOPIC 15.2

Lords, vassals, knights and manors

The account

A medieval **lord** was not only a rich landowner. He was expected to keep order, hold courts and lead men in war. A **vassal** was someone who had accepted land or protection from a lord and owed service in return. The same person could be both: a knight might be a vassal to a count, and a lord to peasants living on his land. That double role is important. Medieval society was not a simple cartoon of "one king at the top and everyone else below." It was a web of duties that could pull a person in two directions at once.

Knights were professional fighting men, trained to fight on horseback with sword, lance and shield. Their gear was costly, so knighthood was linked to land and wealth. Training often followed steps: (1) as a **page**, a boy learned manners, riding basics and household service; (2) as a **squire**, he polished armour, practised weapons and followed a knight to war or tournament; (3) he might be dubbed a knight if he proved ready and his family could support him. **Chivalry** (the knightly code of courage, loyalty and honour) was an ideal taught in stories and songs. Real knights could also be ruthless. The ideal and the reality did not always match.

The **manor** was the basic rural estate. It usually included the lord's house or castle, village houses, strips of arable land, meadow, woodland and rights over mills or ovens. **Peasants** worked the fields. Some were freer than others. A **serf** (unfree peasant in many regions) was tied to the land: they could not leave easily and owed labour days and produce to the lord. Free peasants still paid rents or dues but had more legal room to move or negotiate. Life followed the farming year: ploughing, sowing, haymaking, harvest and winter repair.

Worked example: one harvest week. Monday to Wednesday, serfs might cut the lord's grain first. Thursday and Friday they work their own strips. Saturday, the mill grinds flour and the lord takes a share as mill due. Sunday is church. If weather ruins the crop, hunger hits both village and lord, but the village feels it first.

Example of a court day. A peasant is accused of cutting wood without leave. The lord's steward hears witnesses. A fine in grain or labour days is set. Justice is local, personal and hard to appeal. **Why it matters:** once you see labour, dues and courts as everyday systems, feudalism stops being only a diagram and becomes a lived timetable. Understanding the manor also explains why knights needed land: without peasant work, expensive horses and armour could not be paid for. **Bridge:** those same lords who ran manors also chose hills and fords for castles, the topic that follows.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is the difference between a free peasant and a serf on a manor? Give one right or limit for each.
- 2 List three things a knight needed that made knighthood expensive (gear, horse or training).
- 3 Write a short diary entry (six to eight sentences) for one day in a manor village at harvest time. Include at least one duty owed to the lord and one moment of ordinary life (food, weather or church).

◆ CAREFUL

Chivalry was an ideal taught in stories. Real knights could be brutal, and peasants rarely appear as heroes in knightly songs. Read both the code and the court records in your mind.

TOPIC 15.3

Castles and strategic geography

The account

A **castle** was a fortified home for a lord and a military machine. Early castles might be earth and timber: a mound (**motte**) with a tower, and a fenced yard (**bailey**) for people and animals. Later castles used stone walls, towers, gatehouses and sometimes water-filled **moats**. Thick walls and high towers made attackers climb, dig or wait while defenders shot from above. Building in stone took years, skilled masons and a fortune in timber, limestone and labour. Only powerful lords or kings could afford the biggest ones.

Where you put a castle was half the battle. Builders loved **high ground**. From a hilltop you can see enemies approaching for miles. A castle on a ridge can control a road. A castle at a river bend can watch a crossing. Coastal castles guarded harbours. Castles near borders watched rival kingdoms. Think of a castle as a lock on a door: the door is a pass, a bridge, a valley or a town gate. If you control the lock, you control who moves and who pays. Castles were also statements. A stone keep rising over the fields told everyone who ruled that place.



Figure 15.3 · Why put a castle here?

Follow the steps: high ground to see danger, control of pass or road to tax and block, stone walls to delay a siege, then power signal. For one real hill near your home or on a Portugal map, say which step fits best.

Step-by-step site choice (worked reasoning). (1) List threats: raiders, rival lords, sea landing. (2) Mark routes: roads, fords, harbour mouths. (3) Find height or water that slows attackers. (4) Check food and water for a long siege. (5) Build only if you can pay for stone and garrison. **Example 1.** A castle above a river ford forces travellers to pass under watch. **Example 2.** A coastal keep near a harbour can warn of fleets and protect warehouses. **Why it matters:** geography does not "decide" history alone, but it prices every choice: a flat open field is a poor bargain for defence. **Bridge:** the next topic shows how these same ideas of loyalty, land and fortified places helped Afonso Henriques turn a frontier county into a kingdom.



Figure 15.4 • Roads, height and control.

Long-distance routes still needed watchpoints. Notice how a strong point on a path can tax, delay or protect traffic.



Figure 15.5 • A stone castle on high ground.

Walls and towers sit above the valley so defenders see danger early. Notice height, stone mass and the open approaches attackers would have to cross under fire.

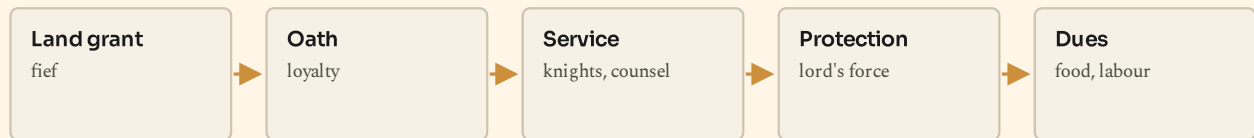


Figure 15.6 · From land grant to dues.

Follow the chain: a lord grants a fief, a vassal swears loyalty, service and protection follow, then food and labour flow back. Use it to explain feudal bonds without claiming every kingdom looked identical.

■ **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Why would a builder choose a hill or a river bend for a castle? Name one advantage of each site.
- 2 Name two features of a stone castle that made it hard to attack, and say how each one works.
- 3 Look at a simple map of your local area (or Portugal). Mark one place where a medieval lord might build a castle and write three sentences explaining why, using height, roads or water.

◆ **CAREFUL**

A castle on a perfect hill still fails without food, water and loyal people inside. Site geography helps; **supply and loyalty** finish the defence.

TOPIC 15.4

Portugal in the global story: Afonso Henriques and independence

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** ****WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?**** IN THE TWELFTH CENTURY, THE COUNTY OF PORTUGAL SAT ON THE WESTERN EDGE OF IBERIA, BETWEEN THE ATLANTIC OCEAN AND RIVAL CHRISTIAN AND MUSLIM POWERS. ****AFONSO HENRIQUES**** (AFONSO I) LED CAMPAIGNS AND DIPLOMACY THAT TURNED THAT COUNTY INTO A RECOGNISED KINGDOM. VICTORY IN BATTLE, DEALS WITH OTHER RULERS AND SUPPORT FROM THE CHURCH ALL PLAYED A PART. INDEPENDENCE DID NOT ARRIVE IN ONE NEAT DAY LIKE A SWITCH FLICKED ON. IT GREW THROUGH WAR ON THE FRONTIER, NEGOTIATIONS WITH LEÓN AND CASTILE, AND A SOCIETY USED TO FIGHTING AND FARMING ON A MOVING BORDER.

Feudal ties of loyalty, land and service mattered here as much as banners and sermons. Afonso needed vassals who would ride when called, and he needed to look like a king in the eyes of other Christian rulers and the papacy. Castles and fortified towns locked down river valleys and routes. Control of key places such as Guimarães early on, and later strongholds further south, showed the same strategic logic you met in Topic 15.3: hold the high ground and the crossing, and you hold the county.

Key person, place or event. Afonso Henriques and the emergence of the Portuguese kingdom in the twelfth century, on a frontier between Christian and Muslim Iberia and between land war and Atlantic opportunity. Later ages remembered him as the first king; historians still debate dates and documents, but the political fact is clear: a separate Portuguese crown took lasting shape.

Geography connection. The early Portuguese lands stretched from the rainy Minho in the north toward the Mondego valley and beyond. Hills, rivers and the Atlantic coast shaped where armies could march and where ports could grow. Limited width between mountain and ocean pushed rulers to mind both frontier war and coastal trade. **Why it matters for the year question:** states form when leaders combine force, loyalty networks and recognised borders on real ground. **Bridge:** Unit 16 moves from lords and castles to the villages, towns and churches that organised daily life inside those borders.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Who was Afonso Henriques, and why does his story matter for Portugal? Give one military and one political point.
- 2 How did rivers, hills or the Atlantic coast help or challenge early Portuguese power? Give two concrete points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences: Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did? Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel and name one European connection (for example the Church or a neighbouring kingdom).

◆ CAREFUL

Independence was a **process**, not a single magic date. Treat "founding" stories as useful memory, then check war, diplomacy and geography as well.

WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

vassal, manor, castle, feudalism

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THE ENQUIRY

Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

UNIT 15 AT A GLANCE

Feudalism and medieval society

Enquiry. Why did feudal ties and castles develop where they did?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 15.1 Why feudal relationships developed
- 15.2 Lords, vassals, knights and manors
- 15.3 Castles and strategic geography
- 15.4 Portugal in the global story: Afonso Henriques and independence

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** **priced a choice** for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

vassal

manor

castle

feudalism

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 4 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 15 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?

A vibrant illustration of a medieval market scene. In the foreground, several market stalls with colorful awnings (yellow, green, purple, red) are set up on a cobblestone street. People in medieval attire are walking around, some carrying baskets. In the background, a large Gothic church with a tall, green-roofed spire and a clock face stands prominently against a clear blue sky. Several flags (yellow, purple, red) are flying from poles. The overall atmosphere is bright and lively.

PART FIVE · UNIT 16

16

Life in medieval Europe

How did village, town, Church and learning organise medieval life?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Describe villages, towns, guilds, Church institutions and Gothic building.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did village, town, Church and learning organise medieval life?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 16.1

Villages and towns

The account

Most medieval people lived in villages. They farmed strips of land, kept animals and shared tasks such as mending fences or harvesting. Houses were often timber and thatch. Life followed the seasons and the church calendar. A bad harvest could mean hunger. A good harvest meant bread, ale and a little to trade. Neighbours knew one another. The village was a community of work, not only a place on a map. When someone fell ill or a cart broke, help often came from the same people who shared the field strips.



Figure 16.1 · Town market and craft stalls.

Medieval villages and towns mixed food, guilds and faith. Notice colour and crowd: urban functions grow where people meet to buy and sell.

Towns were different. They grew at river crossings, bridges, castle gates and harbours where people met to buy and sell. Walls and gates controlled who came in. Markets filled the main square with noise: cloth sellers, butchers, bakers and travellers. Some towns won a **charter** from a king or lord. A charter was a written grant of rights, such as holding a market or running local courts. Rights could mean freer movement and more chance to earn money than a serf on a manor. A charter was not freedom for everyone, but it was a step toward different rules inside the walls.

Urban life was not free for everyone. Apprentices worked long hours. The poor crowded into dirty streets. Disease spread easily where water was foul and waste ran in open channels. Still, towns multiplied choices. A skilled weaver, a merchant or a clerk might rise higher than a peasant tied to one field. Towns also linked the countryside to wider trade. Grain, wine, wool and salt moved between village and market. News moved with them: a rumour from a port could reach an inland fair in days.

Worked comparison. Village: strip fields, seasonal rhythm, face-to-face help, dues to a lord. Town: market square, craft specialisation, walls and gates, written rights. **Example 1.** A river ford town: farmers bring grain; boatmen load barrels; a lord taxes the bridge. **Example 2.** A harbour town: salt and fish leave by ship; foreign cloth arrives; a charter protects market days. Geography decided which villages became towns: only some sites offered enough traffic, water and safety. **Why it matters:** understanding village and town stops medieval life looking like only castles and kings. **Bridge:** once towns had markets, craft workers organised into guilds, the next topic.



LOOK FURTHER

Victoria and Albert Museum, medieval collections. Faith, craft and materials of medieval life.

www.vam.ac.uk/collections/medieval

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Give two differences between village life and town life in the Middle Ages.
- 2 What is a town charter, and why might people want one? Use rights or market once.
- 3 Choose a real town near a river or harbour (for example Lisbon or Porto). Write four sentences on why that site helped a town grow. Use at least one geographical word (estuary, ford, harbour, ridge).

◆ CAREFUL

A **charter** gave rights to a town community, not automatic equality for every resident. Apprentices, servants and the poor still faced hard rules.

TOPIC 16.2

Guilds

The account

In many towns, skilled workers joined a **guild**. A guild was an organised group of people in the same craft or trade: bakers, goldsmiths, weavers, masons or merchants. Guilds set rules for quality, prices and training. They protected members from unfair competition and tried to keep outsiders from undercutting them. If you imagine a modern sports club with strict rules about who can play and how, you are close: guilds were about belonging, skill and control of a street market.

Training usually followed steps. (1) A young person became an **apprentice**, living with a master and learning the craft for years, often without full pay. (2) Next came the **journeyman**, who worked for pay and might travel between workshops. (3) To become a **master**, a person often had to produce a fine piece of work (a "masterpiece") and pay fees. Guilds could be strict. They watched who opened a shop and how goods were made. Cheating the public or selling poor work could mean fines or expulsion. Customers gained some protection; outsiders often found the door closed.

Guilds were more than workplaces. They held feasts, supported sick members and paid for funerals. They funded chapels and windows in churches. That mix of work, welfare and faith made the guild a social spine of the medieval town. **Example 1.** A bakers' guild might set a standard loaf weight so buyers are not cheated by light bread. **Example 2.** A masons' guild trains people who can raise a cathedral wall safely; bad work on scaffolding could kill. **Why it matters:** guilds show how medieval towns organised skill without modern factories or national companies. **Bridge:** guild money and craft skill also built churches and supported learning communities linked to the Church.

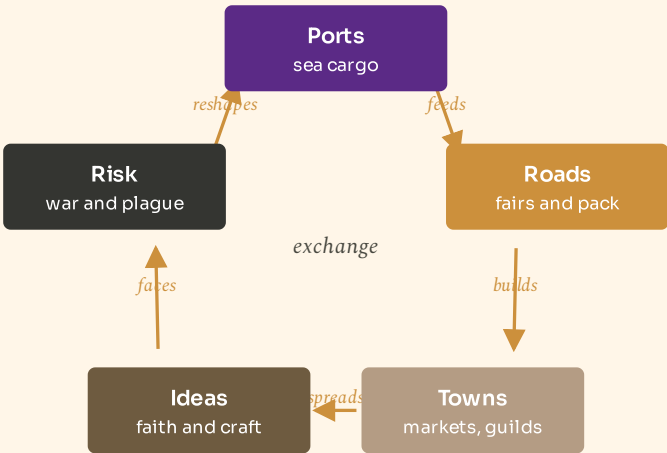


Figure 16.2 · Medieval exchange as a cycle.

Start at Ports or Roads and follow the arrows: cargo and pack trains feed towns; towns build markets and guilds; ideas and crafts spread; risk (war and plague) reshapes the whole loop. Name one modern parallel for "risk" that can still close a shop street today.

	Guild protects	Guild controls
Training	Apprentice to master path.	Who may practise the craft.
Quality	Shared standards.	Poor work can be punished.
Price	Fair trade ideals.	Competition limited.
Town power	Voice in city politics.	Entry fees and rules.

Figure 16.3 · What guilds protect and control.

Read each row across: training, quality, price and town power. Notice that protection for members can also mean limits for outsiders. That tension is the point of the figure.



Figure 16.4 • Harbour market and wooden ships.

Sea and river cargo feed town stalls. Notice colour, crowd and hulls together: trade is not only a list of goods, it is a place where people meet.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What did a guild do for its members and for customers? Give one benefit for each.
- 2 Put these in order and explain each in one sentence: apprentice, journeyman, master.
- 3 Invent a simple guild rule for bakers (for example about bread weight or honest flour) and say why the rule helps people. Then add one sentence: who might hate the rule, and why?

◆ CAREFUL

Guild rules could protect quality **and** lock out rivals. Ask who gains and who is shut out, not only whether bread weighs enough.

TOPIC 16.3

Church, monasteries and universities

The account

The **Church** structured time, belief and much of learning in medieval Europe. Parish churches marked Sundays, holy days and stages of life: baptism, marriage and burial. Bells rang the hours when clocks were rare. Priests taught basic beliefs and collected **tithes** (a share of produce or income). For most people, the parish was the closest religious community: the place you walked to, the graves of your family, the sermons you heard whether you could read or not. The church porch was often where news, gossip and justice mixed after Mass.

Monasteries and convents were communities of monks or nuns who followed a religious rule. They prayed, farmed, taught and cared for travellers. Many monasteries copied books by hand before printing existed. Their libraries kept religious texts, and sometimes works of science, medicine and ancient authors. Monastery estates could be large. Monks managed land, mills and vineyards. A monastery on a hill or river valley could become a landmark of power as well as prayer. When you see a ruined abbey today, you are looking at an economic centre as well as a spiritual one.

Universities grew later in busy towns such as Bologna, Paris and Oxford. Students and masters organised teaching in law, medicine and theology. A university needed books, lodging, food markets and enough traffic to support scholars. That is why remote forests rarely hosted the first universities: learning followed people and money. Steps for a medieval student might include: arrive in a town, join a "nation" or hall of students, hear lectures, debate, and sit examinations under masters. Discipline could be strict; life could also be rowdy.

Example 1. A parish: weekly Mass, tithe of grain, burial in the churchyard. **Example 2.** A monastery scriptorium: a monk spends months copying a single book so that another house can teach from it. **Why it matters:** Church networks organised time, charity, literacy and travel hostels across regions that still lacked strong national schools. **Bridge:** the same faith and wealth that funded monasteries also raised Gothic cathedrals that rewrote the skyline.



Figure 16.5 • Temple stone and later faith landscapes.

Sacred buildings dominate skylines in many ages. Notice how height and stone signal belief as well as engineering.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did a parish church shape an ordinary person's week and year? Give two examples.
- 2 Give two jobs a monastery might do besides prayer.
- 3 Why might a university grow in a busy town rather than in a remote forest? Give two reasons.

◆ CAREFUL

The Church was about belief **and** organisation: land, schools, courts and money. Spiritual language does not cancel economic power; both can be true together.

TOPIC 16.4

Gothic architecture

The account

Gothic architecture is the tall, light style of many later medieval churches and cathedrals. Earlier **Romanesque** buildings often had thick walls and round arches. Gothic builders used **pointed arches**, **rib vaults** and **flying buttresses** (stone supports that took the weight of the roof outward). Those inventions let walls hold huge windows filled with stained glass. The building almost becomes a frame for coloured light. Compare a thick Romanesque wall to a Gothic wall of glass and you see the engineering leap at a glance.

Stand inside a Gothic cathedral and look up. Light pours through glass that tells Bible stories for people who could not read. Pillars rise like a stone forest. The height was meant to lift the mind toward heaven. Building such a church took decades. Generations of masons, carpenters and glass-makers worked on scaffolds high above the town. Fathers and sons might spend their whole working lives on one choir or one rose window. A cathedral was a multi-generation project, not a weekend build. Accidents, money shortages and wars could pause work for years.

Gothic style spread across Europe, but each region left its mark. French cathedrals such as Chartres became famous for their rose windows. English builders developed long naves and distinctive towers. Iberian churches mixed Gothic ideas with local stone and frontier needs. Towns competed: a taller spire could mean prestige, pilgrims and trade.

Worked reasoning. If the roof pushes down and out, you need either very thick walls or external props. Flying buttresses are the props. Free the wall of bulk, and you can cut in glass. Glass needs stories and donors: bishops, guilds and rich families pay for windows that show their names and saints. **Example 1.** A weavers' guild funds a window showing their patron saint, advertising skill and piety at once. **Example 2.** A bishop orders a taller choir so processions and music fill a grander space that rivals a neighbouring town. Scaffold accidents and money shortages show that beauty rested on dangerous labour. **Why it matters:** architecture is history you can still walk through: engineering, faith and urban pride stacked in stone. **Bridge:** Portugal's growing towns and monasteries after Lisbon's capture show the same mix of faith, walls and markets on the Atlantic edge.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name two features that make a building Gothic, and explain one advantage of each.
- 2 Why did stained glass matter for people who could not read?
- 3 Sketch a simple side view of a church with a pointed arch and a flying buttress. Label both. Then write one sentence: how does the buttress help the window?

◆ CAREFUL

"Gothic" is a later label, not a medieval self-name. Use it as a style word for pointed arches and light walls, not as an insult meaning "barbaric".

TOPIC 16.5

Portugal in the global story: Lisbon, towns and monasteries

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?*** IN 1147, DURING THE PERIOD OF THE SECOND CRUSADE, CHRISTIAN FORCES CAPTURED ****LISBON**** FROM MUSLIM RULE AFTER A LONG SIEGE. SHIPS AND FIGHTERS FROM NORTHERN EUROPE JOINED PORTUGUESE TROOPS. TAKING LISBON WAS NOT ONLY A LOCAL VICTORY. IT GAVE THE YOUNG KINGDOM A MAJOR RIVER-PORT CITY ON THE ****TAGUS**** ESTUARY. FROM THEN ON, MONASTERIES, PARISH CHURCHES AND GROWING TOWNS HELPED ORGANISE THE LANDSCAPE AS THE FRONTIER MOVED SOUTH. RELIGIOUS HOUSES RECEIVED LAND GRANTS. MARKETS AND CHARTERS SPREAD. PORTUGAL'S MAP FILLED WITH PLACES OF PRAYER, TRADE AND ROYAL CONTROL. VILLAGE FIELDS STILL FED MOST PEOPLE, BUT THE KINGDOM NOW HAD AN URBAN GATEWAY LARGE ENOUGH TO ANCHOR POLITICS AND SHIPPING FOR CENTURIES.

Key person, place or event. The capture of Lisbon in 1147 and the growth of towns and monasteries in the expanding kingdom. The siege linked Iberian frontier war with wider European crusading networks: some crusaders paused on the way east and helped take the city. That global link sits inside a Portuguese story of walls, river and faith.

Geography connection. The Tagus estuary offers deep water and shelter from Atlantic storms. Ships can sail inland yet stay linked to the ocean. Hills and walls made the city defensible. Control of Lisbon meant control of a gateway between river traffic and sea routes. Inland valleys supplied grain and timber; the harbour exported salt, fish and later richer cargoes. **Why it matters:** states need both rural food systems and urban nodes; Lisbon became Portugal's key node. **Bridge:** Unit 17 follows the roads, seas and pilgrim paths that linked such towns into wider medieval networks.



Figure 16.6 · Lisbon and the river gateway idea.

Coastal capitals grow where river and ocean meet. Notice how a sheltered estuary can hold ships, markets and power together.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why was the capture of Lisbon in 1147 a turning point for Portugal? Give one military and one economic reason.
- 2 Explain how the Tagus estuary helped a city grow and stay powerful. Use two geographical points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences: How did village, town, Church and learning organise medieval life? Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel and mention either the harbour or the river inland route.

◆ CAREFUL

Capturing a city changes the map, but **holding** it needs settlers, markets, churches and walls. Victory day is not the whole story of urban growth.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

guild, monastery, Gothic, charter

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ **THE ENQUIRY**

How did village, town, Church and learning organise medieval life?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

A vibrant illustration of a medieval market scene. In the foreground, several market stalls with colorful awnings (yellow, green, purple, red) are set up on a cobblestone street. People in period clothing are browsing and trading goods, including baskets of fruit and vegetables. In the background, a large stone church with a tall, green-roofed spire and a clock face stands prominently against a clear blue sky. Several flags (yellow, purple, red) fly from poles along the market street.

PART FIVE · UNIT 17

17

Medieval trade and connections

How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain expanding trade, Mediterranean and Silk links, and pilgrimage.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 17.1

Trade expands

The account

Medieval Europe did not live only on isolated manors. A **surplus** is extra food or goods beyond what local people need for themselves. When farmers produced more grain, wine or wool than they needed, they sold that surplus. Surplus fed markets and towns. Safer roads in some periods, stronger lords who punished robbers, and growing demand for cloth and tools all helped trade expand. Think of a school fair: when families bring extra cakes, a table of exchange appears. Medieval markets were larger versions of that habit, with more risk and more silver.



Figure 17.1 • Goods on the move at market.

Surplus grain, cloth and spices needed fairs and ports. Notice how a river crossing or coastal square can become a trade magnet.

Fairs were big temporary markets that met at set times of year. Merchants travelled long distances to sell spices, furs, metalwork and fine cloth. Buyers came from many regions. A fair near a river or at a crossroads could become famous. Ports did similar work all year: ships unloaded salt, fish, wine and grain. Money, credit and bills of exchange slowly made long-distance deals easier, though most people still paid in coin or kind. Trust mattered. A merchant who cheated once might never sell again on that road.

What moved? Wool from England and Iberia became cloth in Flanders and Italy. Wine from France and Portugal travelled by sea and river. Grain fed growing cities. Luxury goods such as silk and spices came from farther east and commanded high prices. Trade was uneven. War, bad weather and pirates could close a route overnight. Still, over centuries, denser networks linked more places. A map of successful fairs and ports is a map of connection under pressure.

Steps that grow a fair (worked reasoning). (1) Local surplus appears. (2) A safe meeting place exists (bridge, river bank, town square). (3) A calendar date is fixed so strangers know when to arrive. (4) Lords or towns protect traders and take tolls. (5) Reputation spreads and more distant merchants come. **Example 1.** A Champagne fair (in modern France) linked northern cloth with southern goods. **Example 2.** A Portuguese coastal market ships salt and wine while bringing in foreign cloth. Geography set the stage. Rivers were highways before good roads existed. Mountain passes funnelled caravans. Coastlines with harbours became chains of port towns. **Why it matters:** trade is how networks form; without surplus and routes, "Europe" stays a patchwork of closed villages. **Bridge:** the longest links ran through the Mediterranean and the Silk Road systems next.



LOOK FURTHER

Smarthistory, Silk Roads beginner guide. A network of routes, not one road.

smarthistory.org/a-beginners-guide-to-the-silk-roads/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a surplus, and how does it help markets grow?
- 2 Name three goods that moved in medieval trade and say roughly where each might come from.
- 3 Why might a fair grow at a river crossing rather than on a lonely mountain top? Give two reasons.

◆ CAREFUL

Trade maps show **possibility**, not constant safety. A famous fair could empty overnight if war closed the road. Connection always carried risk.

TOPIC 17.2

Mediterranean and Silk Road links

The account

The **Mediterranean Sea** was a busy medieval highway. Italian cities such as Venice and Genoa built fleets that linked Christian Europe with Islamic ports in North Africa and the eastern Mediterranean. Ships carried cloth, timber, grain, slaves and luxury goods. Muslim and Christian merchants often traded even when their rulers fought. Ports such as Alexandria, Tunis and Constantinople (later Istanbul) were nodes where cultures and cargoes met. A single harbour warehouse might hold goods from three continents.

Overland, the **Silk Road** name covers many routes across Asia. Caravans moved silk, spices, gems and ideas from China and Central Asia toward the Middle East and Europe. No single road ran all the way like a motorway. Goods passed through many hands. Each middleman took a cut. That is one reason spices cost a fortune in western markets. Distance, deserts, mountains and politics all raised the price. A bag of pepper in Lisbon or London had already paid for camels, guards, taxes and luck.

These networks were fragile and powerful at once. A blockade, a war or a new tax could shift routes. When overland paths became costly or risky, sailors looked harder at sea options. That long habit of searching for cheaper paths to Asian goods later fed Atlantic exploration. **Compare the systems.** Mediterranean: ships, ports, fleets, naval power. Silk Road: oases, caravanserais, desert and mountain stages, city tolls. **Example 1.** A Venetian galley loads spices in an eastern port and sells them in a northern market for many times the purchase price. **Example 2.** A caravan pays for water and protection at each desert stage; one broken peace treaty can strand cargo for months. **Why it matters:** long-distance trade is a chain of trust and geography; break one link and prices jump. **Bridge:** faith also put people on the road as pilgrims, creating another layer of movement beside merchants.

	Mediterranean	Silk Road network
Links	Europe, N. Africa, W. Asia.	China to Europe via Asia.
Moves	Grain, oil, pottery, people.	Silk, spices, ideas, disease.
Space	One sea, many coasts.	Many routes, not one road.
Power	Who holds ports wins.	Who holds oases and cities wins.

Figure 17.2 · Two long-distance systems side by side.

Read across each row: Mediterranean versus Silk Road network. Compare who holds power (ports versus oases and cities) and what moves (grain and people versus silk, spices, ideas and disease). Which system would a Genoese captain know best, and why?

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why were Italian port cities so important in Mediterranean trade? Use fleets or harbours once.
- 2 Why did spices cost so much by the time they reached western Europe? Give two reasons from the journey.
- 3 On a blank outline map, mark the Mediterranean and one land path toward Asia. Label two port cities. Add one sentence: what danger might close each route?

◆ CAREFUL

Trade between Christian and Muslim ports does **not** prove peace or friendship. People can exchange goods and still fight. Keep motives separate.

TOPIC 17.3

Pilgrimage routes

The account

A **pilgrimage** is a journey made for religious reasons, often to a holy place. In the Middle Ages, Christians walked or rode to sites such as **Santiago de Compostela** in north-west Spain, **Rome** and **Jerusalem**. Muslims performed the **hajj** to Mecca. Jewish travellers also moved between communities and holy sites. Faith put people on the road. Not every pilgrim was a saint in later stories. Some sought forgiveness, healing, adventure, status or a chance to leave home for a season. A badge or shell worn after a successful journey could prove you had been, the way a modern stamp fills a passport page.

Pilgrim routes were corridors of movement. Hostels, monasteries and towns along the way sold food, lodging and souvenirs. Roads to Santiago crossed the Pyrenees and threaded through northern Spain. The journey was hard: weather, illness and robbery were real risks. People still went. Kings and bishops encouraged some routes because pilgrims brought money and prestige. A shrine that attracted crowds could remake a town the way a modern festival remakes a quiet street for a weekend, except the "weekend" lasted for centuries. Blacksmiths, bakers and innkeepers all felt the traffic.

Pilgrimage moved more than people. Stories, songs, diseases, coins and craft ideas travelled the same paths. A pilgrim from Flanders might meet a Portuguese traveller at a hostel and swap news of wars and weather. **Steps on a typical long pilgrimage.** (1) Vow or decision. (2) Pack simple gear and seek blessing. (3) Follow marked routes and river valleys where possible. (4) Stay in hostels or monasteries. (5) Reach the shrine, pray, buy a badge. (6) Return, often poorer in money and richer in status. **Example 1.** Santiago: scallop shells mark the Camino. **Example 2.** Rome: many routes converge on the city of popes and ancient ruins. **Why it matters:** pilgrimage proves medieval Europe was not frozen in place; belief organised long-distance travel. **Bridge:** Portugal's Atlantic edge joined both pilgrim and merchant traffic to wider seas.



Figure 17.3 • Valley corridors for travellers.

Pilgrims and traders often followed rivers and low passes. Notice how landscape funnels movement into repeatable routes.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a pilgrimage, and name two famous Christian destinations in the Middle Ages.
- 2 How could a town on a pilgrim road become richer? Give two ways.
- 3 Plan a three-stop journey to Santiago for a medieval pilgrim. At each stop, say one danger or one help they might meet. End with one sentence on why geography still shapes the plan.

◆ CAREFUL

Pilgrims were not all pure saints. Motives mixed faith, status, adventure and trade. A holy road can still carry thieves and disease.

TOPIC 17.4

Portugal in the global story: Atlantic and Mediterranean edges

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?**** MEDIEVAL PORTUGAL SAT WHERE THE **ATLANTIC OCEAN** MEETS PATTERNS OF TRADE THAT ALSO TOUCHED THE MEDITERRANEAN WORLD. COASTAL TOWNS LIVED BY FISHING, SALT, SHIPPING AND THE CARRYING TRADE AS WELL AS BY FRONTIER WAR INLAND. PORTUGUESE MERCHANTS AND SAILORS LEARNED ATLANTIC WINDS AND CURRENTS WHILE THE KINGDOM STILL FOUGHT AND FARMED ALONG A MOVING SOUTHERN BORDER. PORTS SUCH AS LISBON AND PORTO LINKED RIVER VALLEYS TO OPEN SEA. SALT PANS, FISH AND WINE WERE EVERYDAY CARGOES LONG BEFORE THE FAMOUS VOYAGES OF THE 1400S. THOSE LATER VOYAGES DID NOT APPEAR FROM NOWHERE. THEY GREW FROM GENERATIONS OF COASTAL WORK, SHIP REPAIR AND HARD WEATHER EXPERIENCE.

Key person, place or event. Atlantic coastal trade and port life in medieval Portugal: the ordinary skills of salt, fish, wine and river-to-sea shipping that trained a seafaring society. No single captain invented ocean skill overnight; the coast was a school.

Geography connection. Portugal is a long, narrow coastal kingdom. Limited inland width and a long shoreline pushed attention toward the sea. Rivers such as the Douro and Tagus opened paths from interior farms to harbours. Westerly winds and Atlantic swell demanded tough ships and skilled crews. Compared with a landlocked county, Portugal's map made maritime habits almost inevitable if rulers wanted wealth. **Why it matters for networks:** an Atlantic edge can join Mediterranean-style exchange to ocean-scale projects later. **Bridge:** Unit 18 shows how holy war and long routes also linked Iberia to Jerusalem and to crusading language.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What everyday goods and skills linked medieval Portugal to the sea?
- 2 How did Portugal's long coastline and river mouths shape its economy? Give two points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences: How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe? Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel and name one inland challenge and one coastal opportunity.

◆ CAREFUL

Later Age of Discovery glory can hide earlier, ordinary port work. Salt barrels and fishing boats are evidence too, not only famous captains.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

fair, pilgrimage, port

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

UNIT 17 AT A GLANCE

Medieval trade and connections

Enquiry. How did roads, seas and pilgrimage link medieval Europe?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 17.1 Trade expands
- 17.2 Mediterranean and Silk Road links
- 17.3 Pilgrimage routes
- 17.4 Portugal in the global story: Atlantic and Mediterranean edges

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** priced a choice for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

fair

pilgrimage

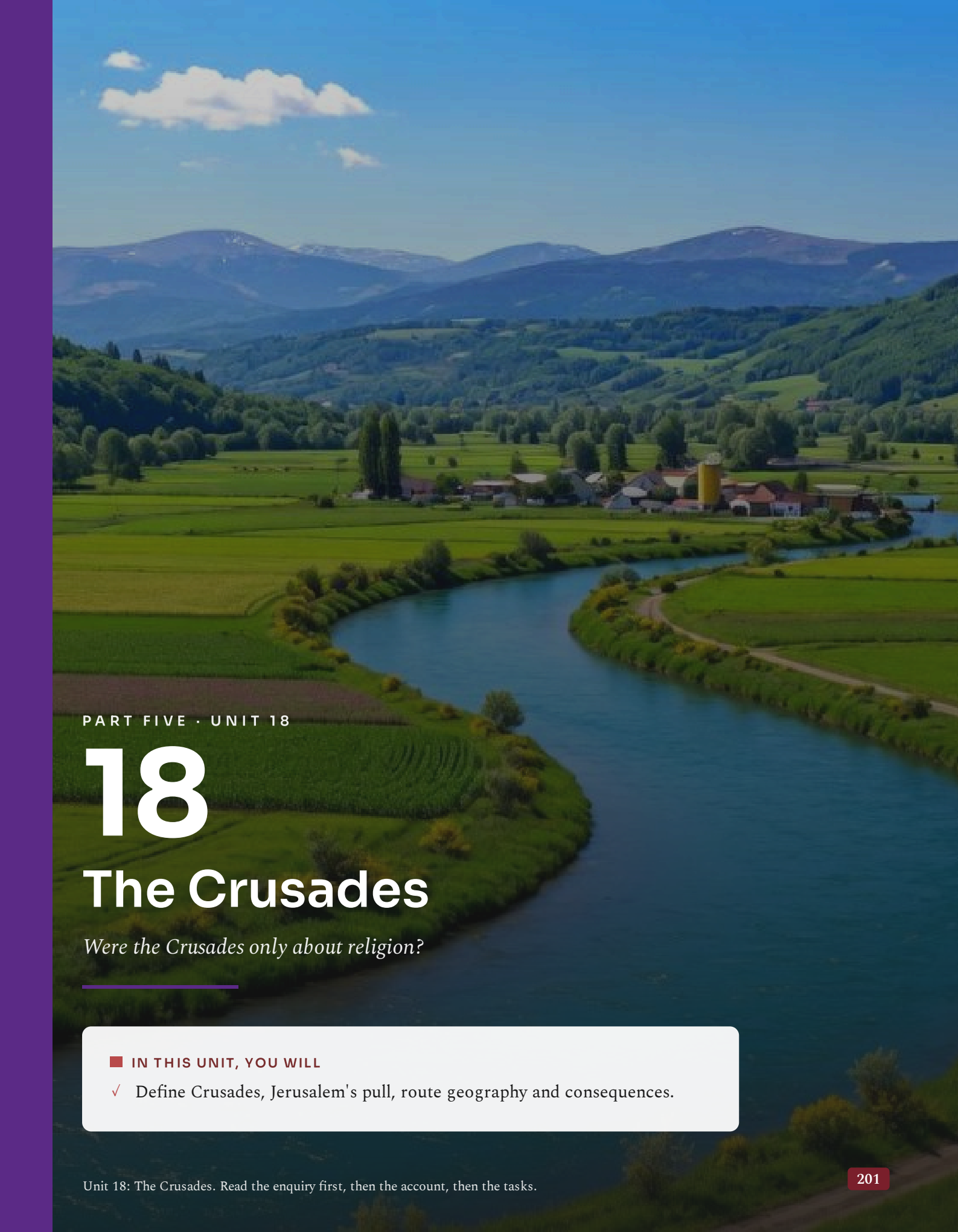
port

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 4 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 17 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART FIVE · UNIT 18

18

The Crusades

Were the Crusades only about religion?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define Crusades, Jerusalem's pull, route geography and consequences.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Were the Crusades only about religion?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 18.1

What were the Crusades?

The account

The **Crusades** were a series of military expeditions launched mainly from Latin Christian Europe toward the eastern Mediterranean between the late eleventh and thirteenth centuries (with later campaigns too). Popes and preachers called them **holy war**: fighting framed as service to God, especially to recover or defend Christian holy places. Knights took vows, sewed crosses on their clothes and expected spiritual rewards as well as earthly ones. For many people at the time, that religious frame was real and urgent, not a thin costume over pure greed.



Figure 18.1 • Valley and water in a crusading age.

Armies and pilgrims crossed rivers, plains and coasts. Notice how landscape prices every long journey.

Religion was central to the language of the Crusades. Sermons spoke of Jerusalem, sin and salvation. Many ordinary people genuinely believed they were doing God's work. Yet motives mixed. Some nobles sought land, titles and adventure. Merchants wanted safer or richer trade. Kings used crusading prestige in politics at home. Younger sons who would not inherit family estates sometimes looked for opportunity abroad. Historians therefore treat the Crusades as tangled events, not a single pure cause. If a football match is "only about sport," why do sponsorship, local pride and school rivalry still shape who plays? Past wars also had more than one engine.

There was no one "Crusade army" that always looked the same. Leaders argued. Routes changed. Some expeditions reached the Holy Land; others attacked different targets, including Christian cities. Violence against Jewish communities in Europe and massacres in captured towns stain the story. Muslim rulers, for their part, saw invasions of their lands and responded with their own wars and alliances. The timeline of calls, captures and losses is not a straight line of "Christians win, then lose." It is a sequence of campaigns with different goals and outcomes.

Worked balance for the enquiry. Evidence for religion: papal calls, vows, Jerusalem sermons. Evidence for other motives: trade rights, land grants, prestige. A strong Year 8 answer uses both sides and refuses the word "only." **Why it matters:** multi-cause thinking is a core humanities skill. **Bridge:** to test motives further, study the city that pulled so many armies: Jerusalem, and the hard geography of getting there.

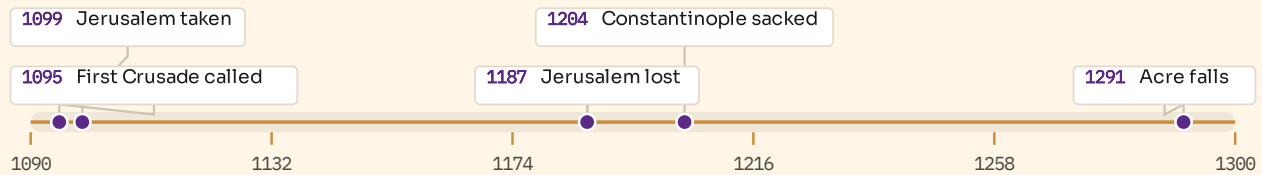


Figure 18.2 · A crusading timeline, 1095 to 1291.

Read left to right: First Crusade called, Jerusalem taken, Jerusalem lost, Constantinople sacked, Acre falls. For two events, write one sentence: what does this date suggest about whether crusading was a short adventure or a long, changing story?



LOOK FURTHER

British Library, medieval manuscript articles. Manuscripts that record conflict, faith and travel.

www.bl.uk/medieval-english-french-manuscripts/articles

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 In two sentences, define the Crusades for someone who has never heard of them.
- 2 List three possible motives a knight might have had for joining a Crusade. Star the motive you think was strongest for most leaders and explain why in one sentence.
- 3 Why do historians warn us not to say the Crusades were "only about religion"? Use one religious reason and one non-religious reason.

◆ CAREFUL

"Only about religion" is a trap. Faith was real for many people **and** land, trade and glory still mattered. Hold both truths without erasing either.

TOPIC 18.2

Jerusalem and geography of the routes

The account

Jerusalem is sacred to Jews, Christians and Muslims. For medieval Christians, it was the city of Jesus's death and resurrection. For Muslims, it held the Dome of the Rock and Al-Aqsa Mosque. For Jews, it was the ancient holy city of the Temple. That shared sacred status made Jerusalem a magnet and a prize. Control of the city carried huge religious meaning. When three faiths care about one place, politics around that place is never only about walls and wells.

Getting there was a geographical nightmare. From western Europe, armies could march overland through the Balkans and Anatolia, or sail the Mediterranean. Land routes meant months of walking, mountain passes, heat and the need for food at every stage. Sea routes needed ships, money and fair winds. Storms sank fleets. Disease killed more soldiers than some battles. Distance itself was an enemy: the farther an army travelled, the thinner its supply line became. A knight with a fine sword but empty stomachs around him was already half defeated.

The eastern Mediterranean coast (the Levant) offered ports such as Acre and Tyre. Inland lay hills, desert edges and fortified towns. Crusaders who held coastal ports could resupply by sea; those stuck inland depended on local grain and risky roads. **Compare routes.** Land: slower, more stages, more local politics. Sea: faster if ships exist, deadly if storms hit, expensive for horses and cargo. **Example 1.** An army crosses Anatolia in summer heat and loses horses to thirst. **Example 2.** A fleet from Italian ports lands troops near a Levant harbour but then demands trading rights in return. **Why it matters:** holy goals still travel on real maps; geography prices every vow. **Bridge:** once armies are on the road, supply and logistics decide whether courage is enough.



Figure 18.3 • Sacred stone and contested cities.

Holy places draw pilgrims and armies. Notice how built landmarks become symbols people will fight to hold or free.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why was Jerusalem important to more than one religion? Name the three faiths linked in the account.
- 2 Compare one problem of the land route with one problem of the sea route.
- 3 On a map, trace a possible path from France to Jerusalem and mark two difficult places (for example mountains or a long sea crossing). Write one sentence under each mark.

◆ CAREFUL

Calling Jerusalem "holy" does not make violence automatic or justified. Sacred status explains **attraction and conflict risk**; it does not excuse massacre.

TOPIC 18.3

Travel, supply and consequences

The account

Crusading armies needed **supply**: food, water, weapons, horses, ships and money. Lords borrowed from moneylenders. Italian merchants provided fleets in return for trading rights. Without bread and transport, holy vows meant little on a dusty road. **Logistics** (the work of keeping an army alive) decided campaigns as much as courage did. A knight with a fine sword but no grain still starved. A fleet without water still failed. Modern armies still live or die by supply chains; medieval ones were no different, only slower and more fragile.

Travel itself was a test. Horses needed fodder. Armour rusted in rain. Summer heat and winter cold killed the unprepared. Messengers rode ahead to beg or buy grain from towns that might refuse. Every delay gave enemies time to gather. That is why ports and river mouths mattered so much: they were choke points for food and ships as well as for flags. A campaign map is also a shopping list written across a continent.

Consequences of the Crusades were mixed and long-lasting. Temporary crusader states rose and fell in the Levant. Castles such as Krak des Chevaliers showed how Europeans adapted to eastern frontier war. Contact increased knowledge of eastern goods, medicines and technologies, even while hatred and atrocity also grew. Italian ports grew richer on crusade traffic. Some eastern Christian communities were damaged by western armies that failed to distinguish allies from enemies. In 1204, crusaders even sacked Constantinople, a Christian capital: proof that "holy" labels do not guarantee holy behaviour.

Worked consequence map. Short term: battles, sieges, new coastal lordships. Medium term: trade deals, castle building, memory of holy war. Long term: stories that shaped identity, and habits of Mediterranean connection that outlived any single kingdom. **Example of logistics deciding a campaign.** An army waits three weeks for grain that never arrives; desertion rises; the siege fails even though the walls were climbable. Courage without bread is a short story. **Why it matters:** consequences outlive the last sword stroke, and supply explains why some "holy" armies never reached their target. **Bridge:** Iberia's Reconquista used similar holy-war language on a different map.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why was supply (food, ships, money) as important as fighting skill? Give two concrete examples.
- 2 Give one positive and one negative consequence of the Crusades for people in Europe or the eastern Mediterranean.
- 3 Write a short balanced paragraph (seven to nine sentences) answering: Were the Crusades only about religion? Include faith, at least one other motive, and one geographical or supply point.

◆ CAREFUL

Consequences are **mixed**. Do not write only "good cultural exchange" or only "pure evil." Use at least one gain and one harm when you judge impact.

TOPIC 18.4

Portugal in the global story: Reconquista and crusading ideals

The account

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** ON THE IBERIAN PENINSULA, CHRISTIAN KINGDOMS PUSHED SOUTH FOR CENTURIES AGAINST MUSLIM-RULED LANDS. THAT LONG PROCESS IS OFTEN CALLED THE **RECONQUISTA**. PORTUGUESE KINGS AND NOBLES USED CRUSADING LANGUAGE AND SOMETIMES RECEIVED PAPAL SUPPORT, JUST AS EASTERN CRUSADES DID. THE SIEGE OF LISBON IN 1147 EVEN DREW NORTHERN EUROPEAN CRUSADERS WHO PAUSED ON THEIR WAY EAST. YET IBERIAN WARS WERE ALSO LOCAL PROJECTS: WINNING TOWNS, RIVER VALLEYS AND TAX RIGHTS ALONG A MOVING FRONTIER. HOLY SYMBOLS AND HARD POLITICS SHARED THE SAME CAMPAIGN. A CROSS ON A BANNER DID NOT CANCEL THE DESIRE FOR LAND AND HARBOUR DUES.

Key person, place or event. Crusading ideology in the Portuguese Reconquista, including links such as the Lisbon siege of 1147, where eastern-bound crusaders and Iberian forces met. The same century that sent armies toward Jerusalem also redrew Iberia's map town by town.

Geography connection. Southward advance followed river lines, fortified towns and coastal strongholds. Each new castle or captured city shifted the frontier. Mountains and rivers channelled armies. Control of harbours linked land war to sea supply. The map of Portugal filled in as the frontier moved, from northern cores toward the Algarve coast over generations. **Why it matters:** Portugal's kingdom took shape inside a multi-cause frontier war, not in isolation from European holy-war ideas. **Bridge:** Unit 19 shows how the same trade routes that carried crusaders and merchants later carried plague.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What was the Reconquista, and how did it connect to crusading ideas?
- 2 How did rivers, towns or coasts shape Portugal's southward expansion? Give two points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences. Use evidence from both Iberia and the eastern Crusades. Mention religion once and land or supply once.

◆ CAREFUL

Reconquista is a later, contested label. It can hide centuries of mixed living and treat history as a simple scoreboard. Use it carefully with dates and places.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

Jerusalem, holy war, supply

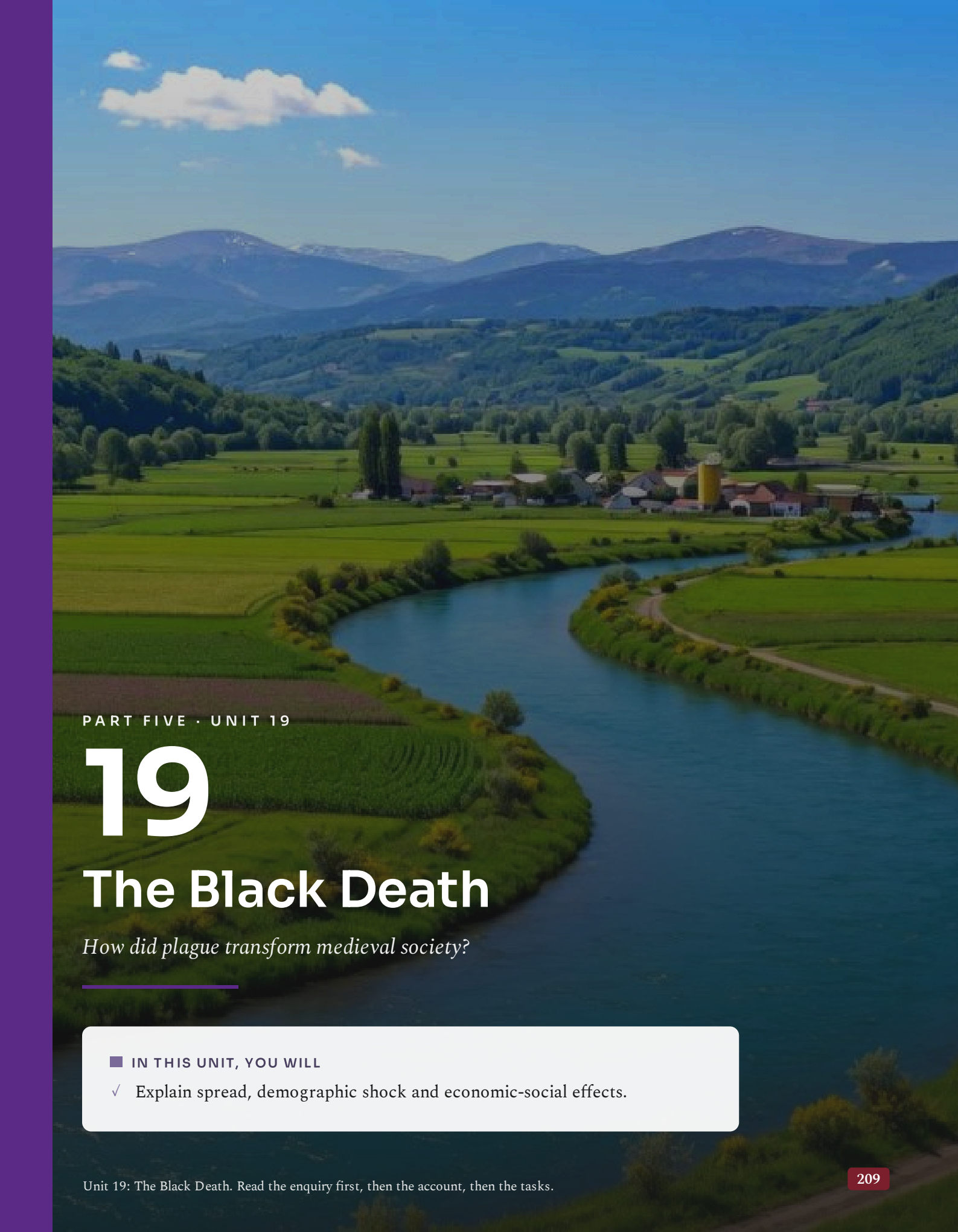
■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Were the Crusades only about religion?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FIVE · UNIT 19

19

The Black Death

How did plague transform medieval society?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain spread, demographic shock and economic-social effects.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did plague transform medieval society?**
You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 19.1

Spread of disease

The account

In the mid-fourteenth century, a terrible disease swept across Europe and beyond. People later called it the **Black Death**. Most historians link it mainly to **bubonic plague**, caused by bacteria that can live in fleas and rodents, though forms of the disease also attacked the lungs and blood. Victims often developed painful swellings, fever and, for many, death within days. Medieval doctors did not know about bacteria. They blamed bad air, God's anger, the stars or enemies. Fear spread almost as fast as the illness. When you do not understand a threat, rumours fill the gap.



Figure 19.1 • Settled land beside water.

Plague travelled along roads and ports that linked river valleys to the sea. Notice how connection can carry both goods and disease.

How did plague move? Along the same paths that carried wealth. Ships from the Black Sea and eastern Mediterranean brought infection to Italian ports around 1347. From harbours, disease followed trade routes inland along roads, rivers and market towns. Grain ships, cloth caravans and busy inns all mixed strangers. A port that lived by exchange also imported risk. Rats and fleas thrived in crowded wooden towns and on cargo vessels. The networks you studied in Unit 17 (fairs, ports, roads) became highways of catastrophe as well as of cloth.

Geography and connection explain the pattern. Isolated mountain villages sometimes escaped longer. Busy cities and coastal towns often suffered first and worst. The disease moved in waves, not in one neat line. Some places were hit hard in 1348-49, then again years later. Maps of spread look like trade maps drawn in tragedy. If you colour every market town on a medieval map, you are halfway to a plague map. Connection created vulnerability. The medieval world was linked enough for plague to race, yet medicine was not ready to stop it. That combination made the Black Death one of the greatest shocks in European history.

Steps of spread (worked model). (1) Infection enters a port on a ship. (2) Markets and inns mix people and goods. (3) Roads and rivers carry contact inland. (4) Dense towns amplify transmission. (5) Countryside feels loss of workers and traders. **Example 1.** An Italian harbour receives eastern cargo and within weeks burial pits fill. **Example 2.** A fair that once meant profit becomes a cluster of infection when strangers share lodgings. **Why it matters:** networks are double-edged; the same link that brings silk can bring death. **Bridge:** death on that scale remade wages, land and belief, the next topic.



LOOK FURTHER

Wellcome Collection stories. Health, bodies and disease in history; choose a plague-related story with a teacher.

www.wellcomecollection.org/stories

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did ships and trade routes help the Black Death spread?
- 2 Why might a busy port suffer sooner than a remote mountain village?
- 3 Draw a simple flow diagram: ship arrives at port → town market → inland road → countryside. Add one sentence at each step about how disease could move. Then circle the step where densest contact happens.

◆ CAREFUL

Medieval people lacked germ theory. Do not mock them as "stupid." Judge their choices by the knowledge and tools of their time, while still using modern science to explain the disease.

TOPIC 19.2

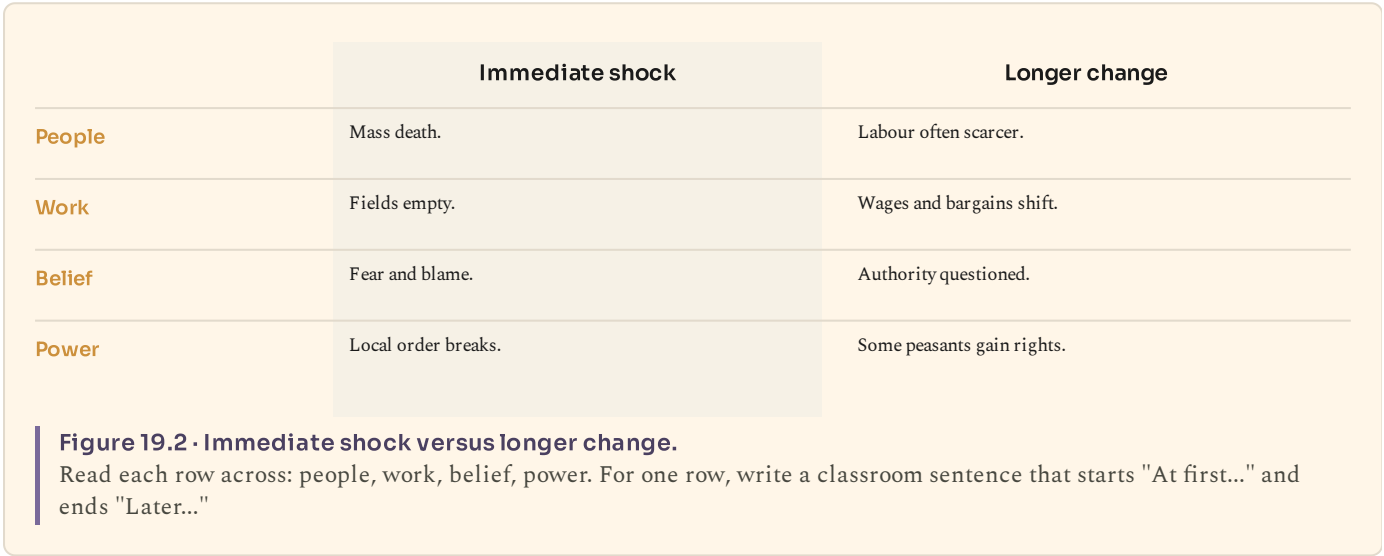
Population, economy and society

The account

The human cost was enormous. In many regions, roughly one third to one half of the population may have died in the first great wave, though numbers varied by place. Fields went unharvested. Workshops fell silent. Whole families vanished. **Mortality** (the death rate) of that scale changes everything: who works, who inherits land, who can demand higher wages. Imagine one third of your school missing next week and never returning. Timetables, teams and friendships would all change. Medieval villages faced that scale of loss without modern medicine or insurance.

In the years that followed, **labour** often gained bargaining power. There were fewer workers for the same amount of land and work. Some peasants could ask for better pay or leave a harsh lord. Some lords lost income when rents fell or land lay empty. Governments tried to freeze wages and punish workers who demanded more. Tension rose. Revolts and protests broke out in several countries. The shock did not free everyone overnight, and change was uneven by region, but the old balance of power shifted. Power is partly about who is scarce. After plague, skilled hands were scarcer.

Faith and blame also reshaped society. Some people gave more to the Church; others questioned why God allowed such suffering. Minorities were wrongly accused and attacked in some places: a cruel pattern when fear needs a target. Art and writing turned to death themes. Recovery took generations. Later waves of plague returned, so the fourteenth century was not a single blow and then peace. **Compare immediate and longer change** in the figure: mass death is the first row; wages, belief and rights shift over years.



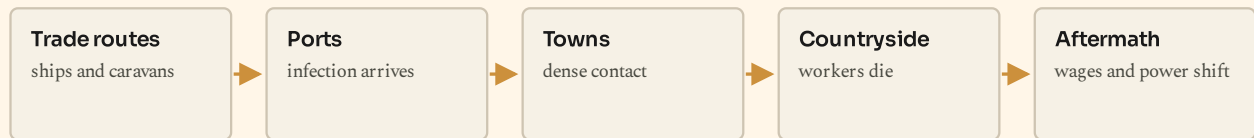


Figure 19.3 · How plague moved and remade society.

Follow the flow: trade routes, ports, towns, countryside, then aftermath. Notice that the last box is not only death: it is wages and power shifting. Explain in one sentence why the aftermath box belongs on a disease diagram.

Why it matters: demography (population size and structure) is historical power. **Bridge:** Portugal's Atlantic ports sat on the same dangerous network of ships and markets.

■ **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Why might surviving workers be able to demand better pay after the plague?
- 2 Give one economic effect and one social or religious effect of the Black Death.
- 3 Write seven to nine sentences answering the unit enquiry: How did plague transform medieval society? Use at least two pieces of evidence (for example labour, belief, land use or ports).

◆ **CAREFUL**

Not every peasant "won" after 1348. Change was **uneven** by region, status and later law. Avoid fairy-tale endings about instant freedom for all.

TOPIC 19.3

Portugal in the global story: plague on the Atlantic edge

The account

■ PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** PORTUGAL SUFFERED PLAGUE WAVES LIKE ITS NEIGHBOURS IN THE FOURTEENTH CENTURY. COASTAL CITIES THAT LIVED BY SHIPPING AND MARKETS WERE DOORWAYS FOR BOTH WEALTH AND INFECTION. WHEN DISEASE ENTERED A HARBOUR, IT COULD MOVE UP RIVER VALLEYS INTO INLAND TOWNS. RURAL AREAS WERE NOT ALWAYS SAFE; TRADERS, SOLDIERS AND PILGRIMS CARRIED RISK WITH THEM. LATER ROYAL POLICY AND SOCIETY HAD TO COPE WITH A THINNER POPULATION: EMPTY FARMS, LABOUR SHORTAGES AND THE SLOW WORK OF RECOVERY. PORTUGAL'S ATLANTIC EDGE DID NOT PROTECT IT FROM A PAN-EURASIAN SHOCK. DISTANCE FROM CENTRAL ASIA LOOKED LARGE ON A WALL MAP, BUT SHIPS HAD ALREADY STITCHED HARBOURS INTO ONE VULNERABLE CHAIN.

Key person, place or event. Fourteenth-century plague waves in Portugal and their impact on ports, river towns and population recovery. The Atlantic fringe was part of the same crisis, not a sealed sanctuary. Ordinary dock workers and farmers, not only kings, lived the shock.

Geography connection. Harbour cities such as Lisbon sat on estuaries that linked ocean routes to the interior. Ships that brought salt, fish, cloth and news could also bring infection. A long coastline meant many points of entry. River valleys that once looked like highways of grain became highways of contact.

Why it matters: Portuguese history is global history whenever ships link the Tagus to wider seas. **Bridge:** Unit 20 follows long war and stronger kings in the generations after plague had already shaken labour and loyalty.



Figure 19.4 • Harbour city risk and reward.

Ports concentrate people, cargo and contact. Notice how an estuary capital can grow rich and still remain exposed to whatever ships bring.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why were Portuguese ports especially exposed to plague?
- 2 How did river estuaries and coastal trade link Portugal to a wider disease network? Give two points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences. Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel. Name one good that trade brought and one risk that came with it.

◆ CAREFUL

"Atlantic edge" does not mean isolated safety. Edge of the continent still means **connected by sea**. Isolation and coast are not the same idea.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

plague, labour, mortality

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ **THE ENQUIRY**

How did plague transform medieval society?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART FIVE · UNIT 20

20

War, monarchies and national identity

How did long war and stronger kings remake Europe?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Outline the Hundred Years' War, changing warfare and centralising monarchies.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How did long war and stronger kings remake Europe?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 20.1

Hundred Years' War and changing warfare

The account

From 1337 to 1453, England and France fought a long, on-and-off conflict later called the **Hundred Years' War**. The causes mixed royal claims to the French crown, control of rich lands such as Gascony, and pride. It was not one continuous battle lasting a hundred years. Periods of truce and raiding alternated with major campaigns. Ordinary villagers paid the price when armies burned crops and seized food. If a modern school rivalry lasted a century with breaks for exams, the name would still mislead: the conflict was long, but not unbroken.



Figure 20.1 · A hard road for long war.

Campaigns of the later Middle Ages still needed routes for troops and supply. Notice how control of paths and ports decides who can fight far from home.

Warfare changed during these decades. English armies made famous use of the **longbow**, a powerful bow that could shoot arrows quickly and pierce armour at range. At battles such as Crécy and Agincourt, disciplined infantry and archers shocked French knights who expected cavalry charges to decide everything. Later, **gunpowder** weapons (early cannon and handguns) began to crack castle walls that had seemed almost permanent. Fort design had to change. Sieges became different when stone towers could be smashed by artillery. The castle you met in Unit 15 was no longer the last word in defence.

Geography shaped the war. The English Channel was a barrier and a highway. Whoever controlled ports could move men and supplies. French rivers and walled towns forced long marches and sieges. Control of the countryside meant control of food. Maps of the conflict show English footholds along coasts and valleys rather than easy conquest of the whole kingdom. War followed the lines of water and walls as much as the lines of royal genealogy. The war helped build a sense of "us" and "them". Songs, stories and taxes tied people more tightly to kings and kingdoms.

Worked change in weapons. (1) Knightly charge is the older ideal. (2) Massed archers disrupt horses and armour at distance. (3) Early cannon threaten walls that once only starved or scaled. (4) Kings who can pay for trained troops and guns outgrow pure feudal call-ups. **Example 1.** Crécy: terrain and archery blunt French cavalry. **Example 2.** Later sieges: powder and shot force new fortress designs. **Why it matters:** long war remakes technology, tax and identity together. **Bridge:** Joan of Arc and stronger monarchies show how leadership and royal power rode those changes.



Figure 20.2 · Hundred Years' War timeline, 1337 to 1453.

Read left to right: war begins, Crécy, Agincourt, Joan of Arc rises, war ends. Choose two dates and write one sentence each: what changed in weapons, leadership or identity around that moment?



LOOK FURTHER

National Army Museum, Explore. How war changes more than battle lines.

www.nam.ac.uk/explore

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Why is the Hundred Years' War a slightly misleading name?
- 2 How did the longbow or gunpowder change the power of knights and castles? Explain one weapon carefully.
- 3 Why did control of ports and rivers matter so much in this war? Give two reasons.

◆ CAREFUL

The war was **on and off**, not one endless battle for 116 years. Treat "Hundred Years'" as a later label for a long rivalry with pauses.

TOPIC 20.2

Joan of Arc and stronger monarchies

The account

Joan of Arc was a young French woman who believed God had called her to help drive the English out of France. In the late 1420s she inspired troops, supported the coronation of Charles VII and became a powerful symbol of French resistance. Captured and tried, she was executed in 1431. Her story shows how belief, leadership and propaganda can change a war's mood even when one person cannot win it alone. Symbols matter in long wars: they keep people fighting when maps look dark. Later memory of Joan became part of French identity, even though her own lifetime was short and tragic.

Across Europe in the later Middle Ages, many **monarchies** (kingdoms ruled by kings or queens) grew stronger. Long wars cost money. Kings who could tax more reliably, hire professional soldiers and build gunpowder forts edged out purely feudal armies of short-term vassals. Royal courts, written law and officials spread the king's reach into regions that once answered mainly to local lords. Power slowly **centralised**: more decisions and more money flowed toward the crown. The feudal pyramid of Unit 15 did not vanish overnight, but the top of the pyramid grew heavier.

Steps toward a stronger crown (model). (1) War creates urgent need for cash and troops. (2) Kings invent or expand taxes and officials. (3) Paid soldiers reduce pure reliance on vassal loyalty. (4) Courts and law codes push royal justice outward. (5) Stories of national heroes (such as Joan) bind subjects emotionally as well as legally. **Example 1.** A king who can fund cannon does not need every minor castle's goodwill to siege a rebel town. **Example 2.** A coronation in a sacred city turns a disputed prince into a recognised king in the eyes of many subjects.

Identity grew with war. Songs mocked the enemy. Taxes were justified as defence of the realm. People who never met the king still heard his name in proclamations and church prayers for victory. That is not yet a modern nation-state, but it is a step toward wider loyalty beyond one manor. **Why it matters:** modern ideas of nation and state partly grow from late medieval war pressure. **Bridge:** Portugal's crisis of 1383-1385 shows a similar fight over independence, dynasty and chosen ground.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Who was Joan of Arc, and why did she matter to France's war effort? Give one military and one symbolic reason.
- 2 Give two ways a king could become stronger than a purely feudal lord.
- 3 Write a short explanation (seven to nine sentences): How did long war and stronger kings remake Europe? Include weapons or money once, and identity or loyalty once.

◆ CAREFUL

Joan of Arc mattered as a **symbol and catalyst**, not as a one-woman army that won the war alone. Leadership and mood matter; so do taxes, men and terrain.

TOPIC 20.3

Portugal in the global story: 1383–1385 and Aljubarrota

The account

■ PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** IN 1383–1385 PORTUGAL FACED A **SUCCESSION CRISIS**. WHEN KING FERNANDO DIED WITHOUT A CLEAR MALE HEIR, CASTILE CLAIMED THE PORTUGUESE CROWN THROUGH MARRIAGE TIES. MANY PORTUGUESE FEARED LOSING INDEPENDENCE. A POPULAR AND NOBLE RESISTANCE FORMED AROUND **JOÃO OF AVIS**, WHO BECAME KING JOÃO I. THE DECISIVE BATTLE CAME AT **ALJUBARROTA** IN 1385. PORTUGUESE FORCES UNDER THE CONSTABLE **NUNO ÁLVARES PEREIRA**, WITH ENGLISH ALLIES, DEFEATED A LARGER CASTILIAN ARMY. THE VICTORY SECURED A SEPARATE PORTUGUESE CROWN AND OPENED THE WAY FOR THE **AVIS DYNASTY**. THAT DYNASTY LATER SPONSORED THE MARITIME PROJECTS THAT MADE PORTUGAL A LEADING SEAFARING POWER. A BATTLEFIELD IN THE CENTRE OF THE KINGDOM HELPED UNLOCK AN OCEAN STORY DECADES LATER.

Key person, place or event. The crisis of 1383–1385; the Battle of Aljubarrota; Nuno Álvares Pereira; the rise of the Avis dynasty under João I. English alliance links this Iberian fight to the same wider Anglo-French world you met in the Hundred Years' War.

Geography connection. Portugal is a smaller kingdom pressed against larger Castile on a long land border. Defending independence required careful use of terrain, fortified towns and alliances (including with England). Hills, approaches and chosen ground at Aljubarrota helped a smaller force resist. Control of approaches mattered more than raw numbers when position, discipline and local knowledge combined. **Why it matters:** independence preserved a separate Portuguese state that could later project power on the Atlantic. **Bridge:** Unit 21 turns to Renaissance learning, print and the ocean skills that Avis patronage would eventually fund.



Figure 20.3 · Coastal kingdom after inland victory.

Keeping a separate crown later mattered for Atlantic projects. Notice how a land battle can still open a sea story for later generations.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What was at stake for Portugal in 1383-1385, and who became king?
- 2 Why did terrain and alliances matter at Aljubarrota? Give two points.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences. Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel and name the Avis dynasty once.

◆ CAREFUL

Aljubarrota did not "create" the Age of Discovery by itself. It **secured a dynasty** that later chose maritime projects. Keep cause chains honest: one battle, then many decisions.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

longbow, gunpowder, Avis, Aljubarrota

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ **THE ENQUIRY**

How did long war and stronger kings remake Europe?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.

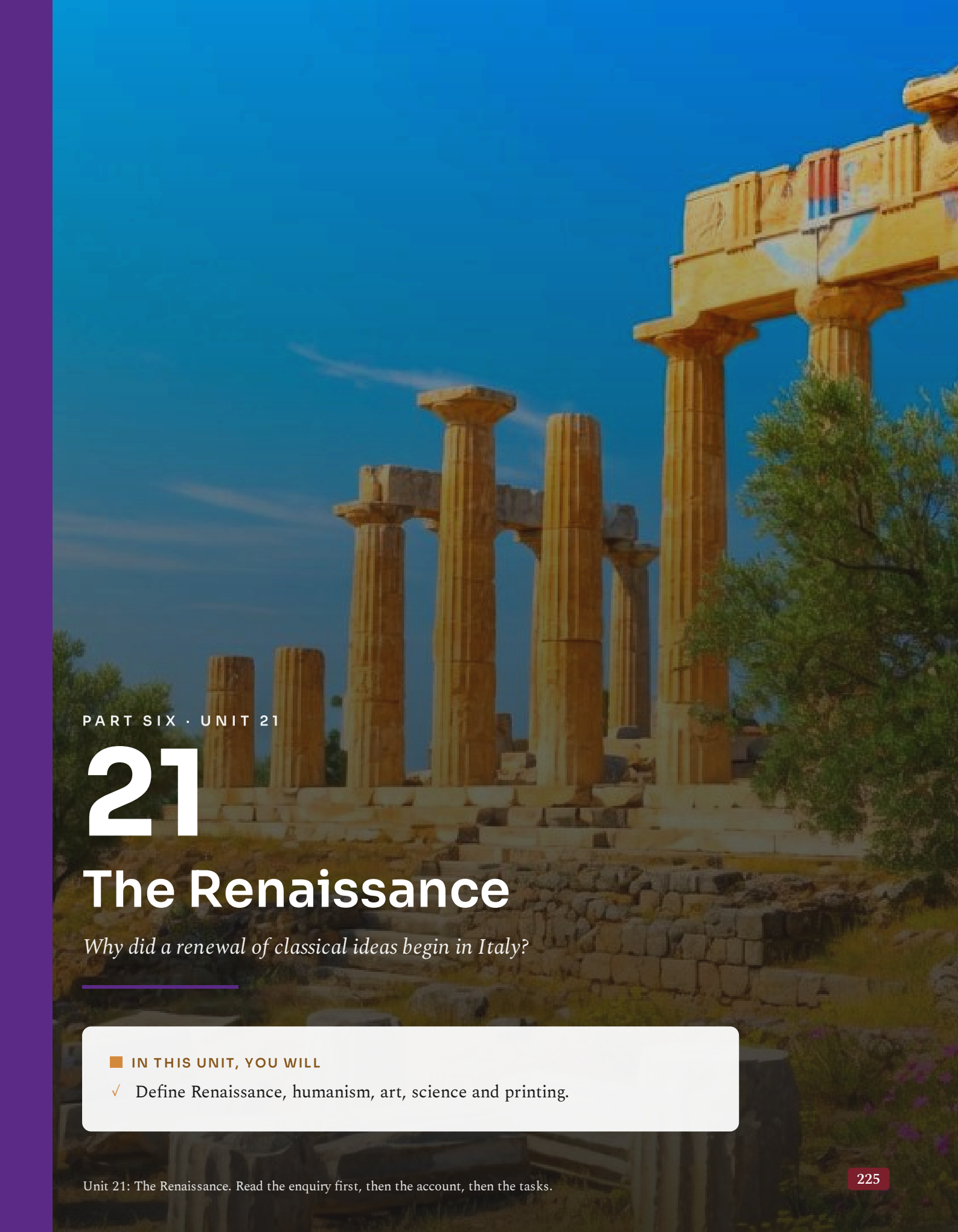
PART SIX

Renaissance and a new age

Classical learning returned in new forms, print spread ideas, and Atlantic winds pulled European power onto the ocean. Portugal stands at the hinge of that change.

Link the study desk to the ship. Humanist reading and better charts both change what a kingdom can attempt far from home.

Units 21 and 22 join Renaissance enquiry to exploration, navigation and maritime empire.



PART SIX · UNIT 21

21

The Renaissance

Why did a renewal of classical ideas begin in Italy?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define Renaissance, humanism, art, science and printing.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why did a renewal of classical ideas begin in Italy?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 21.1

What was the Renaissance?

The account

The word **Renaissance** means "rebirth". Historians use it for a movement of cultural and intellectual renewal that began in Italian cities in the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries and later spread across Europe. Artists, writers and scholars looked back to the literature, art and learning of ancient Greece and Rome. They did not simply copy the past. They mixed classical models with new techniques, new wealth and new questions. A rebirth is not a photocopy: it is old material remade under new conditions.



Figure 21.1 • Old stone, later learning.

Classical ruins remind us that Renaissance and humanist readers looked back to Greece and Rome. Notice how past buildings become future symbols.

Was everything before the Renaissance a "Dark Age"? Many historians say no. Medieval Europe already had cathedrals, universities, trade and rich scholarship. The Renaissance was a change of emphasis and energy, especially in art, classical languages and the confidence that human skill could shape the world. Labels help us organise time, but they can oversimplify. Treat "rebirth" as a useful idea to test with evidence, not as a fairy tale of sudden light after total darkness. Unit 14 already trained you to challenge lazy labels. Use that habit here.

The Renaissance was not only paintings in galleries. It touched architecture, politics, education and science. City leaders and rich families paid for buildings and books that displayed their power. Ideas moved with travellers, diplomats and printed pages. Different regions developed their own styles: Florence, Venice, Rome and later northern Europe each left a mark. Italian beginnings matter, but the story does not stop at the Alps.

Worked definition steps. (1) Name the word meaning (rebirth). (2) Say what was reborn (interest in classical models). (3) Say what was new (techniques, patronage, later print). (4) Refuse the cartoon of total medieval darkness. **Example 1.** A painter studies Roman statues and invents better ways to show depth on a flat wall. **Example 2.** A scholar re-reads Cicero and argues that citizens need eloquent speech as well as prayer. **Why it matters:** a renewal of ideas can reshape how people see beauty, learning and their own place in history. Ideas are historical forces when people pay for them, teach them and sail with them. **Bridge:** Italy's cities explain the "where first" half of the enquiry.

	What renewed	What was new
Learning	Classical texts reread.	Humanist education.
Art	Greek-Roman models.	Perspective, anatomy.
Knowledge	Ancient authorities.	Observation and print.

Figure 21.2 · What renewed, and what was new.

Read across each row (Learning, Art, Knowledge). The left column is classical inheritance; the right column is the Renaissance twist. For one row, invent a school-room example of "old idea, new tool."



LOOK FURTHER

National Gallery of Art (Washington), teachers. Art resources for Renaissance looking and questioning.

www.nga.gov/learn/teachers.html

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What does the word Renaissance mean, and what kind of "rebirth" do historians mean?
- 2 Why should we be careful about calling the Middle Ages a total "Dark Age"? Give two reasons.
- 3 Name two areas of life (besides painting) that the Renaissance touched, and give one concrete example for each.

◆ CAREFUL

Renaissance is a useful label, not a light switch. Medieval learning already existed. Use "rebirth" to organise evidence, not to erase earlier centuries.

TOPIC 21.2

Why Italy, humanism and art

The account

Why Italy first? Geography and history give strong clues. Italian cities such as Florence, Venice and Milan sat on trade routes between the Mediterranean and northern Europe. Merchant wealth funded art and scholarship. City-states competed for prestige: a more beautiful cathedral or a finer statue was a way to outshine rivals. Ancient Roman ruins still stood in the landscape. People literally walked among classical remains, which made the ancient world feel close. A broken column in a field is a better prompt for classical curiosity than a blank forest clearing.

Humanism was a way of studying and teaching that put classical texts and human experience at the centre. Humanists learned Latin (and sometimes Greek), read ancient historians and poets, and argued that education should form eloquent, active citizens, not only train clergy. They still lived in a Christian world. Humanism was not simple atheism. It shifted attention toward what humans could achieve through reason, skill and virtue. Think of it as turning the camera slightly: God remains in the frame, but human talent fills more of the shot.

Patronage paid the bills. A **patron** is someone who supports an artist or scholar with money and protection. Banking families, popes and city councils hired painters, architects and writers. Art was public power as well as private beauty: a chapel fresco announced who ruled the neighbourhood. Techniques such as linear **perspective** (a method for showing depth on a flat surface) and closer study of anatomy made bodies and spaces look more "real" to viewers. Workshops trained apprentices much as medieval guilds had done, but the products now included classical columns, lifelike portraits and carefully measured space.

Worked chain: why Italy. (1) Trade wealth. (2) City competition. (3) Visible Roman past. (4) Networks of scholars and workshops. (5) Patrons who want glory. **Example 1.** Florence: cloth and banking money fund workshops and public art. **Example 2.** Venice: sea trade brings wealth and contact with eastern styles and goods. Remove any one link and the "why Italy first" answer weakens: genius alone does not pay for marble. **Why it matters:** culture follows money, competition and memory as much as talent. **Bridge:** science, enquiry and printing multiplied those ideas beyond one city wall.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Give two geographical or economic reasons Renaissance culture grew strongly in Italian cities.
- 2 What is humanism, in one clear sentence for a twelve-year-old?
- 3 What is a patron, and why did artists need patrons? Add one modern comparison (for example a sponsor of a sports team or a school arts fund).

◆ CAREFUL

Humanism was not automatic atheism. Most humanists remained Christian. Do not turn a shift of emphasis into a false claim that faith disappeared.

TOPIC 21.3

Science, enquiry and printing

The account

Renaissance curiosity did not stop at paintings. Scholars and craftspeople observed nature more carefully. Anatomists studied bodies. Engineers tested machines. Astronomers tracked the skies. Not every claim was correct, and old authorities still carried weight. Yet a culture of **enquiry** (careful questioning and testing) grew stronger. Looking, measuring and comparing began to challenge some inherited answers. Enquiry is not the same as knowing everything. It is the habit of checking. A wrong idea written carefully can still be tested and improved later.

Printing with movable type, spreading in Europe from the mid-fifteenth century (associated with Johannes Gutenberg in Germany), multiplied books. A text that once took a monk months to copy could be reproduced in many copies far faster. Prices fell over time. More people could own or borrow books. Arguments, maps, religious debates and scientific ideas travelled farther. Knowledge became harder for any single gatekeeper to control. Printers set up in busy towns where paper, markets and readers met. A press without customers is just a heavy machine. Paper mills, ink recipes and skilled typesetters all belonged to the same industry of ideas.

Science, art and print overlapped. Accurate drawings helped anatomy. Perspective linked art and geometry. Printed maps and tables supported travellers and merchants. **Steps of a printed idea.** (1) Author or scholar writes or edits a text. (2) Printer sets type and runs sheets. (3) Booksellers and fairs move copies. (4) Readers far away argue, copy and teach. (5) Corrections and rival books follow. **Example 1.** An anatomy book with careful pictures trains doctors who never met the author. **Example 2.** A printed grammar helps students learn Latin outside a single monastery library. **Why it matters:** tools change the speed of history; print is a network technology. **Bridge:** Portugal used observation, maths and charts for Atlantic problems, not only gallery walls.



Figure 21.3 · Maps and measurement on the desk.

Learning becomes practical when charts and instruments leave the study for the voyage. Notice how tools sit between curiosity and risk.

Press

many copies



Cheaper books

more readers



Shared ideas

science and faith



Faster debate

across cities

Figure 21.4 · How print speeds ideas.

Follow the steps: press, cheaper books, shared ideas, faster debate across cities. Use the flow to explain why Renaissance learning did not stay locked in one library.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did printing change the spread of ideas compared with hand-copied books? Give two changes.
- 2 Give one example of Renaissance enquiry in science or medicine.
- 3 Why might a printer set up in a busy trading town rather than a tiny isolated village? Give two reasons.

◆ CAREFUL

Print spread ideas faster; it did not make every idea true. Bad arguments can travel at the same speed as good ones. Always ask for evidence.

TOPIC 21.4

Portugal in the global story: learning on the Atlantic edge

The account

■ PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY **WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?** WHILE ITALIAN WORKSHOPS PAINTED FRESCOES, PORTUGUESE COURTS AND NAVIGATORS USED MATHEMATICS, ASTRONOMY AND **CARTOGRAPHY** (MAP-MAKING) AS TOOLS FOR OCEAN PROJECTS. SAILORS NEEDED BETTER CHARTS, INSTRUMENTS AND STAR TABLES TO LEAVE THE FAMILIAR MEDITERRANEAN AND HUG THE AFRICAN COAST INTO THE OPEN ATLANTIC. ROYAL SPONSORSHIP, SHIPYARDS AND ACCUMULATED SEAMANSHIP TURNED LEARNING INTO RANGE. RENAISSANCE SKILLS WERE NOT ONLY FOR GALLERY WALLS. THEY COULD ALSO MEAN A SAFER RETURN FROM A LONG VOYAGE. A BEAUTIFUL PAINTING AND A CAREFUL CHART BOTH REST ON OBSERVATION, MEASUREMENT AND PATRONAGE, EVEN IF ONE HANGS IN A HALL AND THE OTHER LIVES IN A SEA CHEST.

Key person, place or event. Navigation science and cartography in fifteenth-century Portugal, linked to Atlantic exploration and to the wider European revival of classical and practical learning. The Avis dynasty's interest in ocean projects (you met that dynasty in Unit 20) turned court resources toward ships and knowledge of winds.

Geography connection. Atlantic problems demanded more than coastal hopping. Out of sight of land, crews relied on compass, stars and estimated distance. Winds and currents off Africa and among Atlantic islands forced new route-planning. A wrong chart could mean death by thirst or storm. The ocean does not forgive sloppy measurement. Portugal's long Atlantic facade made those skills valuable to rulers who wanted wealth, prestige and new routes past Mediterranean middlemen. **Why it matters:** the year question about states, empires and networks now opens onto the ocean. **Bridge:** later units follow exploration motives, tools and routes in more detail.



Figure 21.5 · From motives to routes.

Follow the flow: motives, tools, Atlantic conditions, then routes. For one box, write a Portuguese example (for example a chart, a wind, or a royal motive).

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did mathematics and map-making help Portuguese sailors?
- 2 Why did Atlantic voyages need better tools than short Mediterranean trips? Give two reasons.
- 3 Answer the key question in five to seven sentences: Why did a renewal of classical ideas begin in Italy? Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel. Mention observation or measurement once, and name Italy once.

◆ CAREFUL

Portuguese ocean learning was practical and royal as well as "Renaissance". Do not force every chart into an Italian art story; link shared habits of observation without erasing Atlantic difference.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

humanism, patronage, printing

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why did a renewal of classical ideas begin in Italy?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question.



PART SIX · UNIT 22

22

The Age of Exploration

Why did Portugal turn towards the Atlantic?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Explain motives, navigation, ships and Iberian oceanic routes.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why did Portugal turn towards the Atlantic?**
You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 22.1

Why explore?

The account

In the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries, European kingdoms poured money and lives into long ocean voyages. Historians often call this the **Age of Exploration** (or Age of Discovery), though many lands were already known to the people who lived there. From a European point of view, ships pushed farther down Africa, across the Atlantic and toward the Indian Ocean than before. The label describes European expansion of range, not empty continents waiting to be invented. When you use the phrase, keep that fairness rule in mind: exploration for one side was invasion or disruption for another.



Figure 22.1 · Ocean-going sail.

Iberian explorers used improved ships and navigation to leave the Mediterranean for the Atlantic. Notice hull and canvas built for long blue-water voyages.

Why explore? Motives mixed, and they rarely arrived alone. Historians often group them under wealth, faith and glory, then add curiosity and competition. Rulers and merchants wanted **gold**, silver and **spices** that sold for high prices in Europe. Spices from Asia flavoured food and showed wealth; middlemen on old land and sea routes took large cuts. Finding a direct ocean path could bypass rivals and raise the share that reached a king's treasury. **Faith** mattered too: missionaries and kings spoke of spreading Christianity and of rivalries between Christian powers. **Glory** and honour drove nobles and captains who wanted fame written into

chronicles. Curiosity and the thrill of the unknown pulled some individuals. No single cause explains state investment. Kings weighed cost, risk and prestige together, the way a school might weigh a big trip: money, safety, reputation and learning all at once.

Worked reasoning. Imagine two neighbouring courts in Iberia. Court A hears that Court B is funding a fleet down the African coast. Even if Court A is unsure about profit this year, fear of being left behind becomes a motive. Competition sharpens ambition. If one kingdom gained a rich route, another feared empty harbours and weaker status. Portugal and Spain led early oceanic pushes from south-western Europe. Later the Dutch, English and French joined. Exploration was also about power: who taxed trade, who built forts, who claimed oceans on paper. Paper claims and real control were not always the same thing.

Costs were real. Ships sank. Crews died of scurvy, storm and combat. Peoples in Africa, the Americas and Asia faced invasion, disease and forced labour as European power grew. Why it matters: when you explain "why explore," you are explaining why money moved, why maps changed and why some places became hubs while others paid a price. That habit prepares you for every later unit on trade, cities and globalisation. The bridge to the next topic is practical: motives without tools stay dreams. Navigation and ships turned ambition into routes.

	What people wanted	What geography demanded
Wealth	Gold, spices, trade	Ocean winds and currents
Faith	Mission and rivalry	Long empty sea legs
Glory	Kings and captains	Charts and instruments
Routes	Bypass middlemen	Know how to return

Figure 22.2 • Motives versus what the ocean demanded.
Read each row left to right: what people wanted, then what geography forced them to master. Pick one row and write two sentences: how a motive and a geographic demand worked together on a real voyage.



LOOK FURTHER

Royal Museums Greenwich, **age of exploration**. Navigation, ships and ocean routes.

www.rmg.co.uk/stories/topics/age-exploration

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 List four motives for exploration. Underline the two you think mattered most to kings, and explain why in two sentences using the ideas of treasury, risk or rivalry.
- 2 Why did Europeans want a sea route that avoided some middlemen in the spice trade? Use the words *price* and *control* once each.
- 3 Who is missing if we only tell the story of the explorers and not the people they met? Write three sentences that put those people back into the account, then name one cost of exploration for a non-European place.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not reduce exploration to one slogan ("for gold" or "for God"). Motives mixed, and European gain often meant loss, disease or forced labour for others. Paper claims on maps are not the same as fair consent on the ground.

TOPIC 22.2

Navigation and ships

The account

Ocean travel needed tools as well as courage. The **magnetic compass** helped sailors keep a direction when clouds hid the sun and stars. Improved **charts** recorded coasts, hazards and distances, though early maps still held errors and blank spaces. Astronomical reckoning used the sun and stars to estimate **latitude** (how far north or south you were). Knowing roughly where you stood made it safer to leave sight of land. Guessing is not navigation. Measurement is. A crew that can name its latitude has a better chance of finding an island again next season. **Longitude** (how far east or west) was much harder at this date; sailors often combined dead reckoning (estimate of speed and time) with coastal landmarks when they could.

Steps a navigator might use. (1) Set a course with compass and plan. (2) Watch wind and current so the real path matches the intended one as closely as possible. (3) Measure latitude with instruments and star tables when skies allow. (4) Mark the chart with new coast detail after a successful leg. (5) Plan the return as carefully as the outward trip, because a one-way hero story still needs water, food and a home wind. Every improvement was tested in real storms, not only on paper. A clever drawing that sinks in a gale is not progress.

Ships mattered just as much. The **caravel** was a relatively small, sturdy sailing ship used by the Portuguese. It could sail closer to the wind than some older designs, which helped on coasts with awkward breezes. Larger ships later carried more cargo and guns for long Indian Ocean runs. Shipwrights learned from Mediterranean and Atlantic practice. Hull shape, sail plan and strength of timber all mattered when Atlantic swells slammed a vessel for weeks. **Example 1:** hugging the West African coast, a caravel that can tack (zigzag against the wind) keeps options open when the breeze turns foul. **Example 2:** a bigger cargo ship on the India run needs more crew, more stores and more defence, but pays off if spice cargoes return. Why it matters: tools and hulls priced which motives could become routes. Without charts and ships that returned, kings would stop funding dreams. The bridge is geography itself: the Atlantic is not a flat blue board. Winds, currents and islands structure every successful voyage.



Figure 22.3 · From motive to route.

Read left to right: motives, tools, Atlantic geography, then routes. For one box, add a sticky note in your book: what fails if that stage is weak?

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name two navigation tools and explain how each helped sailors leave sight of land more safely.
- 2 What was special about the caravel compared with many older coastal craft? Use the idea of sailing nearer the wind.
- 3 Why is the return journey as important as the outward journey on an ocean voyage? Use winds or supply in your answer, then write one sentence on how that fact affects a king's decision to fund a second voyage.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat "brave sailors" as enough explanation. Without compass, charts, latitude skill and a ship that can return, courage alone does not open a lasting route.

TOPIC 22.3

Portugal, Spain and Atlantic geography

The account

Look at a map of south-western Europe. **Portugal** faces the open Atlantic along a long coast. **Spain** has both Atlantic and Mediterranean shores and, after 1492, a growing American empire. Geography did not force either kingdom to explore, but it priced their choices. A landlocked mountain realm has different options from a fishing coast with Atlantic weather in its bones. Westerly winds, ocean currents and island stepping-stones (the Canaries, Madeira, the Azores, Cape Verde) structured routes down Africa and across the ocean. Islands are not decoration on a map. They are service stations for the age of sail: water, food, repairs and practice. Lose the island chain and every voyage becomes longer, thirstier and more dangerous.

Portuguese strategy often followed the African coast southward, seeking a way around to the Indian Ocean spice world. Spanish sponsorship later backed westward voyages across the Atlantic, famously those of Columbus, which linked Europe to the Americas. Treaties such as **Tordesillas** tried to divide spheres of influence between Spain and Portugal on paper, even while the real world of islands and peoples was far more complex. Lines drawn in Europe did not ask local permission. **Worked reasoning.** Why might Portugal push south-east around Africa while Spain invests heavily west? Portugal's long Atlantic face, existing African coastal probes and island bases already pointed toward a route that hugged Africa then turned toward Asia. Spain, after dynastic union and rivalry, backed a western gamble that (from a European map view) sought Asia by a shorter-looking ocean path and instead opened the Americas. Different situations, shared competitive pressure.

Portugal's coastal position, fishing tradition and experience from the Reconquista and medieval trade gave a head start in seamanship. A narrow kingdom with limited inland width looked seaward for wealth and status. That does not mean destiny. Other Atlantic coasts existed. Portugal combined geography with royal sponsorship, accumulated pilot knowledge and a habit of patient coastal advance. Why it matters: human geography always asks where choices are made, not only who is famous. The Atlantic edge of Iberia became a hinge between Mediterranean memory and ocean empire. The bridge to the next topic is the people who proved the steps: Dias, da Gama and the maritime system that followed.

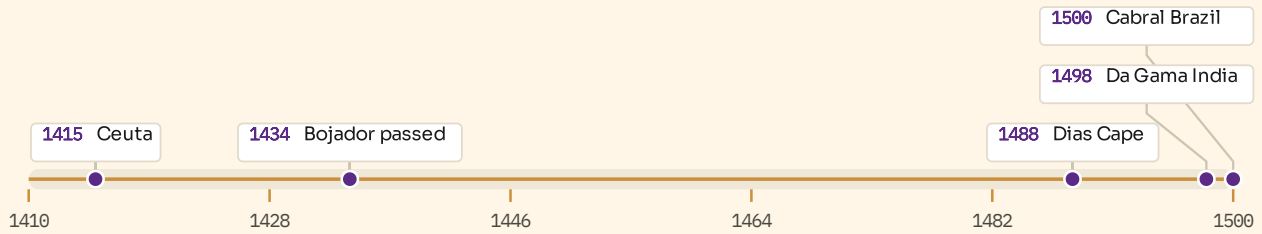


Figure 22.4 • Portuguese oceanic steps, 1415 to 1500.

Read left to right: Ceuta, Bojador passed, Dias at the Cape, da Gama to India, Cabral and Brazil. For two events, write one sentence each: what new door on the world map did this open?

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 How did Portugal's coastal geography encourage a seaward strategy? Give two concrete points (coast, islands, limited inland width or winds).
- 2 Why were Atlantic islands useful as "stepping-stones"? Give two uses a crew would care about.
- 3 On an outline map, mark Portugal, the West African coast, the Cape of Good Hope and India. Draw the idea of a sea route linking them. Add one arrow for a possible return path using ocean winds, and one sentence explaining why the return path may not be a simple reverse of the outward line.

◆ CAREFUL

Geography prices choices; it does not remove human decision. Do not write "Portugal had to explore" as if the coast pressed a button. Other coastal peoples did not build the same empire in the same way.

TOPIC 22.4

Portugal in the global story: Dias, da Gama and maritime power

The account

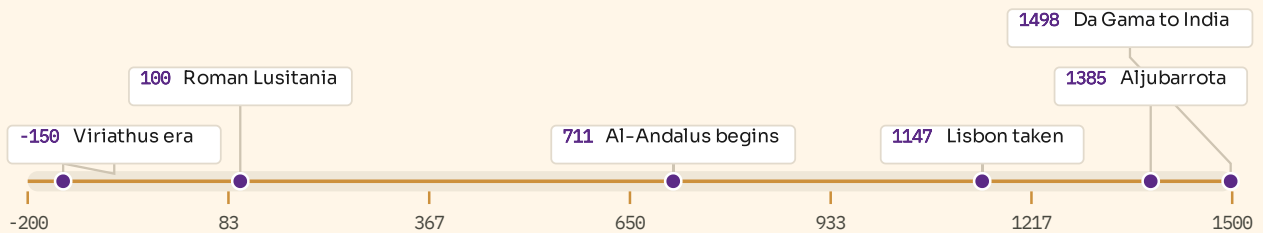


Figure 22.5 · Portugal in a longer arc.

Read from Roman Lusitania through medieval kingdom to da Gama. Notice how ocean power sits on older layers of place and politics. Pick two dates and write one sentence each on what changed for people on the ground.



Figure 22.6 · A caravel-type hull for long horizons.

Ocean power needed ships that could sail into the wind, carry stores and return. Notice the hull as technology and as a claim on distance: without it, Atlantic ambition stays a speech.

■ **PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY** ****WHAT WAS HAPPENING IN PORTUGAL?**** PORTUGUESE EXPLORATION BUILT STEP BY STEP. TRADITIONS OF ROYAL SPONSORSHIP (INCLUDING THE EARLIER SUPPORT ASSOCIATED WITH ****PRINCE HENRY****, OFTEN CALLED HENRY THE NAVIGATOR) FUNDED COASTAL PROBES, CHARTS AND SHIP DESIGN. PROGRESS WAS PATIENT, NOT A SINGLE MAGIC VOYAGE. EACH SUCCESSFUL LEG TAUGHT PILOTS MORE ABOUT WINDS, REEFS AND SUPPLY POINTS. FAILURES TAUGHT EXPENSIVE LESSONS TOO: SCURVY, STORMS AND HOSTILE RECEPTIONS WERE PART OF THE SCHOOL OF THE SEA. ****BARTOLOMEU DIAS**** ROUNDED THE ****CAPE OF GOOD HOPE**** AT AFRICA'S SOUTHERN TIP IN 1488, PROVING A SEA LINK BETWEEN THE ATLANTIC AND THE INDIAN OCEAN WAS POSSIBLE. THE CAPE IS WHERE OCEANS MEET AND WEATHER CAN TURN BRUTAL. ROUNDING IT WAS A GEOGRAPHIC PROOF AS MUCH AS A PERSONAL FEAT. TEN YEARS LATER, ****VASCO DA GAMA**** REACHED ****INDIA**** (CALICUT) IN 1498. THAT VOYAGE LINKED EUROPEAN DEMAND FOR ASIAN GOODS TO AN OCEAN HIGHWAY UNDER PORTUGUESE NAVAL PRESSURE. PORTUGAL BECAME A MARITIME POWER LINKING ATLANTIC AND INDIAN OCEAN WORLDS THROUGH FORTS, FLEETS AND TRADING POSTS. CONTROL OF CHOKE POINTS AND HARBOUR ACCESS MATTERED AS MUCH AS THE FIRST LANDING STORY. THE CONSEQUENCES FOR AFRICA, ASIA AND EUROPE WERE PROFOUND: NEW WEALTH AND KNOWLEDGE FOR SOME, VIOLENCE, DISRUPTION AND FORCED SYSTEMS FOR MANY OTHERS. A FAIR PORTUGUESE GLOBAL STORY HOLDS BOTH THE SEAMANSHIP AND THE COST. ****KEY PERSON, PLACE OR EVENT.**** BARTOLOMEU DIAS (1488); VASCO DA GAMA (1498); THE CAPE OF GOOD HOPE ROUTE; EARLIER SPONSORSHIP TRADITIONS UNDER PRINCE HENRY'S GENERATION; THE STEP-BY-STEP AFRICAN COASTAL ADVANCE; LATER FORTS AND FLEETS THAT TRIED TO TAX AND POLICE TRADE. ****GEOGRAPHY CONNECTION.**** ATLANTIC WINDS, THE SHAPE OF THE AFRICAN COAST AND ISLAND BASES SHAPED THE ROUTE SYSTEM. ROUNDING THE CAPE MEANT MASTERING STORMY SEAS WHERE OCEANS MEET. ONCE THAT HINGE OPENED, INDIAN OCEAN MONSOONS AND HARBOUR POLITICS BECAME PART OF PORTUGUESE STRATEGY. ****GLOBAL CONNECTION.**** WHILE PORTUGUESE FLEETS OPENED AN OCEAN HIGHWAY, OTHER POWERS STILL USED MEDITERRANEAN AND OVERLAND ROUTES; THE SPICE WORLD WAS ALREADY NETWORKED BEFORE DA GAMA. WHAT CHANGED WAS WHO COULD FORCE TERMS AT SEA. WHY IT MATTERS FOR YOUR YEAR QUESTION: STATES AND EMPIRES GROW WHEN GEOGRAPHY, TOOLS AND AMBITION LOCK TOGETHER, AND NETWORKS CAN EXPAND FASTER THAN JUSTICE.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What did Bartolomeu Dias achieve in 1488, and what did Vasco da Gama achieve in 1498? Write one clear sentence for each.
- 2 Explain how the Cape of Good Hope links the Atlantic story to the Indian Ocean story. Use the words *hinge* or *door* once.
- 3 Answer the unit enquiry in six to eight sentences: **Why did Portugal turn towards the Atlantic?** Use at least one piece of evidence from this panel, one geographical reason (coast, wind, cape or island), and one consequence for people beyond Europe.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not end the story at "da Gama arrived." Arrival is one moment. Forts, fleets, forced trade and local resistance are part of the same global story. Celebrate seamanship without erasing harm.

■ WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

caravel, Cape of Good Hope, da Gama, compass, latitude, spice trade

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why did Portugal turn towards the Atlantic?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question. Include motives, one navigation or ship fact, one Atlantic geography point, and Dias or da Gama as evidence.

PART SEVEN

Human geography and the connected world

Return to geography with history in your pocket: borders, economies, cities, development and globalisation are old patterns moving at a new speed.

Use everything you have learned about ports, roads and empires. Modern maps still hide the same questions: who draws the line, who moves the goods, who lives densely and who is left sparse.

Units 23 to 27 name political and economic geography, cities, development and global links, then synthesise the year.



PART SEVEN · UNIT 23

23

Political geography

Why are borders not permanent?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define country, state, nation, territory, border and region using historical maps.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why are borders not permanent?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 23.1

Country, state, nation and territory

The account

People often use **country**, **state** and **nation** as if they mean the same thing. In geography and history they do not, and mixing them up leads to weak answers. This unit gives you precise words so that when you look at a map of Greece, Rome or Portugal you can say what kind of power you are really seeing. Precision is not pedantry. It is the difference between "people feel they belong together" and "a government claims the right to tax and punish inside a line."



Figure 23.1 · Lisbon harbour and city edge.

A capital on a river mouth shows state power on a real territory. Notice how ports and borders sit on living landscapes, not only ink lines.

A **state** is a political unit with a government that claims the right to make laws, collect taxes and use force inside a **territory**. That claim is called **sovereignty**: the idea that no higher power should rule there. Portugal is a state. So was the Roman Empire, even though it was huge and ruled many peoples. A city-state in classical Greece was a state too, just on a smaller scale. A state is about power and rules, not only about flags or football shirts. A **territory** is the land (and often sea) that the state claims. Territory can be full of mountains, rivers and cities; the claim is political, the ground is physical. A **nation** is a community of people who share a sense of belonging. That may come from language, history, culture, religion or a story people

tell about themselves. A nation can exist without a full state of its own, and a state can rule more than one nation. When nation and state line up closely, people talk about a **nation-state**, but history is full of mismatches.

Worked comparison. Think of a football club carefully. The club is like a state: it has managers, rules, a pitch and staff who decide who plays. The supporters are more like a nation: they share songs, colours and identity even if they live in different cities and never sit in the same stand. The comparison helps, then stops. A real state can imprison people; a club cannot rewrite your passport. Everyday speech still uses **country** as a friendly word for the place you live or the team you cheer. That is fine in casual talk. In essays, choose the sharper word: *state* for organised power, *nation* for shared identity, *territory* for the claimed ground, *region* for an area that may cross or sit inside borders (for example the Algarve, Attica or the Mediterranean world).

Two historical examples. Classical Athens was a state (a polis with laws and an army) for a citizen body that was not the whole population. The Roman Empire was a vast state ruling many nations and languages under one centre. Why it matters: if you call everything a "country," you cannot explain why empires rise, why minorities struggle for recognition, or why a border drawn by treaty can cut through a people who feel they belong together. The bridge to the next topic is the line itself: borders are how states try to fix territory on the map, and those lines move.

	Seem fixed	Actually change
On maps	Hard ink lines.	Wars and treaties redraw.
In life	Checkpoints, passports.	People still move and mix.
History	Rome looked eternal.	Medieval map is different.

Figure 23.2 · Borders look fixed but change.

Compare the left column (what maps and checkpoints make us feel) with the right (what history actually does). Notice how Rome once looked permanent and how a medieval map redraws the same land. The figure teaches that borders record human decisions, not eternal facts of nature.



LOOK FURTHER

CIA World Factbook. Modern political map facts; borders are not eternal.

www.cia.gov/the-world-factbook/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 In your own words, write one sentence that defines **state** and one that defines **nation**. Do not use the word "country" as a cheat.
- 2 Sort these labels under *state*, *nation* or *both*: government, passport, shared language, army, folk songs, tax office, shared history story. Then add one label of your own to each column.
- 3 Explain why a football club is a useful comparison for state and nation. Then write two sentences on where the comparison stops working, using the idea of force or law.

 CAREFUL

Do not treat country, state and nation as synonyms in essays. Choose the word that matches what you mean: organised power (state), shared identity (nation) or everyday place name (country). A flag alone does not prove sovereignty.

TOPIC 23.2

Borders and regions over time

The account

Open four maps in your mind: classical Greece, the Roman Empire at its height, medieval Europe, and modern Portugal. The lines of ink look solid. The story behind them is not. **Borders** are photographs of power at one moment. Power moves, so the photograph goes out of date. A border is a political line (sometimes marked by walls, rivers or posts) that claims where one authority ends and another begins. **Regions** are broader areas defined by culture, language, climate or economy; they may ignore the latest treaty. Attica, the Peloponnese, Iberia and the Mediterranean basin are regions that outlast many border redraws.

In classical Greece, power sat in many **poleis** (city-states). Mountains and islands made one big kingdom hard to keep. Borders between Athens, Sparta and their neighbours shifted with war, alliance and fear. A treaty one summer could be broken the next. The map was a patchwork of tiny claims, not a single coloured shape like a modern country. That patchwork is political geography in action: many states, overlapping identities, and regions such as Attica or the Peloponnese that meant more than any permanent national line. Rome later painted huge areas one colour on our classroom maps. That colour meant Roman law, taxes, roads and legions more than one language or one people. When the western empire broke up, the map shattered into kingdoms. Rivers, mountains and old Roman roads still guided people, but new borders cut through older regions.

Medieval and modern steps. In medieval Iberia, Christian and Muslim powers advanced and retreated for centuries. Frontiers moved with castles, raids and treaties. The land under your feet in modern Portugal was not always inside a neat Portuguese outline. Modern Portugal's borders look calm on a wall map, yet they are the result of long processes: reconquest, royal diplomacy, war and recognition by other states. Natural features can help a border "stick." A high mountain range is hard to cross; a wide river is easy to name in a treaty. Nature alone cannot freeze a border forever. Bridges get built. Armies cross passes. People marry across lines. Trade ignores ink when profit is high enough.

Worked reasoning. Why are borders not permanent? Because borders record human decisions about power, and human decisions change. War redraws. Treaties redraw. Empires collapse. Nations demand new states. Colonies become independent. Even "stable" borders need constant maintenance: passports, customs, maps and agreement. Why it matters: every unit this year that mentions empires, city-states or exploration is also a border story. The bridge to economic geography is simple: once a border exists, it shapes who taxes trade, who needs an import permit and which market you call "home."



Figure 23.3 · Maps on a working desk.

Historical and modern maps side by side show how ink lines move. Notice how comparing maps across centuries turns borders from "facts of nature" into evidence of changing power.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Complete this sentence with evidence from two different centuries: "Borders are not permanent because..."
- 2 Choose one pair to compare on two historical maps: (a) classical Greece and the Roman Empire, or (b) medieval Iberia and modern Portugal. Name one border or region that changed and say why it mattered for power or trade.
- 3 Give one natural feature that can help a border stick (for example a river or mountain range) and one reason nature alone cannot freeze a border forever. Then write one sentence linking borders to trade or taxes.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat a single cause as the whole story. War, treaties, trade, identity and geography can all redraw lines. A river helps a border only if people agree to use it that way. Geography prices choices; people still choose.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

state, nation, border, sovereignty, territory, region

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why are borders not permanent?

On one page, design a three-panel poster: (1) define state, nation and border in pupil-friendly words; (2) show one historical map change with dates; (3) write a six-sentence answer to the enquiry using two pieces of evidence from this unit.

UNIT 23 AT A GLANCE

Political geography

Enquiry. Why are borders not permanent?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

23.1 Country, state, nation and territory

23.2 Borders and regions over time

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** **priced a choice** for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

state

nation

border

sovereignty

territory

region

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 2 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 23 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART SEVEN · UNIT 24

24

Economic geography

How do sectors and networks link places?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define primary, secondary and tertiary sectors and simple trade terms.
- ✓ Compare Roman roads with modern networks.

BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How do sectors and networks link places?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 24.1

Economic sectors

The account

Economies are made of jobs and products. Geographers sort them into **sectors** so you can compare places and times without drowning in detail. Sectors are not moral ranks. They are three big bins that help you see how food, goods and services connect farms to factories to shops, and how empires and modern cities depend on all three. If you only study marble temples, you miss the farmers who fed the builders.



Figure 24.1 · Harbour economy in colour.

Ships, warehouses and waterfront work link primary goods, making and services. Notice how a port city mixes all three sectors in one view.

The **primary sector** takes things from nature: farming, fishing, mining, forestry. A Roman farmer growing grain, a medieval shepherd and a modern olive grower in Portugal all work in the primary sector. Without primary work, there is little food or raw material for anyone else. Empires that looked glamorous in marble still ate bread grown by someone with soil under their nails. The **secondary sector** makes things. It turns raw materials into products: bread from wheat, swords from iron, ships from timber, phones from metals and plastics. Workshops, factories and shipyards sit here. In towns that grew under Rome or in medieval craft streets, secondary work clustered where customers and transport met. A smith needs ore (primary) and then sells a tool to a farmer or soldier. The chain is already linking places. The **tertiary sector** provides **services** rather than a physical object you can stack in a warehouse. Teachers, shopkeepers, sailors who carry cargo

for pay, bankers, doctors and app designers all sit here. As places grow richer and more urban, a larger share of people often work in services. That does not mean primary work vanishes. It may move to other regions or countries while the city fills with offices and shops.

Worked chain (bread). Wheat grown in a field (primary) is milled and baked (secondary) then sold in a shop or cafe (tertiary). Each stage may sit in a different place: rural plain, mill town, city street. **Worked chain (ship).** Timber and pitch from forests and coasts (primary) become a hull in a shipyard (secondary); pilots, merchants and tax officials then run the voyage and the deal (tertiary). Why it matters: sectors let you compare classical Athens, medieval Lisbon and a modern port with the same toolkit. The bridge to trade is obvious. Once you know what a place produces, you can ask what it must import and what it can export.

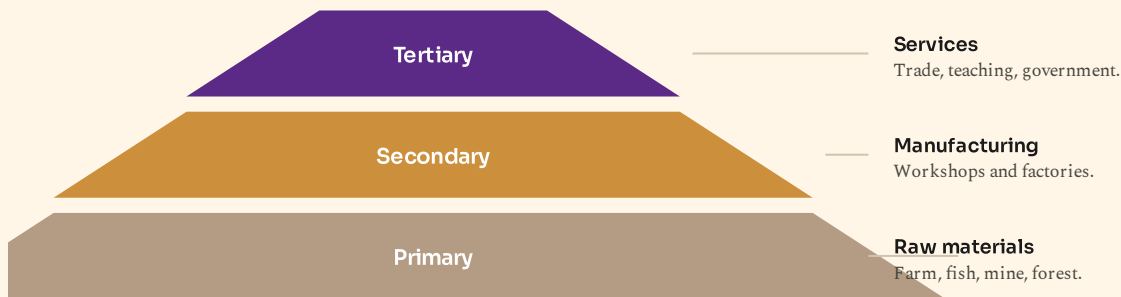


Figure 24.2 · Three economic sectors.

Read from the base upward: primary (raw materials), secondary (making), tertiary (services). Look how each tier depends on the one below it. The figure teaches that cities full of services still rest on farms, mines and workshops somewhere on the network.

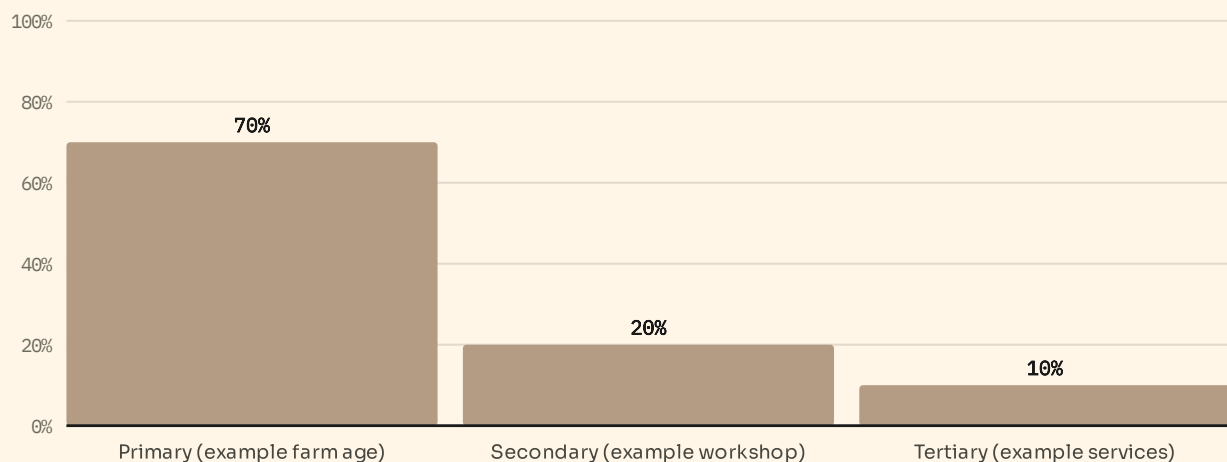


Figure 24.3 · Example sector mix in a farm-heavy age.

These bars are teaching examples, not a real census: they show how primary work can dominate before industry and services grow. Read the heights as "share of activity", then invent a modern city bar that would look very different.



LOOK FURTHER

Our World in Data, **economic growth**. Long patterns of production and trade.

ourworldindata.org/economic-growth

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Write a one-line definition of primary, secondary and tertiary. Do not copy the textbook wording word for word.
- 2 Sort these jobs into the three sectors: fisher, baker, nurse, iron miner, shipbuilder, online delivery driver, vineyard worker, temple or church builder. Then add one modern job of your own to each sector.
- 3 Follow one everyday item (bread, a cotton T-shirt or a mobile phone) through all three sectors. Name at least one place each stage might happen, and underline the stage that creates most of the final price if you can make a reasoned guess.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat sectors as a moral ladder. Primary work is not "simple" or less important. Cities starve without it. A skyline of offices still eats primary food from somewhere.

TOPIC 24.2

Imports, exports and markets

The account

Places rarely have everything they want. **Trade** is how they fill the gap. Economic geography starts from a blunt fact: climate, soil, ores and skills are uneven. One coast has fish; another has good clay for pots; a third has silver in the hills. Trade turns unevenness into connection, and connection into power for those who sit on the best routes. An **import** is a good or service that comes into a place from outside. An **export** is one that goes out. Ancient Athens imported grain and exported olive oil, pottery and silver at different times. Medieval Lisbon sat where Atlantic and Mediterranean goods could meet. Today Portugal might export cork, wine or tourism services and import oil, cars or electronics. The labels "import" and "export" depend on which place you are standing in. Grain leaving Egypt for Rome was Egypt's export and Rome's import. Same ship, two labels.

A **market** is where buyers and sellers meet, in person or through long chains of middlemen. A market is not only a square with stalls. It is any system that sets prices and moves information: who needs grain, who has spare cloth, what a cargo is worth this week. Prices rise when demand is high and supply is short. Prices fall when goods pile up. Power can twist that simple story. A strong navy can force cheaper terms. A toll on a bridge can make a short journey expensive. Enslaved labour can make some cargoes profitable for owners while destroying freedom for others. Trade is connection, not automatic fairness.

Two examples. (1) Mediterranean grain fleets fed imperial Rome: Egypt's fields and Rome's mouths were linked by sea lanes and political control. (2) A modern supermarket shelf holds coffee, phones and fruit from many climates; the market is global even if the checkout is local. **Worked reasoning.** A coastal city exports salt and imports grain. Locally the primary sector may be strong in salt production, but the city depends on other places for bread. Specialisation brings wealth when trade is open, and risk when war or storm cuts the route. Why it matters: imports and exports turn borders (Unit 23) into economic facts. The bridge to transport is physical: goods do not teleport. Networks move them.



Figure 24.4 • Market exchange.

Buyers and sellers meet in person long before online shops. Notice how stalls and crowds turn surplus from one place into choice for another.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define import and export using Portugal as the place you stand in. Give one real or realistic example of each.
- 2 Name two markets from this year's history (for example a Mediterranean port, a Silk Road oasis, a medieval fair) and say what linked them to somewhere else.
- 3 A coastal city exports salt and imports grain. Which sector is strongest locally for the export, and what risk does that specialisation create? Write four sentences.

◆ CAREFUL

Trade is not automatically fair. Power decides who sets prices, who pays tolls and who is forced to sell cheap. Do not write "trade makes everyone richer" without asking who gains and who loses.

TOPIC 24.3

Transport networks then and now

The account

A **network** is a set of linked routes and nodes (towns, ports, junctions). Whoever designs, repairs and guards a network can tax it, speed their own army and starve a rival of supplies. Sectors tell you what people make. Networks tell you how those things move and who sits on the path. Without networks, primary, secondary and tertiary work stay local and limited.

Roman roads are the classic ancient example. Stone surfaces, milestones and bridges moved legions, officials, messages and goods. The road did not only help travellers. It helped Rome hold a large empire together. Sea lanes across the Mediterranean were just as important: bulk grain moved more cheaply by ship than by cart. Roads and sea routes formed one system, not two separate worlds. A port was a node where land and sea networks shook hands. Medieval Europe reused pieces of that system and added others: river traffic, pack-animal tracks, pilgrimage roads and later improved bridges. Speed was slower than Rome's best military marches in many places, but connection never vanished. Crusading routes, Italian merchant fleets and Atlantic edges all show networks shaping who got rich. A fair town on a river could become wealthier than a fertile but isolated valley.

Then and now. Compare three moments. (1) Roman road or sea lane: relatively fast for its time, guarded by imperial power, carrying grain, troops and tax information. (2) Medieval route: mixed quality, strong at fairs and river ports, slower overall, still vital for cloth, salt and pilgrimage. (3) Modern rail, highway, container ship or air freight: high speed and huge scale for those connected to hubs; places off the network can lag. The pattern is old: connection rewards hubs. The pace is new. **Worked reasoning.** Why did Rome invest in roads? Because an empire is not only conquered once; it must be held. A legion that arrives in time, a tax order that travels, and a merchant who trusts a route all strengthen the centre. Why it matters for the year question: states and empires develop partly by building networks that turn territory into a working system. The bridge to cities is clear: hubs on networks become urban magnets.



Figure 24.5 • Roman road as network technology.

Stone routes linked nodes across an empire. Notice straight alignments and durable surface: design that served army and trade together.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 What is a transport network? Use the words *route* and *node* in your answer, then name one ancient node and one modern node.
- 2 Give one way Roman roads served the army and one way they served traders. Add one sentence on how the same road could do both on the same day.
- 3 Complete a three-row table: *Roman road or sea lane* / *medieval route* / *modern rail, highway or container ship*. For each row, state speed (slow/medium/fast for its time) and one cargo that would travel on it. Then write two sentences answering: how do networks link sectors across places?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not study roads as pretty lines only. Ask who built them, who paid, who was protected and who was forced to move along them. A network is a power tool as well as a travel aid.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

primary, secondary, tertiary, export, import, market, network

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How do sectors and networks link places?

Draw a one-page diagram that starts with a primary product, passes through secondary and tertiary stages, and rides at least two transport links between named places (one ancient or medieval, one modern). Write five sentences underneath answering the enquiry.

UNIT 24 AT A GLANCE

Economic geography

Enquiry. How do sectors and networks link places?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 24.1 Economic sectors
- 24.2 Imports, exports and markets
- 24.3 Transport networks then and now

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** **priced a choice** for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

- primary
- secondary
- tertiary
- export
- import
- market
- network

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 3 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 24 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART SEVEN · UNIT 25

25

Cities and urbanisation

Why do cities grow in some places and not others?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Use location → function → growth with Athens, Rome, Constantinople and Lisbon.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Why do cities grow in some places and not others?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 25.1

Location, function and growth

The account

A city is not a random pile of buildings. It grows where geography and human choice meet. If cities appeared only by luck, every empty plain would eventually fill with towers. They do not. Some places keep attracting people for centuries; others stay villages. This topic gives you a chain that stops the answer "because they are big" from going round in a circle. **Urbanisation** means a rising share of people living in towns and cities, and the spread of urban ways of life. You can study one city's growth or a whole region's shift from countryside to urban.



Figure 25.1 • A city that grew at a gateway.

Urban sites cluster where rivers meet the sea. Notice density, waterfront and hills: location still shapes city form.

Location means where something is. Geographers often split this into **site** (the exact ground: hill, river bend, harbour) and **situation** (how that place links to a wider region: roads, coasts, borders, other towns). A hilltop is a strong site for defence. A river mouth may be a strong situation for trade even if the ground is marshy. Site answers "what is under my feet?" Situation answers "who can I reach from here?" Both matter. A beautiful hill with no roads may stay a fortress, not a market capital. **Function** means what the city mainly does for people. Common functions in this year's story include market town, port, capital, fortress, holy

place and craft centre. Many cities wear more than one hat. A capital that is also a port has two engines of growth. A holy city can attract pilgrims even when its farmland is thin. Function can change over time: a fortress may become a tourist centre; a fishing village may become a container port.

Growth follows when function attracts people, food, money and ideas. Workers need homes. Homes need markets. Markets need roads or quays. Schools, temples, barracks and warehouses follow. Growth is not automatic forever. Silting harbours, lost trade routes, plague, conquest or a new rival hub can shrink a city. **Steps to analyse any city.** (1) Describe the site. (2) Describe the situation. (3) Name the main functions in a given century. (4) Explain what pulled people in. (5) Note any limit or risk (defence, water, food supply, politics). **Worked mini-example.** A river-crossing village sits on firm ground (site) where two valleys meet (situation). It becomes a market and later a fortress. Traders and soldiers attract bakers and smiths. Growth follows function, which followed location.

Why it matters: every capital and port you met this year obeys some version of this chain. The bridge to case studies is application: Athens, Rome, Constantinople and Lisbon each answer location and function differently, yet all show place offering possibilities and people choosing what to build.



Figure 25.2 · Location to growth.

Read left to right: location, function, people, growth. For one step, write a sticky-note example from a city you know or from Lisbon.



LOOK FURTHER

UNESCO World Heritage List. Cities and sites chosen for outstanding value; compare locations.

whc.unesco.org/en/list/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define site and situation in one sentence each. Give a made-up or real example of each.
- 2 List four city functions from this topic. Circle the one that best fits a modern capital you know, and write one sentence explaining why.
- 3 Write the chain **location** → **function** → **growth** as a short story about a port town (four to six sentences). Include one risk that could reverse growth.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat a single cause as the whole story. A great harbour without peace, food supply or trade laws may stay small. Geography prices choices; people still choose. "The city is big because it is important" is a circle, not an explanation.

TOPIC 25.2

Athens, Rome, Constantinople and Lisbon

The account

Four cities, many centuries of power, one shared logic. Use them as case studies, not as slogans. Each answers location and function differently, yet all show the same chain: place offers possibilities; people choose functions; growth or decline follows. Always name the century you mean, because capitals move and harbours silt.

Athens sat near the sea with a defensible high point (the Acropolis) and access to harbours such as Piraeus. Its situation in the Greek world of islands and coasts favoured navy, trade and cultural pull. Function mixed politics, religion, craft and empire. Growth came in waves: classical glory, later decline, later revival. Geography enabled a maritime city-state; people built the democracy, temples and fleets. Without the sea, Athens would have been another hill town. Without people and politics, the sea alone would not have invented philosophy.

Rome began on hills by the Tiber in central Italy. The site offered river water, fording points and defence. The situation later became the hub of a peninsula and then of a Mediterranean empire. Functions stacked: kingdom capital, republican centre, imperial capital. Roads and aqueducts locked growth into stone. Rome shows how situation can expand when power builds networks outward from a strong site. The city did not stay "only seven hills." It became the head of a system that pulled grain, taxes and talent toward the centre. When western imperial power failed, the city changed function and scale, proving that growth is not a one-way street.

Constantinople (later Istanbul) sat on the Bosphorus, the strait between Europe and Asia and between the Black Sea and the Mediterranean world. That site-situation mix is almost a textbook definition of a gateway. Function: imperial capital of the eastern Roman (Byzantine) world, fortress, trade hinge and sacred centre. Control of the strait meant control of ships, tolls and messages. Walls and water protected the core. For centuries the city showed how a choke point can fund a capital. When political control shifted, the urban site remained valuable because the geography did not move.

Lisbon grew on hills above the Tagus estuary, where a great river meets the Atlantic. Site: defensible heights and a deep harbour approach. Situation: western Iberian edge facing ocean routes, with river access inland. Functions layered over time: Roman and medieval port, royal capital, and later a command centre for Atlantic exploration and empire. The Age of Exploration magnified Lisbon's situation, but the harbour and river logic were older. Saying Lisbon grew "only because of da Gama" skips the long location story.

Compare and reason. Which depended most on a harbour or strait? Athens and Lisbon lean on harbours; Constantinople on a strait; Rome on river plus road hub that later ruled seas. Why it matters: comparison trains you to transfer the location → function → growth chain instead of memorising four isolated stories. The bridge to development units is inequality inside cities: grandeur and poverty can share the same skyline.

	Location (site)	Function (job of the place)
Athens	Near sea, Attica hills	Navy, trade, culture
Rome	Tiber hills	Capital of empire
Constantinople	Bosphorus strait	Bridge of continents
Lisbon	Tagus estuary	Atlantic harbour capital

Figure 25.3 • Four cities: location and function.

Read each row: Athens, Rome, Constantinople, Lisbon. Match site (where) with function (job of the place). The figure teaches that different sites can power different city roles, yet all four need a clear link between place and purpose.



Figure 25.4 • Monument and urban power.

Grand buildings mark capitals that pulled people and taxes. Notice how stone claims permanence even when political power later moves.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Copy a four-row table: Athens, Rome, Constantinople, Lisbon. Fill columns for *site*, *main function*, *one reason for growth*.
- 2 Which of the four depended most on a harbour or strait? Explain in three sentences with named evidence.
- 3 "Lisbon grew only because of the Age of Exploration." Use earlier Roman or medieval points to challenge or support that sentence in five to six lines, then finish with your own balanced judgement.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not turn each city into a single slogan. Capitals change, harbours silt, and rivals rise. Always check the century you are talking about before you claim "this city was always..."

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

site, situation, function, urbanisation, capital

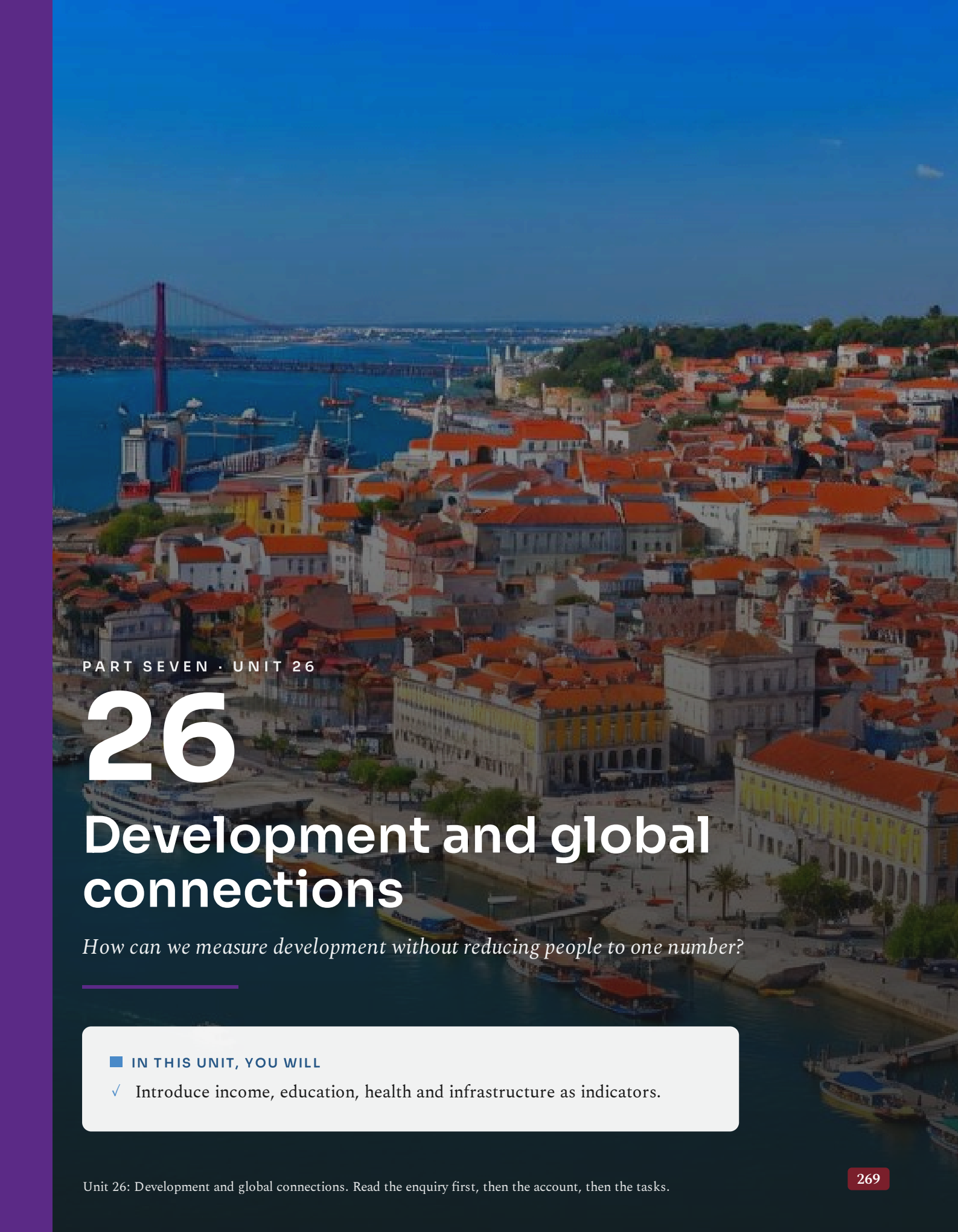
■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

Why do cities grow in some places and not others?

Make a one-page enquiry poster with a labelled sketch map of one city from this unit, a clear **location** → **function** → **growth** flowchart, and a short paragraph that answers the enquiry using two cities as evidence.



PART SEVEN · UNIT 26

26

Development and global connections

How can we measure development without reducing people to one number?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Introduce income, education, health and infrastructure as indicators.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **How can we measure development without reducing people to one number?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 26.1

What development means

The account

Development is a word adults use as if everyone agreed what it means. In this unit it means improvement in how people can live, stay healthy, learn and choose their futures. It is not only "more money in the national piggy bank." Money matters, but money alone can hide hunger next door to luxury. A useful definition stays human: safer births, longer healthy lives, food security, schooling, rights and a real chance to shape your own path.



Figure 26.1 · Wealth and place side by side.

Development shows unevenly across coasts and interiors. Notice how a rich harbour city can sit near poorer hinterlands on the same map.

Average income can rise while many families stay poor. A city can look modern while villages lack clean water. An empire can be rich in marble and still leave most farmers with short, hard lives. So development has to stay human. When a graph goes up, ask "for whom?" When a skyline grows, ask "who builds it and who can afford to live there?" History already showed you uneven lives. In Athens, male citizens and enslaved people did not share the same freedoms. In medieval Europe, a merchant's child and a serf's child faced different horizons. Roman roads and aqueducts were brilliant **infrastructure** (basic systems such as

roads, water, ports and later electricity), yet they served imperial power first. Development talk that only praises monuments misses who was left outside the walls. A golden dome does not feed a village without a well.

Keep two ideas together. First, places can become better for more people over time: longer lives, more literacy, safer births, wider rights. Vaccines, cleaner water and more girls in school are real gains when they happen. Second, gains are uneven across space and groups. Coastal capitals may pull ahead of interior regions. Men and women, citizens and outsiders, rich and poor may not share the same progress. **Worked contrast.** Empire A builds temples and triumphal arches while farmers face heavy taxes and short life expectancy. Tourists later call the ruins "advanced." A fairer development view asks about food, health and freedom as well as stone. Why it matters: without a careful definition you will rank whole cultures as "advanced" or "backward," which is bad geography and worse history. The bridge to indicators is measurement: if development is multi-sided, you need more than one clue on the dashboard.

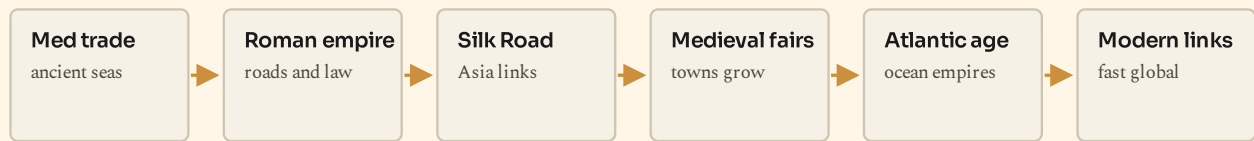


Figure 26.2 · Long chain of connections.

Follow the six stages from Mediterranean trade to modern links. Look how each age reuses routes and power, only faster. The figure teaches that development and connection are old human patterns, not inventions of the last ten years.

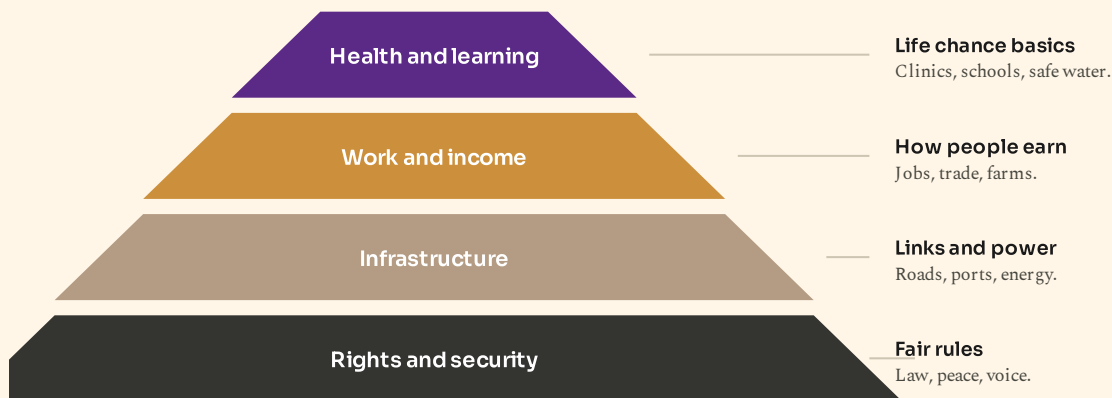


Figure 26.3 · A development ladder for pupils.

Read from the base: rights and security, then infrastructure, work and income, then health and learning. Development is multi-layered: money alone at the top does not fix a missing clinic or unsafe road.



LOOK FURTHER

UN Human Development Reports. Income is not the only measure of development.

hdr.undp.org/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Write your own definition of development in no more than twenty-five words. Avoid the word "money" as your only idea.
- 2 Give one historical example from this year where grand buildings hid unequal lives. Name the place and the inequality.
- 3 A country doubles its average income. List three questions you would still ask before calling it "more developed," then star the question you think matters most and explain why in two sentences.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not rank whole cultures as "advanced" or "backward." Measure living conditions and freedoms with care, and remember values differ. Stick to evidence, not insults. Monuments are not a full development score.

TOPIC 26.2

Indicators and connections

The account

An **indicator** is a measurable clue. It is not the whole truth. Think of a school report: one test score helps, but it does not describe the whole pupil. One football score does not describe a whole season. Development needs a small dashboard of clues, not a single dial that pretends to rank human worth. Useful development indicators include **income** (what people earn or what an economy produces per person), **education** (years in school, literacy), **health** (life expectancy, child survival) and **infrastructure** (roads, clean water, electricity, ports, internet). Together they sketch a picture. Alone, each can mislead.

Strengths and weaknesses (worked). High average income can hide a deep gap between rich and poor: a billionaire and ten struggling families can produce a flattering average. Long schooling means little if classrooms have no teachers or books. Fine motorways matter less if villages still lack clinics. Life expectancy can rise while some groups still die young from preventable causes. So good enquiry uses several indicators and always asks about inequality inside the average.

Steps for a fair comparison of two places. (1) Choose at least four indicators across income, education, health and infrastructure. (2) Check the date of the data. (3) Look for gaps inside each place (city versus rural, different groups). (4) Add one historical connection that shaped today's pattern (trade route, empire, war, investment). (5) Write a balanced judgement, not a single number trophy. **Example dashboard idea:** average income, literacy rate, life expectancy, access to clean water, and quality of transport links. Five dials beat one.

Connections through trade and technology can help or harm depending on power. Mediterranean trade brought grain and ideas; it also moved armies and enslaved people. The Silk Road carried silk and stories; it also carried disease. Portuguese oceanic routes linked continents and created wealth for some while imposing costs on others. Modern container ships and fibre-optic cables continue the same double pattern at higher speed: jobs and goods for some, pressure and dependence for others. Why it matters: the unit enquiry is not anti-measurement. It is anti-laziness. Measure carefully, connect historically, and refuse to shrink people to one score. The bridge to globalisation is scale: indicators and connections now operate on a planet-wide network that still rests on older routes and hubs.



Figure 26.4 • Coastal wealth and wider links.

Harbours concentrate trade and services. Notice how development indicators may look strong at the waterfront while inland areas tell a different story.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Name four indicators from this topic. For each, write one strength and one weakness as a measure.
- 2 Design a "dashboard" of five indicators you would use to compare two places fairly. Explain one choice in two sentences, and say which indicator you would never trust alone.
- 3 Give one historical connection (trade route or empire link) that improved some lives and harmed others. Then write two sentences on how a modern global link can show the same double pattern.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat a single cause or a single number as the whole story. Connection, resources, government, history and luck all shape outcomes. An average can hide a gap large enough to make the "story" false for half the population.

— WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

development, indicator, infrastructure, income, life expectancy

■ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

■ THE ENQUIRY

How can we measure development without reducing people to one number?

Create a one-page dashboard poster: title, five indicators with icons, a warning box about averages, and a short paragraph that answers the enquiry using one historical and one modern link.

UNIT 26 AT A GLANCE

Development and global connections

Enquiry. How can we measure development without reducing people to one number?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

26.1 What development means

26.2 Indicators and connections

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** priced a choice for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

development

indicator

infrastructure

income

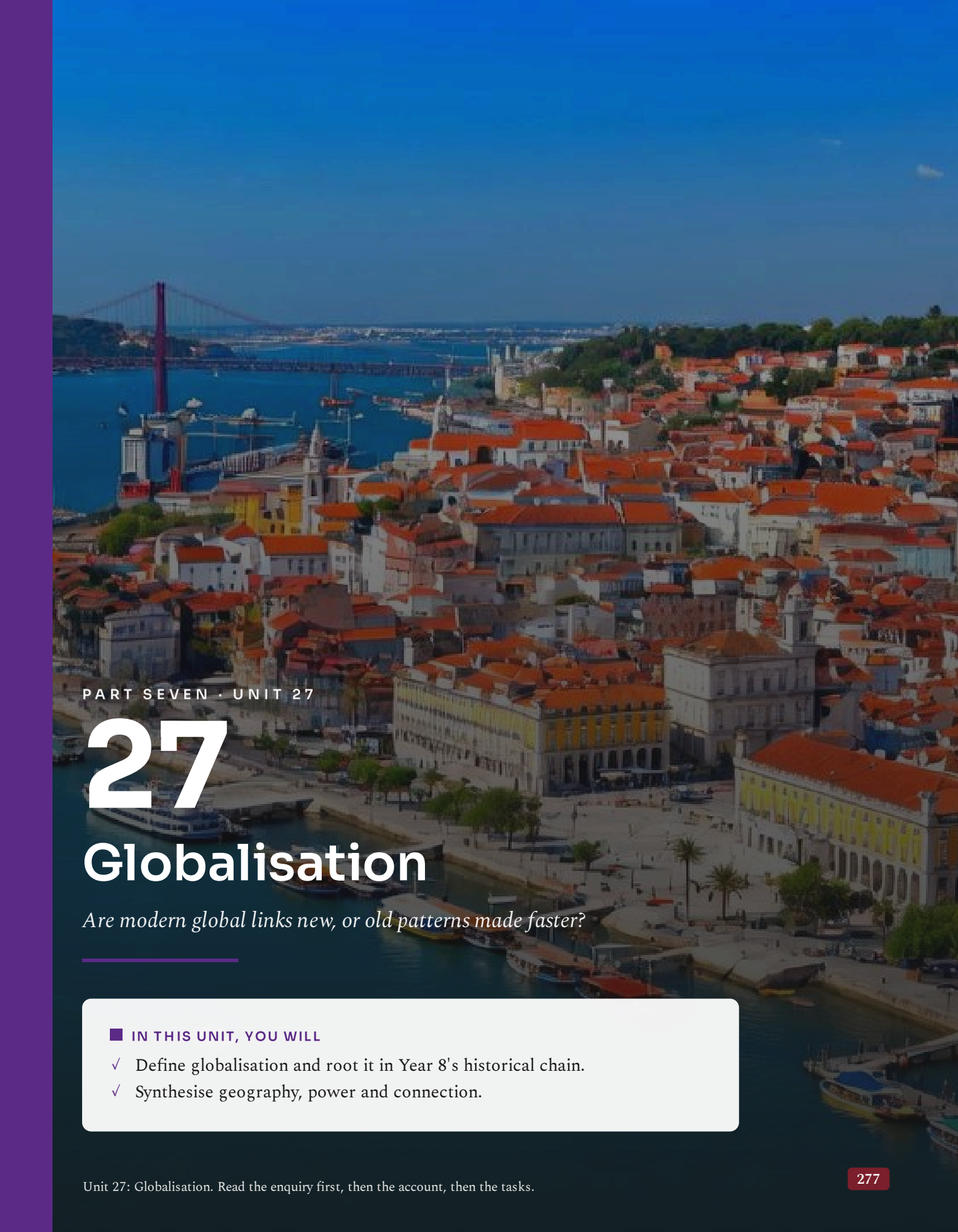
life expectancy

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 2 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 26 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?



PART SEVEN · UNIT 27

27

Globalisation

Are modern global links new, or old patterns made faster?

■ IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Define globalisation and root it in Year 8's historical chain.
- ✓ Synthesise geography, power and connection.

● BEFORE YOU READ

In one sentence, write your first answer to this enquiry: **Are modern global links new, or old patterns made faster?** You will improve it at the end of the unit with evidence.

TOPIC 27.1

What globalisation means

The account

Globalisation means the thickening of links between distant places through trade, migration, transport, communication, money and technology. Goods, people, ideas, fashion, diseases and news move further and more often. The world feels smaller, even though it is the same size on the globe. That feeling is real in your pocket: a phone can show a match in another continent while you wait for a bus. Globalisation is not only shopping, and it is not only the internet. Law, language, music, belief and power travel with cargo.



Figure 27.1 · Atlantic door to a connected world.

Global links old and new pass through harbour cities. Notice how one skyline can stand for local life and long-distance networks at once.

That does not mean everything is new. What is modern is mainly **speed** and **scale**. A message that once needed a ship can now cross oceans in a second. A container can move factory parts through three continents before you finish a school term. Phones and the internet are to our age what sea lanes and caravan tracks were to earlier ages: tools that shrink distance for those who can use them. The pattern (distant places feeding one market) is old. The pace is new. Compare shopping then and now. A medieval fair gathered cloth, spices and stories from far routes, but slowly and for fewer buyers. Today a high-street or online basket can hold Brazilian coffee, Asian electronics and European design in one click. The

merchant's problem is still the same: surplus here, shortage there, a route in between, and someone who takes a cut. What changed is how many steps fit into a day and how many people can join the market without leaving home.

Globalisation is also uneven. Some cities are hubs; some regions are edges. Some workers gain jobs; others lose them when factories move. Some languages spread; others shrink under pressure. **Worked comparison.** "Phones are the new sea trade." The comparison helps because both shrink distance and move value and news. It fails when we forget that ships moved bulk grain and armies, while phones move data and voice more than wheat. Different tools, similar network logic. Why it matters: if you think globalisation began last Tuesday, you will misread every unit this year. If you think nothing is new, you will miss how speed changes power. The bridge is the long chain: Mediterranean to modern, with Portugal as one Atlantic hinge.

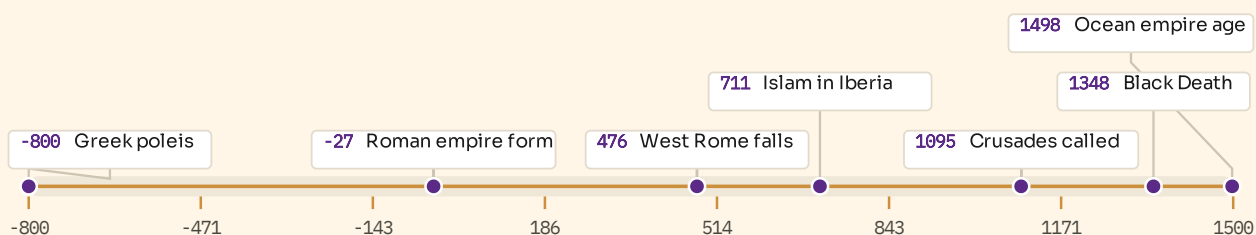


Figure 27.2 · Year timeline: states, empires, shocks.

Read left to right from Greek poleis to ocean empire. Pause at each date and name a place. The figure teaches that this year's story is a sequence of real places and decisions, not a pile of disconnected facts.



LOOK FURTHER

World Economic Forum stories. Modern global connections; preview bias with a teacher.

www.weforum.org/stories/

Extension only, and not a substitute for the pages. Ask your teacher before you scan.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Define globalisation in two sentences without using the word "global." Include trade and at least one of: migration, communication or power.
- 2 List five things that move between countries today. Mark which also moved in the ancient or medieval world, and star one that is mostly modern.
- 3 "Phones are the new sea trade." Explain one way this comparison helps and one way it fails. Then write one sentence on who might be left out of fast modern links.

◆ CAREFUL

Do not treat globalisation as only shopping or only the internet. Migration, law, language and power travel with cargo. Uneven hubs and edges mean "the world is connected" is not the same as "everyone benefits equally."

TOPIC 27.2

From Mediterranean trade to modern links

The account

Trace one long chain across your Year 8 map. This is not a fairy tale of smooth progress. It is a sequence of networks that reuses geography and rewrites power. Start with **Mediterranean exchange**. Greeks, Phoenicians and others moved wine, oil, metals and ideas across a shared sea. Geography made the basin a highway: many coasts, many harbours, one connecting water. City-states and colonies sat on that highway like shops on a ring road. **Rome** then wrapped much of that sea in imperial roads, law and grain fleets. Connection served power. Pax Romana was peace for some and control for many. Bulk grain from Egypt fed the capital. Roads moved soldiers as reliably as merchants. The Mediterranean became one political and economic system under a single centre for long stretches of time.

Eastward, the **Silk Road** network linked China, Central Asia, the Middle East and Europe. It was never one road. It was a web of oasis towns, mountain passes and desert stages. Religions and technologies rode with the silk. Disease could ride too. Connection is never only goods. **Medieval commerce** rebuilt and redirected links after western Rome's political break-up: Italian merchant fleets, river fairs, pilgrimage roads and Islamic trade worlds across North Africa and into Iberia. Towns grew where routes crossed. Surplus and skill still sought markets, even when empires changed name. **Maritime exploration** then opened Atlantic and Indian Ocean systems under Iberian leadership and later rivals. Portugal's step-by-step African advance, the Cape hinge, and routes to India and Brazil plugged European demand into ocean-scale networks. Forts, fleets and forced labour show that wider maps can mean sharper inequality.

Modern links reuse many of the same geography ideas at higher speed: hubs at straits and harbours, bulk goods by sea, messages by cable and satellite, money moving faster than ships. Container ports, air freight and the internet are new tools on old problems: how to move value, people and ideas between places with different resources. **Worked reasoning**. Name one geographical feature that mattered in at least three stages. The Mediterranean Sea itself, or a strait such as the Bosphorus, or later the Cape of Good Hope, each priced routes across ages. Why it matters: the unit enquiry answers itself with evidence if you can walk the chain without skipping the violence and the gains. The bridge to synthesis is the three-strand braid: geography, power and connection.

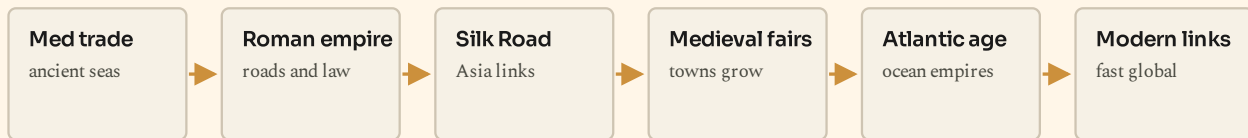


Figure 27.3 · Long chain of connections.

Follow six stages from Mediterranean trade to modern links. For two stages, write who gained and who paid a cost.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Draw a six-box timeline: Mediterranean trade → Rome → Silk Road → medieval commerce → maritime exploration → modern links. Add one place-name in each box.
- 2 Name one geographical feature that mattered in at least three of those stages (for example a sea, strait or cape). Explain in three sentences.
- 3 Which stage first made Portugal a hinge between worlds? Use one fact from earlier units and one geographical reason (Atlantic coast, Tagus, Cape or islands).

◆ CAREFUL

Do not draw a straight line of "progress" that ignores violence, slavery and unequal gain along these routes. Connection and justice are not the same thing. Speed can spread harm as well as help.

TOPIC 27.3

Year synthesis: geography, power and connection

The account

This year asked one big question: **How do states, empires and networks develop?** You now have a full toolkit to answer it in simple, strong language. Do not try to remember every date first. Remember three strands that always braid together: geography, power and connection. Then put them back onto real ground. History happens somewhere.

Geography is the stage. Mountains split Greek city-states. The Tiber and Italian position lifted Rome. The Bosphorus crowned Constantinople. The Tagus and Atlantic winds pulled Portugal seaward. Deserts, seas and passes priced every choice on the Silk Road and every crusading march. Climate shaped crops; coasts shaped fleets; straits shaped taxes. Maps were never decoration. They were the first clue. If you forget the place, you forget half the cause.

Power is how people organise force, law, taxes and belief. A **state** claims **sovereignty** inside borders. An **empire** stacks many peoples under one centre. Armies, roads, castles, navies and bureaucracies turn claims into facts on the ground, until they fail. Borders move because power moves. **Nations** (shared identity) and states (organised rule) do not always match, and that tension fills history books. Feudal ties, imperial provinces and exploration charters are all power designs written onto geography.

Connection is the movement of goods, people, ideas, money and disease between places. Mediterranean lanes, Roman roads, Silk Road stages, medieval fairs, caravels and modern cables are different tools for related jobs. Connection funds power and spreads culture; it also spreads plague and exploitation. Sectors and cities grow where networks meet. Development indicators rise or stall partly because of how places plug into those networks.

How to write a synthesis answer (steps). (1) State the year idea in one line: states, empires and networks develop where geography, power and connection interact. (2) Choose two or three concrete places from different parts of the book. (3) For each place, name one geographic fact, one power fact and one connection fact. (4) Compare: what is similar, what changed in speed or scale. (5) Close with a judgement, not a list. **Mini worked example.** Lisbon: Tagus-Atlantic site; royal and later imperial power; ocean routes linking Africa, Asia and Brazil. Athens: coastal Attica; polis institutions; Aegean and wider Mediterranean exchange. Same three strands, different outcomes and centuries.

Why it matters: synthesis is the skill that turns a year of units into one coherent story instead of a pile of facts. Your final bridge is outward: the same three strands still shape the news, the phone in your bag and the food on your plate. Use them.

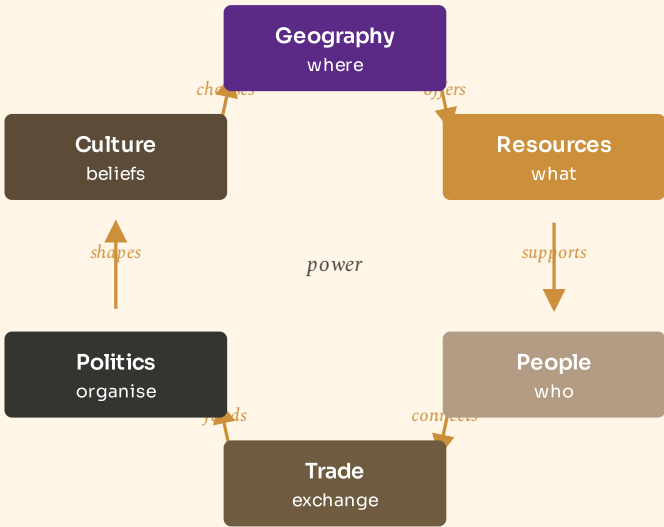


Figure 27.4 • Year synthesis cycle.
Geography, resources, people, trade, politics and culture turn around power in the centre. Trace two arrows and explain in your own words how one feeds the next.

	Medieval / early modern link	Modern global link
Speed	Months by ship or caravan.	Hours by plane; seconds online.
Goods	Silk, spices, grain, wool.	Electronics, oil, food, finance.
Risk	Piracy, storm, plague.	Markets, climate, conflict.
Power	Who holds ports and routes.	Who sets rules and tech.

Figure 27.5 • Then and now: global links.
Compare speed, goods, risk and power across the rows. Medieval and early modern links were real; modern ones are faster and denser. The skill is naming what changed and what still depends on routes and rules.



Figure 27.6 • Power chain for the whole year.

Place → surplus → organisation → networks → change. Use this flow to plan any enquiry answer: start with site and routes, end with who gained or lost.



Figure 27.7 • Maps as memory of the year.

Desk maps pull places into one view. Notice how comparing regions turns separate units into one story of power and connection.

■ YOUR TURN

- 1 Complete three sentences starting: "Geography mattered when..."; "Power mattered when..."; "Connection mattered when..." Use different units for each.
- 2 Choose one place studied this year (Athens, Rome, Constantinople, Jerusalem, Lisbon or another). In ten sentences, explain how geography, power and connection shaped it. Underline one sentence that could open an essay.
- 3 Design a revision poster titled **History happens somewhere** with four labelled examples from four different parts of the book. Add a five-sentence box that answers: are modern global links new, or old patterns made faster?

◆ CAREFUL

Do not dump dates without places, or places without power. A synthesis that lists facts but never braids

geography, power and connection is only a timeline in disguise. Always ground big words in a real map.

WORDS FOR THIS UNIT

globalisation, network, synthesis, state, empire

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.
- State the year idea in one line: history happens somewhere.

THE ENQUIRY

Are modern global links new, or old patterns made faster?

Plan a one-page enquiry poster for this chapter's main question. Include a six-stage chain from Mediterranean trade to today, one modern comparison (phones or internet versus sea trade), and a closing box with the sentence **History happens somewhere** explained in your own words.

Answers

Check your own work here after you have attempted it. Closed questions have short model answers. Open questions give acceptance criteria: what a good answer must contain, not the only words that can score. Portugal panels need a named person or place, a clear geography link, and a link to the wider story. Reading these first costs you the only thing they are useful for: finding the gap while you still remember what you were thinking.

Unit 1 • Maps and geographical skills

TOPIC 1.1 • TYPES OF MAPS

- 1 Any two with a matching question, for example: physical map (Where are the mountains and rivers?); political map (Who ruled this border in 1200?); topographic map (How steep is this castle site?); thematic map (Where did).
- 2 A physical or topographic map (or a map showing the river mouth and coast): you need the shape of the land and water, not only borders, to explain why ships used the site.
- 3 Map-makers choose what to show and what to leave out, so the same place can look different on two maps; a map is selected evidence, not a perfect photograph of the whole world.

TOPIC 1.2 • COMPASS DIRECTIONS

- 1 North, south, east, west; one intermediate such as north-east, south-east, south-west or north-west.
- 2 Accept precise answers such as south or south-east from Athens across the Mediterranean toward Egypt (Egypt lies roughly south-east of Athens by sea).
- 3 Vague pointing cannot be tested on a map; a precise direction plus a feature (pass, coast, river) is evidence that links a decision to a real line of travel.

TOPIC 1.3 • SCALE

- 1 50 km (2.5×20 km).
- 2 Wall maps shrink huge distances; without scale a centimetre can hide days of walking, mountains, or costly bulk transport that made "nearby" cities expensive to link by land.
- 3 Scale restores time and cost: an empire that looks small on paper may still have taken months to cross, so size on a wall map is not the same as power or ease of control.

TOPIC 1.4 • LATITUDE AND LONGITUDE

- 1 Latitude: how far north or south a place is from the Equator. Longitude: how far east or west a place is from the Prime Meridian (Greenwich).
- 2 Examples: Lisbon more Atlantic; Athens and Constantinople more eastern Mediterranean; Rome Mediterranean central; Jerusalem eastern Mediterranean/Near East. Accept any three Year 8 places with a rough Atlantic versus eastern Mediterranean contrast.
- 3 Hemispheres are regions defined by the Equator and Prime Meridian (north/south, east/west), not vague labels for cultures or "ways of life".

TOPIC 1.5 • TOPOGRAPHIC MAPS

- 1 Close contours mean a steep slope; wide contours mean a gentle slope.
- 2 Attackers must climb while defenders look down; height aids watch and defence.

- 3 A pass is a natural gap through mountains: traders and invaders both use it as a corridor, so controlling a pass means taxing or blocking movement.

TOPIC 1.6 · SATELLITE IMAGES AND GIS

- 1 Geographic Information Systems; a layer is one kind of information stacked on a base map (for example roads, rivers, population or elevation) that can be switched on or off.
- 2 Advantage: shows rivers, coasts, fields and cities as they look today. Not enough alone: without labels or historical layers you may not know past harbours, borders or who ruled a bright modern city.
- 3 Both are choices about what to show for a question: selecting layers is like choosing physical, political or thematic content to match the enquiry.

Unit 2 · Landforms and human settlement

TOPIC 2.1 · MOUNTAINS

- 1 Advantages: defence, border markers, water storage (snow/ice), minerals. Difficulties: hard travel, little flat farmland, isolation, slow news and trade. Accept any two of each.
- 2 Ranges cut valleys apart so communities could keep their own laws, markets and defence rather than melting into one kingdom.
- 3 Height blocks invaders but also blocks friendly traders and messengers; protection and isolation are the same barrier from two sides.

TOPIC 2.2 · RIVERS

- 1 Water supply, fertile silt/floodplain farming, fish/food, transport, trade, and often a defensive or tax point at a bridge or mouth. Accept any four.
- 2 Barges and ships carry bulk grain and stone more cheaply than carts over land tracks; water reduces cost per load.
- 3 Bridges and river mouths control movement and tax trade: who holds them can block armies or charge for passage.

TOPIC 2.3 · PLAINS

- 1 Flat fertile land suits large-scale farming; open ground lets armies and carts move quickly.
- 2 It strengthens a state with food and fast movement, but offers fewer natural defences so invaders can advance more easily.
- 3 Everyday comparison: walking a flat riverside path is faster and less tiring than climbing a steep street with a heavy bag (or similar).

TOPIC 2.4 · ISLANDS

- 1 Sea surrounds the land, so fishing, harbours, fleets and sea trade matter more than inland roads.
- 2 Ships connect the island to many coasts, but enemies can also blockade harbours and cut food or trade.
- 3 Crete sat on Mediterranean sea lanes, encouraging Minoan maritime links, palace trade and sea skill.

TOPIC 2.5 · PENINSULAS

- 1 Land almost surrounded by water but still joined to a larger landmass by a neck of territory.
- 2 Greek, Italian and Iberian (Spain and Portugal); shared advantage: long coasts for maritime trade and naval habits (accept similar).
- 3 Land frontiers need armies; surrounding seas invite trade and naval threats, so both forces matter.

TOPIC 2.6 · STRATEGIC GEOGRAPHY

- 1 A place whose position multiplies power (port, pass, river crossing, strait, river mouth). Examples: a mountain pass, the Bosphorus, Lisbon's river mouth, a bridge town. Accept any clear definition plus two examples.
- 2 A bottleneck can tax or block movement even if the surrounding land is empty; control of the path can matter more than owning a wide plain.
- 3 Lisbon sits where a major river meets the Atlantic, linking inland routes to ocean trade and making the site valuable to hold or attack.

Unit 3 · Population, migration and settlement

TOPIC 3.1 · POPULATION DISTRIBUTION

- 1 High density: many people per unit area. Low density: few people per unit area.
- 2 Water, fertile land, climate, jobs, transport, security (any three).
- 3 Density describes opportunity and risk (crowding, food, jobs), not whether a region is "better" or "worse" as a people.

TOPIC 3.2 · RURAL SETTLEMENTS

- 1 A countryside community (village or farms); most people farmed and produced food before modern industry, so rural living was the majority pattern.
- 2 Surplus food feeds non-farmers (traders, craft workers, officials, soldiers), so towns only work if the countryside produces more than farmers need themselves.
- 3 Stream: water and soil; hill: defence and lookout. Accept either with a clear reason.

TOPIC 3.3 · URBAN SETTLEMENTS

- 1 Markets, specialised crafts, courts/government, harbours, temples/churches, record-keeping, universities (any four non-farm activities).
- 2 Rulers choose a capital for political reasons (control, tradition, frontier) and geographic ones (defence, river, port, crossroads).
- 3 Accept a fair comparison of two sites, for example Athens (harbour/sea access), Rome (hills and Tiber), Constantinople (strait), Lisbon (river meets Atlantic).

TOPIC 3.4 · MIGRATION

- 1 Push: drives people out (war, famine, taxes, lack of land). Pull: draws people in (work, better land, safety, family). One example each required.
- 2 Movements responded to pressure behind and opportunity ahead; "wandering" ignores push and pull factors and human decisions.
- 3 Open: any modern school or family move that names both a push (for example job loss) and a pull (for example new job or better housing).

TOPIC 3.5 · URBANISATION

- 1 A process in which a larger share of people live in towns and settlements gain more urban functions (markets, walls, officials, specialised crafts), not only "more people".
- 2 Trade, defence, government/court, regular markets, ports, roads/bridges (any three).
- 3 A large camp can be big without laws and markets; a smaller place with urban functions is still urban. Function shows what the place does.

Unit 4 · Trade, transport and connection

TOPIC 4.1 · WHY DO SOCIETIES TRADE?

- 1 Resources → production → surplus → exchange/trade. Resources: what the land or sea provides. Production: turning resources into goods. Surplus: more than local need. Exchange: trading surplus for what is short.
- 2 Everyday bulk goods (grain, oil, timber, pottery) also moved; luxury alone understates ordinary exchange.
- 3 Open: any clear local pair, for example fish surplus by the sea and grain shortage inland, or similar.

TOPIC 4.2 · TRADE ROUTES

- 1 A repeated path for goods and people; rivers and coasts lower cost and risk compared with random overland wandering.
- 2 Forts, ports or navies can tax passage and take a share of other people's trade without making the goods.
- 3 River meets road, mountain pass onto a plain, harbour where ships unload (any one junction type).

TOPIC 4.3 · THE MEDITERRANEAN SEA

- 1 Trade route, cultural bridge, military space, food source, migration path (all five).
- 2 Sea links cut sailing distance between many coasts; harbours support markets, fleets and food supply.
- 3 It is a nearly enclosed sea between southern Europe, North Africa and western Asia, so ships link all three regions' shores.

TOPIC 4.4 · THE SILK ROAD

- 1 It was a web of caravan paths, oases and sea links, not one motorway; goods changed hands many times.
- 2 Spices, glass, metals, horses, paper ideas, religious teachings (any three non-silk items).
- 3 Taxing traffic can enrich a city; war, closed passes or disease travelling with merchants can harm the same city.

TOPIC 4.5 · TRANSPORT NETWORKS

- 1 Faster messages and armies let a ruler react, tax and defend more ground; markets can widen.
- 2 Ships and barges carry heavier bulk loads more cheaply than pack animals and carts over rough land.
- 3 Roads moved soldiers, orders and taxes as well as goods; they were tools of control, not only engineering.

Unit 5 · The Greek world**TOPIC 5.1 · GEOGRAPHY OF ANCIENT GREECE**

- 1 Mountains + islands + seas → political separation + maritime connection.
- 2 Rocky slopes and limited good soil made grain hard; people turned to fishing, trade and colonies by sea.
- 3 Mountains and separate shores priced unity highly; a wide plain is easier for one centre to march across and hold.

TOPIC 5.2 · CLIMATE AND AGRICULTURE

- 1 Mediterranean climate: hot, dry summers and milder, wetter winters.
- 2 Olives and grapes (vines) suited hillsides; grain still worried people because good cereal land was limited and shortages were a real risk.
- 3 Scarcity raised the value of overseas land and grain trade, but ambition, politics and opportunity also drove colonisation; both can be true.

TOPIC 5.3 · THE MINOANS

- 1 On Crete; Knossos (or another named palace site if stated).
- 2 Island position on eastern Mediterranean/Aegean sea lanes encouraged ships, trade and maritime skill.

- 3 Myths are traditional stories about identity and values; archaeology studies remains (walls, pottery, writing). They answer different questions and should not be treated as the same proof.

TOPIC 5.4 · THE MYCENAEANS

- 1 Mainland centres often looked more like fortresses with massive walls and hilltop sites than open Minoan-style palace complexes.
- 2 They also sailed, traded and kept palace records; warrior elite does not mean no trade.
- 3 Crete: island, maritime palace culture. Mainland: fortified power still linked to Mediterranean exchange. Hold both patterns in one wider Greek world.

TOPIC 5.5 · THE POLIS

- 1 A polis joins urban centre, surrounding farmland, shared institutions, military duty and religious identity (at least three parts).
- 2 Shared language, gods and culture could sit beside fierce political independence and local laws.
- 3 Athens and Sparta are different answers to how a polis should run; without the unit idea, comparisons float free of the basic Greek political form.

Unit 6 · Athens and Sparta

TOPIC 6.1 · ATHENS

- 1 Sea access via harbours such as Piraeus; silver at Laurion; Attica's coastal position (any two).
- 2 Limited grain land meant food, trade and naval power depended on the sea and overseas links.
- 3 Women, enslaved people, foreign residents (metics) and children; not only free adult male citizens.

TOPIC 6.2 · ATHENIAN DEMOCRACY

- 1 Speak and vote in the Assembly on laws, war and policy (and related civic roles such as offices filled by lot or jury service).
- 2 Women, enslaved people, foreign residents/metics (and often children; any three excluded groups).
- 3 No for everyone: large groups were excluded from full rights even though male citizens had strong participation tools.

TOPIC 6.3 · SPARTA

- 1 Helots were unfree people who farmed and supported Spartiate citizens; their labour and the fear of revolt shaped Spartan policy.
- 2 Power mixed dual kingship, elders and elite bodies rather than a wide open citizen assembly like Athens.
- 3 Training mattered, but the system also rested on helot labour, land control and elite institutions; toughness alone is a cartoon.

TOPIC 6.4 · ATHENS AND SPARTA COMPARED

- 1 Accept three categories with one fact each side, for example government (Assembly vs kings/elders), military (navy vs land infantry), economy (trade/silver vs land/helots), education or culture.
- 2 A sea war or campaign needing fleets, long-distance supply and naval blockade would favour Athens.
- 3 "Better" ignores different tests (sea vs land), shared exclusions and cruelty, and what question is being asked; judgement needs categories and evidence.

Unit 7 · Greek culture, ideas and conflict

TOPIC 7.1 · GREEK RELIGION AND MYTHOLOGY

- 1 Examples: Zeus (sky/kingship), Athena (wisdom/Athens), Poseidon (sea), Apollo (music/prophecy), Artemis (hunt). Any three with a role each.
- 2 Myths show values, fears, sacred places and identity even when they are not scientific reports of events.
- 3 Shared gods, festivals and stories helped Greeks recognise common culture even when their poleis fought.

TOPIC 7.2 · OLYMPIC GAMES

- 1 At Olympia; Zeus.
- 2 Honour returned to the athlete's polis as well as to the individual.
- 3 Similarity: athletic contest linked to Greek memory/identity. Difference: ancient Games were a religious festival for male Greek competitors, not a modern global sports brand (accept other fair differences).

TOPIC 7.3 · PERSIAN WARS

- 1 Marathon (land), Thermopylae (land/pass), Salamis (sea). Accept other correctly typed key places.
- 2 Narrow passes and straits limited how many enemy troops or ships could attack at once, reducing the value of larger numbers.
- 3 Cooperation was temporary under threat; after danger lessened, poleis returned to rivalry and no permanent single Greek state formed.

TOPIC 7.4 · PELOPONNESIAN WAR

- 1 Athens: navy, walls, harbours, allies and sea empire. Sparta: land infantry and land coalitions.
- 2 Plague, siege, shifting alliances, civil strife, exhaustion and damage to many cities (any two).
- 3 Exhausted, divided poleis were easier for a northern power (Macedon under Philip and Alexander) to dominate.

TOPIC 7.5 · PHILOSOPHY, THEATRE, SCIENCE AND MEDICINE

- 1 Socrates: questioning; Plato: the city and knowledge; Aristotle: logic and observation (accept close matches).
- 2 Plays were staged for citizens at festivals before large audiences; they explored public themes, not only private fun.
- 3 Natural explanations of illness rather than only blaming the gods (Hippocratic tradition).

TOPIC 7.6 · ARCHITECTURE AND LEGACY

- 1 Doric, Ionic, Corinthian; the Parthenon (on the Acropolis).
- 2 What later people inherit, reuse or argue with from the past.
- 3 Open: one clear achievement (for example democracy tools, drama, architecture, philosophy) and one limit (slavery, exclusion of women, war damage, or similar).

TOPIC 7.7 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: WESTERN IBERIA AND THE GREEK WORLD

- 1 Phoenician and other Mediterranean traders (and Iberian metal/coastal markets): contacts linked western shores into wider exchange without dense Greek colonisation like southern Italy or Sicily.
- 2 Atlantic coastline, metal-rich interiors, river mouths (later Lisbon/Tagus) or routes via the Strait of Gibraltar allowed goods and techniques to move step by step.
- 3 Open (key question: How did the future territory of Portugal connect to Mediterranean civilisation without being Greek?): four to six sentences; uses panel evidence (traders/metals/coasts); links western Iberia to Mediterranean networks; does not treat the region.

Unit 8 · Alexander the Great

TOPIC 8.1 · MACEDON AND PHILIP II

- 1 North of the famous southern poleis; that edge position and resources helped Philip build power before forcing much of Greece into a league under Macedon.
- 2 Year-round professional training; improved phalanx with long sarissas; cavalry on the flanks; mines/money for specialists (any two with how each helped).
- 3 Alexander inherited Philip's army, reforms and invasion plan; judging the son alone hides the system the father built.

TOPIC 8.2 · ALEXANDER, ARMY AND CONQUEST

- 1 Phalanx held or fixed the centre while cavalry struck weak points (often led by Alexander).
- 2 Each victory lengthened supply lines, distance from home, and strain on food, pay, equipment and loyalty.
- 3 Surrender: fear of punishment, hope to keep customs if they paid and obeyed. Fight: defence of home, distrust of promises, or resistance to new rule (one reason each).

TOPIC 8.3 · EGYPT, ASIA AND THE LIMITS OF EXPANSION

- 1 Mediterranean harbour, access to Nile trade, position facing Africa and the wider sea; good for control, trade and a lasting Greek-speaking hub.
- 2 Distance, terrain, climate, exhaustion, broken equipment, supply problems, army refusal (any three non-battle limits).
- 3 Even a famous commander was limited by tired soldiers and geography; power was not unlimited will alone.

TOPIC 8.4 · THE HELLENISTIC WORLD AND LEGACY

- 1 Hellenistic means Greek-like mixed culture after Alexander; local and Greek traditions blended, so "purely Greek" is false.
- 2 Positive: cities, language, trade and scholarship hubs such as Alexandria. Critical: destruction, unstable succession, wars among successors (one of each).
- 3 No adult heir ready to rule the whole empire; generals fought for pieces while culture still mixed and spread.

TOPIC 8.5 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: IBERIA AND MEDITERRANEAN TRADE

- 1 Alexander never reached Iberia; western Iberia stayed outside his political map yet still traded with Mediterranean partners (metals, coastal exchange). That matters because influence travelled without Macedonian governors.
- 2 Atlantic coast and metal-rich inland zones linked step by step through Mediterranean sea routes even without conquest.
- 3 Open (key question: How can a region be influenced by distant civilisations without joining their empires?): four to six sentences; panel evidence of trade/goods/ideas without political rule; links Portugal's future lands to Mediterranean networks; rejects isolation.

Unit 9 · The rise of Rome

TOPIC 9.1 · GEOGRAPHY OF ITALY

- 1 Central Mediterranean position shortens routes to North Africa, Greece, Iberia and the east, so expansion could project in many directions once Italy was organised.
- 2 Help: natural barriers and valley defence. Hinder: break the land into valleys and slow unification across the spine.
- West toward Iberia/Spain; south toward Africa; east toward Greece and Asia (any two with what lay that way).

TOPIC 9.2 · SEVEN HILLS AND THE TIBER

- 1 Site: local features (seven hills, Tiber bend). Situation: how Rome relates to wider Italy and the Mediterranean (central western Italy, access inland and to the sea).
- 2 Water, transport toward the sea, a crossing for trade between coast and inland (any two).
- 3 Even modest height aids defence, lookout and settlement above flood-prone ground.

TOPIC 9.3 · FOUNDATION MYTH AND THE KINGDOM

- 1 A story about origins that shapes identity; Romulus and Remus shows what Romans valued (courage, destiny, walls, divine favour) even if not proven fact.
- 2 Archaeology uses physical remains (soil layers, pottery, walls, graves); legends are later written stories and may invent or reshape the past.
- 3 Details are patchy and contested; some kings or tales may be later inventions to explain customs, so lists need care.

Unit 10 · The Roman Republic**TOPIC 10.1 · WHAT IS A REPUBLIC?**

- 1 Government without a hereditary king, with public offices, laws and shared institutions rather than one permanent royal line.
- 2 Time-limited magistrates, shared offices, laws, checks among elites/Senate (any two limits the system tried to use).
- 3 Large groups (women, enslaved people, many non-citizens) were excluded; "public" power was not power for everyone.

TOPIC 10.2 · SENATE, CITIZENS AND CONFLICT

- 1 The Senate advised and steered policy; senators held wealth, experience and influence even without being kings.
- 2 Patricians: elite families with early privileges. Plebeians: other free citizens who gained more rights over time (tribunes, laws). One difference and one gain required.
- 3 Wider citizenship could bind Italian communities with legal ties and military service, helping Rome control Italy with allies as well as force.

TOPIC 10.3 · ARMY, EXPANSION AND CARTHAGE

- 1 Italian allies supplied men and support so Rome fought with more than Rome's own citizens alone.
- 2 Hannibal invaded Italy and won major battles; Rome survived through alliances, persistence and eventually taking the war beyond Italy rather than collapsing after defeats.
- 3 Rome became a Mediterranean power controlling seas, provinces and overseas rivals, not only an Italian city-state.

TOPIC 10.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: LUSITANIA AND VIRIATHUS

- 1 Viriathus (Lusitanian leader) and Lusitanian resistance: shows Roman conquest of western Iberia was long, costly and incomplete for decades.
- 2 Mountains, river valleys and open grazing lands favoured mobile fighters who knew the ground; distance from Rome slowed messages and reinforcements.
- 3 Open (key question: Why was western Iberia hard for Rome to hold quickly?): four to six sentences; uses guerrilla/terrain or Viriathus evidence; links to wider Roman Mediterranean expansion; does not treat the region as instantly peaceful.

Unit 11 · Julius Caesar and the end of the Republic

TOPIC 11.1 · PROBLEMS OF THE REPUBLIC

- 1 Huge wealth and slaves for some elites; debt and land loss for many small farmers; urban poor as a political force; bribery and violence (any two).
- 2 Generals paid them, promised farms and shared years of campaign; the Senate felt distant compared with the commander who fed and rewarded them.
- 3 Institutions built for a city managing Italy struggled with distant provinces, slow communication and governors who commanded real armies far from Rome.

TOPIC 11.2 · CAESAR, CIVIL WAR AND AUGUSTUS

- 1 Leading troops into Italy against the state's will meant civil war and a break with republican norms (crossing the Rubicon as a point of no return).
- 2 He kept consuls, Senate and forms of election while holding the key military and financial powers in practice.
- 3 Destroyed: seized personal power and normalised dictatorship. Already broken: inequality, violence and rival generals had already wrecked fair competition before him (one argument each).

Unit 12 · The Roman Empire**TOPIC 12.1 · PAX ROMANA**

- 1 "Roman peace": long relative peace in many provinces under empire; incomplete because peace was uneven and rested on force as well as order.
- 2 Force: army and frontiers. Incentives: trade, law, local elites keeping status if they cooperated (one of each).
- 3 Elites might keep wealth, offices and order under Rome even when ordinary people paid heavy taxes.

TOPIC 12.2 · ARMY, ROADS AND ENGINEERING

- 1 Soldiers, messages/orders, goods/taxes (or similar): each helped speed control, reaction and supply across distance.
- 2 Aqueducts brought reliable water for baths, fountains and denser urban life beyond local wells alone.
- 3 Distance still meant days or weeks of travel; even good roads could not make a huge empire feel small to one emperor in Rome.

TOPIC 12.3 · TOWNS, LAW, RELIGION AND TRADE

- 1 Forum, baths, temples, walls, grid streets, amphitheatre (any three); one linked to government or trade (for example forum for markets and public business).
- 2 Shared rules and coinage made contracts and payments easier across long Mediterranean routes.
- 3 Local languages, customs and identities continued; "Roman" was a layered mix, not total replacement everywhere.

TOPIC 12.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: ROMAN LUSITANIA

- 1 Lusitania as a province; towns such as Conimbriga: show Roman urban life, law and roads at the Atlantic edge of the empire.
- 2 River valleys and road corridors stitched Atlantic Iberia into Mediterranean administration and trade.
- 3 Open (key question: How does a western province show both Roman power and local adaptation?): four to six sentences; army/roads/towns/law as power; local customs and adaptation; global link to the same imperial toolkit elsewhere.

Unit 13 · Christianity and the transformation of Rome

TOPIC 13.1 · ORIGINS AND EARLY COMMUNITIES

- 1 Began in the eastern Mediterranean (Judea/Palestine around Jesus and early communities); Roman roads and sea lanes moved people, letters and ideas between towns.
- 2 Persecution is punishment for beliefs or identity; it was not constant everywhere at all times, so "always persecuted everywhere" is false.
- 3 Ports mixed strangers, traders and news, so new ideas could spread faster than in remote villages.

TOPIC 13.2 · CONSTANTINE AND CONSTANTINOPLE

- 1 He favoured and publicly supported Christianity (legalisation/imperial backing), shifting it from a vulnerable minority faith toward a favoured imperial religion.
- 2 The Bosphorus controls a strategic waterway between seas and continents, ideal for trade and defence of a capital.
- 3 Power, court and strategic attention can shift east even while old cities still exist; the empire's centre of gravity can move.

TOPIC 13.3 · DIVISION AND FALL OF THE WEST

- 1 The west faced long frontiers and weaker resources in some crises while the richer east could hold differently; division could leave the west more exposed.
- 2 476 marks a traditional end of the western imperial line in Italy; misleading because eastern empire continued and Roman culture, towns and Christianity did not vanish everywhere that year.
- 3 Military pressure on frontiers; economic strain; political instability; loss of tax base (any two different types).

TOPIC 13.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: LATE ROMAN IBERIA

- 1 The late Roman and post-Roman transition in Iberia (towns, roads, Christian organisation surviving as central power failed): shows change was layered, not a single switch-off.
- 2 Peninsula open to Mediterranean and Atlantic movements; mountains and river basins changed at different speeds; distance from Italy shaped local forms of crisis.
- 3 Open (key question: Why is it misleading to treat 476 as the end of everything Roman in Iberia?): four to six sentences; survival of towns/roads/church; several clocks (east continues, local Iberian change); rejects one-year total end.

Unit 14 · Europe after Rome**TOPIC 14.1 · EARLY MIDDLE AGES**

- 1 Changes: new kingdoms, weaker central Roman tax/army in the west. Continuities: Christianity, towns (in places), Roman roads and ideas reused (accept two of each).
- 2 "Dark Age" can imply total darkness, which overstates loss and ignores learning, trade and continuity in many places; historians test the label against evidence.
- 3 Monasteries copied books, kept learning and organised land; that is evidence against total cultural blackout.

TOPIC 14.2 · BYZANTINE EMPIRE

- 1 The eastern Roman empire continuing from Constantinople with Roman traditions, law and Christian rule.
- 2 Strategic Bosphorus site controlled trade and military routes between continents and seas for centuries.
- 3 A powerful Mediterranean capital and empire continued after 476, so "whole Mediterranean went dark" is false.

TOPIC 14.3 · THE RISE OF ISLAM

- 1 A caliphate is a state under a caliph (successor leadership in the Islamic community); early expansion reached the Middle East, North Africa and into Iberia by the eighth century.
- 2 Learning, trade, cities, law and culture also flourished; armies alone are a narrow picture.
- 3 New Islamic powers reshaped control of coasts and routes from Arabia through North Africa into Iberia, changing who ruled key Mediterranean shores.

TOPIC 14.4 · A CONNECTED MEDITERRANEAN

- 1 Trade, shared cities, learning, diplomacy, mixed populations, borrowed techniques (any two non-battle interactions).
- 2 Solid colour blocks hide border zones, mixed towns and daily contact; life was not only pure separate blocks at war.
- 3 Goods and ideas still moved across the sea, which challenges total isolation and total darkness labels.

TOPIC 14.5 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: SUEBI, VISIGOTHS AND AL-ANDALUS

- 1 Al-Andalus after 711 (and Suebi/Visigothic kingdoms before): places Iberia between late Roman, Christian and Islamic worlds.
- 2 Strait of Gibraltar as a sea gate between Africa and Europe; mountains and river basins shaped which powers held which valleys.
- 3 Open (key question: How did Islam and Christianity interact in medieval Iberia beyond only battlefield stories?): four to six sentences; trade, learning, frontiers, mixed societies or cities; links Portugal's later lands to wider Mediterranean systems; not.

Unit 15 · Feudalism and medieval society

TOPIC 15.1 · WHY FEUDAL RELATIONSHIPS DEVELOPED

- 1 Lord grants land use/protection; vassal gives loyalty, service and military support (accept clear two-way deal).
- 2 When kings are weak, local control of fords, hills and food matters more than a distant capital that cannot reach every valley.
- 3 Open/diagram task: chain of three people with what each gives and gets (for example king grants land, lord gives knights, knight gives military service). Acceptance: reciprocal labels, not one-way only.

TOPIC 15.2 · LORDS, VASSALS, KNIGHTS AND MANORS

- 1 Free peasant: more personal freedom and often some land rights. Serf: bound to the manor with labour dues and limited freedom to leave.
- 2 Armour, horse, weapons, training time, land income to support them (any three that show cost).
- 3 Open diary: six to eight sentences; harvest work, dues, weather or lord's demands; age-appropriate and set on a manor.

TOPIC 15.3 · CASTLES AND STRATEGIC GEOGRAPHY

- 1 Height for defence and lookout; river bend for water barrier and control of movement.
- 2 Thick stone walls, towers, gatehouses, moats, arrow slits (any two with how each slows attackers).
- 3 Open map task: chosen site with two sentences on height, road, river or harbour control.

TOPIC 15.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: AFONSO HENRIQUES AND INDEPENDENCE

- 1 Afonso Henriques (Afonso I) led the County of Portugal toward recognition as a kingdom in the twelfth century; foundation figure of Portuguese kingship.
- 2 Rivers, hills and Atlantic harbours shaped army routes, towns and the chance to tax trade as well as win fields; land frontiers and ocean options both mattered.

- 3 Open (key question: How did Portugal become independent without being isolated from European politics?): four to six sentences; war, Church, León/Castile diplomacy, Reconquista and feudal Europe; independence inside European networks, not cut off.

Unit 16 · Life in medieval Europe

TOPIC 16.1 · VILLAGES AND TOWNS

- 1 Villages: farming-focused, fewer specialised crafts. Towns: walls, markets, more specialised work, charters/rights (any two clear differences).
- 2 A charter grants rights and rules for a town; people wanted freer trade, self-government or protection of customs.
- 3 Open: three sentences on a river/harbour town (Lisbon, Porto or similar) linking water site to trade, food or defence.

TOPIC 16.2 · GUILDS

- 1 Protected members' training and livelihoods; set quality and competition rules that also guided customers on standards.
- 2 Apprentice (learns), journeyman (works for wages after training), master (runs a workshop). Order and one-line each required.
- 3 Open: a clear baker rule (weight, price, quality) with a reason that helps buyers or fair trade.

TOPIC 16.3 · CHURCH, MONASTERIES AND UNIVERSITIES

- 1 Mass, feast days, moral teaching and calendar of the year structured ordinary time from week to season.
- 2 Copy books, farm/organise land, care for sick, educate, host travellers (any two).
- 3 Busy towns feed scholars, supply books and customers, and concentrate patrons; remote forests lack that density.

TOPIC 16.4 · GOTHIC ARCHITECTURE

- 1 Pointed arches, flying buttresses, large windows/stained glass, height and light (any two features with one advantage each, for example height/light or wall support).
- 2 Pictures in glass taught Bible stories and messages to people who could not read text.
- 3 Open sketch task: pointed arch and flying buttress both labelled.

TOPIC 16.5 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: LISBON, TOWNS AND MONASTERIES

- 1 Capture of Lisbon in 1147: major turning point securing a key city for Portugal's growth and Christian control of a strategic estuary.
- 2 The Tagus estuary links ocean routes to the interior, supporting harbour trade, supply and power.
- 3 Open (key question: Why did Lisbon's geography make it worth a major siege?): four to six sentences; estuary/port/inland links; strategic value for kingdom and trade; panel evidence; not isolated local colour.

Unit 17 · Medieval trade and connections

TOPIC 17.1 · TRADE EXPANDS

- 1 Surplus is more goods than local need; it feeds markets because producers can sell extras and buy what they lack.
- 2 Examples: wool, cloth, wine, salt, grain, spices, timber (any three with a rough origin such as England wool, Mediterranean wine, eastern spices).
- 3 River crossings gather travellers and cargo; lonely mountain tops lack traffic and easy bulk transport.

TOPIC 17.2 · MEDITERRANEAN AND SILK ROAD LINKS

- 1 Italian ports sat on Mediterranean sea lanes linking Europe to Islamic and eastern trade networks.
- 2 Long chains of middlemen, long distance and high demand raised prices by the time spices reached the west.
- 3 Open map task: Mediterranean marked, one land path toward Asia, two port cities labelled.

TOPIC 17.3 · PILGRIMAGE ROUTES

- 1 A journey for religious devotion; destinations such as Santiago de Compostela, Rome, Jerusalem (any two).
- 2 Lodging, food sales, offerings and traffic could enrich towns on the road.
- 3 Open three-stop plan: each stop names a help (hostel, shrine, road) or danger (theft, weather, illness).

TOPIC 17.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: ATLANTIC AND MEDITERRANEAN EDGES

- 1 Fish, salt, shipping skills, coastal trade and river-mouth markets linked Portugal to the sea (accept panel goods/skills).
- 2 Long coastline and river mouths supported harbours, fishing and trade while also tying the kingdom to ocean and coastal routes.
- 3 Open (key question: How can a kingdom be both a land frontier state and a sea-facing trader?): four to six sentences; land border wars/Reconquista plus Atlantic/Mediterranean trade; one panel evidence; dual geography.

Unit 18 · The Crusades

TOPIC 18.1 · WHAT WERE THE CRUSADES?

- 1 Military expeditions from Latin Christendom toward the eastern Mediterranean, framed as holy war but tangled with politics, land and trade (two clear sentences).
- 2 Faith, adventure, land/wealth, status, pressure to fight, papal calls (any three).
- 3 Politics, plunder, trade and power mixed with religion; single-cause slogans miss the mix.

TOPIC 18.2 · JERUSALEM AND GEOGRAPHY OF THE ROUTES

- 1 Sacred to Jews, Christians and Muslims (holy sites and shared sacred status).
- 2 Land: long marches, mountains, hostile territory, supply strain. Sea: storms, ships, cost, naval risk (one problem each route).
- 3 Open map task: path from France toward Jerusalem with two hard places marked (mountains, sea crossing, deserts).

TOPIC 18.3 · TRAVEL, SUPPLY AND CONSEQUENCES

- 1 Armies fail without food, ships and money even if fighters are skilled; distance makes supply decisive.
- 2 Positive: contact, trade, knowledge exchange. Negative: violence, massacre, distrust, costly failure (one each).
- 3 Open balanced paragraph (six to eight sentences): religion mattered, but politics/trade/supply/consequences also; not "only religion".

TOPIC 18.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: RECONQUISTA AND CRUSADING IDEALS

- 1 Reconquista: long Christian advance against Muslim-ruled lands in Iberia; linked to crusading ideals of holy war and papal/military support, while also about land and power.
- 2 Rivers, towns and coasts shaped southward campaigns, supply and which strongholds were worth taking.
- 3 Open (key question using Iberia and the East): four to six sentences; religion plus politics/land/trade; evidence from both Iberia and eastern Crusades; not single-cause.

Unit 19 · The Black Death

TOPIC 19.1 · SPREAD OF DISEASE

- 1 Ships and caravans that moved goods also moved infection along the same trade routes and ports.
- 2 Busy ports had denser contacts with many ships and strangers; remote villages had fewer early links (though not always safe later).
- 3 Open flow diagram: ship → market → inland road with one sentence per step on how disease moves with people and goods.

TOPIC 19.2 · POPULATION, ECONOMY AND SOCIETY

- 1 Fewer workers raised the value of labour, so survivors could bargain for better pay or terms in many places.
- 2 Economic: labour shortage, wage pressure, empty farms. Social/religious: fear, piety, blame, changes in belief or local power (one each).
- 3 Open (unit enquiry, six to eight sentences): mass death, labour and society change, uneven effects; at least two pieces of evidence.

TOPIC 19.3 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: PLAGUE ON THE ATLANTIC EDGE

- 1 Harbour cities lived by shipping and markets, so infection entered with trade and crowds.
- 2 Estuaries linked ocean routes to inland towns; coastal trade formed a chain into wider Mediterranean/Atlantic networks.
- 3 Open (key question: How can the same trade links explain both prosperity and catastrophe?): four to six sentences; wealth and infection travel together; panel evidence from ports; connection as double-edged.

Unit 20 · War, monarchies and national identity**TOPIC 20.1 · HUNDRED YEARS' WAR AND CHANGING WARFARE**

- 1 It was not one continuous hundred-year battle; it was on-and-off war with truces from 1337 to 1453.
- 2 Longbows could defeat knightly cavalry charges at range; gunpowder began to smash castle walls, changing sieges and fort design.
- 3 Ports moved men and supplies across the Channel; rivers and walled towns shaped marches, food and control of the land.

TOPIC 20.2 · JOAN OF ARC AND STRONGER MONARCHIES

- 1 A young French woman who inspired resistance, supported Charles VII's coronation and became a symbol of French resolve (even though one person alone could not win the war).
- 2 More reliable taxes; professional soldiers; gunpowder forts; royal courts, law and officials reaching beyond local lords (any two).
- 3 Open (five to seven sentences): long war costs money and builds "us/them" loyalty; kings who tax and command better outgrow purely feudal short-term forces; identity and central power grow unevenly.

TOPIC 20.3 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: 1383-1385 AND ALJUBARROTA

- 1 Independence of the Portuguese crown versus Castilian claim; João of Avis became King João I after the crisis and Aljubarrota.
- 2 Chosen ground/hills and fortified approaches helped a smaller force; English alliance added military support against Castile.
- 3 Open (key question: How did military crisis produce a stronger Portuguese monarchy?): four to six sentences; succession crisis, Aljubarrota, Avis dynasty, later maritime sponsorship; crisis to stronger royal line.

Unit 21 · The Renaissance

TOPIC 21.1 · WHAT WAS THE RENAISSANCE?

- 1 "Rebirth"; historians mean renewed interest in classical learning, art and enquiry (not a magic restart of all life).
- 2 Medieval centuries still had learning, trade, faith and art; total "Dark Age" oversimplifies.
- 3 Science/medicine, politics, architecture, printing, literature, education (any two besides painting).

TOPIC 21.2 · WHY ITALY, HUMANISM AND ART

- 1 Wealthy trading cities, classical ruins nearby, competition among city-states, patronage networks (any two geographical or economic reasons).
- 2 Humanism: study of human life, classical texts and eloquent education centred on human potential and learning (age-appropriate one sentence).
- 3 A patron pays for art or learning; artists needed money, materials and protection that wealthy sponsors provided.

TOPIC 21.3 · SCIENCE, ENQUIRY AND PRINTING

- 1 Printing multiplied copies faster and cheaper than hand copying, spreading arguments beyond a few scribes and gatekeepers.
- 2 Observation in anatomy, astronomy, or careful measurement/experiment examples from the period (any one clear example).
- 3 Trading towns have markets, customers, paper trade and ideas on the move; isolated villages lack that demand.

TOPIC 21.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: LEARNING ON THE ATLANTIC EDGE

- 1 Mathematics, charts and map-making improved navigation, position-finding and planned voyages for Portuguese sailors.
- 2 Ocean voyages needed better tools for long distances, open seas and return routes than short coastal Mediterranean hops.
- 3 Open (key question: How can 'Renaissance' describe both a painting and a navigational table?): four to six sentences; shared culture of measurement, classical learning and enquiry applied to art and to Atlantic navigation; panel evidence.

Unit 22 · The Age of Exploration

TOPIC 22.1 · WHY EXPLORE?

- 1 Gold/wealth, spices, faith, glory/fame, new routes, rivalry (any four; underline two with reasons linked to royal power, revenue or prestige).
- 2 A sea route could cut out some land middlemen who raised spice prices between Asia and Europe.
- 3 Indigenous peoples of Africa, Asia and the Americas, and people harmed by conquest or forced systems (accept clear missing groups).

TOPIC 22.2 · NAVIGATION AND SHIPS

- 1 Compass (direction), charts/portolan maps, stars/astrolabe or cross-staff for latitude (any two with how each helped).
- 2 The caravel was a versatile sailing ship suited to exploration: better handling on coasts and open seas for its time (accept textbook features: lateen sails, sturdiness, manoeuvrability).
- 3 Without a return path and home supply of knowledge, a one-way voyage cannot build lasting routes or power.

TOPIC 22.3 · PORTUGAL, SPAIN AND ATLANTIC GEOGRAPHY

- 1 Long Atlantic coast, harbours and seafaring habits encouraged looking west and south by sea rather than only inland.
- 2 Islands offered water, repair, staging and learning stops on longer ocean legs (stepping-stones).
- 3 Open map task: Portugal, West African coast, Cape of Good Hope and India marked with the idea of a linking sea route.

TOPIC 22.4 · PORTUGAL IN THE GLOBAL STORY: DIAS, DA GAMA AND MARITIME POWER

- 1 Dias rounded the Cape of Good Hope (1488), proving an Atlantic-Indian Ocean sea link possible; da Gama reached India (Calicut) in 1498.
- 2 The Cape is where Atlantic and Indian Ocean routes meet at Africa's southern tip, turning coastal African probing into a path toward Asia.
- 3 Open (key question: Why did Portugal turn towards the Atlantic, and what did that change for the world?): four to six sentences; geography (winds, coast, islands), royal sponsorship, Dias/da Gama evidence; global trade and unequal consequences.

Unit 23 · Political geography

TOPIC 23.1 · COUNTRY, STATE, NATION AND TERRITORY

- 1 State: political organisation with government and authority over a territory. Nation: people who share identity (language, culture, history) whether or not they form one state. Accept clear one-sentence each.
- 2 State-leaning: government, passport, army, tax office. Nation-leaning: shared language, folk songs. Some fit both (language can support nation and state policy). Accept reasoned sorting.
- 3 Club has rules, members and symbols like a state/nation mix; comparison fails because clubs lack sovereign territory, monopoly of force and full legal citizenship (accept clear limit).
- 4 Open: any real cross-border region (for example Basque Country, Kurdistan, or a mountain/language region spanning states).

TOPIC 23.2 · BORDERS AND REGIONS OVER TIME

- 1 Complete with evidence: war, treaties, empires rising and falling change lines (for example Roman frontiers, medieval Iberia, modern Portugal).
- 2 Open comparison: one changed border/region named with why it mattered (control, identity, trade or defence).
- 3 Natural feature (river, mountain) can help a border stick; nature alone fails because people still move, conquer, negotiate and redraw lines.
- 4 Open sketch: same coastline, two political colourings, centuries labelled.

Unit 24 · Economic geography

TOPIC 24.1 · ECONOMIC SECTORS

- 1 Primary: take raw materials from nature. Secondary: make/manufacture goods. Tertiary: provide services. Wording need not match the book exactly.
- 2 Primary: fisher, iron miner, vineyard worker. Secondary: baker, shipbuilder, temple/church builder. Tertiary: nurse, online delivery driver. (Accept close reasoned sorts.)
- 3 Open chain for one item through all three sectors with at least one place per stage (for example wheat farm → bakery → shop/delivery).
- 4 Empires need tax collectors, engineers, traders and officials to organise complex systems even when most people still farm.

TOPIC 24.2 · IMPORTS, EXPORTS AND MARKETS

- 1 Import: goods brought into Portugal (for example grain or cloth). Export: goods sent out (for example salt, wine, cork). Accept realistic examples.
- 2 Two markets with links, for example Mediterranean port to North Africa, Silk Road oasis to China, medieval fair to regional producers.
- 3 Local strength often primary (salt); risk is depending on imported food if trade fails.
- 4 Open four sentences: market as meeting point of producers, prices, information and long-distance links, not only a shopping street.

TOPIC 24.3 · TRANSPORT NETWORKS THEN AND NOW

- 1 A network of routes (paths of movement) and nodes (junctions, ports, towns) that connect places.
- 2 Army: move troops and supplies. Traders: move goods to markets more reliably (one each).
- 3 Open table: three rows with speed relative to its time and one cargo each (for example Roman road/grain, medieval pack route/wool, modern rail/containers).
- 4 Open: support or challenge with one historical and one modern example (roads, ports, rail, internet logistics).

Unit 25 · Cities and urbanisation**TOPIC 25.1 · LOCATION, FUNCTION AND GROWTH**

- 1 Site: exact local features of the place. Situation: how it relates to wider region and routes. One example each required.
- 2 Port, market, fortress, capital/administration, holy site, industrial or service centre (any four; circle one for a known capital).
- 3 Open short story (four to six sentences) using location → function → growth for a port town.
- 4 Safe hills may lack easy trade routes, water transport or farmland; safety alone may not attract large growth.

TOPIC 25.2 · ATHENS, ROME, CONSTANTINOPLE AND LISBON

- 1 Open table: site, main function, one growth reason for each of the four cities (harbour/sea; hills/Tiber; strait capital; estuary/Atlantic).
- 2 Constantinople (strait) or Athens/Lisbon (harbour) with three-sentence explanation; strongest strait/harbour dependency accepted with reason.
- 3 Challenge or support with Roman/medieval Lisbon or Tagus points: exploration mattered, but earlier geography and roles also count.
- 4 Open six-sentence comparison of situation (wider links) for two cities, not only local site features.

Unit 26 · Development and global connections**TOPIC 26.1 · WHAT DEVELOPMENT MEANS**

- 1 Own definition (≤25 words) about how people can live, choose, learn and stay healthy, not money alone.
- 2 Open historical example: grand temples/forums/palaces beside slavery, poverty or exclusion (Greece, Rome or medieval examples).
- 3 Questions about inequality, health, education, rights, environment, who gains (any two).
- 4 One number (for example average income) hides uneven lives and other dimensions of well-being.

TOPIC 26.2 · INDICATORS AND CONNECTIONS

- 1 Income, education, health, infrastructure (four): each needs one strength and one weakness (for example easy to compare vs misses inequality or culture).
- 2 Open dashboard of five indicators with one choice explained for fair comparison.
- 3 Open: trade route or empire link that brought wealth to some and harm, forced labour or disease to others.
- 4 Open six sentences: several indicators, inequality, historical links, avoid single-number reduction.

Unit 27 · Globalisation

TOPIC 27.1 · WHAT GLOBALISATION MEANS

- 1 Two sentences: increasing connection of places through movement of goods, people, money, ideas and culture, becoming denser and faster over time (without using the word "global").
- 2 Goods, people, money, ideas, diseases, news, styles (any five); mark which also moved in ancient/medieval worlds (most did, speed differs).
- 3 Helps: both move information and goods across distance. Fails: different speed, technology, scale and who controls networks (one help, one fail).
- 4 Open: local industry, port access, wealth or policy can make the same country experience connection differently in two towns.

TOPIC 27.2 · FROM MEDITERRANEAN TRADE TO MODERN LINKS

- 1 Open six-box timeline with one place-name per stage (for example Athens/Rome/Samarkand/Venice/Lisbon/modern hub).
- 2 Mediterranean Sea, Strait of Gibraltar, Bosphorus, Cape of Good Hope or similar feature used in at least three stages.
- 3 Age of Exploration / Dias-da Gama Atlantic-Indian Ocean turn (or Lisbon as Atlantic hinge); one earlier-unit fact required.
- 4 Open eight sentences: modern speed is new; long-distance connection is old; two stages as evidence; balanced judgement.

TOPIC 27.3 · YEAR SYNTHESIS: GEOGRAPHY, POWER AND CONNECTION

- 1 Open three sentences, each tied to a different unit example (geography, power, connection).
- 2 Open ten sentences on one place using geography, power and connection with Year 8 evidence.
- 3 Open poster task: four labelled examples from four different parts of the book under "History happens somewhere".
- 4 Open final paragraph (eight to twelve sentences) on how states, empires and networks develop: multi-causal; place, people, trade and politics interact; uses year evidence.

Glossary

Every word this book teaches, defined as it is used here, with the unit that introduces it. 57 entries.

Afonso Henriques	Twelfth-century leader associated with the rise of the Portuguese kingdom. Unit 15
Al-Andalus	Muslim-ruled Iberia in the medieval period. Unit 14
Aljubarrota	The 1385 battle that helped secure Portuguese independence under the Avis dynasty. Unit 20
aqueduct	A channel or bridge built to carry water into a city. Unit 12
Black Death	The mid-fourteenth-century plague wave that killed a large share of Europe's population. Unit 19
border	A claimed line between political territories; not permanent. Unit 23
Byzantine Empire	The eastern Roman empire centred on Constantinople. Unit 14
caliphate	A large Islamic political community led by a caliph. Unit 14
caravel	A versatile sailing ship used in Iberian Atlantic exploration. Unit 22
contour	A line on a map joining points of equal height. Unit 1
Crusades	Military expeditions from Latin Christendom toward the eastern Mediterranean, framed as holy war. Unit 18
democracy	Rule involving citizen participation; in Athens, limited to adult male citizens. Unit 6
development	Improvement in how people can live and choose, not only higher average income. Unit 26
Equator	The line of 0 degrees latitude around the middle of the Earth. Unit 1
export	A good or service sent out from a place to sell elsewhere. Unit 24
feudalism	A model of land granted for service and loyalty in medieval Europe. Unit 15
foundation myth	A traditional origin story, not the same as proven fact. Unit 9
GIS	Geographic Information Systems: layered digital map information. Unit 1
globalisation	Increasing connections through trade, migration, transport, communication and technology. Unit 27
Gothic	A medieval building style with pointed arches, rib vaults and large windows. Unit 16
guild	An urban association of craft or trade workers regulating training and quality. Unit 16

Hellenistic	The mixed Greek and local cultures after Alexander's conquests. Unit 8
helot	A conquered labourer class supporting Spartiate citizens in Sparta. Unit 6
historical map	A map that shows past territories or change over time. Unit 1
humanism	Renaissance learning that placed classical texts and human experience at the centre. Unit 21
import	A good or service brought into a place from outside. Unit 24
latitude	Distance north or south of the Equator, measured in degrees. Unit 1
legion	A major unit of the Roman army. Unit 10
longitude	Distance east or west of the Prime Meridian, measured in degrees. Unit 1
Lusitania	A Roman province in western Iberia covering much of future Portugal. Unit 10
manor	A lord's estate where peasants worked land for dues and protection. Unit 15
nation	A community of people who share a sense of identity. Unit 23
Pax Romana	A long period of relative peace inside much of the early Roman Empire. Unit 12
phalanx	A dense infantry formation used by Macedonian and Greek armies. Unit 8
physical map	A map that shows landforms, rivers and coasts. Unit 1
polis	A Greek city-state: urban centre, farmland, citizens, army and cult. Unit 5
political map	A map that shows countries, borders and cities. Unit 1
population density	How many people live in a given area. Unit 3
primary sector	Work that takes raw materials from land or sea. Unit 24
Prime Meridian	The line of 0 degrees longitude used as the east-west zero. Unit 1
province	A territory ruled by Rome outside Italy. Unit 12
pull factor	A reason that draws people to a place. Unit 3
push factor	A reason that drives people to leave a place. Unit 3
Reconquista	Christian kingdoms' expansion across medieval Iberia. Unit 15
republic	Government without a hereditary king, with public offices and laws. Unit 10
scale	The relationship between distance on a map and distance on the ground. Unit 1

secondary sector	Manufacturing and making. Unit 24
Senate	The council of leading Romans that guided republican policy. Unit 10
Silk Road	A network of routes linking East Asia to the Mediterranean world. Unit 4
state	A political organisation that claims sovereignty over a territory. Unit 23
strategic location	A place whose control changes power more than its size suggests. Unit 2
tertiary sector	Services such as trade, teaching and government. Unit 24
thematic map	A map that shows one theme, such as trade or population. Unit 1
topographic map	A map that shows elevation, often with contours. Unit 1
urbanisation	The growth of towns and cities and the shift toward urban living. Unit 3
vassal	A person who receives land use in return for service to a lord. Unit 15
Viriathus	A Lusitanian leader who resisted Roman conquest in the second century BCE. Unit 10

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For teachers

This section is for the adult using the book. It states what was assumed, how the book is put together, and where its limits are.

Curriculum spine

This book follows the Year 8 brief *Civilisations, Empires and the Medieval World*. Central question: how do states, empires and networks develop? History and geography stay connected throughout. Portugal appears only inside the global story.

Parts

- 1 Geographical thinking (units 1 to 4)
- 2 Ancient Greece (5 to 7)
- 3 Alexander and the Hellenistic world (8)
- 4 Ancient Rome (9 to 13)
- 5 The medieval world (14 to 20)
- 6 Renaissance and maritime expansion (21 to 22)
- 7 Human geography and synthesis (23 to 27)

Assessment habits

- ✓ Demand place and cause in the same answer where the topic allows.
- ✓ Accept ranked multi-causal answers; reject single-cause slogans.
- ✓ Portugal panels: require person or place, geography link, and global link.
- ✓ QR codes: one unique destination per chapter, unique host, adult-supervised.

Sources and copyright

PDF/Input is scope and sequence only. Do not copy third-party continuous prose or illustrations. Factual chronology rests on standard reference consensus logged in the sources section of this book.

What this book does not do

It does not replace a full campaign history of any single war, nor a science course on climate physics. It teaches the geographical and historical links between states, empires and networks for Year 8.

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Where each term is taught, read off the printed pages of this edition. 57 entries.

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UNIT 27 AT A GLANCE

Globalisation

Enquiry. Are modern global links new, or old patterns made faster?

THE TOPICS YOU HAVE COVERED

- 27.1 What globalisation means
- 27.2 From Mediterranean trade to modern links
- 27.3 Year synthesis: geography, power and connection

WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

- ✓ Answer the unit enquiry with at least two pieces of evidence.
- ✓ Use one map skill or geographical term correctly in that answer.
- ✓ Explain how this unit connects to the year question: how states, empires and networks develop.
- ✓ State the year idea in one line: history happens somewhere.

THINK LIKE A HUMANITIES PUPIL

Name **what** you learned, **where** it sits on a map, and **why geography** priced a choice for people in power. If you can only do one of those three, return to that topic.

THE WORDS THIS UNIT TAUGHT

globalisation

network

synthesis

state

empire

QUICK REVISION

Cover the topic list. Say the 3 topic titles in order from memory, then uncover and check. For one topic, write a two-sentence answer using one keyword from the chips below.



Figure · Unit 27 revision image. Name two details you can see. Link each detail to one topic number above. What does the place in the picture help you explain about power or connection?

Go there. Measure it. Map it.

This Year 8 Student Book puts you in the field. You will learn what makes a fieldwork question answerable, choose methods and state their limitations honestly, and use GIS layers to reveal patterns no single map could show.

Written for Prime School pupils, in clear British English, with real places and real methods.

FIELDWORK

DATA

METHODS

GIS

MAPPING